THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp ★★★★★ FRIDAY, OCTOBER 16, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVIII NO. 91 WSJ.com U.S. Edition

DJIA 52177.69 ▲ 556.21 1.08% NASDAQ 26713.03 ▲ 0.1% STOXX 600 640.16 ▲ 0.4% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 25/32, yield 5.086% OIL $97.97 ▲ $2.88 GOLD $4,147.70 ▲ $62.90 EURO $1.1222 YEN 157.99

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** rose, with the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq gaining 0.3%, 1.1% and 0.1%, respectively. The yield on the 10-year U.S. Treasury note settled at 5.086%, down from 5.189% Wednesday. **B1**

◆ **Sales at U.S. retailers** rose in September, but at a slower pace than in August, Commerce Department data show. **A2**

◆ **Netflix's chief content** officer, Bela Bajaria, is leaving the company as it struggles to engage viewers and stimulate growth. She will be succeeded by Peter Rice. **B1**

◆ **Meta Platforms released** an open-weight artificial-intelligence model and is collaborating with Apple to run it locally on the company's high-end Mac computers. **B1**

◆ **TSMC raised the** prospect of additional U.S. manufacturing capacity beyond Arizona as demand for AI chips continues to outpace supply. **B4**

◆ **KFC struck a deal** to take on Coca-Cola as its beverage provider at thousands of U.S. restaurants in a blow to longtime supplier PepsiCo. **B3**

◆ **YouTube has had** discussions with publishers about developing an audiobook feature, an offering that could be ready next year. **B4**

◆ **Pernod Ricard said** it is preparing for a potential listing in India, looking to capitalize on growing demand there as sales fall in many of the group's other markets. **B3**

◆ **Ericsson shares** surged as investors cheered strong growth in sales of network gear, shrugging off a company warning that higher parts costs will impede profitability next year. **B4**

Worldwide

◆ **Progress toward a** U.S-Mexico tariff deal stalled after opposition from Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, the second time recently that he has had a hand in upending advanced negotiations with a North American partner. **A1**

◆ **The Justice Department** sued California in an attempt to block the state from counting mail-in ballots it receives from 20,000 people the Trump administration says may not be U.S. citizens. **A3**

◆ **The FBI said it was** investigating suspicious mailings sent to election offices across the country just weeks before the midterm elections. **A3**

◆ **Three children** and one teacher were killed in a shooting at an elementary school in Bend, Ore., and the 16-year-old suspect was shot and killed by a community member who followed the shooter into the school. **A3**

◆ **Republicans are** playing defense on an expanding electoral map, spending hundreds of millions of dollars in the final stretch to the midterms to prevent a Democratic takeover of Congress. **A1, A4**

◆ **Minnesota turned** into a political Rorschach test after two state flashpoints became nationalized and part of this year's midterm election debate. **A5**

◆ **Trump said the** execution by firing squad of condemned killer Nidal Hasan won't be livestreamed, reversing a decision by Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth. **A4**

◆ **The roof of a** school collapsed in Peshawar, Pakistan, killing at least 34 children and a teacher and injuring more than 50 people. **A6**

CONTENTS

Arts in Review.. A9,11
Business & Finance B2-3
Crossword..... A11
From Page One... A8
Heard on Street.. B10
Mansion..... M1-16
Markets..... B9
Money & Investing B10
Opinion..... A13-15
Sports..... A12
Technology..... B4
U.S. News..... A2-4
World News..... A5-7

This edition of THE WALL STREET JOURNAL was originally published in the United States and reprinted locally for regional distribution.

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Sky-High Fuel Prices Widen World's Growth Gap

JOHANNES CHRISTO/REUTERS

RUNNING ON EMPTY: Motorcyclists line up for gasoline Thursday in Indonesia, where high prices have sparked protests. Economic damage from the rising cost of fuel and of borrowing are stifling most countries while only those leading the AI boom grow. **A7**

Trump's Sudden Turn on Kyiv Triggers Confusion, Mistrust

In the early hours of Wednesday, Denys Sienik, the top Ukrainian diplomat in Washington, D.C., sent a frantic message to U.S. lawmakers:

*By **Robbie Gramer**, **Lindsay Wise** and **Marcus Walker***

Ukraine was suddenly facing restrictions on its military-grade Starlink terminals, and he didn't know why. The change, Sienik warned, would give Russia an upper hand in the war and make it tougher for Kyiv to intercept strikes.

Other Ukrainian officials were suspecting the worst: President Trump ordered Elon Musk, who owns the company that operates Starlink, to throttle Kyiv's access to the satellite systems. The suspicions, which haven't been confirmed, underscore the extent to which the U.S.-Ukraine relationship has soured as Trump presses to end the war.

On Thursday, Ukraine resumed strikes on Russian refineries after accusing Moscow of violating Trump's ceasefire on energy targets, and as its military regained full access to Starlink.

Long-range drones, which don't require Starlink connections, attacked Ryazan oil refinery, where a fire broke out, Russian officials said. The strike ended a dayslong pause in Ukrainian attacks on Russian energy infrastructure, during which Moscow repeatedly defied the Trump-imposed truce.

"That's it. The block is out," President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine said in an interview with the Financial Times published on Thursday, referring to Ukraine's moratorium on refinery strikes.

Ukraine hasn't officially claimed responsibility for the Ryazan attack.

Kyiv is navigating an increasingly fraught relationship with Washington. In recent

Please turn to page A6

◆ **Ukraine needs arms, intel only U.S. can provide..... A6**

Lutnick Snarls Tariff Pact With Mexico

Commerce secretary objects to significant cuts in levies on steel, aluminum and autos

By Gavin Bade And Santiago Pérez

Progress toward a U.S-Mexico tariff deal has stalled after opposition from Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, people familiar with the talks said, the second time recently that he has had a hand in upending advanced negotiations with a North American partner.

The U.S. and Mexico had been zeroing in on a deal that would reduce U.S. levies on steel, aluminum and automobiles in exchange for a series of concessions from Mexico, these people said, paving the way for further talks on renewing the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement.

Mexican officials and many corporate executives expressed optimism that a deal was close, they said.

But in recent days, progress toward a deal has slowed considerably, the people said, because of disagreements over the U.S. tariffs on vehicles and metals, which are imposed on national-security grounds and are administered by Lutnick's department.

Lutnick has opposed significant reductions in the 25% tariff on Mexican automobiles and the 50% tariff on steel and aluminum, the people said. Also on metals, he has objected to reductions in tariffs on so-called derivative products—finished products made of steel and aluminum. Domestic aluminum companies have told the administration that any reduction in these levies would undermine U.S.

Please turn to page A2

OpenAI Suspect Kept Ties To Saudis

By Maxwell Zeff And Abeer Ayyoub

When Saudi Arabia's Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman appeared at an event in Silicon Valley with young Saudi tech workers in the summer of 2016, a new graduate from Massachusetts Institute of Technology was looking for guidance on whether to return to his homeland.

Prince Mohammed told the group that the better strategy was to hone skills in the U.S. before coming back to the kingdom, the young graduate, named Abdulrahman Alfozan, recalled in a recently released podcast interview.

"You learn from the source and then, God willing, bring that experience and knowledge back to the homeland," Alfozan said.

A decade later—after stints at Meta Platforms and a startup backed by Andreessen Horowitz—Alfozan allegedly booked one-way plane tickets to Saudi Arabia from San Francisco for himself, his spouse and a family member.

Three days before he was to depart, he was arrested by the Federal Bureau of Investigation and charged with trying to record secret conversations within his latest employer, OpenAI, which fired him that day.

Federal prosecutors allege the 35-year-old Alfozan had spent weeks scoping out an executive conference room inside an OpenAI office building

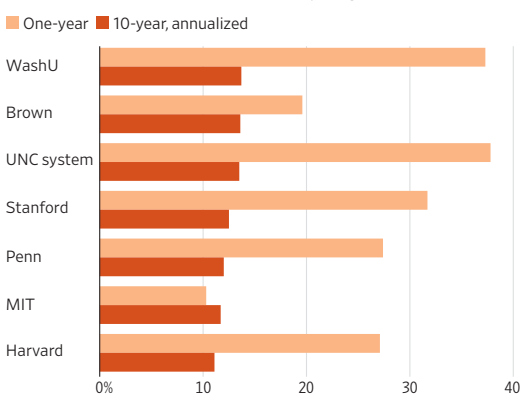
Please turn to page A2

◆ **AI giants' cat-and-mouse game with spies..... B1**

SpaceX, AI Lift Endowments

U.S. college and university endowments are having their strongest returns in five years thanks in part to gains from SpaceX and bets on artificial intelligence. **A3**

Endowment returns over one- and 10-year periods



Note: Returns are for fiscal years ended June 30, 2026. Universities including Dartmouth, Princeton and Yale have not yet reported.
Source: the schools

Has Britain Lost Its Mojo? Exhibit A Is Oxford's New Bridge.

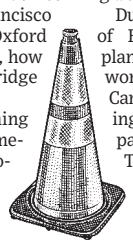
* * *

'Ludicrously ugly' structure took longer to build than Eiffel Tower—and cost more

By Joanna Sugden

OXFORD, England—Venice has the Rialto. San Francisco has its Golden Gate. Oxford has the...wait a minute, how much did that new bridge cost?

This city of dreaming spires has lit the Promethean flame under poets and artists for centuries, but its latest architectural offering—20-yard rail and foot bridges connecting Oxford Station over Botley Road—has underwhelmed. Especially as the structures cost over a quarter of a billion dollars, and, to some, are giving nothing but "loveless ugliness."



Slow zone

During more than a decade of Britain's tinkering and planning, China built the world's highest bridge and Canada forged a river crossing to the U.S. In centuries past, the British built the Titanic in less time and for less money. The French erected the Eiffel Tower more quickly and cheaply, even after adjusting for inflation.

Detractors say it's Exhibit A that Britain has lost its mojo.

Please turn to page A8

GOP Midterm Angst Rises as Map Widens

By Sabrina Rodriguez And Olivia Beavers

WASHINGTON—Republicans are playing defense on an expanding electoral map, spending hundreds of millions of dollars in the final stretch of the midterms to prevent a Democratic takeover of Congress as campaigns nationwide reach a fever pitch.

With less than three weeks until the election, deep-pocketed GOP groups are trying to push candidates over the finish line, while President Trump and Vice President JD Vance are crisscrossing the country to shore up Republican support in red areas that seemed unassailable just months ago.

Democrats, working to capitalize on Trump's weak approval ratings and economic concerns amid the war with Iran, have expanded their target map into more Republican-leaning territory. That has forced Republicans to pour in huge sums to defend traditionally safe red seats, while attempting to pick off some seats in purple states such as Michigan and New Hampshire to help stanch potential losses.

In the waning days of campaign season, Republicans hope money and structural advantages in the electoral map will

Please turn to page A4

◆ **Jump in gasoline prices hits battleground states..... A4**

Tether Steered Funds To Firms of Trump Crypto Adviser

Bo Hines crafted stablecoin legislation

By Sam Kessler

Lawmakers and executives crowded into the East Room of the White House in July 2025 to watch President Trump sign the Genius Act, a landmark crypto bill that set rules for selling stablecoins pegged to the U.S. dollar.

From a podium, Trump rattled off thank-yous to the law's architects. "Where's Bo Hines?" he asked. The president's 29-year-old crypto adviser rose from the front row to applause.

What most people in the room didn't know: While Hines was leading the White House's push to pass the Genius Act, Tether—the company with the most at stake in the legislation—was steering millions of dollars to a business he co-owned, according to messages, internal documents and payment records reviewed by The Wall Street Journal.

Hines exchanged Signal messages showing that while he was in the White House, he took part in a group chat with his company partners,

Please turn to page A8

U.S. NEWS

Lutnick Snarls Pact With Mexico

Continued from Page One

firms and cost U.S. jobs.

Officials on both sides said the talks are continuing and denied there was any impasse. "There's progress in the negotiations, and we maintain a constructive relationship with the Department of Commerce," Mexico's Deputy Trade Minister Luis Rosendo Gutiérrez said in an interview.

"The Commerce Department remains in constant dialogue with Mexico on trade," department spokesman Ben Kass said, and it "is committed to advancing President Trump's America First trade agenda."

Lutnick's position on the tariffs is a significant obstacle to a deal after months of negotiations led by U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer, the people familiar with the talks said.

Mexico and Canada are the U.S.'s two largest national trading partners and are the top buyers of U.S. goods. The continuing disagreements over the vehicle and metals tariffs weakens the momentum to conclude a deal before next month's midterm elections in the U.S., throwing the future of their extensive trading relationship into further doubt.

Lutnick's intervention is a sign that he has again asserted himself in President Trump's trade agenda after being sidelined for most of 2026. At the beginning of Trump's second term, Lutnick played a key role in imposing tariffs and negotiating trade deals with nations like Japan, South Korea and the European Union. But in recent months, Greer became more prominent, in part because many trading partners preferred his lawyerly approach to the aggressive negotiating style of Lutnick, a billionaire former Wall Street executive.

A senior Mexican official said that every time both sides get close to a deal, the Trump administration brings up something else that it wants.

At a news conference on Tuesday, President Claudia Sheinbaum of Mexico said the sides haven't reached an agreement despite significant progress in talks over the past year. Trump, a Republican, has demanded that Mexico buy more U.S. goods to narrow the U.S.'s widening trade gap with its southern neighbor. Sheinbaum said the U.S. had a list of 54 tariff and nontariff concerns that it wanted to address. That list had shrunk to about a dozen issues in the latest rounds of negotiations.

The continuing difficulties in U.S. talks with Mexico recall a similar falling-out with Canadian officials. In August, the U.S. and Canada walked away from the negotiating table after Lutnick objected to proposed tariff reductions on steel, aluminum and autos.

The breakdown in talks led the U.S. to impose new levies on $20 billion of Canadian goods,

ALEX BRANDON/AP

Commerce Secretary Lutnick

which Canada retaliated against with levies of its own, leading the U.S. to ban some imports of Canadian alcohol and other products. The conflict continues to simmer, with Trump pledging to double tariffs on Canadian autos to 50% in January if a deal can't be reached.

Mexico has taken a more conciliatory approach, refraining from imposing retaliatory measures and engaging in talks, with Sheinbaum at times joining conversations with Greer and Lutnick.

In recent talks between the U.S. and Mexico, major automotive firms in both the U.S. and Mexico have complained about the Byzantine process that Lutnick has imposed on Mexican and Canadian cars coming into the U.S.

U.S. tariffs on Mexican automobiles stand at 25%, but companies can earn rebates from the levies based on the value of U.S.-made car components. Claiming those refunds requires extensive paperwork and approval from the Commerce Department, which can deny the requests.

Tariffs on Japanese and South Korean automobiles stand at 15% under the terms of trade deals that Lutnick helped shape last year. The difference in tariff rates, along with the extensive red tape involved in tracing U.S.-made components, has led some firms to shift production from North America to Asia, representatives from automakers told the negotiators.

Overseas, the companies can source metals and components from China and other low-cost economies without the sourcing rules in USMCA, or the difficulties of the refund process.

Throughout the talks, the Mexican government has pushed for tariff rates of 15% or lower, as well as a broader rebate program that would allow content from all three USMCA nations to qualify for tariff refunds, but the sides have yet to come to an agreement.

Mexico wants better terms than the rest of the world, especially considering the significant concessions being asked of Mexico, such as purchasing more U.S.-made products or imposing additional tariffs on China.

"You cannot be treated the same as everyone else when you are asked to undertake systemic changes," said Juan Carlos Baker, Mexico's former deputy trade minister who led Mexico's trade team during USMCA negotiations in Trump's first term.

NYC Comptroller Defends Decision On Israeli Bonds

By James Fanelli

New York City Comptroller Mark Levine on Thursday defended his decision not to use the city's pension funds to invest in Israeli bonds, after the Jewish Democrat faced mounting criticism for backtracking on a key campaign promise.

Levine, who controls how some $2 billion of the city's pension funds are invested, has faced backlash since he said in an interview earlier in the week that he would opt not to purchase the bonds. Some Jewish leaders accused him of breaking a pledge he made during last year's comptroller race to restart buying Israeli bonds and said it could add further fuel to a rise in antisemitism.

The comptroller, who serves as the city's fiscal hawk, said in a social-media post on Thursday that politics didn't influence his decision. He reached his conclusion, he said, after an internal analysis by his office found the bonds weren't a sound financial investment, especially during a time of conflict in the region.

"I expressed my deep appreciation for the Israel-NYC economic relationship during my campaign for comptroller, and that appreciation remains unchanged," Levine said. "I also pledged to make every investment decision free of politics, based solely on its financial merits and my fiduciary responsibility to 750,000 current and future retirees."

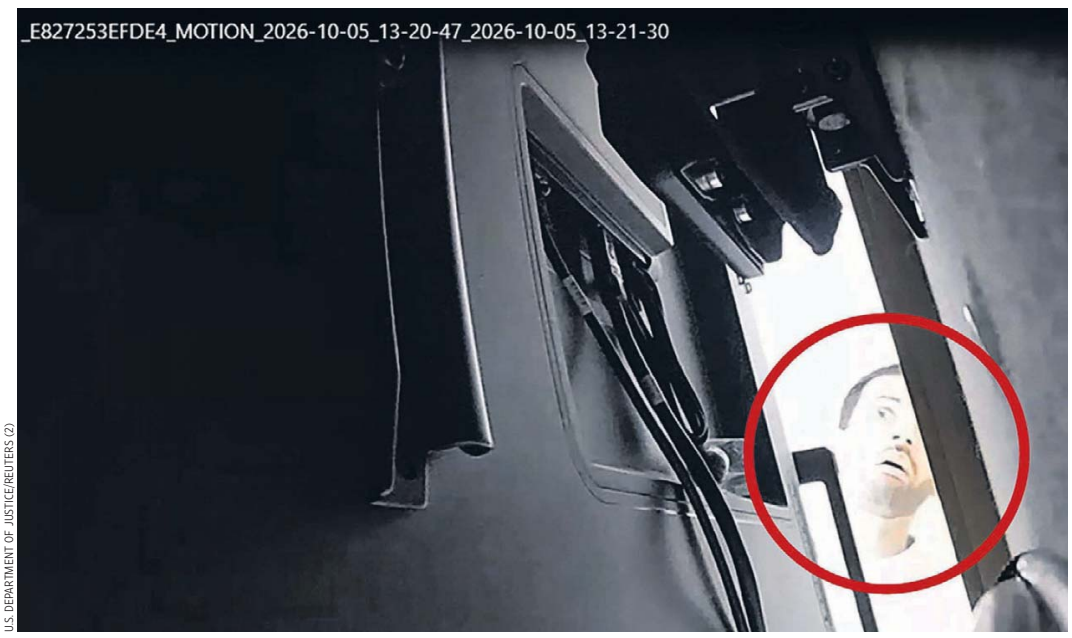
Israel's war in Gaza played a high-profile role in last year's elections in New York City, including the mayoral race. Mayor Zohran Mamdani, a Democratic socialist, has been a fierce critic of Israel, accusing its government of genocide and calling for the arrest of its prime minister, Benjamin Netanyahu. The mayor has stuck to the rhetoric despite drawing rebuke from Jewish leaders, who say his words have made members of their community less safe.

Mamdani said at an unrelated press conference on Wednesday that he supported Levine's decision. "We don't purchase the bonds of any other sovereign nation," he said. "I don't think that we should make an exception when it comes to Israel."

Ofir Akunis, consul general of Israel in New York, said Levine's decision was misguided and would end up hurting the city's economy. "The fact that Mayor Mamdani welcomed this decision speaks volumes," Akunis said. "This decision will only further fuel antisemitism in New York City."

Levine's comments in the New York Times interview drew victory cheers from supporters of the pro-Palestinian campaign known as Boycott, Divestment and Sanctions, which has pressed over the past year to end city investment in the bonds.

"This is a political earthquake," anti-Zionist group Jewish Voice for Peace said. "In the most Jewish city in the country, New Yorkers have made it clear that it's no longer politically or financially viable to pledge unconditional support for the Israeli military and government."



U.S. DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE/REUTERS (2)

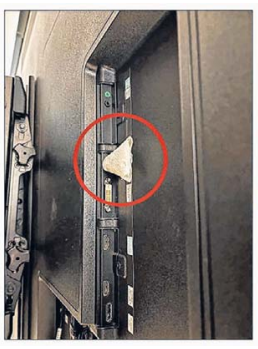
An image from a surveillance video, above, shows a man identified as Abdulrahman Alfozan, an OpenAI engineer suspected of placing a recording device behind a television in a conference room at the company's headquarters in San Francisco.

Suspect Kept Ties To Saudis

Continued from Page One

where top-secret meetings about industry-leading AI models and products took place. The complaint alleges Alfozan wanted to record what was being said behind those closed doors on an encrypted device wrapped in toilet paper.

"This arrest highlights our relentless efforts in partnership with the FBI to identify and prosecute those who seek to steal our technology," U.S. Attorney for the Northern



District of California Craig Missakian said. "For us, it is a matter of national security."

William Pernik, a lawyer representing Alfozan, said his client was charged with violating a federal recording statute, "not stealing trade secrets or working as a foreign agent," and asked for "everyone to withhold judgment until full facts become known."

Alfozan "came to this country years ago as a young person with a dream," Pernik said. "He spent years studying, working and contributing to an American technological sector that leads the world, a sector built in large part by immigrants like him."

A representative of Saudi Arabia's Embassy in Washington, D.C., declined to comment.

Alfozan grew up in an eastern province of Saudi Arabia, where his father was a lecturer at a technical college, he said in the podcast interview. Early on, he took an interest in computers, and, he said, in high school programmed custom real-estate software for his uncles.

He said his first visit to the U.S. was in 2008, to Dallas, as part of a math-olympiad program, which sparked his interest in studying abroad. In high school, he also toured U.S. universities. "I met people here and realized, 'This is a field I'd really enjoy,' " Alfozan said in the podcast interview.

Alfozan started at Facebook in 2017 as a systems engineer, working on some of the company's most popular open-source software projects. At a 2019 conference in Amsterdam, Alfozan delivered a talk on how Facebook used an open-source tool internally to build custom software applications.

During his time in Silicon Valley, Alfozan regularly visited Saudi Arabia, he said in the podcast, and kept close ties to tech-centric communities in the region. In November 2018, he spoke at an event hosted by "Riyadh Data Geeks" on data technologies. In 2020, he delivered a talk on machine learning, video-calling in from California for a group called "PyData Riyadh."

"I've been working with various Saudi startups for years, acting as an adviser or mentor," Alfozan said in the podcast interview.

In 2020, Alfozan became a legal permanent resident in the U.S., and in 2022 joined the San Francisco-based logistics startup Nash, which connects businesses with third-party couriers. While working at Nash, Alfozan started an online program with University of California, Berkeley. He and five classmates completed a project that used AI to predict the locations and arrival times of cargo ships.

Since early 2025, Alfozan has been a venture partner at Saudi-based investment firm Raed Ventures, according to the firm's website. Another partner at the firm since that time is Prince Khalid Bin Bader Al Saud, a member of the royal family, the website says.

Alfozan joined OpenAI in July 2025, the company said. He was an engineering lead on the product team, working on an open-source tool kit that allows third-party developers to build AI agents. He committed code to the project's public GitHub repository as recently as last week. That same day, a camera placed by investigators caught what federal prosecutors said is Alfozan peering behind a television set where they claim he had placed a recording device a week earlier.

CORRECTIONS & AMPLIFICATIONS

Bank of America chief investment strategist Michael Hartnett recommends selling global equities when fund managers' average cash levels drop below 4%. He offers the same recommendation when BofA's Bull & Bear Indicator rises above 8; it's now at 8.1. A Heard on the Street article Thursday incorrectly said he recommended selling when average cash levels dropped below 5%, and when BofA's indicator rose above 5, and that it was at 5.1.

Readers can alert The Wall Street Journal to any errors in news articles by emailing **wsjcontact@wsj.com** or by calling 888-762-5450.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL

(USPS 664-880) (Eastern Edition ISSN 0099-9660) (Central Edition ISSN 1092-0935) (Western Edition ISSN 0193-2241)

Editorial and publication headquarters: 1211 Avenue of the Americas, New York, N.Y. 10036

Published daily except Sundays and general legal holidays. Periodicals postage paid at New York, N.Y., and other mailing offices.

Postmaster: Send address changes to The Wall Street Journal, 200 Burnett Rd., Chicopee, MA 01020.

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U.S. Retail Sales Expanded In September but at a Slower Pace Than Previous Month

Sales at U.S. retailers rose in September, but at a slower pace than in August, according to Commerce Department data released on Thursday.

Retailers' sales rose by 0.8% last month to $745 billion, slowing from the upwardly revised 1.3% pace recorded in August. September's reading was higher than the 0.4% increase economists polled by The Wall Street Journal expected.

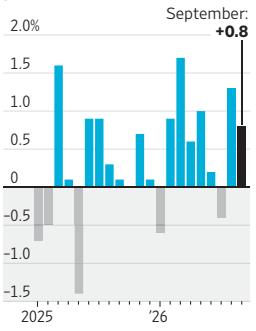
Retail sales numbers are recorded in nominal terms and account for the total number of dollars spent, regardless of inflation. In September, the consumer-price index accelerated more than expected to 3.7% on a 12-month basis, from 3.4%.

Sales except autos rose 0.9% in September, also higher than 0.5% in the Journal consensus. Sales ex-autos and gas rose 0.2%.

The September retail sales report adds to indications that U.S. economic growth remains resilient, potentially supporting the argument that the Federal Reserve has room to keep interest rates elevated to fight inflation.

—Paulo Trevisani

U.S. retail sales, change from previous month



Note: Seasonally adjusted
Source: Commerce Department

Wholesale Inflation Index Climbed 1.3% In September, Biggest Advance in Years

The producer-price index rose by 1.3% last month, versus a 0.4% increase in August. It is the index's largest advance since March 2022. Economists polled by The Wall Street Journal were expecting a more modest 0.6% increase.

Over the 12 months through September, producer-price inflation was 6.3%, marking the fastest wholesale inflation rate since December 2022.

The September report bolsters the case for the Federal Reserve to raise rates again when its rate-setting committee convenes this month.

Officials have said in recent weeks that they're keeping an open mind about the future path of interest rates and would let economic data guide their decision-making.

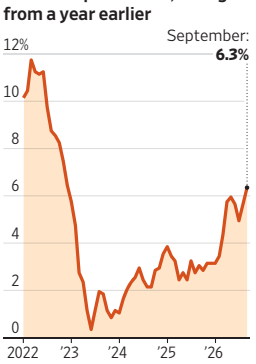
The producer-price index can serve as something of a bellwether for the Fed's policy direction. A portion of its data is used alongside consumer-inflation numbers to calculate the price index of personal-consumption expenditures, the Fed's preferred inflation metric.

The Labor Department said Wednesday that consumer inflation was hotter than expected in September, driven by high energy prices that appear to be filtering into other parts of the economy. Core prices, which strip out food and energy, grew faster than anticipated, too.

"If the September PPI report also surprises to the upside, it could tip the balance toward a hike at the meeting," Bill Adams, an economist at Fifth Third Commercial Bank, said Wednesday.

—Dean Seal

Producer-price index, change from a year earlier



Source: Labor Department

Four Are Killed in School Shooting in Oregon

Suspect was a 16-year-old who was shot to death by a community member

By Joseph Pisani

Three children and one teacher were killed in a shooting at an elementary school in Bend, Ore., on Thursday, local police said.

The suspect, a 16-year-old who lived in Bend, was shot and killed by a community member who followed the shooter into Silver Rail Elementary School, police said.

The children who were killed were ages 5, 8 and 11, Bend Police Chief Mike Krantz said at a news conference Thursday night.

Two people were also critically injured and taken to a hospital: a 7-year-old child and a 54-year-old teacher, Krantz said.

"We are heartbroken. We are horrified," said Steven Cook, superintendent of the Bend-La Pine Schools district, which includes Silver Rail Elementary. The school has more than 400 students in kindergarten through fifth grade.

Police said they were called about 1 p.m. local time to the school, with reports of a shooter firing into a car. Minutes later, emergency calls were made about a shooter inside the school, police said.

The suspect fired at locked doors to enter Silver Rail, Krantz said, describing the weapon used as a long gun, but declining to specify the type. He said police were still investigating whether the shooter knew anyone at the school or had attended it at one point.

Police didn't identify the community member who stopped the shooter.

Oregon Gov. Tina Kotek said the person "heroically intervened to stop further loss of life."

"Your actions carry a heavy emotional burden," she said at the news conference. "And I just want you to know my thoughts are with you."

JOE KLINE/AP

Police tape is placed outside Silver Rail Elementary School, where a shooting took place, on Thursday in Bend, Ore.

Watch a Video

Scan this code to watch authorities describe the school shooting.

SpaceX, AI Bets Propel College Endowments

By Juliet Chung

University endowments are notching their strongest returns in five years thanks in part to gains from SpaceX and other artificial-intelligence bets, with Harvard becoming the latest school to report a gain of more than 20%.

Harvard on Thursday reported a 27.1% gain by its endowment for the fiscal year ended June 30, swelling the endowment's coffers to almost $68 billion. Other big winners include the University of North Carolina system, which gained 37.8%—about half of that from SpaceX; Washington University in St. Louis, which gained 37.3%; and Stanford, which gained 31.7% in its main investment vehicle.

"You either had SpaceX or you didn't," said Greg Dowling of Fund Evaluation Group, an investment advisory firm whose clients include endowments.

The Massachusetts Institute of Technology's endowment was among those with more modest returns, with a 10.3% gain.

A spokeswoman didn't return requests for comment on the endowment's exposure to SpaceX or other venture hits.

U.S. college and university endowments have returned a median of 16.1% this past fiscal year, according to early data from Cambridge Associates. A portfolio made up of 70% global stocks and 30% high-quality U.S. bonds—a typical benchmark for endowments—gained 17.9%.

SpaceX was among the most widely held investments across schools, according to endowment executives, making its record-breaking initial public offering one of the great windfalls for American endowments. While its market cap has fallen closer to earth from its post-IPO peak, that has done little to diminish endowments' returns because of how its valuation soared in recent years.

Endowments fund a portion of school operating budgets and pay for financial aid, research and teaching salaries. They typically invest in a mix of public and private assets and have long-term investment horizons.

Harvard disclosed in an August regulatory filing that it had a $2.2 billion direct stake in SpaceX as of June 30; it also had exposure via managers including Thrive Capital and Valor Equity Partners, according to people familiar with the matter. Other investments, including in biotech funds and multistrategy hedge funds, also paid off.

"This was an exceptional year, at an important moment," Harvard endowment chief N.P. "Narv" Narvekar wrote in his annual letter, saying the gains would support Harvard as it "continues to navigate significant challenges."

One such challenge: a higher tax on a handful of research universities' net investment income that was included in Trump's big tax bill and kicks in for the 2027 fiscal year. Harvard executives wrote that the increase, from 1.4% to 8%, would cost the university about $300 million annually and would be "several times larger" in a year like this last one.

Stefan Strein recently became head of UNC Management Co., which manages endowments for schools in the UNC System. He said at a September UNC Chapel Hill trustees meeting that it made an initial investment with a venture-capital fund in 2009 and, "17 years later, we are now harvesting an enormous gain."

SpaceX and semiconductor company Cerebras Systems made up roughly half of WashU's gain, said Scott Wilson, investment chief of the school's endowment.

The endowment had at least a midteens percentage of its portfolio in Elon Musk's rocket-and-satellite company earlier this year, an unusually large bet for an endowment.

Despite endowments' longer-term gains, higher education is facing challenges including inflation, dropping enrollment and the loss of research funds, said Margaret Chen, global head of Cambridge's endowments and foundations practice.

"All these things still put a lot of pressure on higher education—but listen, you take it where you can," she said.

CASSANDRA KLOS/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Harvard's endowment fund grew 27.1% in the latest fiscal year.

DOJ Sues California To Block 20,000 Ballots

By Louise Radnofsky

The Justice Department sued California Thursday in an attempt to block the state from counting mail-in ballots it receives from 20,000 people the Trump administration says may not be U.S. citizens.

The lawsuit, filed in federal court in central California, is a significant extension of the administration's efforts to expand federal control over elections. It comes less than three weeks before a critical midterm election that will determine control of Congress for the remainder of President Trump's term.

The administration is asking for an injunction that would stop California from tabulating mail ballots from 20,000 individuals it has identified as "likely noncitizens until those individuals' citizenship status can be verified."

Voting is already under way in California, where every active registered voter receives a mail-in ballot. The state is one of eight that allows all elections to be conducted entirely by mail. Trump has long railed against mail-in voting, saying it is open to manipulation. In June, he also cast doubt on California's primary results, focusing on the slow vote-counting process there.

The Trump administration has alleged for months that some states have noncitizens on their voter rolls.

"We provided California an opportunity to self correct its records," Attorney General Todd Blanche said after the lawsuit was filed. "California has refused to comply."

California's secretary of state, Shirley Weber, who is named as a defendant in the lawsuit, has been trading increasingly angry letters with the Justice Department in recent days, saying a list it has been circulating of approximately 20,000 names "lacks both the detail and function to be of any investigative use," and that the federal government has never explained its basis for suspecting that people on the list are noncitizens.

"This is an emergency of the DOJ's creation," she said in a reply sent shortly before the lawsuit was filed.

States compile and maintain voter rolls, so only they have complete information about who is registered and casts ballots.

Maduro Denies Torture Allegations

JANE ROSENBERG/REUTERS

Former Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro said in court on Thursday that newly unsealed torture allegations against him and his wife were "false accusations."

Maduro and Cilia Flores, both shackled at the ankles, were brought to court to face a rewritten indictment that expands on an initial set of drug trafficking charges to accuse them of leading a state-sponsored repression campaign that tortured scores of victims, including three Americans.

Maduro twice defied a judge's request that he enter a plea to the charges, instead condemning them through a courtroom interpreter as "false accusations and false testimony." Irked, Judge Alvin K. Hellerstein took matters into his own hands, interjecting that "a plea of not guilty will be entered on behalf of Mr. Maduro."

Flores told the judge through a Spanish interpreter: "I am completely innocent. I am not guilty."

They were seized from their Caracas home by the U.S. military in a nighttime raid in January. Their trial will begin June 14, 2027, two weeks later than previously set, as per a schedule approved by the judge Thursday.

According to the rewritten indictment, Maduro oversaw a violent torture system that beat, asphyxiated, and delivered electric shocks to its victims. He is accused of personally recommending torture methods, receiving updates on specific victims' treatment, and threatening to kill one prisoner's child as a form of psychological torture.

Flores, 70, helped develop the repressive system and ordered the torture of some specific people, the indictment alleges.

—Associated Press

FBI Is Investigating Substances Mailed To Election Offices

By Victoria Albert

The Federal Bureau of Investigation said it is investigating suspicious mailings—some containing an "unknown substance"—sent to election offices across the country, just weeks before midterm elections.

The letters were sent to addresses including secretary of state offices and related election offices, the bureau said Thursday. On a statewide level, secretaries of state are usually tasked with running elections.

The FBI said authorities were working to identify the people responsible for the mailings.

The bureau added it was working on the investigation with the U.S. Postal Inspection Service. The inspection service referred a request for comment to the FBI.

The FBI didn't disclose the individual locations that received the mailings. However, several states reported suspicious mailings this week.

On Tuesday, an employee at the Louisiana secretary of state's office in Baton Rouge was taken to the emergency room as a precaution after opening a letter containing white powder, a spokesperson said.

Law enforcement conducted tests and found no evidence of harmful substances.

Oklahoma's State Election Board also received an envelope on Tuesday containing a "suspicious white powder," according to board secretary Paul Ziriax.

Ohio Secretary of State Frank LaRose said Wednesday that his office had been the intended recipient of a suspicious mailing "that contained a powdery white substance." Investigators with the U.S. Postal Service preempted the letter's delivery, LaRose said.

The National Association of Secretaries of State and the National Association of State Election Directors said they were alarmed by reports of the mailings. "Threats against election officials and workers have no place in our democracy," the groups said in a joint statement. "Those who administer our elections should never fear for their safety while carrying out their essential duties."

line Price Rise Hits Hard me Battleground States

portation costs. At the same time, people in rural states tend to consume more gasoline because they drive bigger vehicles over longer distances. That means they are more exposed to rising prices.

Researchers at Brown estimated the typical household's increased cost for each state by looking at both per capita gas consumption and the increase in local prices. The results show a disproportionate hit to the heartland—including key battleground states in coming Senate races.

Of the nine states where The Wall Street Journal's election tracker lists this year's Senate race as a tossup or merely leaning toward one party, seven saw household gasoline costs rise faster this year than the U.S. average: Iowa, Kansas, Maine, Michigan, New Hampshire, North Carolina and Texas.

Meanwhile, populous coastal states such as California and New York have seen bills rise more slowly than the U.S. as a whole. Both states saw prices at the pump rise faster than the national average, but because households there consume less gas than the rest of the country they haven't felt the impact as much.

Inflation is a top concern for voters going into the midterms.

"The big driver is really much more about consumption patterns," said Jeff Colgan, director of the Climate Solutions Lab.

Surveys show that inflation is a top concern for voters going into the midterms. Nationally, gas prices were up 34% over the past year and fuel oil prices were up 74% in September, according to the Labor Department.

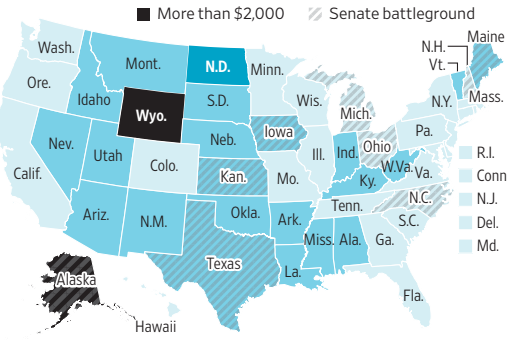
President Trump, who on the 2024 campaign trail promised to lower prices "starting on day one," has seen his approval rating fall to historic lows since the start of the Iran war. Anger over the rising cost of living is one of the factors that have turned once solidly Republican states like Kansas and Texas competitive.

Gasoline prices tell only half the story. Costs for diesel fuel have increased even more.

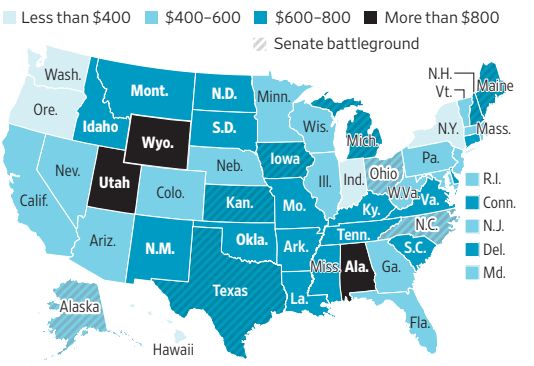
The burden, again, falls heavily on agricultural regions, where the fuel is used to power tractors, combines and trucks. Wyoming led the pack with an additional per-household cost of $2,239 due to higher diesel prices—almost five times the national average—closely followed by the key Senate swing state of Alaska at $2,167.

Swing states Iowa, Kansas, Maine, New Hampshire and Texas were also hit harder by rising diesel prices than the country as a whole.

Estimated additional household expenditure on diesel since start of Iran war, by state



Estimated additional household expenditure on gasoline since start of Iran war, by state*



*Data as of Oct. 15. Data show estimates for regular unleaded gas.
Source: Brown University

Becomes Bright Spot for GOP

FROM TOP: SOPHIE PARK/GETTY IMAGES; JOSEPH PREZIOSO/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

New Hampshire Republican Gov. Kelly Ayotte at Oktoberfest festival. Below, Cinde Warmington.

a majority on the state's executive council while flipping a competitive U.S. Senate seat.

"There's no question that the Ayotte campaign has got a special sauce that they've put together to be very effective in what I think is otherwise going to be a very good year for Democrats around the country," said Jim Merrill, a longtime Republican strategist in New Hampshire.

Democrats have controlled federal offices in New Hampshire for the past decade, and the state has voted Democratic in every presidential election since 2004. Ayotte, who won

her single Senate term in 2010, is the last New Hampshire Republican to serve in the Senate, and Democrats have controlled the two House seats for the past decade.

The state's Republicans are hoping Ayotte can help former Sen. John E. Sununu in his Senate battle against Democratic Rep. Chris Pappas. Polls have shown Pappas with a slight lead against Sununu, who is attempting to recapture the seat of retiring Democratic Sen. Jeanne Shaheen.

A recent AARP poll offered a window into the potential for ticket-splitting. In the race for governor, the poll found Ayotte at 52% and Warmington at 45%, with 3% undecided. In the Senate race, Pappas had an edge with 51% and Sununu at 44%, with 5% undecided.

Execution Livestream Canceled After Criticism

By Lara Seligman And Josh Dawsey

WASHINGTON—President Trump said the execution by firing squad of Nidal Hasan, a former officer who admitted to killing 13 people in a 2009 shooting at Fort Hood Army base in Texas, won't be livestreamed, reversing a decision by Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth.

In a Thursday social-media post, Trump called Hasan "a very bad and evil man," and said he thought "streaming the execution for all to see might have been a strong deterrent for the World to witness how America deals with Terrorists and SCUM like Hasan."

But, he said, "many very good and well meaning people would rather not watch him die, through streaming, or through any other visual device."

"He will die, as scheduled, by firing squad, but this event won't be streamed," Trump said, noting that immediate families of the victims could choose to view the event in person.

Trump made the decision after talking to White House advisers and other allies in recent days, expressing concern about a bloody spectacle on live television.

Hasan is paralyzed from the waist down from injuries sustained in his attack, and some U.S. officials worried that livestreaming his death would be a propaganda victory for adversaries. Lawmakers from both parties have also expressed concerns.

Even some of Trump's closest allies had questioned the decision. Vice President JD Vance cast doubt last week on whether the livestream would happen and said he wouldn't watch it if it did.

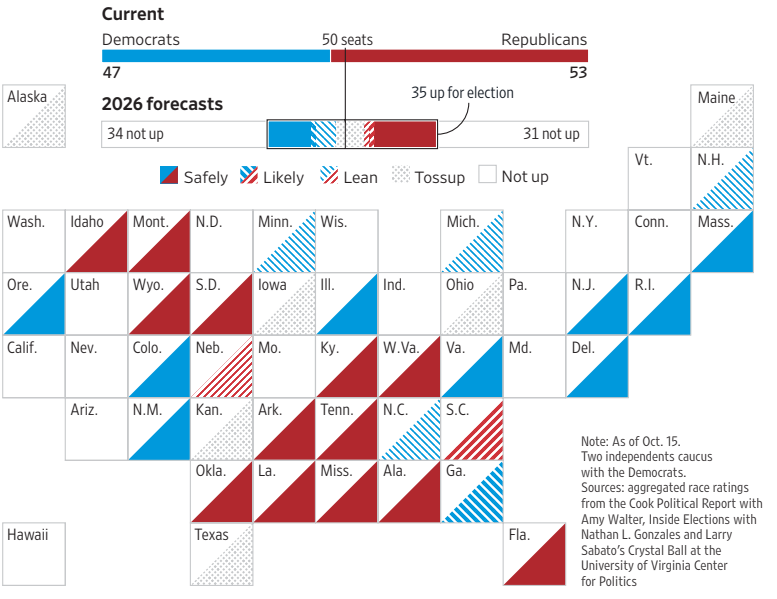
House Speaker Mike Johnson (R., La.) told CBS News there were concerns that footage of the execution would become a "recruiting tool for future terrorists."

The cancellation is a rebuke to Hegseth, who had said the event would be public. Hegseth told a conservative news outlet he had wanted to ensure "people are able to watch it" because "people need to understand that there's serious consequences for these types of things."

Hegseth's comments sent Army officials, who had been planning for Hasan's execution by lethal injection, scrambling to figure out how to carry out the event, Army and Pentagon officials said.

Hasan, a U.S.-born Muslim who worked as a psychiatrist, said during his court-martial that he went on a shooting rampage at Fort Hood, wounding 32 in addition to the 13 killed, because he believed the military was at war with Islam.

Senate seats



Note: As of Oct. 15. Two independents caucus with the Democrats.
Sources: aggregated race ratings from the Cook Political Report with Amy Walter, Inside Elections with Nathan L. Gonzales and Larry Sabato's Crystal Ball at the University of Virginia Center for Politics

early voting record Tuesday, with more than 188,000 ballots cast in person, beating the record set in the 2022 midterms, the secretary of state's office said. Georgia, a battleground state, has competitive Senate and governor races.

Trump plans to be in Georgia on Friday to boost Rep. Mike Collins, a Republican, in his bid to unseat Sen. Jon Ossoff, a Democrat. He rallied Wednesday in Arizona, where there are competitive House and governor races, and he had stops this week in Ohio and Alaska to try to shore up the campaigns of GOP Sens. Jon Husted and Dan Sullivan, respectively.

Trump is to campaign next week in North Carolina, where redistricting is making at least one GOP incumbent more vulnerable. Rep. Greg Murphy is facing a more competitive race than expected after his district lost Republican voters, following map changes that were meant to boost GOP fortunes.

On Tuesday, Senate candidates from races in Georgia, Maine and Iowa faced off in debates. Ossoff, the Georgia Democrat, and Sen. Susan Collins of Maine, a Republican, are fighting to keep their seats—and Iowa is an open race. Collins and her Democratic opponent Troy Jackson faced off again on Thursday night.

Big Spend, No Gain?

Republicans are flexing their money advantage over Democrats and throwing hundreds of millions of dollars into races across the country. Still, polls haven't shown significant shifts in high-profile contests since more money started pumping in, with key Senate races largely unchanged.

"What we need to see is those ad dollars transferring into voter enthusiasm," said Mark Bednar, a Republican strategist, pointing out a consistent voter enthusiasm gap between Democratic and Republican voters. "Republican voters need to get excited in this final stretch."

Republicans entered this election cycle with a significant advantage on money.

GOP advertisers have outspent Democrats by almost $298 million across eight competitive Senate races—Ohio, Texas, Maine, Michigan, Iowa, Alaska, New Hampshire and Kansas, according to a new report from ad-tracking firm AdImpact.

The Senate race in Ohio between Husted and former Sen. Sherrod Brown, a Democrat, is the most expensive Senate general election this cycle in terms of ad spending, with more than $422 million spent, the report found.

The matchup between Democratic state Rep. James Talarico and Republican state Attorney General Ken Paxton in Texas came in second—and is one where Republicans are significantly outspending Democrats. Outside Republican groups have poured in over $209 million in the general election, the report found. Much of that money is coming from Texas PAC, a political-action committee run by the Senate Leadership Fund, the big-donor group aligned with Senate Republicans.

Last week, the Senate Leadership Fund shifted more money toward the Texas Senate race. Rather than working to rehabilitate Paxton's image, as he has faced a number of legal and ethical scandals, Republican spending has focused on trying to tear down Talarico, according to a Republican working on Senate races.

More competition

Despite the aggressive Republican spending in both Senate and House races, Democrats have sought to expand their map of target races.

In a donor memo from the Democratic Congressional Campaign Committee on Friday, the House Democratic campaign arm's executive director, Julie Merz, made the pitch that if the group can raise an additional $17 million by Oct. 22, the party can play in more races.

"We need more resources to close the sale in these winnable seats," Merz wrote.

The letter cited races such as Florida's 27th Congressional District, where GOP Rep. Maria Elvira Salazar is fighting off Democratic challenger Eliott Rodriguez as well as South Carolina's 1st District, where the House Republican-aligned Congressional Leadership Fund is now spending.

Klobuchar Pushes Moderation In Bid for Minnesota's Governor

Democratic senator looks to tamp down Republican criticism as part of campaign

By John McCormick

ST. PAUL, Minn.—Republicans see Minnesota as a state where liberal naiveté delivered welfare fraud and general decline. Democrats view it as a blue bastion where a grassroots resistance rose up and turned the tide in a battle against President Trump's aggressive immigration enforcement.

Once known mostly for cold winters and Bob Dylan, Minnesota is now a political Rorschach test after two state flashpoints became nationalized and part of this year's midterm election debate.

Sen. Amy Klobuchar, the chamber's third-highest-ranking Democrat and heavily favored to be Minnesota's next governor after the Nov. 3 election, is a top actor in that debate as she tries to help her state turn a page after a troubled first six years of this decade.

As some Democrats try to move their party in a more progressive direction, Klobuchar is pushing moderation. She has called for no new taxes, expressed a willingness to work with Republicans and businesses, and has distanced herself from Democratic Gov. Tim Walz, who abandoned his bid for a third term because of the fraud scandal.

"Major things went wrong," Klobuchar said of the state's current leadership, in an interview. "That pissed me off, and everyone else off."

Republicans, meanwhile, are questioning whether her moderate rhetoric would become liberal governance, as was the case with Walz.

"She has a more moderate temperament, but it remains to be seen if she governs in a more moderate way," said Jim Schultz, a Republican and leader of the Minnesota Private Business Council. "She has been a reliable liberal vote in the U.S. Senate."

TIM EVANS/REUTERS

Sen. Amy Klobuchar is trying to help her state turn a page after a troubled first six years of this decade.

Klobuchar pushed back by noting how she raised her hand on a debate stage while running for the 2020 Democratic presidential nomination when candidates were asked if they worried about a "Democratic socialist" at the top of the party's ticket, a reference to Sen. Bernie Sanders's bid. Businessman Tom Steyer was the only other candidate to raise his hand.

While the 2028 Democratic presidential field is expected to be large, Klobuchar has said she wouldn't be a candidate then or in 2032.

Turning around Minnesota's reputation after one of the nation's largest pandemic-era welfare fraud scandals won't be easy. Trump and Republicans have called it an example of Democratic mismanagement.

Total losses remain unknown, but estimates range from $300 million to billions.

The incident, perpetuated mostly by Somali immigrants, has been an embarrassment for a state that had long clung to an unofficial motto: Our taxes may be high, but we have good government and services.

Republicans now lump Minnesota in with traditional GOP punching bags such as New York, California and Illinois.

Klobuchar, 66 years old, argues her experience as the top prosecutor of the state's most populated county puts her in a unique position to ferret out fraud and make changes.

"They were just signing off on these grants," she said. "Walz himself said he should have caught it earlier. Well, yeah. When the line item is skyrocketing up for one program that should be an immediate red alert."

The senator also stressed her differences from Walz.

"I was in the private sector for over a decade," she said, referring to work for Minneapolis law firms where her concentrations included telecommunications law. "That is a very different background."

A river of sadness has flowed through Minnesota this decade, from the 2020 killing of George Floyd by police—and the riots that followed—to political assassinations and a mass shooting of school children inside a church.

The fatal shootings of two Minneapolis residents in January by federal immigration officials amid a enforcement surge were among the latest calamities.

The events have left many residents shellshocked.

Asked about Minnesota's run of bad news, Klobuchar suggested it has been amplified on the national stage, in part, because Minnesotans have protested in large numbers when people have been killed. "We stand up, and so that is not an excuse for any of this. It just is a partial answer to why I think it's been in the public's eye," she said.

The state's tarnished reputation stands in contrast to when TIME magazine in 1973 put Minnesota's governor on its cover wearing a plaid shirt and holding freshly caught northern pike. The article showcased a robust economy and Norman Rockwell-like quality of life.

A half-century later, state economic growth has trailed the nation's since the early 2000s, population gains rank in the bottom half of states, and personal and corporate taxes are among the nation's highest, as are binge drinking rates.

If elected, Klobuchar will also face challenges from within the Democratic-Farmer-Labor Party, as Democrats are known in the state. The DFL has moved left in recent years, and the state has passed paid family and medical leave, transgender-rights protections and more.

She has already had extensive conversations with progressive legislators and has stressed to them that economic growth would be the ultimate revenge against Republicans who have mocked the state.

U.S. WATCH

NEW ORLEANS

Custodian Played Role in Jailbreak

A New Orleans jail worker received a 2.5-year prison sentence Thursday for enabling 10 inmates to escape through a hole behind a toilet after he turned off its water.

Custodian Sterling Williams, 34, pleaded guilty to one count of malfeasance in office for clearing the way for one of the largest jailbreaks in recent U.S. history. In May 2025, after Williams shut off the water in a cell, 10 inmates removed a toilet, crawled through a gap in the wall and scaled a fence out of the jail. They left behind a scrawled graffiti note reading "To Easy LoL."

Williams' attorney, Michael Kennedy, said that Williams didn't intentionally help the escapees but acknowledged making mistakes. Williams should have had a work order generated before shutting off the water for the clogged toilet, his attorney said.

All 10 of the inmates were eventually captured, though one convicted murderer remained on the run for five months before being discovered hiding beneath a house in Atlanta. They are all facing charges of aggravated escape and are scheduled for jury trial in April.

—Associated Press

MASSACHUSETTS

New Oversight Set For Long-Term Care

The Massachusetts Public Health Council approved regulations designed to strengthen oversight of long-term-care facilities and stop irresponsible nursing-home owners from putting residents at risk.

The new rules expand the Department of Public Health's authority to review the track records of the companies seeking licenses to run nursing homes, and to take action when nursing homes break the rules. They also introduce new standards, including staff training requirements.

The regulations had been pending since February and were written to finalize changes the Legislature passed in 2024 in a landmark long-term care law. The two-year delay between the law and final regulations had puzzled and frustrated elder advocates.

The elder advocacy group Massachusetts Dignity Alliance had supported the long-term care law and the proposed regulations that followed it. "Better late than never, right?" said Jim Lomastro, an elder advocate with the alliance who has experience leading and inspecting healthcare facilities.

—Associated Press

CHARLES KRUPA/AP

FALL FORWARD: Lynne Gagnon cleared fallen leaves before mowing her yard on Thursday in East Derry, N.H.

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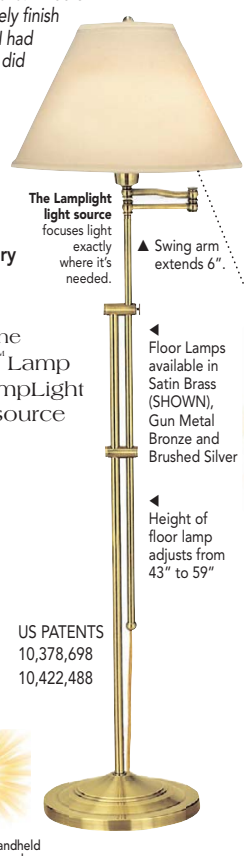

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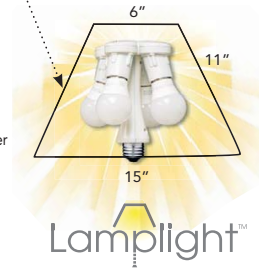

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WORLD NEWS

Ukraine Needs Arms, Intel Only U.S. Can Provide

Kyiv has developed its own weapons, EU has boosted support, but it isn't enough

By Daniel Michaels

Warnings by Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky and disruptions to SpaceX's Starlink network have exposed how vulnerable Kyiv would be if the U.S. withdrew all of its support, threatening everything from drone strikes to air defenses.

Ukrainian forces on Wednesday said their access to satellite communications was throttled, slowing their drones. This week Zelensky said Ukraine hadn't received warnings from its partners that usually allow its air defenses to intercept Russian ballistic missiles.

President Trump has demanded that Ukraine stop hitting Russian oil refineries and called for Zelensky to step down, raising the prospect that Washington could cut off its backing for Kyiv.

Ukraine has developed its own weapons to wean itself off U.S. help, and Europe has boosted its financial and military support as Washington pulls back. Overall, Ukraine is much less beholden to the U.S. for its defense than when Russia launched its 2022 invasion. But there are still things that only the U.S. can provide.

EFREM LUKATSKY/AP

Ukrainian servicemembers set up drones in an undisclosed location in Ukraine earlier this year.

Starlink

Starlink and its military version, Starshield, are unique in their satellite coverage, signal strength and transmission capabilities. Canada and European countries are developing systems that will have some of Starlink's scale and potency, but not before 2028 at the earliest, said people familiar with their rollout.

Warning system

America's globe-spanning ballistic-missile early warning system can detect heat from a rocket launch, which is then confirmed by a worldwide network of missile-tracking radars, said Thomas Withington of the Royal United Services Institute, a military-focused think tank.

It "is close to irreplaceable," said Franz-Stefan Gady, a Vienna-based military analyst and head of Gady Consulting.

Kyiv's European allies provide satellite and other airborne intelligence, but it lacks the precision, scope and capabilities of that coming from the U.S. In terms of missile alerts, "Europe has nothing comparable and won't for years," Gady said.

Interceptors

Ukraine has relied on the U.S. for advanced missile interceptors, particularly Patriot PAC-3 MSE rockets, to shoot down ballistic missiles. But even before Trump renewed pressure on Kyiv over its strikes on Russian refineries, supplies of those interceptors dwindled. U.S. stockpiles were spent in the Mideast this year defending against Iranian attacks.

Meanwhile, Europe and Ukraine are offering alternatives. The makers of the French-Italian Samp/T say their latest version can tackle ballistic missiles. The system is on its way to Ukraine.

At least two Ukrainian companies are working on ballistic-missile interceptors with European peers, with the first expected to come into operation as early as the middle of 2027. A British startup says it is set to produce its own.

Air-defense mapping

Ukrainian intelligence services have developed their own data on Russian infrastructure and military assets using a mix of allied intelligence, Ukrainian drones, human intelligence and other sources including hacked video cameras inside Russia.

But the U.S. also has helped Ukraine conduct strikes on Russian assets, say people familiar with the operations.

U.S. technology and intelligence have helped Ukraine refine its data for strikes, including through precise information on the altitude of targets, according to a European military official.

One crucial capability: U.S. surveillance can give a very detailed picture of Russian air defenses through the systems' electromagnetic signatures, said Withington.

Information on weak spots in Russia's aerial defenses has helped Ukraine to guide drones and missiles to avoid interception, he said.

F-16 jet fighters

Ukraine has gathered a fleet of secondhand F-16 jet fighters, donated by European allies in recent years. Kyiv relies on the U.S. for spare parts, maintenance, software upgrades and arms for the U.S.-made aircraft.

Many of the F-16 supplies are being paid for by Ukraine's European allies in the North Atlantic Treaty Organization, through a program called the Prioritized Ukraine Requirements List, or PURL. Ukraine's NATO allies and others, including Australia and New Zealand, have pledged more than $4 billion to PURL since it was launched last year.

A halt to PURL would deprive Ukraine of vital equipment, but Washington might be reluctant to back out of the program, given it is an export earner for U.S. defense companies.

Ukraine's munitions stocks for the F-16s dried up months ago, and pilots are reliant on the planes to shoot down the jet-powered drones, say air-defense officers. Spare parts to fix the U.S.-supplied M777 howitzer must still get Washington's sign off, even though they are made in the U.K.

Trump Turns on Zelensky

Continued from Page One

days, Trump has offered to buy Moscow's oil in a lucrative diesel deal, demanded that Zelensky step down and declared the energy truce that Moscow quickly violated.

During the pause in Ukrainian attacks on refineries, Moscow pummeled Ukraine's energy sites, Kyiv said. While Ukraine's access to Starshield was restricted on Wednesday, Russia launched waves of drones toward its cities.

The result is a livid Ukraine, rattled U.S. allies and a widening rift in the Republican Party over Trump's foreign policy ahead of the November midterm elections.

"This action cannot be a coincidence and is connected to the current political situation," said Serhii Beskrestnov, a senior Zelensky adviser.

"We will do everything we can to fix this," said Rep. Brian Fitzpatrick (R., Pa.). Fitzpatrick, who is facing a tight re-election race, said Congress would act if it turns out Washington imposed speed limits on Ukraine's military-grade Starlink access.

"If we start going dark on Ukraine, there will be consequences," he told The Wall Street Journal.

Asked what consequences, he said Congress could hold up funding for federal agencies that are responsible.

SpaceX declined to comment, but Musk noted in a social-media post that limits on Starlink's military platform Starshield are set by the Pentagon and "ultimately" Trump.

The White House declined to answer questions on the Starlink situation. "The President and his team remain committed to continuing to play a constructive role in ending the war," it said.

Ukraine's difficulty in accessing the satellite terminals followed U.S. warnings that Trump could cut off intelligence support or military sales to Kyiv, top European and Ukrainian officials said. U.S. officials deny the threats were made.

Ukrainian officials and European allies are incensed at Trump, said senior European officials, arguing he is pursing talks the wrong way. Ramping up pressure on Moscow—not Kyiv—is the only way to end the war, they argue, and President Vladimir Putin of Russia will use any economic lifelines from the U.S. to replenish his war chest and prolong the fighting.

> **'If we start going dark on Ukraine, there will be consequences.'**

Zelensky on Wednesday told British broadcaster Piers Morgan that he felt betrayed by Trump's offer to buy diesel fuel from Putin.

Administration officials said Trump is working to de-escalate the fighting, then bring a new offer to Moscow that would grant it access to economic and political benefits if it adheres to a more-lasting ceasefire.

Administration officials also characterized Trump's offer to buy Russia's diesel fuel as a way to lower U.S. gas prices and dangle an economic incentive in front of Putin to bring him back to talks.

Some Republican lawmakers cheered on Trump's deal with Russia as a reprieve for U.S. consumers squeezed by high energy prices, while others rebuked it as a misguided freebie for a Russian leader uninterested in peace.

Officials said the latest tension between Trump and Zelensky started with a meeting in New York.

Zelensky flew to the U.S. in mid-September for a United Nations summit confident that many things were going his way. Ukraine had blunted Russian advances on the battlefield, and Zelensky previously had several positive interactions with Trump. But at the meeting, Trump pressed Zelensky on why Ukraine was striking Russian oil refineries, people familiar with the matter said. Hitting such infrastructure is a crucial part of Ukraine's strategy to hit Moscow where it hurts most—its bank accounts—in an effort to rob it of revenue for the war.

Energy analysts widely agree that rising energy prices, especially the cost of diesel fuel, are primarily the result of the Iran war. Ukraine's successful drone campaign against Russia, however, has taken between 40% and 50% of its refining network offline, analysts said.

Since Trump's discussion with Zelensky, the U.S. has asked Ukraine a half dozen times to halt the strikes, people familiar with the discussions said. Ukrainian officials said they would agree to an energy truce, but Russia refused—so they didn't pull back.

During the next month, Trump soured on Zelensky as Ukrainian strikes continued. The president grew annoyed that Ukraine was using U.S. resources to target Russia's energy exports in a way that he thought could hurt U.S. consumers, the people said.

In early October, senior Ukrainian and European officials flew to Miami to meet with two top Trump aides in a bid to revive peace talks. The discussions on Oct. 9, led by Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner and U.S. envoy Steve Witkoff, were aimed at drafting proposals to end the conflict that would be acceptable to Moscow and Kyiv. During the meeting, Kushner and Witkoff said Trump was considering the diesel deal with Russia. The Ukrainian and European officials were floored.

During the six-hour meeting, Kushner and Witkoff pushed the Ukrainians and Europeans to come up with new proposals to try to end the war, people familiar with the matter said. That day, Trump held a 90-minute call with Putin, announcing the diesel deal shortly after hanging up.

Several angry GOP lawmakers called the White House after the announcement, legislators and U.S. officials said. The deal, they said, handed Russia a win without concessions, and went against a 2022 law that bars the U.S. from importing Russian energy without prior congressional consultation.

"We need HONESTY from our partners about this war: It is important that everyone in America stand not with the aggressor, but with our efforts to protect lives, end this war, and guarantee security," Zelensky posted on X Thursday.

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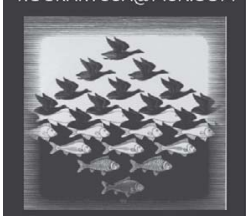

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WORLD WATCH

MAAZ AWAN/AP

Mourners in Peshawar, Pakistan, on Thursday attended funeral prayers for those who died after a roof collapsed at a private school, killing at least 34 children and a teacher.

PAKISTAN

Roof Collapses, Killing at Least 35

The roof of a private school collapsed in the northwestern city of Peshawar on Thursday, killing at least 34 children and a teacher and injuring more than 50 other people in the deadliest incident of its kind in the country, authorities and a hospital official said.

The children killed or injured at Al-Khair school were between 6 and 12 years old, while the oldest was 14, Lady Reading Hospital spokesman Mohammad Asim said. Some of the injured were in critical condition, he said.

Hours after the collapse in Peshawar, the capital of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, emergency-services spokesman Bilal Faizi said everyone trapped beneath the rubble had been pulled out and crews had cleared debris. He said the roofs of two classrooms collapsed when second- and third-grade children were in them with their teachers. Faizi said ambulances and disaster management personnel arrived from a nearby facility within five minutes of being alerted.

Nearly 100 rescuers eventually joined the operation, he said. Panicked, grieving parents were trying to help when crews arrived, Faizi said. He credited the rapid evacuation with saving at least 40 lives.

—Associated Press

GAZA STRIP

Commercial Goods Blocked From Entry

No commercial goods have entered the Gaza Strip for two days, Israeli authorities said Thursday, blaming the suspension on merchants angered by taxes imposed by Hamas—a claim Palestinian importers deny.

The halt to commercial shipments, including fruit and winter clothing, cuts off a key source of food and other critical supplies as fears grow about procuring supplies needed to get through winter. The move stands to immediately reduce Gaza's supplies, because the closed-off territory is completely reliant on whatever goods Israel allows in through border crossings.

Aid groups generally bring in staples such as flour, while merchants import more-perishable foods like fruits and meat, according to data released this year by COGAT, the Israeli military body that oversees humanitarian affairs in Gaza. Humanitarian workers saying aid and a robust commercial market are needed to keep prices under control.

COGAT announced the suspension of commercial shipments on Wednesday. Its deputy spokesperson, Lt. Daniel Kantorovich, said the agency was acting on a decision made by Palestinian merchants a day earlier and could reverse it at their behest.

—Associated Press

TURKEY

Heavy Rainstorms Shut Down Istanbul

A heavy downpour shut down Istanbul, flooded homes and roads and killed at least three people, officials said on Thursday, as rescuers worked overnight to save hundreds of people stranded at their workplaces.

The downpour Wednesday night flooded homes and businesses and inundated roads and underpasses, stranding vehicles and causing traffic chaos in Turkey's largest city.

The Istanbul governor's office Thursday reported three deaths in the city and said four other people were reported missing. A 14-year-old was electrocuted after stepping in a puddle at a park in the Fatih district, and a 34-year-old slipped on a sidewalk in the Sariyer district and hit their head, local media reports said. The governor's office said the body of a third victim was discovered near another park in the Kagithane district.

Interior Minister Mustafa Ciftci said over 2,700 people who were stranded by the floods were safely evacuated throughout the city. The Istanbul Metropolitan Municipality said some areas had the highest amount of rain since 1985.

The country's weather agency has predicted more showers for Istanbul and the surrounding area in the coming days.

—Associated Press

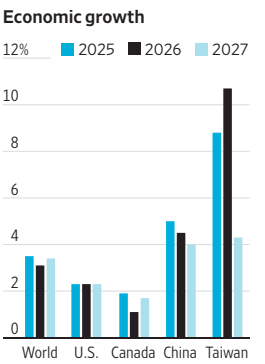
AI Boom Shields Only a Few Countries

Most nations suffer from the fallout as economic pain sweeps the globe

By Gabriele Steinhauser And Katrina Northrop

TOM NICHOLSON/GETTY IMAGES

French students have been protesting this month against government plans to cut spending amid a selloff in the nation's debt.



Note: 2026 and 2027 are projections. Inflation adjusted and measured on a 4Q/4Q basis
Source: International Monetary Fund

BANGKOK—Economic damage from high energy prices and rising borrowing costs is mounting globally, splitting the world into a new set of winners and losers as countries with limited exposure to the artificial-intelligence boom fall behind.

In the U.S. and a few other countries, surging investments in AI are helping mask the financial pain of higher costs, triggered in part by the Iran war and its widening fallout. But elsewhere, popular discontent is boiling over as governments get caught between spending more to help their citizens and servicing their spiraling debts.

In France, high-school and university students are protesting plans by the government to cut spending amid a selloff in the nation's debt. Transport drivers in the Philippines and Indonesia have taken to the streets over high gas and diesel prices. Senegal last month alerted international bondholders and Chinese state-owned banks that it would need debt relief.

The International Monetary Fund, whose annual meetings in Bangkok this week bring together the world's finance ministers and central bankers, says it expects the global economy to grow 3.1% this year, down from 3.5% in 2025.

That forecast remains in line with what the fund predicted in April, shortly after the U.S. and Israel attacked Iran. But growth is being buoyed by strength in a few countries that are leading the AI boom, while other nations, particularly in the developing world and parts of Europe, are getting hit.

Overall, just 32 economies are responsible for 95% of global growth, down from 54 economies in April, the IMF said. Persistently high energy costs could concentrate growth in an even smaller number of countries, it said.

"Growth across the globe is distributed unevenly," said German Finance Minister Lars Klingbeil.

Federal Reserve Chairman Kevin Warsh is to have a public discussion on the forces shaping the global economy Friday with IMF Managing Director Kristalina Georgieva.

Oil prices have jumped from around $70 a barrel before the Iran war to around $105 now. That, along with a surge in borrowing by AI companies, has led to investors demanding higher interest rates on government bonds, especially for countries already carrying heavy debt loads.

In the U.S., inflation picked up in September, with consumer prices climbing 3.7% from a year earlier, marking the sixth month in a row of inflation outpacing wages. The U.S. is running the biggest budget deficit of any advanced economy, projected to reach 8.5% of gross domestic product this year, and has seen yields on its 10-year Treasury rise to their highest levels since 2002.

The jump in fuel and borrowing costs is combining with other economic concerns to weigh heavily on voters ahead of midterm elections.

The U.S. is better placed than many other countries to deal with those challenges, thanks to its large AI and energy sectors. The U.S. economy is expected to grow 2.3% this year, unchanged from the IMF's April forecast. Other winners in the current environment include Asian chip makers such as South Korea and Taiwan, which is expected to be the world's fastest-growing advanced economy with a nearly 11% expansion forecast for this year.

"Those who are part of AI will be better off," said Ekniti Nitithanprapas, Thailand's finance minister. "But those who are not in the supply chains will be worse off."

Energy exporters not hit by the wars in the Middle East, such as Nigeria or Guyana, are also reaping the benefits of high oil prices. The IMF lowered its growth forecast for nearly half of the countries assessed in its October report.

"Every major central bank is worried" about high energy prices also making other goods more expensive, Tiff Macklem, the Bank of Canada governor, told a banking-industry group meeting in Bangkok.

Canada is expected to grow just 1.1% this year, down from the 1.5% that the IMF forecast in April, due in part to the U.S. trade challenges.

Many investors are wearily watching France, whose debt the IMF expects to hit a record 118% of GDP this year. "It's important to stick to the commitments of reducing the deficit," said Bank of France Gov. Emmanuel Moulin.

China is battling its own problems, including a painful property-market crisis and high youth unemployment. The IMF slightly raised its growth forecast for the Chinese economy for this year, when it is expected to reach 4.5%, but predicted a drop to 4% in 2027.

Poorer countries, even those recording strong growth this year, have fewer resources to buffer high energy costs. Many subsidize retail fuel prices to shield consumers from swings in the global oil market.

In Ethiopia, cars are being turned away at gas stations as authorities preserve limited fuel for transport and agriculture vehicles.

In Indonesia, fuel shortages this week spread to the island of Bali, with long lines and warnings that stocks had run out at multiple gas stations.

Fuel prices in Pakistan have surged more than 50% since the start of the Iran war. Last month, the government rolled out austerity measures to conserve fuel, including a ban on official foreign travel, and mandated early market closures, as well as a new fuel subsidy for low-income groups.

The government opted against a broader subsidy.

"Quite frankly, we simply can't afford it," said Muhammad Aurangzeb, Pakistan's finance minister.

U.K. Defies Dour Economic Outlook With Help From Big Tech Spending

By Ed Frankl

The AI investment boom has lifted the British economy, underlining the technology's potential to drive growth beyond the U.S. and East Asia.

AI-related spending contributed as much as a third of growth in the first seven months of the year, helped in particular by a jump in computer consultancy services, according to analysis by Deutsche Bank economists.

If sustained, the boost from AI could help the U.K. economy emerge from a long period of sluggish growth, and make it easier for the government to reduce its large debt. But for that to happen, economists say the technology would have to diffuse throughout Britain's large services sector and boost productivity, a development that is by no means certain.

"Last year there was about 50 billion to 60 billion pounds [$66 billion to $79 billion] of announced investment in AI in the U.K. It didn't show up in the data much in 2025, but you're starting to see that filter through finally into the data this year," said Sanjay Raja, the bank's chief U.K. economist.

Gross domestic product growth was 0.1% on month in August, latest official data from the U.K.'s Office for National Statistics showed on Thursday. That came after GDP expanded around 1.2% in the first half of the year, outpacing the U.S. and offsetting the worst fears that the war in Iran would hit the U.K. hard.

Compared with the same month of last year, GDP grew by 2.1% in August, the strongest rise in four years, the data showed. While information-and-communication output edged lower in the month of August, it was up 7.1% on year, with computer programming, consultancy and related activities—markers of AI adoption—the largest contribution to three-monthly growth in each of the last six months, the ONS said.

Economies worldwide have proved more resilient than expected to the energy-price shock stemming from the war in the Middle East. The U.S. and China lead in capital expenditure on innovation and frontier models, with AI tech-investment rollout accounting for a third of U.S. growth in 2026, ING economists said in August.

The International Monetary Fund on Tuesday raised its forecast for Britain's full-year growth to 1.3%, among the largest upward revisions of any developed nation. But higher energy prices and long-term interest rates would weigh on U.K. consumption and investment next year, it said.

2.1%
British GDP growth in August from the year-ago period, the best in four years

Britain's economy has grown sluggishly since the 2008 financial crisis, with relatively lackluster productivity exacerbated by high energy prices following Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine and the downtrend in foreign investment after the U.K.'s exit from the European Union.

"The U.K. is certainly No. 1 in Europe when it comes to funding of artificial intelligence and tech startups," Deutsche Bank's Raja said.

Spending in IT and AI-related industries contributed around 65% of business investment in the U.K. in the second quarter, Barclays economists said in a report. That incorporates software, hardware and infrastructure.

Europe's largest cluster of data centers is in Slough, a town 25 miles west of London, with only Virginia in the U.S. boasting more globally. This year, U.S. logistics real-estate company Prologis agreed to buy U.K. rival Segro, the parent company of Slough's trading estate.

Industrial Resilience Falters in Eurozone

By Don Nico Forbes

Eurozone industrial output declined again in August under the weight of lingering energy-price concerns as the war in the Middle East continued to flare.

Industrial production fell 0.5% from the previous month, following a downwardly revised 0.3% decline in July, the statistics agency Eurostat said on Thursday. August's reading was below a consensus of economists polled by The Wall Street Journal, which expected output to rise 0.2%.

The fall in activity compounds a tough few months for the industrial sector in the region.

After a surprisingly resilient response to the outbreak of war in Iran, production across the 21-nation euro area has now declined for three consecutive months, raising concern that high energy costs and extreme weather are putting the brakes on momentum.

While production rebounded somewhat in Germany, the eurozone's largest economy, following a steep decline in July, output fell back in France, Italy and Spain.

"Industry may not be immune to higher energy prices and global uncertainty after all," said Bert Colijn, an economist at ING.

August's reading comes despite signs of confidence among eurozone manufacturers, who have remained upbeat.

Purchasing managers' indexes for July through September showed manufacturing sentiment rising sequentially to its highest level since May 2022.

But rising energy costs continue to pile pressure on factory margins, while also complicating the outlook for interest rates. In September, the rate of industrial input cost and output price inflation rose to its highest level since May.

Output is expected to pick up again in September, boosted by an anticipated rebound in vehicle production, said Megan Fisher, an economist at Capital Economics.

With China Facing More Trade Barriers, It Can't Afford to Lose Europe

By Brian Spegele And Kim Mackrael

TIM FRANCO FOR WSJ

A Chinese EV was unveiled this week at the Paris Motor Show.

For years, China pushed Europe to the breaking point, flooding it with exports that were crushing profits and killing jobs, while issuing tough warnings to the bloc not to fight back.

Now, Beijing is backing down, at least temporarily, as it buys time for further talks.

China is going along with a European Union plan to cap hybrid-vehicle imports, which bloc officials said should cut their volume by more than half after talks last week in Beijing. The move will offer some protection to European carmakers, including **Volkswagen** and **Fiat**-maker Stellantis, easing frustration in Europe over the flood of Chinese auto imports.

Beijing feared the mounting concerns were finally pushing European officials toward concerted action, particularly after France and Germany moved toward a common approach on the issue.

In a closed-door meeting Thursday in Brussels, European leaders expressed support for the hybrid-vehicle plan, while saying more measures will be needed to protect European industries from Chinese goods, said officials and diplomats.

At first glance, China's export machine looks all but unstoppable, with its trade surplus last year hitting a record $1.2 trillion. But China's reliance on exports to support its otherwise struggling economy means Beijing can't afford to lose access to Europe's lucrative market. President Trump's protectionist tilt raises the stakes further.

Beijing has long had close friends in high places in Europe, including at big industrial companies that championed more trade with China. Those relationships made it tough for the EU to take a harder line against Beijing. In recent years, these firms not only struggled to make money inside China, but saw their market shares at home eroded by what many European executives viewed as unfair Chinese competition.

European officials previously sought to rebalance the bloc's trade relationship with Beijing by expanding its market access to China, but that is no longer viewed as sufficient to offset the economic and political pain caused by an influx of Chinese imports.

Under the latest plans, the EU will cap hybrid-vehicle imports at 350,000 annually, which officials said could cut the current import volume by more than half.

The quota is expected to take effect in coming months and would increase by 6% in each of the following three years, officials said.

To be sure, China isn't the only source of Europe's economic problems. Bureaucracy, high energy costs and a lack of innovation and investment in advanced technologies are also contributing to its lagging competitiveness. And while European consumers benefit from cheap cars and China-made machinery, the threat of even bigger job losses at factories and across supply chains carries potentially destabilizing political and social consequences.

Before the latest talks in Beijing, Europe's unhappiness with China culminated last week with a joint proposal from France and Germany that would lower the bar for blocking Chinese goods.

According to senior German officials, the proposal aims to give the EU an instrument that could be a tool to restore balance between the EU and China.

European leaders have agreed to develop two legal tools, the bloc's officials said. One is a so-called diversification instrument, which aims to reduce European companies' dependencies on one country for the inputs they need. The EU is also preparing measures to support specific industries or regions that China—or other trade partners—might target for economic retaliation.

The challenge for Europe is to sustain its show of unity. European elections in coming months could make it harder for EU countries to move together.

A firm show of retaliation from China could also give officials cold feet, said Noah Barkin, an analyst with Rhodium Group in Berlin.

"No matter how united Europe is today, if China hits back hard, that unity will be tested," he said.

FROM PAGE ONE

Oxford's 'Ludicrously Ugly' Bridge

Continued from Page One

"That can happen to a country," said Julian Le Vay, a former director of finance and procurement for Britain's prison service. He led a campaign to highlight the economic damage to local businesses.

Planners said the project would close a key route into the city center for four to five days. That turned into 41 months.

Adding insult to injury, the end result is drab."On arriving in Oxford by train, you should think 'Wow,' " said Nicholas Boys Smith, founder and chairman at the think tank Create Streets. But then there is "this ludicrously ugly bridge."

It wasn't supposed to be this way. The Oxford Station Masterplan said its mission was to reflect the city's world-class status. It was one of the first projects under a new government program: swift, pragmatic and efficient enhancement delivery. SPEED for short. The aim was to halve the time it takes to complete a rail-infrastructure project and slash the cost of project delivery.

But when they got going, builders hit a thicket of utilities running under the road. They needed to lower the carriageway by around 16 inches to let standard double-decker buses pass under the bridges.

JOANNA SUGDEN/WSJ

The city's latest architectural offering hasn't impressed locals or aesthetes. 'It's so underwhelming,' says Zack Iqbal.

Other setbacks included the discovery of a 109-yard upside-down arch designed by the Victorians to reduce flooding—a finding described by Network Rail as the "point of no return" for the closure of the road. One contractor said it was the most complex project he'd ever worked on.

Modern Britain is beset by planning delays, project overruns and ballooning infrastructure budgets. The postponements are so frequent and the sums so astronomical that it's becoming a sport among the literati to come up with new ways to make the numbers make sense.

The superfast 140-mile rail line between London and Birmingham will cost up to $971 million a mile by the time it's fully open—and that's after the government cut the route by almost 60% to save money. A 3.3-mile stretch of a branch line to be re-laid in Portishead required 79,187 pages of planning documents.

"There's 14.6 miles of paperwork, more than 4½ times the length of the line that is to be reinstated," calculated Ben Hopkinson, head of infrastructure at the Centre for Policy Studies.

On average, the U.K. pays 65% more per unit of infrastructure than comparable countries, according to a study by Britain Remade and the Centre for British Progress.

In other words, Britain gets less for more.

Analysts blame planning, environmental and legal hoops that projects now have to pass through. Transport Secretary Heidi Alexander was more blunt. "This country can build big things—we just need competent people at the helm to deliver them," she told lawmakers in May.

Some who saw Oxford's Botley Road bridges after their unveiling said they could understand the delays and expense. "There are things in the ground you can't see," said Graham Wood, who works in construction. "X-ray vision would be great, but they haven't invented it."

Others were less forgiving. When Dominika Mikitiuk, a veterinarian visiting from eastern Poland, saw the bridge and heard the $314 million price tag, the 30-year-old had one question: "Just for that?"

As the problems piled up, businesses closed or relocated and residents became more irate, the project pivoted in January 2025 from reimagining Oxford station to just getting the road back open by August this year. A month before that deadline, Network Rail discovered three gas leaks.

When they were fixed and the road opened late last month, a local brewery threw a party to celebrate. They wore hard hats and smashed a bridge-shaped piñata.

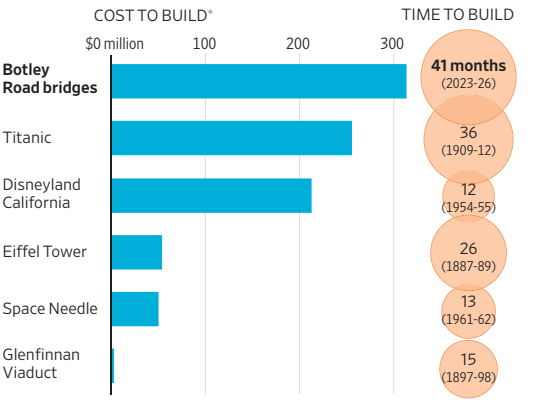
Local merchants and residents said Network Rail, which owns and operates Britain's rail infrastructure, also invited them to a party to thank them for their patience. Those who spoke with The Wall Street Journal said they declined.

A proposed opening ceremony was scrapped. "I think they were so embarrassed," said Zack Iqbal, 55, who runs a garage near the project. "It's a functional structure, but it's so underwhelming."

Network Rail discussed a formal opening event with Oxford City Council and agreed "it would not be appropriate given the challenges and delays," a spokesman said.

But it's not the end of the line for the unfinished project. Network Rail invited locals to discuss the next steps over tea and cake this week.

Cost of selected projects



*Cost adjusted for inflation
Sources: Network Rail, U.K. Department of Transport (Botley Road bridges); Encyclopedia Britannica, Smithsonian (Titanic); EBSCO (Disneyland, Eiffel Tower); GustaveEiffel.com (Eiffel Tower); Space Needle; Gazetteer for Scotland, Sir Robert McAlpine (Glenfinnan Viaduct)

Funds Paid To Firm Of Adviser

Continued from Page One

where he discussed legislative developments and relayed Genius Act talking points as his partners were communicating with Tether's chief executive.

Once the bill was signed, Tether hired him—to run its U.S. operations.

Hines had started Nxum, a small consulting firm, with his father and another partner around 2022. Each owned one-third. He stepped back from day-to-day management of the company when he joined the administration in early 2025 but kept his ownership stake, his government ethics disclosures show.

Weeks after Hines began working on stablecoin legislation inside the White House, Nxum, which had only dabbled in crypto until that point, started pursuing business with Tether, the world's largest stablecoin issuer.

A Nxum business partner forged a deal in May 2025 for a "strategic brand and public affairs plan" for El Salvador-based Tether with the understanding that Nxum would carry out the work, according to documents reviewed by the Journal.

Since the deal was signed, Nxum has earned $6.3 million from the arrangement, according to the documents, messages and blockchain records, plus a person involved in the deal.

The payments began while Hines was working to finalize the Genius Act—legislation that would dictate Tether's ability to operate in the U.S.

In addition to strategizing with his Nxum partners over Signal, Hines encouraged lawmakers to double the bill's compliance period from 18 months to 36 months, according to people involved in the negotiations. Tether, which would need more time than its U.S.-based competitors to reach compliance, was the primary beneficiary of the longer transition period.

The Genius Act was signed into law on July 18, 2025, with enthusiastic support from Tether's CEO, Paolo Ardoino, who sat beside Hines at the White House signing ceremony. Three weeks later, on Aug. 9, Hines announced he was leaving the White House. The following month, Tether named him chief executive of its new U.S. division.

A Nxum representative said that when Hines was working in the White House, he wasn't aware that Nxum had business dealings with Tether and wasn't involved in them. The representative said Hines "did not receive any Tether-derived funds during that period, and had no economic relationship of any kind with Tether while serving in the White House," and that he didn't engineer an arrangement for a position at Tether.

The representative said Hines recused himself from all company business when he joined the White House and that ethics rules didn't require him to divest what the representative described as his "passive investment" in the firm. Hines's communications with his Nxum business partners "related only to topics already in the public domain," the representative said.

The extension of the compliance period was the result of deliberations among multiple stakeholders, according to the representative. Additionally, "it was not necessary for Tether to enter into any payment arrangements, as it could (and did) simply use the weight of its market position to advocate for an extension of the compliance period," the representative said.

Tether didn't respond to requests for comment.

A White House official said Bo Hines was no longer a White House employee and that the administration expects its staff to comply with all applicable federal ethics laws and regulations.

FROM TOP: JONAH ROSENBERG; ANNABELLE GORDON/REUTERS

Bo Hines, above, spoke at the Digital Asset Summit in New York in March 2025. President Trump, below, signed the Genius Act in July that year.

Rise of Nxum

Hines never held a role in government or at a crypto company before Trump brought him into the White House. He had played college football, first at NC State and then at Yale, before going to law school. He then led two unsuccessful congressional campaigns to represent his home state of North Carolina as a Republican.

He and his father, Todd Hines, founded Nxum with Gary Dennis, a marketing executive, describing themselves at various points as a media company, a consulting agency and an investment firm.

Early on, the firm managed social-media accounts for right-wing figures such as Ryan Fournier, the activist behind Students for Trump.

In 2023, Nxum began helping to market a marijuana-themed NFT collection called Kush Kriminals that failed to get off the ground.

In the run-up to the 2024 presidential election, Nxum drew closer to the Trump campaign, helping create a Trump-themed meme coin called Restore the Republic and donating $1 million worth of billboard ads to MAGA Inc., the pro-Trump super PAC.

After the election, Trump appointed Hines to be executive director of the President's Council of Advisers on Digital Assets, handing him day-to-day control over the administration's crypto agenda. Trump named his AI and crypto czar David Sacks as the council's chair.

Nxum's partners told a business associate after Hines's appointment that he would have no role in the company's crypto-related work because of his new position, according to messages reviewed by the Journal.

Trump and his family have launched several crypto ventures since 2024, including a stablecoin, delivering the president a windfall of more than $1.4 billion last year.

The digital-asset council's first legislative mission was to pass the Genius Act—a step toward fulfilling Trump's promise to introduce laws that would make America the "crypto capital of the world."

Until the Genius Act, the U.S. government lacked specific rules for issuing stablecoins—cryptocurrencies pegged to real-world assets such as the U.S. dollar. The regulatory gap left room for Tether to grow with limited oversight; its flagship product, USDT, now accounts for roughly 60% of the $300 billion global stablecoin market.

In 2021, Tether paid nearly $60 million in penalties without admitting wrongdoing to regulators over claims it had misled investors by stating USDT was backed 1:1 by U.S. dollars. The company has also drawn scrutiny from lawmakers for its use by cybercriminals and money launderers.

Tether has said it works actively with law enforcement to combat illicit activity.

In April 2025, while Hines was leading the administration's push for the Genius Act, his father and their Nxum co-owner, Dennis, traveled to New York to meet Ardoino, the Tether chief.

The meeting was convened by Peter Vincer, a marketing entrepreneur who has worked with Nxum on business deals. Vincer after the meeting sent Ardoino a "Tether Comprehensive Brand Plan," that said Nxum would lead a "strategic lobbying and a full scale public relations and media awareness campaign" for Tether, according to a copy of the draft plan reviewed by the Journal.

Payments began while Hines worked to finalize the Genius Act.

The Nxum representative said Nxum didn't approve or execute the proposal and that Nxum didn't have a contract with Tether while Bo Hines was in the White House.

The group made revisions to the proposal and came to a final contract, which didn't refer to "lobbying," documents show. Tether signed the deal with Vincer's marketing company.

Tether agreed to pay Vincer's company $415,000 a month, in six-month installments, for a minimum of two years.

Tether sent its first $2.49 million payment on May 11, 2025. Tether used Bitfinex—a cryptocurrency exchange owned by Tether's parent company—to wire USDT to Vincer. He kept $498,000 and sent the remainder to a crypto wallet used by Nxum, and from there the money was split three ways, according to the messages and blockchain records.

Tether sent subsequent payments—which occurred after Bo Hines had left the White House—directly to Nxum. Vincer told the Journal he served as an intermediary for Nxum's deal with Tether. He transferred the contract directly to Nxum after Bo Hines left the administration.

Vincer said Bo Hines told him he would be paid a share of Tether's payments after signing over the contract. In a Signal message, Bo Hines wrote to Vincer, "Everyone has agreed that you are never to be f—ed."

But Vincer said Nxum failed to pay him what he believed he was owed. The Nxum representative told the Journal the company disagreed with Vincer's claim.

In August 2026, Nxum offered Vincer $311,000 plus 21% of a coming Tether payment if he agreed never to discuss his dealings with Nxum, Tether, Dennis, or Todd or Bo Hines, according to a copy of the agreement. He said he didn't sign.

'Bo got it done'

The Senate passed the Genius legislation in June 2025, and it moved to the House. It included language—dubbed the "Tether loophole" by critics in Washington—providing a pathway for stablecoin issuers to operate in approved countries outside of the U.S.

Separately, the bill gave a three-year grace period for crypto exchanges to phase out noncompliant assets. The longer time frame was pushed by Hines.

In the House negotiations, the bill hit a speed bump. On June 25, Todd Hines messaged Dennis. Rep. Tom Emmer, the House Majority Whip, was joining Republican holdouts to delay a House vote. Emmer "is working against Bo and Sacks," Todd Hines told Dennis. An Emmer spokesperson said he wasn't working against them.

Todd Hines wrote to Dennis that he was meeting with Jesse Spiro, Tether's head of government affairs, and had received a "very worried" call from Ardoino.

Several hours later, in their "Nxum" group chat on Signal, Bo Hines delivered talking points to his father and Dennis about the Republican holdouts: "Message is they are undermining the president and are bought and paid for by democratic shills like coinbase and a16z," referring to a crypto exchange and a venture-capital firm.

His father responded, "let's start knocking heads."

On July 15, 2025, Trump met with a small group of the holdouts in the Oval Office. Later that evening, he announced he had reached an agreement for the members to support the bill when it returned to the floor.

"Bo got it done," Dennis messaged an associate following the announcement. "It was huge and epic," he added. "It was simply Bo and Trump getting it done in the oval office."

The Genius Act was signed into law three days later.

ARTS IN REVIEW

FILM REVIEW | KYLE SMITH

A Fascinating Portrait of a Fraud

Nathan Fielder crafts an innovative and involving documentary about Elizabeth Holmes in 'You Can See Everything'

A good documentarian assembles snippets and shards to create something that illuminates reality, whereas a good humorist distorts or reframes reality. So what about a documentarian-humorist?

Nathan Fielder, on such comic-reality shows as HBO's "The Rehearsal," has demonstrated that warped goggles can make a fuzzy truth come more clearly into focus. In "You Can See Everything," a fractured three-hour documentary about the corporate fraudster Elizabeth Holmes, he has made something oddly innovative, deeply fascinating and extremely amusing. "Help me make sense of what I just experienced," he has been asking audiences; his film, which he stars in and co-directed with Lance Oppenheim, presents more questions than it answers. Which is why it resonates with our confusing times; it's a pocket symphony in the key of now.

The mischievous, deadpan, emotionally disengaged Mr. Fielder is not whom you or I would select to improve our public image and yet, bizarrely, 34 days before she reported to prison, Holmes and her partner, tech entrepreneur and hotel heir Billy Evans, invited him and his film crew into their rented San Diego beach home to record what they wished. "You can totally see everything," Holmes texts Mr. Fielder in the film.

She was once a billionaire on paper but is now a convicted felon who in 2023 began serving an 11-year sentence in Texas for defrauding investors in Theranos, a Silicon Valley startup that promised a new system for conducting a wide range of medical tests from just a few drops of blood. Long past the point when she realized her tech didn't work, she reassured the world that it did. She is therefore one of the century's most infamous liars.

And yet she tells Mr. Fielder she's never told a lie in her life, a statement that itself would be a lie coming from almost anyone who has ever lived. The dazed-angel expressions on Holmes's face when she says such things have become a marketing hook and subject of social-media fascination. Unfortunately there is no Oscar category for least convincing actress. "Why would I deceive you?" she asks the filmmaker, looking like a cartoon character called Lyin' Lizzie.

Awkwardness is to Mr. Fielder what explosions are to Michael Bay, and he revels in the long, bizarre takes in which she maintains a frozen facial expression for agonizing periods. She seems less like a criminal than an alien. In a priceless interlude in which Mr. Fielder holds her to account for having said her tech "can" run any test, which turns out not to mean what most would assume, he plays for her a video of Abbott and Costello's "Who's on First" routine. When he asks her the name of the first baseman in the skit, she can't answer. Mr. Evans chimes in that he's not surprised at this. She just thinks differently.

While Holmes comes across as very evasive and very bad at hiding it, though, Mr. Evans proves strong competition for being the strangest person here. Allowing the crews to film him even while he's in the shower (hence the movie's R rating for nudity), he encourages her to undergo 3-D virtual-reality scans, which Mr. Fielder observes could be used for pornographic purposes. Mr. Evans blithely replies that that's inevitable. Eh? The pair have young children.

When Mr. Fielder asks the couple how they fell in love, Mr. Evans says it was during a conversation while she wore a large hat, sunglasses and a Band-Aid. "But you couldn't see her face," Mr. Fielder notes. Can either one of these people be trusted about anything? Mr. Evans posts on Holmes's X account while she's locked up, and uses it to hurl profanities at random people. He apparently demanded profit participation in Mr. Fielder's documentary without telling Holmes, who says she has a negative net worth due to restitution requirements.

The movie takes us inside Holmes's house before she heads to prison.

When Holmes enters prison, she seems content with allowing Mr. Evans to make all decisions for her. Mr. Fielder, unable to record their conversations, devises a droll workaround deploying his signature meta-comic style. The movie becomes a sort of caper in which Mr. Fielder is joined by a fellow amateur sleuth investigating the two personalities. This isn't a whodunit, though. It's a whoisit. The directors' use of zoom lenses creates what feels like a larkish parody of a Brian De Palma stalker thriller, and with his headphones on, lurking in corners during filming, Mr. Fielder comes across like the audio-voyeur of Mr. De Palma's "Blow Out."

Can Holmes really be who she is, or is she being manipulated? If so, why does she allow it, and to what extent is it happening? Viewers are left with a lot to debate about what is going on with Elizabeth Holmes and Billy Evans. What few would dispute is that "You Can See Everything" is ingenious, intricate and involving—a documentary that stands not only apart from the usual format but above it.

Mr. Fielder (background), who co-directed the film with Lance Oppenheim, and Elizabeth Holmes.

A24

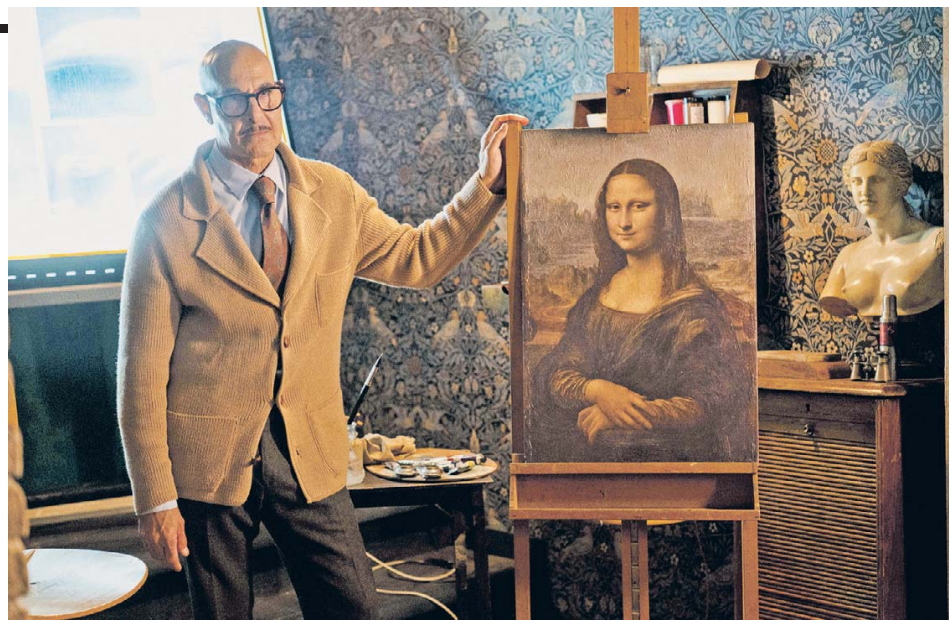
TELEVISION REVIEW | JOHN ANDERSON

Staging a Heist Of the Mona Lisa

The year 1911 doesn't resonate like 1929 or 1941 or 1968 or 2001, but it saw its share of historic events. The Triangle Shirtwaist Factory caught fire. Roy Eldridge and Bill Monroe were born. The RMS Olympic successfully docked in New York (unlike like its sister Titanic a year later). And the Mona Lisa was stolen from the Louvre, establishing it forever as a mythic work of art and the three-minute mile of art theft.

The outlandish idea that Stanley Tucci's felonious character, Roger Cavendish, plans to steal Leonardo da Vinci's most famous painting makes "Masterplan" exactly what it has to be—a tart, smart, slightly farcical and lightly sardonic reboot of late-20th-century crime comedies and caper films. The soundtrack's persistently chukka-chukka guitar and the echoes of "Shaft" and James Bond establish a musical mood; the actor, who has more range than he's given credit for (see "Conclave"), is doing what might be called trademark Tucci: Roger is precise, polite and sophisticated, his Britishisms enunciated within an inch of their lives. He is also something other than transparent.

Picking up on Roger's more dubious virtues are Chiara (Simona Tabasco), an expert in virtual technology and its criminal applications; and Jay (Victor Belmondo, grandson of Jean-Paul), an *artiste* at using explosives to liberate other people's money. Chiara is in Rome, Jay in Paris, but Roger tracks them down with a job offer and some news: He is their father. He has the explanations and the paperwork. The two unacquainted orphans sign up, conscious that they have inherited the larceny gene and, unconsciously perhaps, craving a family.



Stanley Tucci, above, in Prime Video's 'Masterplan,' directed by Thomas Vincent.

Victor Belmondo and Simona Tabasco, left, as the children of Mr. Tucci's master thief.

AMAZON MGM STUDIOS (2)

Director Thomas Vincent's production is very European in its locales and casting. But while Mr. Tucci is doing neither Jean Servais in the classic "Rififi" nor Maximilian Schell in "Topkapi," there are echoes of both of those crime classics as the intricate scheme is laid out, and we're sucked in. Even if it has as much to do with reality as "Andor."

The Louvre was victimized last year by thieves who exploited the museum's antiquated security in a specific wing, but the Mona Lisa—kept in a virtual aquarium when on public view—is another story. It's curious, actually, that a heist film would follow even this closely an actual art theft—still among the missing are historic pieces from the French crown jewels. Odd, too, is that such a movie would appear almost exactly a year after that crime occurred (on Oct. 19, 2025). We can be fairly certain that any cooperation between the museum and the film production came with the understanding that no actual security mechanisms would even be hinted at. Still, the fictional security is tight as the backside of a *huître creuse* (oyster), and the younger robbers' reasonable doubts are allayed by Roger's meticulous planning.

His secret weapon? A "long-forgotten," pre-Revolution passageway under the Louvre (and the Académie Française and the Seine). The tunnel will be mapped out and explored by Jay's physical self; the Louvre's electronics are investigated via Chiara's VR goggles. Meanwhile, Roger seals the deal with his putative buyer, Bruno (the ever-reliable Mark Ivanir), the kind of crime lord who would buy the Mona Lisa and keep it in his bathroom.

"Masterplan" is a lot of fun, because it's a kind of crime procedural involving likable criminals with lofty aspirations. There will be misfires for sure—how could there not be? But the attraction is a deftly organized outrage executed with highly calibrated timing, technology and chutzpah. Implausible? Certainly, but also charming, thanks to Mr. Tucci and his "kids," all of whom know exactly what movie they're in.

Masterplan
Friday, Prime Video

Mr. Anderson is the Journal's TV critic.

THEATER REVIEW | CHARLES ISHERWOOD

Minds Unraveling Off-Broadway

Conspiracy theories and a ghost story prove insidious in the new plays 'Anon' and 'A Ghost in Your Ear'

Andrew Garman, Izabel Mar, and Crystal Finn in 'Anon,' by Anne Washburn.

New York

Beware the voices you let in your ear. They could easily become the voices that get stuck in your head.

That's the dark message implicit in two distinctly different off-Broadway plays currently onstage. In "Anon," by Anne Washburn (best known for "Mr. Burns, a Post-Electric Play"), a seemingly average American wife and mother in Texas—she makes her own ranch dressing, bless her heart—becomes radicalized by listening to and engaging with podcasters and TikTokers. By the play's opening they have thoroughly colonized her brain and turned her into a virulent warrior for pretty much every far-right conspiracy theory rampaging across the internet.

"A Ghost in Your Ear" offers a less ambitious but viscerally engaging illustration of how the ear, and the mind, can play disorienting and devastating tricks on you. It's a semi-immersive thriller about a struggling American actor in London who is hired to record an audio drama and finds the experience increasingly disturbing—and psychologically destructive.

"Anon," at MCC Theater, is directed by the reliably excellent Anne Kauffman, who has assembled a top-flight cast led by Crystal Finn as Jeanie, the slightly dithery mother of the teenage Delia (Izabel Mar, in a wry and subtle turn) and wife of Michael (Andrew Garman), neither of whom evinces enthusiasm for Jeanie's proliferating obsessions and her frantic TikTok habits (she's on her third account after her incendiary views got her banned).

Delia is particularly weary of her mother's behavior. Early on, after Jeanie has forgotten to pick her up from school and Delia flounces upstairs, a guilty Jeanie begs Delia to come down and talk rather than bicker by text. Delia drips sarcasm (via text): "Let me get this straight. You want to talk to your daughter. In person. Instead of to a bunch of strangers on the internet. You sure?"

But Jeanie's rabid convictions are not just an irritation to her family but a dark menace to their new neighbors, a gay couple, Will (Jeremy Shamos) and Adam (Jeff Biehl), who discover she has posted a TikTok screed denouncing the rainbow flag they have put up—and inadvertently (or not?) revealing their address.

The first act, directed with cool precision by Ms. Kauffman, is terrific, as the tensions and frictions among the characters slowly build. It is hinted that Michael, who shows up at Will and Adam's door—giving them a moment of panicky anxiety—might be fed up with Jeanie's increasing emotional withdrawal from their marriage and family: He genially asks them if they might save some of the boxes they are still unpacking. Like, maybe 20 or so? Meanwhile Will becomes so unnerved by Jeanie's presence across the street that he buys a Glock, in turn unnerving Adam.

In 'Anon,' a Texas mother grows increasingly deranged thanks to TikTok.

I found the second act less rewarding, and inconclusive, as the play becomes more fantastical and stylized. A late passage finds Jeanie raving in her yard in a storm, specifically evoking the maddened King Lear on the heath (Delia previously discussed Shakespeare soliloquies she is studying), but the allusion seems both confused and a mighty stretch. Absent any indications of what inner conflicts or outside pressures may have set Jeanie on her path to QAnon-style radicalism, it's hard to see her as a tragic or even moving figure.

Shakespeare is a far cry from the text the actor Lucas, played by Lucas Iverson ("The Pitt," "The Gilded Age"), is asked to record for an audiobook in "A Ghost in Your Ear," at the Minetta Lane Theatre, written and directed by Jamie Armitage in collaboration with the sound designers Ben and Max Ringham. Lucas's friend Sid (Owen Campbell), the technician and producer who offered Lucas the gig, is the only other character, sitting in a booth behind Lucas and supplying sound effects to enhance the ghost story Lucas is asked to read—and more or less enact.

Mr. Iverson gives a dynamic, compelling performance—he's essentially the whole show—as Lucas relates the tale of a man long estranged from his father who decides to clear out his house (a spooky old British pile, naturally) after his death, and begins to have dark suspicions about his family's past. The production's novelty: Audience members wear headphones, so we hear Lucas's voice more intimately, and also the creaks and thumps and eerie noises that enhance the chilling tale.

As strange, inexplicable happenings begin to disrupt the recording session—a mysteriously opening door, a sudden appearance of a menacing masked figure in the booth—Lucas begins to lose his emotional equilibrium. Hard to blame him, when a noose suddenly descends above his head. Unless of course he's imagined the unnerving incidents, or Sid has orchestrated them.

Originally seen at London's prestigious Hampstead Theatre, "A Ghost in Your Ear," like "Paranormal Activity" on Broadway, relies less on action than atmosphere to keep us unsettled. I am not entirely sure the headphones do a lot to add to the experience, but the sound design by the Ringhams has an impressive precision, as does the shadowy lighting design by Ben Jacobs. Naturally, there's a startling revelation at the end. It may be familiar to watchers of the hit horror movie "It Follows," but concludes the show with a shivery thunderclap of eeriness aimed directly at the audience, suggesting that we too may be haunted by the ghostly tale that has been whispered into our ears.

Anon
MCC Theater,
511 W. 52nd St., New York
646-506-9393, closes Nov. 1

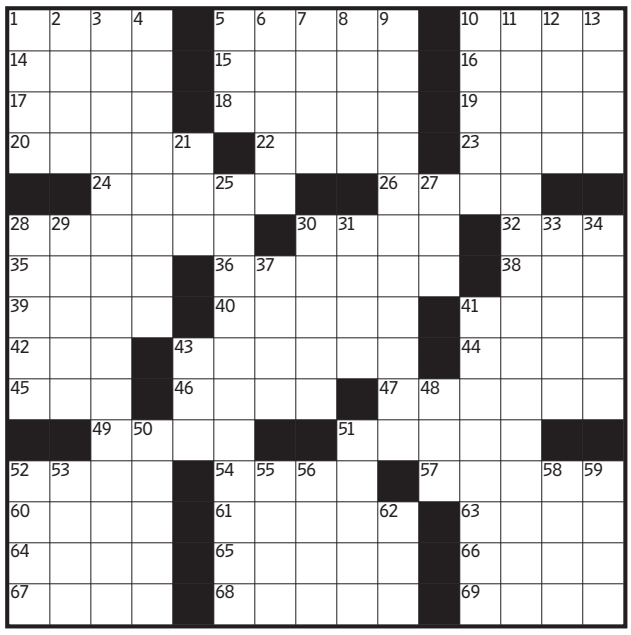
A Ghost in Your Ear
Minetta Lane Theatre,
18 Minetta Lane, New York
800-982-2787, closes Dec. 12

Mr. Isherwood is the Journal's theater critic.

Lucas Iverson, right, and with Owen Campbell, below, in 'A Ghost in Your Ear.'

FROM TOP: MONIQUE CARBONI; MATTHEW MURPHY (2)

The WSJ Daily Crossword | Edited by Mike Shenk



PUZZLE CONTEST

WAVING HELLO | By Matt Gaffney

The answer to this week's contest crossword is a #1 hit of the 1980s.

Across

1 Sieve makeup
5 Pisa pick-me-up
10 Make mittens, maybe
14 Trade show
15 Colgate competitor
16 Clinton cabinet member
17 Poi source
18 Face cover in Jalalabad
19 Othello didn't promote him
20 Buggy drivers
22 Punta del ___ (Uruguayan resort)
23 Quarrel
24 Horan of One Direction
26 Visitor to Oz
28 Tuna type
30 "One more thing..."
32 Young fellow
35 It disbanded in 1991
36 Use, as a dinner plate
38 Nuptial promise
39 Feed bag contents
40 Where dirhams are spent
41 Put away
42 Scot's refusal
43 Faces no danger
44 Give a hoot
45 King topper
46 Green shot
47 Company with little training
49 Fluffy bread
51 Make sense
52 Job at hand
54 Chaps competitor
57 "Goosebumps" creator
60 "Young Frankenstein" role
61 Lost on purpose
63 Pre-1917 ruler
64 Rubik of cubic creation
65 Birdie beater
66 France's Côte d'___
67 Speak with your fingers
68 Tablet amounts
69 Sewer scurriers

Down

1 Puzzle with an extra level
2 Grade determiner
3 "Thunder Road" or "I'm Goin' Down," say
4 Bloomington students
5 Trick out of money
6 Shakespeare sprite
7 User guide sections
8 Like the Pampas
9 Famed Brooklyn baseball venue
10 Nirvana bassist Novoselic
11 It's baked at high heat in a wood-fired oven
12 "Young Frankenstein" role
13 Horn noise
21 Holstein chow
25 Ethan Ampadu's team
27 "That's bad news"
28 Good, for Garibaldi
29 Noteworthy Newton
30 Chance to do well at home
31 Bakery buy
33 Find darling
34 Wooden rod
37 It borders It.
41 Recon vehicle
43 It's got lots of hops
48 Wallet cards
50 Goodyear's HQ location
51 Singer on "25" and "30"
52 Evens up
53 Prefix with business
55 Oscar-winning "Nomadland" director Chloe
56 Assns.
58 Like a capt.'s charts
59 Messes up
62 Bentley of "Yellowstone"

Previous Puzzle's Solution

R	U	B	■	E	V	O	K	E	S	■	I	A	G	O
A	B	U	■	M	I	R	R	E	N	■	S	L	I	D
F	E	T	T	U	C	C	I	N	E	A	L	F	R	E
A	R	T	C	L	A	S	S	■	E	M	A	I	L	S
■	■	O	M	A	R	■	■	E	Z	I	N	E	S	■
I	N	N	■	T	A	B	■	R	E	N	D	■	■	■
N	O	M	D	E	G	U	E	R	■	D	E	B	B	I
A	L	A	I	■	E	L	W	A	Y	■	R	E	A	M
N	A	N	A	S	■	G	E	N	O	A	S	A	L	A
■	■	■	G	L	U	E	■	D	U	B	■	R	E	X
■	M	A	N	O	R	S	■	■	N	A	D	A	■	■
S	O	N	O	M	A	■	T	A	G	S	A	L	E	S
E	N	D	S	O	N	A	H	I	G	H	N	O	T	E
G	E	R	E	■	U	N	O	D	U	E	■	F	R	A
A	Y	E	S	■	S	T	R	A	N	D	■	T	E	N

▶ Email your answer—in the subject line—to **crosswordcontest@wsj.com** by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time Sunday, Oct. 18. A solver selected at random will win a WSJ mug. Last week's winner: Wendy Rayner, Cannon Falls, MN. Complete contest rules at **WSJ.com/Puzzles**. (No purchase necessary. Void where prohibited. U.S. residents 18 and over only.)

SPORTS

Teams Are Stumped By a Simple Coin Flip

NFL coaches can't decide whether it's optimal to kick or receive at the start of overtime—which only means that the new rules are working

By Andrew Beaton

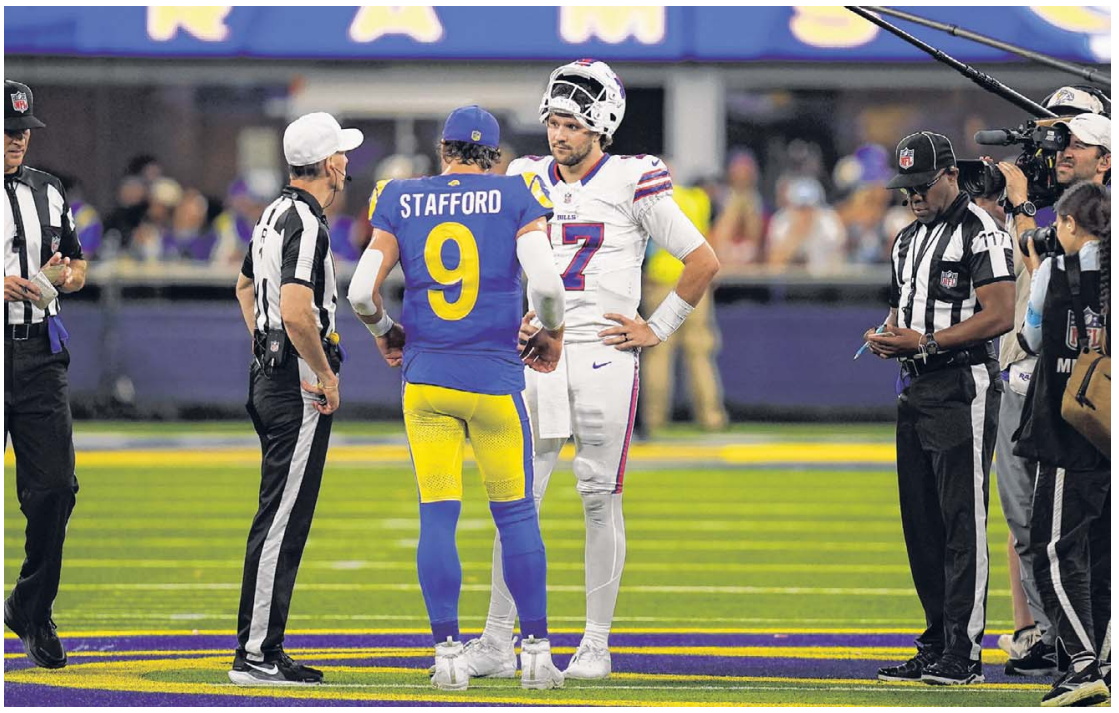
Los Angeles Rams quarterback Matthew Stafford stood at midfield on Monday night to make one of the most consequential decisions of his night. As the referee's coin landed on tails before overtime, he mimicked a kicking motion. The Rams had elected to boot the ball away and let the Buffalo Bills have it first.

And it nearly paid off—until everything went awry.

After forcing a Bills fumble, the Rams set up a game-winning field goal that Buffalo blocked. Just a few minutes later, a Buffalo field goal sealed a 37-34 victory.

The back-and-forth encapsulated how a decision that used to be simple—whether or not to receive the ball at the start of overtime—has become hopelessly fraught. Under the NFL's previous overtime rules, when a touchdown on the opening possession could end the game, everyone understood that winning the coin toss conferred an enormous advantage.

These days, it's far less obvious. In fact, since the rule was changed ahead of last season, teams have predominantly opted to kick the ball away. And yet, so far, the team receiving the first drive has actually fared better.



Rams quarterback Matthew Stafford and Bills quarterback Josh Allen meet before the overtime coin toss.

If that seems a bit baffling, that's also the point. There used to be a clear edge for the team that won the coin flip. Now, coaches see benefits to both kicking and receiving, and they're sorting through in public with games on the line.

"It was exceedingly rare for a team to not want the ball, and now we've entered a time where I think it's up for debate," says Mike Lopez, the NFL's senior director of football and analytics. "This is more fair for the team that goes second."

When the NFL mulled changes to its overtime rules last year, the coaches and executives who oversee these changes considered several factors: Would the format look like traditional football? Would it be exciting or drag on too long? And most importantly, would it be fair?

What they knew was that under the NFL's previous overtime rules for regular-season games, it wasn't anywhere close to fair. From 2017 to 2024, the team that won the coin toss won 60% of the time.

So last year the league adopted a change that had previously been implemented for the postseason: A touchdown on the opening drive would no longer end the game, and both teams would have an opportunity to possess the ball in the 10-minute period.

Since then, there have been 22 overtime games. In 16 of those, the winner of the coin toss has chosen to kick. But in the limited number of games thus far, the receiving team has won more often with 13 wins, seven losses and two ties.

The split is born out of teams seeing a distinct advantage to both sides of the coin.

Kicking off comes with the benefit of information that the receiving team doesn't have. For instance, if the team with the first possession winds up scoring a touchdown, its opponent knows precisely what it must do: Go for it on every fourth down.

Not mastering these subtleties can lead to disasters—just as it did in the Super Bowl three years ago. The San Francisco 49ers won the toss and opted to receive. They settled for a short field goal, but lost when the Kansas City Chiefs responded with a touchdown.

Some 49ers admitted after that they weren't aware of the rule change that allowed both teams to possess the ball.

"I assumed you just want the ball because you score a touchdown and win, but I guess that's not the case," 49ers fullback Kyle Juszczyk said. "I don't totally know the strategy there."

Receiving the first possession now comes with a different upside: the first crack at possessing the ball again if the two teams are still tied. That's how the Bills wound up with their game-winning field goal against the Rams.

The dueling forces can also produce unusual outcomes. Earlier this season, the Detroit Lions began overtime with a touchdown before the New Orleans Saints matched them. With time dwindling, the Saints knew that kicking the ball off would almost certainly result in a tie or loss. So rather than kicking the extra point to tie the game, the Saints went for a two-point conversion.

"We had a chance to go win the football game," Saints coach Kellen Moore said.

Instead, they wound up losing when their pass attempt fell incomplete.

GREGORY BULL/AP

Bauers Is the Brewers' Playoff Hero. He Was Close to Quitting Baseball.

By Jared Diamond

Los Angeles

Two years ago, Jake Bauers wanted to retire. He had been playing professional baseball since he was just 17, spending more than a decade bouncing across seven different organizations with little success. After batting .199 for the Milwaukee Brewers in 2024, he was frustrated, burned out and ready to move on.

Then came the news that changed his life in ways he never could have imagined. Bauers' wife, Lauren, learned she was pregnant with the couple's second child. Suddenly, Jake's plan to become a stay-at-home dad while Lauren returned to her teaching job no longer seemed viable. They needed health insurance—so Bauers begrudgingly decided to give his floundering athletic career one last chance.

"I think," Brewers owner Mark Attanasio said, "there was some divine intervention."

Whatever the reason, the Brewers are glad Bauers stuck with it. They entered Thursday holding a commanding 3-0 lead over the Los Angeles Dodgers in the National League Championship Series, sitting one win away from reaching the World Series for the first time since 1982.

And Bauers, the man who not long ago was on the verge of quitting the game entirely, might be the biggest reason why.

Bauers delivered the knockout blow in Milwaukee's 6-2 victory on Wednesday, smashing a go-ahead, two-run home run off ace Blake Snell to give the Brewers a lead they would never relinquish. The blast came on the 11th pitch of the at-bat—fitting for a player whose entire existence in the major leagues is the result of unrelenting tenacity.

"It's just inspiring," Milwaukee outfielder Sal Frelick said. "It's just a testament to his mindset."

Throughout 2026, Bauers has embodied the Brewers' ethos, demonstrating the kind of resilience that has made the team that plays in MLB's smallest media market an unlikely juggernaut. Now 31, he had the season of a lifetime, emerging as an unexpected star. He led Milwaukee with 26 homers, to go along with his .266 batting average, 86 RBIs and .874 on-base-plus-slugging percentage. They were all career highs.

But nothing has been as meaningful as his gritty performance in the NLCS. Bauers was a hero in Game 2, when he battled Yoshinobu Yamamoto for more than seven minutes, seeing 12 pitches before drawing a critical walk to load the bases.

The next batter, Christian Yelich, drove in two runs with a single to knock Yamamoto out of the game in the third inning and leave the Dodgers reeling. After that display, his teammates were awestruck.

"I didn't think he could have a better at-bat than the one he had against Yamamoto," Frelick said. "And he did, somehow."

The Brewers were struggling when Bauers stepped to the plate in the seventh on Wednesday. The Dodgers had just scored twice to take the lead and appeared to be roaring back to life after an anemic start to the series.

That's when Bauers went to work against Snell. He fouled off Snell's fastball, changeup, curveball and slider. Then Snell left a 98 mph heater in the middle of the zone—and Bauers pounced, sending the ball 412 feet deep into the right-field seats, silencing the raucous Dodger Stadium crowd.

"The impressive thing about those at-bats is staying in the at-bat and not giving in," second baseman Brice Turang said. "The swing is obviously very impressive, but you don't get there unless you're staying focused pitch to pitch and not giving in."

Earlier in this NLCS, Bauers couldn't help but reflect on his journey to this point. Standing on the field before Game 1 during the national anthem, he thought about his family. He admitted that as he tried to establish himself in a sport that kept beating him down, he wasn't always the best husband and father.

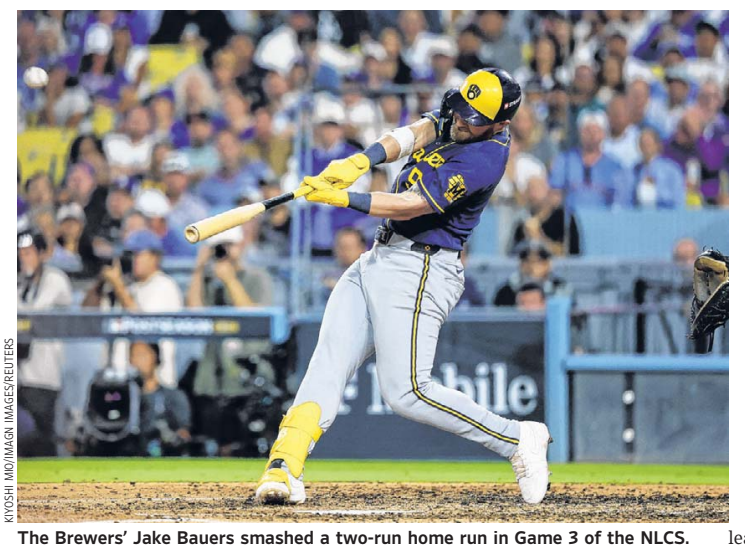
Bauers signed a minor-league contract with the Brewers in 2025, merely hoping to earn a spot on the roster. The season, like so many before it, didn't go all that well at first. In early September, Bauers was hitting .188.

Around then, he arrived at a realization. His only hope was to stop thinking about his failures, stop caring so much about the results—and play ball.

"I started caring about competing," Bauers said. "I started caring about being in the moment and getting out of my own way."

Bauers hit .378 over his final 19 games last season. He hasn't stopped hitting since—and the Brewers are on the brink of a pennant 44 years in the making.

"I came into this year feeling like there was really only one person holding me back, and that was myself," Bauers said. "I just gave myself the space to believe that I could play. I could play in this league."


The Brewers' Jake Bauers smashed a two-run home run in Game 3 of the NLCS.

KIYOSHI MIO/IMAGN IMAGES/REUTERS

Jon Rahm had over $100 million left on his contract with LIV Golf.

Jon Rahm Reaches Deal To Leave LIV Golf

By Andrew Beaton

WHEN JON RAHM JOINED LIV

Golf in late 2023 on a contract worth hundreds of millions, the golf league appeared to be on the verge of joining the sport's establishment. Its Saudi backers had struck a framework deal with the PGA Tour—and Rahm was about to become one of the richest golfers on the planet.

Over the next three years, however, that deal collapsed and Saudi Arabia's Public Investment Fund pulled its backing. All of which leaves Rahm forfeiting much of his payday as part of his exit.

Now, as LIV fights for its life in bankruptcy court, it has struck a separation agreement with Rahm that settles his outstanding claims against the league in exchange for his name, image and likeness, along with other rights. The two-time major champion was directly owed $7.5 million by LIV when it filed for bankruptcy last month. But that figure only represented only a fraction of what he was due over the remainder of his contract. Rahm had over $100 million left on his deal, a person familiar with the matter said.

Rahm's departure, formalized last week, struck a huge blow to LIV as it scrambles to restructure under a new model in which players will own a majority of the league. BC Partners, a British investment firm, has committed up to $300 million to the relaunch, but its total investment is contingent on a certain number of players staying aboard. There is a deadline later this month for players to formally sign on.

That leaves just a matter of days for LIV to convince its remaining high-profile players, led by Bryson DeChambeau, that its new vision is viable. The Saudis pumped over $5 billion into LIV before backing out after the enterprise hemorrhaged money since its 2022 inception.

Rahm chose to chart a new path, right as it became clear that the options for LIV players were winnowing. While LIV chief executive Scott O'Neil has touted the idea that players should be able to compete freely across different tours, the golf ecosystem hasn't agreed. Europe's DP World Tour recently banned LIV players from competing next year after previously agreeing to allow them to bounce back and forth.

What's less clear is whether Rahm will find a route to play on the PGA Tour next season. Five-time major winner Brooks Koepka rejoined from LIV this year through a unique pathway created by the Tour with stiff financial penalties. But Rahm didn't enlist and PGA Tour chief executive Brian Rolapp has said that was a one-time only program.

Instead, Rahm could be left to follow in the footsteps of fellow Masters champion Patrick Reed, who is set to return to the PGA Tour next year after playing in Europe and earning back his membership. Rahm is scheduled to play in the DP World Tour's penultimate event of the season next month.

BRIAN SPURLOCK/ICON SMI/ZUMA PRE

OPINION

Wealth Taxes' French Connection

POLITICAL ECONOMICS
By Joseph C. Sternberg

Californians have a special opportunity when they vote in this year's midterm. They can Make France Great Again. That's what's at stake in the ballot measure to approve a wealth tax.

Proposition 40 has a good claim to be the most significant item on the ballot anywhere in America this cycle. That's only partly due to the fiscal math and the economics of the proposed 5% tax on those with assets above $1 billion. On the merits, the policy is a dog.

As dangerous is the attitude Proposition 40 embodies. Its premise is that any and all private wealth constitutes an illegitimate diversion of resources away from the state. Despite the initial application to fortunes only above $1 billion, one discerns in the academic literature behind Proposition 40 no limiting principle.

This is foreign to America's political tradition, in which property rights are a foundation of our liberty. The tax is entirely redistributive and punitive, and in this regard its philosophical radicalness is underappreciated. Probably because the danger it poses to the economy is so distracting.

That's where the French come in. It's notable that the key academic advocates of Proposition 40, and wealth taxes in general, are French. Emmanuel Saez, an economist who teaches at University of California, Berkeley, is credited as one of the authors of Proposition 40. His frequent collaborator Gabriel Zucman is a vocal proponent. Between them they have done more than any other economists to provide an intellectual veneer to the case for introducing wealth taxes in America.

Messrs. Saez and Zucman derive their conclusions from Thomas Piketty, also French, whose 2014 book, "Capital in the Twenty-First Century," revived academic and popular interest in inequality. Mr. Piketty's political influence has proved more durable than his book's methodological credibility, and debate still rages about whether any of these people can accurately measure "wealth" at all.

This isn't a knock on the French, who can be lovely people when they aren't rioting. But the French origins of Proposition 40 are significant. For one, these economists come from a political-economy tradition very different from America's.

More to the point, they come from a country that is broke. France has just wrapped up another week of rioting over its government's lack of money. This time students are demanding more cash for schools. At various other times it was government employees, retirees and farmers. With a nearly 120% ratio of government debt to gross domestic product and fiscal deficits above 5% of GDP each year, there's no money to give them.

This has encouraged the spread of the convenient fantasy that France—and, by extension, Europe's other bankrupt states—would have enough money to spend if only the wealthy could be forced to pay their fair share of taxes. Most of the global tax debate of the past decade traces back to this myth.

Europeans cherish a fantasy that higher U.S. taxes can make France great again.

The problem is that France already tried a wealth tax of its own. It was a flop. The levy consistently generated less revenue than predicted, and President Emmanuel Macron scrapped it in 2018. French economists managed to avoid learning anything about incentives, prosperity or fiscal sustainability from this experience. But they do think they know how to make a wealth tax work better.

Wealth-tax supporters argue the French attempt failed because it exempted large pools of wealth, especially related to business ownership. Crucially, wealthy Frenchmen also were able to shift their tax residence elsewhere in Europe to avoid it.

The "solution" in both instances is universality, both geographically and in terms of the definition of the tax base. The principle is simple: Wealth taxes must be applied, and they must be applied everywhere.

Et voilà. This explains key features of Proposition 40, such as its application to ownership stakes in businesses and its attempts to thwart Californians who might move elsewhere. And also why it's so important to this crew that wealth taxation take root in America in the first place.

Similar thinking explains an earlier failed attempt to persuade America to adopt a European style of corporate taxation (Google "OECD BEPS" if you must). There too the goal was to universalize European levels of taxation. Mr. Zucman was a leading proponent.

Many Europeans seem to believe that America's tax system is the greatest threat to their own national finances. This misdiagnoses the root of their troubles. Still, it's true that as long as the U.S. is available as a relatively friendly home for investors and companies, the reality of capital and human mobility will impose a practical limit on France's ability to tax itself. Changing this would require a wrenching breach in America's political economy surrounding property rights and taxation—a process Proposition 40 would begin.

Fixing France's public finances is a worthy goal. But Californians are under no obligation to help.

Two Churches Divided by a Common Faith

HOUSES OF WORSHIP
By Dmitri Solzhenitsyn

The gates of hell shall not prevail against the church, Jesus says in Matthew 16:18. But one can understand why some Christians may look at the endless divisions and schisms between those who profess faith in Christ and think that hell is at least doing its best to prevail.

The largest and most painful division is the one that has separated the Eastern churches from the Western churches—the Orthodox from the Catholic—for a millennium. To the Orthodox (like me), the fullness of the church today is realized in each local Orthodox church at the celebration of the Eucharist, because Christ is wholly present in the consecrated gifts. These churches display their unity with one another through communion (excepting recent canonical schisms between several Orthodox churches). Roman Catholicism holds a similar view, with the caveat that a local church's communion with the pope is essential to its being fully within the church.

Both communions deny that the schism between Catholics and the Orthodox has, in any essential sense, divided Christ's one body.

Why, then, should Catholic and Orthodox Christians care about unity? The most pressing answer is that schism contradicts the will of Christ, who prayed in John 17:21 "that they all may be one; as thou, Father, art in me, and I in thee, . . . that the world may believe that thou hast sent me."

The Orthodox liturgy of St. John Chrysostom invokes Christ's prayer when we ask for the "union of all." Catholics frequently pray for unity as well. Though genuine theological barriers stand in the way of Orthodox-Catholic communion, we share across the divide a remarkable amount in common: our Trinitarian theology and our Christology, our belief in apostolic succession and our sacramental worship centered around the Eucharist.

Similarly, we both embrace holy tradition, including the Bible, the church fathers and the seven ancient ecumenical councils, and we venerate the cross, Mary, saints, icons and holy relics. In view of this overwhelming harmony, can we honestly say that we have done our best to follow Christ's prayer for unity over the past thousand years?

On a practical level, the division is no more defensible. Catholics have missed Orthodoxy's rich monastic tradition, its conciliar ecclesiology, and its liturgical stability. The Orthodox have missed Rome's ability to coordinate, its missionary zeal, its indefatigability in serving the needy, and its intellectual heritage. Both communions suffer pastoral costs as a result of the schism, including broken families and strained marriages. We face the threats of Islamic expansion, secularism, materialism and transhumanism divided when we should be united.

Leaders in both communions recognize the tragedy of the schism and are striving to overcome it. Catholic and Orthodox bishops, clergy and laity gathered in July at the St. John Paul II National Shrine in Washington for a conference on unity. Cardinal Seán O'Malley called the divisions "scandalous," insisting they had left converts "sad and embarrassed." His exhortation was simple: "Come together and pray for unity."

The estrangement between Orthodox Christians and Catholics is a scandal.

Pope Leo XIV has taken as his motto "In Illo uno unum": In the one Christ we are one. Last November he joined Ecumenical Patriarch Bartholomew of Constantinople, Patriarch Theodore II of Alexandria and other Orthodox representatives to mark the 1,700th anniversary of the First Council of Nicaea. The pope and the ecumenical patriarch affirmed in a joint declaration their churches' orientation toward "the hoped-for restoration of full communion." Even Patriarch Kirill of Moscow, who leads one of the Orthodox churches most skeptical about Rome, has expressed hope that relations "will progressively develop for a joint witness to Christ."

These symbolic gestures don't directly address the longstanding theological barriers, but there has been some progress over the past several years. The 2023 Alexandria Document was an important step toward a joint understanding of papal authority, though not all Orthodox churches ratified the statement.

Patriarch Bartholomew, for his part, has prayed that the obstacles of the filioque—Rome's teaching that the Holy Spirit proceeds from the Father and the Son, rather than from the Father alone—and papal infallibility be resolved so that they "no longer serve as stumbling blocks to the communion of our churches." The patriarch mentioned these two obstacles intentionally, and a joint international commission plans to examine them head-on over the next several years.

But reunion is the work of all believers, not just hierarchs and theologians. Our churches will surely resolve their objective differences more readily if the faithful harbor mutual affinity and a sincere desire for unity, as expressed through prayer. We must hold fast to Christ's call that we be one, hoping that the Holy Spirit will make it a reality this side of the Second Coming.

Mr. Solzhenitsyn is a John Harvard Scholar and is the author of "Reuniting Rome With the Orthodox: How the Great Schism Unfolded—and Might Yet Be Healed."

Haley Stevens Backs a 'Hate Movement'

By Josh Levs

When a politician displays moral clarity under pressure, it commands attention. So it was good to see Rep. Haley Stevens (D., Mich.) make news recently. When an anti-Israel agitator stalked her at the Capitol last month and said, "We will see you at the gallows," she responded calmly but forcefully. "There is no genocide," she told the man. "Anti-Zionism is a hate movement."

She's right. Anti-Zionism denies the Jewish people alone the right to national self-determination in their ancestral homeland. It seeks the political and physical dismantling of an existing state by the most barbaric means.

Yet Ms. Stevens has endorsed an anti-Zionist for U.S. Senate. After losing the Michigan primary to Abdul El-Sayed, she threw her support behind him and called on other Democrats to do the same. Mr. El-Sayed is a champion of the movement Ms. Stevens rightly condemned. He repeats the genocide lie, works to delegitimize the Jewish state, and refuses to acknowledge the existence of Islamist terrorism.

When I raised this contradiction on my podcast and Substack, Ms. Stevens responded on Instagram: "I lost a Democratic primary and conceded," she wrote. "Are you asking me to ignore or avoid a core tenet of our democracy because I disagree with the person who won?"

That's what she calls anti-Zionism, yet she has endorsed Abdul El-Sayed for Senate.

What "core tenet" is that? She wrote: "Michigan voters made their choice, and respecting that choice doesn't mean I suddenly agree with him on everything."

But Michigan voters don't make their choice until Nov. 3, and while party loyalty is a normal feature of our democracy, it isn't a core tenet. No principle compels an elected official to bend the knee to bigotry for the sake of party discipline.

Adlai Stevenson III understood this in 1986, when he relinquished the Democratic nomination for governor of Illinois rather than share a ticket with the voters' choice for lieutenant governor, a follower of the extremist Lyndon LaRouche.

Republicans, including President George H.W. Bush, understood it too in 1991, when they backed Democrat Edwin Edwards in a runoff for Louisiana governor over Republican candidate David Duke.

The experience of Sen. John Fetterman is instructive. He has refused to play ball with the Democrats' growing anti-Israel contingent and has called out the vile hatred he receives. "I've drunk deeply of the venom of both the left and the right," he wrote in his book, "Unfettered." "And as a connoisseur, I can confirm that the most poisonous, the bitterest is from the far left."

In her Instagram comment, Ms. Stevens said she would "always call out antisemitism, especially when it comes from my own side," and added: "I still belong in the Democratic Party, too. If I want this party to reflect the values I believe in, how am I supposed to help shape it by walking away? You stay. You speak up. You fight for what you believe in from within. That's grit."

No it isn't. If she had endorsed Republican Mike Rogers, or even simply declined to make an endorsement, she would have made a clear statement. By endorsing Mr. El-Sayed, she walked away from what she believes in.

Mr. Levs hosts the podcast "They Stand Corrected."

BOOKSHELF | By Meghan Cox Gurdon

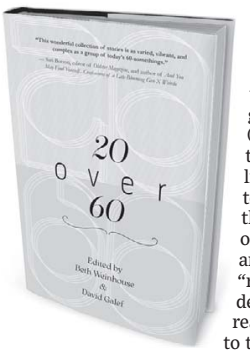
Short Stories With a Long View

20 Over 60

Edited by Beth Weinhouse and David Galef
Regal House, 266 pages, $21.95

As a girl, I remember being mystified by entire aisles at the drugstore: Who needs this stuff? With each passing decade, it was as though the product labels came into focus. I began to understand which customers might have a use for skin-tightening creams, fiber supplements and artificial tears. Something of the same process holds with the short stories collected in "20 Over 60," a beguiling if uneven compendium of pieces written by 20 authors in their later years. As with age-related merchandise at the drugstore, the stories are available to anyone, but they will have special application for those who have reached what the excessively tactful used to call "a certain age."

Husband-and-wife editors David Galef and Beth Weinhouse previously published "20 Over 40" (2006), which was itself a response, of sorts, to "20 Under 30" (1986), a collection of works by promising young American writers, edited by Debra Spark. Mr. Galef and Ms. Weinhouse, in their two collections, have gathered short works of (mostly) realistic fiction having to do with a particular stage of life. As they note in a preface to "20 Over 60," the two of them had assumed when collaborating on their previous anthology that older age was "mostly about decline." Two decades on, they have come to realize that "there's a richness to this age that we hardly imagined. . . . Competence and confidence help compensate for a no-longer-youthful body. Self-knowledge and experience make for a form of contentment."



The stories assembled here bear out the editors' appraisal, though, as with all collections, some offerings are better than others. It is not surprising that the standout pieces were contributed by celebrated longtime practitioners of literary fiction, nor that their stories should all deal with the category shifts of older age. Even when welcome, though, such changes can be discomfiting. People retire, have grandchildren, liquidate a family home or go from being robust to becoming, as the saying goes, medically interesting.

In "First Love," Paul Theroux conjures the subtle awkwardness of an older man spending a week in the household of his married son. Mr. Theroux, the author of numerous travelogues (such as 1975's "The Great Railway Bazaar") and more than two dozen novels (including 1981's "The Mosquito Coast"), uses a light touch in this affecting story. His protagonist is a writer who's trying to build a relationship with his grandchild, Ben, while navigating the half-suppressed scorn of his daughter-in-law and the irritated complacency of his son. "They were in motion when I arrived, and they stayed in motion," he says of the couple when he arrives, finding that he is treated not as a guest or honored elder but as a babysitter who, by his presence (and past statements) is also an imposition.

The prolific novelist and short-story writer Joyce Carol Oates introduces readers to Julia, one half of a couple whose long marriage has come to contain strange, submerged, undiscussable elements in "The Disappearing." Julia's husband, Ryan, is "making her uneasy." He seems secretive. The partner "whom she knew, or believed she knew" is, Julia thinks, "not altogether the same man" as the Ryan with whom she now lives. Is Julia's changing perception a result of some fundamental alteration in her husband? Or is their growing alienation taking place only in her head? After all, Ms. Oates writes in this unsettling story, when Julia now sees Ryan "at a little distance, in a parking lot or on the street," she doesn't always recognize him.

Tales from Paul Theroux, Joyce Carol Oates and other writers capture the experiences—comfortable and otherwise—of older age.

Jane Gardam, who died in 2025, highlights the longing of older people to establish attachments in the easy way of youth. Her "Soul Mates" may be a ghost story or a tale of wish fulfillment tinged with the fabulous. As a novelist, Gardam won special acclaim for her Old Filth trilogy, published between 2004 and 2013, about an elderly English barrister and judge. Here she writes of a persnickety English couple, freshly retired, who yearn to meet people with the same interests and standards as themselves. A chance encounter with a simpatico married pair offers the possibility of friendship—but soon gives way to something spookier.

Other stories in the collection are less assured. It is jarring to come across a prediction that Jared Kushner will become president in 2028 and sell Florida to Cuba, which is part of the fever dream that K.G. Anderson tries to summon in "Patti 209," a creaky bit of science fiction about a high-tech nursing home. The writing style of Sid Sibo in "Incongruous" suffers from congestion. Rebecca Keller's "Meals of a Lifetime" is marked by dreariness.

Yet dreary subjects can be made compelling, as Mr. Galef shows when he steps aside from editing to supply the final story in the book. His "Receding Portrait" takes readers on a fictional trip down the one-way staircase of old age, where a fall leads to hospitalization, hospitalization to rehab, rehab to recovery and recovery to another fall. What makes the story sing is the author's ability to evoke the consciousness of an intelligent person in decline. "Sometimes I feel as if I changed from a boy to an old man overnight," the narrator remarks. "But more often I feel like a gradually loaded container of years. I need to walk slowly or I'll spill over."

Tess Gerritsen, the author of many thrillers, once had an older character, a former spy, observe that for a clandestine agent "gray hair is the best disguise." The world might look and think it sees some nice, dismissible senior citizen. As we are reminded in these stories by and about those in the gray-haired cohort, people over 60 are still people, not all of them nice.

Mrs. Gurdon is a Free Expression columnist at WSJ Opinion. Her memoir, "Free Range Girl," will be out Oct. 20.

Coming in BOOKS this weekend

Rod Serling and 'The Twilight Zone' • Weimar and the rise of Nazism • Technology in the brain • The magic of leaves • The 19th-century short story • Edward Hopper • Feline fascination • The food of Philadelphia • & more

OPINION

REVIEW & OUTLOOK

The Market's Rude Reminder on AI

It's too soon to call what happened this week to artificial intelligence stocks a correction. Call it instead a reminder: Hype about new technologies is an inevitable human temptation, and sometimes it pays off, but eventually investors demand returns on capital.

Sooner or later investors will demand returns, and there will be losers.

That's the way to think about the disconcerting market swings of recent days. Many tech shares have taken a dive, sometimes by large percentages. That has dragged down the NASDAQ and the S&P 500 index, which has come to be dominated by those companies. Our advice is to go for a relaxing walk this weekend instead of checking your 401(k) balance.

This seems counterintuitive in the face of encouraging earnings reports from some big AI-related companies, and in some cases the good earnings news arrested the decline in the company's stock price. But stock prices are forward rather than backward looking, and investors still are grappling with big questions about the AI future.

AI will have a profound effect on the global economy. It remains impossible to say what those effects might be or who will profit from them, and how. Estimates of global AI-related investments regularly top $1 trillion per year and probably are undercounts after including other forms of investment such as the companies that adopt AI in their own businesses.

This implies that AI would need to boost to substantially boost business productivity and generate unprecedented returns eventually. One recent academic study calculated that American data-center hyperscalers alone would need to earn revenue equal to roughly 9% of gross domestic product per year by 2032 to break even on their investments.

America's ability to raise and allocate this private capital—the institutional investors and entrepreneurs, the legal system and market structure—is the envy of the world. But unforgiving market discipline on the way down is a not-so-secret ingredient in the special sauce.

As AI continues to evolve, the challenge will be to reevaluate the risks and do so relative to other bets. It's a continuous process that plays out every second markets are open.

Investors this week didn't abandon equities entirely, even if they did pour some capital back into the bond market. Instead, they pivoted into recently overlooked industries such as consumer goods. The Dow Jones Industrial Average had a decent week.

None of this is to downplay the potential dangers. The sheer quantity of capital that has flowed into tech suggests that if and when investors decide a large-scale reappraisal is required, it is likely to be bloody. All the more so since much of this investment has been financed with debt, especially via opaque private-credit markets. Credit can turn a technological reappraisal into a financial panic or worse.

All of this poses challenges for politicians and policy makers, even as they enjoy the equity ride up. One is monetary: Loose money tends to encourage the kind of credit mania that's especially dangerous when it coincides with a technological revolution. On this score, it's a welcome development if tech investors are acting in part on a growing conviction that Federal Reserve Chairman Kevin Warsh intends to pour less rum into the punchbowl.

Another is regulatory, as officials must stay alert to the corners of the financial system where potential risks may lurk. The goal here isn't to shield everyone everywhere from any loss. It is rather to ensure that markets will be able to operate effectively even in a correction and without recourse to public bailouts. Hey, we can dream.

AI as a technology is a winner and so far has been a boon to the economy without the feared job losses. Whether all the companies currently developing AI will be winners is a different question. Now, time for that walk.

The Democratic Hormuz Alternative

Take Hormuz—please! With apologies to Henny Youngman, that appears to be an emerging Democratic message on Iran. In a TV debate Tuesday night, Iowa's Senate candidate Josh Turek was asked about letting Iran control the strait. What does Mr. Turek consider an acceptable ending to the war? "As soon as possible," he replied. Twice he said "immediately."

'Just get out,' Troy Jackson says. And let Iran charge terror tolls?

Meantime in Maine, Democrat Troy Jackson in a Tuesday debate suggested defunding military action against Iran, despite U.S. troops still in the war zone. Incumbent Sen. Susan Collins is the GOP's appropriations chair. "If she wants to stop the funding for it, she has the ability to stop the funding," Mr. Jackson said. His advice to President Trump? "You're just going to have to own this one, because there is no way to resolve this. Let's just get out."

Both parties have heard the public dissatisfaction with Mr. Trump's erratic conduct of the war, which is why many Republicans are also criticizing it. But Iran is still firing on ships in the Strait of Hormuz, because it wants to turn the international waterway into a toll route to earn billions of dollars for its terror empire. Mr. Turek is OK with that? And Mr. Jackson would cut off the money to prevent it?

"I don't want to leave our troops unprotected," Ms. Collins responded. "I think that would be totally irresponsible. I do want to make sure that they are safe. They are in countries all around Iran." Besides firing on nearby ships, the messianic regime in Tehran has also shot at the United Arab Emirates, Saudi Arabia, Bahrain, Kuwait, Jordan and Israel.

John Sununu, New Hampshire's GOP Senate nominee, made a similar point in a Tuesday debate against Democratic Rep. Chris Pappas. "It was a mistake to go into Iran without a plan to keep the Strait of Hormuz open," Mr. Sununu said. Yet he added: "I don't think it would be wise right now to cut off funding for those vessels and aircraft carriers that are helping to move cargo and oil through the strait and keep commerce flowing."

High oil prices are creating real hardship for voters. But the alternative offered by Messrs. Turek and Jackson is defeat and conceding control to Iran, while giving China the impression that international waters are negotiable based on the U.S. political calendar. That result would be worse for American interests.

Slapping Down an Insubordinate Court

The Supreme Court on Wednesday, for the second time in recent weeks (*FCC v. Brown*), slapped down a Fourth Circuit Court of Appeals panel that sought to help Democrats politically. Maybe the Justices wouldn't have to use their emergency docket as often if lower courts didn't keep committing acts of legal insubordination.

The Justices rebuke the Fourth Circuit for its election gamesmanship.

In an unsigned opinion, the Justices rebuked the Fourth Circuit panel for ordering the Federal Communications Commission to rule pronto on a petition by Democratic candidates. "Our system of separation of powers does not allow the Judiciary to meddle in 'the workings of a coordinate branch of the Government' in this manner," the opinion says. That's correct constitutional law.

The context for the dispute is a federal law that requires broadcasters to give candidates discounted advertising rates during the 60 days before a general election. The FCC last spring issued guidance saying that party committees coordinating with candidates are entitled to the same ad discounts. Whether this is required by federal law is murky, but there's a strong argument that the disparate legal treatment of candidates and party committees violates the First Amendment. It also benefits Democrats.

While individual Democratic candidates tend to have funding advantages over Republicans, GOP party committees are more flush than their Democratic counterparts. The FCC guidance thus stood to reduce a Democratic advantage by letting GOP party committees buy ads at discounts on par with Democratic candidates.

Enter Democratic Senate candidates, including Sherrod Brown (Ohio), Roy Cooper (North Carolina) and Jon Ossoff (Georgia), who challenged the FCC guidance through its administrative process, as required by federal law. But before the FCC decided on their complaint, the Democrats sued the agency. A divided Fourth Circuit panel ruled in their favor.

The Supreme Court in early September stayed the ruling, noting that the Communications Act "'makes clear' that the Commission must resolve an application for review by order 'before an aggrieved party may petition for further review in federal court.'" In other words, parties can't run to the courts if the FCC doesn't resolve their complaints on their preferred timeline.

The candidates then asked the Fourth Circuit to compel the FCC to rule on their appeal so they could litigate their claims. A divided Fourth Circuit panel on Oct. 7 again obliged, requiring the FCC to resolve their appeal in two days. Ready, set, go.

As Fourth Circuit Judge J. Harvie Wilkinson wrote in dissent, the majority "demands at gunpoint an agency decision which will allow the majority to reach the merits and recapitulate its own earlier conclusions, disrupting settled campaign finance rules in the hot breath of an impending election."

The Supreme Court more or less agreed. "The Fourth Circuit's decision to issue an 'extraordinary' writ was inappropriate under the circumstances," the Court said. Federal law requires the FCC to "act on every application it receives, but it does not obligate the Commission to act within a particular timeframe." Justices Sonia Sotomayor and Ketanji Brown Jackson would have kept the Fourth Circuit order in place.

In a better world, Congress would eliminate the FCC, but courts can't micromanage the administrative process created by Congress.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Is Public Execution Really the American Way?

Regarding Your editorial "How to Make a Jihadist Martyr" (Oct. 12): The irony is difficult to ignore. In the same week that Secretary of State Marco Rubio extolled the virtues of Western civilization, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth announced plans to livestream the execution of Nidal Hasan, who murdered 13 people at Fort Hood in 2009.

Your editorial was right to oppose broadcasting the execution, and thankfully, President Trump reversed Mr. Hegseth's decision, announcing Thursday that it won't be livestreamed. Beyond the risk of granting Mr. Hasan the spectacle he might seek, a public execution would have presented a deeper contradiction between the principles of Western civilization the administration claims to champion and the methods it is willing to embrace.

For two decades, American servicemembers fought and died confronting organizations such as the Taliban and ISIS, whose barbaric practices included public executions designed to intimidate and terrorize. Broadcasting an execution would have undermined the principles those Americans sacrificed their lives to defend.

Most troubling is the precedent it would have set. Today, the condemned is a mass murderer. Tomorrow, perhaps a more-ordinary criminal. And what after that? History warns of authoritarian regimes using public executions as instruments of fear, intimidation and repression.

The strength of Western civilization doesn't lie in its capacity to punish. It lies in its commitment to justice, restraint and human dignity—even toward those who demonstrate none themselves.

ALEC STEWART
Seattle

I'm strongly opposed to the death penalty, yet I would have supported a public execution of Nidal Hasan. As long as we choose to allow executions to be part of our criminal justice system, the public should be able to bear witness to the actual consequences of its support for the death penalty. If we can't stomach bearing witness to our government's public executions, then perhaps we should rethink our support for the death penalty.

TODD PICCUS
Venice, Calif.

This Isn't the Age of Illiteracy. Not Even Close

Regarding Daniel Akst's review of James Marriott's book "The New Dark Ages: The Death of Reading and the Dawn of the Post-Literate Society" ("Is Reading a Dead Letter?," Bookshelf, Oct. 8): As a historian of literacy and writing, I disagree with Messrs. Akst and Marriott.

The book Mr. Akst reviews, a copy of which sits beside me as I write this letter, is only the latest in the centuries-old hand-wringing about the end of reading. Mr. Marriott christens this era "the new Dark Ages," but the amount of reading that he admits takes place negates his notion of a "post-literate" society.

Concerns about literacy's decline coincide with every major change in communications technology. This began with the first alphabets and handwriting. It accelerated with printing, telegraphy, radio, TV, computers, social media and AI. None of these technological advances resulted in the end of reading or an era of ill-defined "post-literacy."

Further, Mr. Marriott takes liberties with the relevant scholarly literature. He ignores important studies of literacy and popular reading while he quotes from studies of unrepresentative intellectuals. Mass individual silent reading became common only in the 19th and 20th centuries, long after what we term "democratic revolutions," the Enlightenment and both the Commercial Revolution and Industrial Revolution.

Mr. Marriott expresses concern about the end of reading, but a more accurate understanding is that reading changes over time, and students and others need to be shown how to read different kinds of texts.

Through most of history, reading was collective and oral, not individual and silent. Orality and literacy can't be dichotomized or opposed.

Finally, Mr. Marriott focuses too much on the limits of reading on cellphones without taking into consideration how common and how different reading is on larger screens, from tablets and laptops to desktops.

EM. PROF. HARVEY J. GRAFF
Ohio State University
Chicago

Recycling Strengthens the American Economy

Bjorn Lomborg's assertion that "Most Recycling Is a Waste" (Oct. 8) does a disservice to an industry essential to U.S. manufacturing, our economy and our supply chains. It conflates European recycling systems with the market-based infrastructure that drives recycling in the U.S. and misses a more important question.

We should absolutely ask how to make recycling more efficient and economical. And not everything can or should be recycled. Economics, environmental outcomes and end markets matter. That doesn't mean recycling is a waste. It means we should focus on materials that have real value and real markets.

Producing aluminum from recycled material, for example, can require up to 95% less energy to produce than primary aluminum.

The economic case is significant, too. The recycled materials industry supports more than 600,000 U.S. jobs and generates $184 billion in economic activity annually.

Recycled fiber accounts for 44% of the fiber used in domestic paper mills. Over 70% of all steel manufactured in the U.S. is produced from recycled materials. From cardboard boxes to water bottles, recycled materials power American manufacturing.

Dismissing most recycling as waste sends the wrong message. The goal should be to recover more of what is valuable and put it back to work.

ROBIN WIENER
Recycled Materials Association
Washington

Higher Education Is Failing To Provide Sufficient Value

David Wippman and Glenn Altschuler say op-ed writer Jeff Yass imagines higher education's ills ("Higher Education Isn't Lacking in Innovation," Letters, Oct. 14). But are the 70% of Americans who are dissatisfied with higher ed also imagining?

The market is speaking, and the message couldn't be more clear: The collegiate status quo isn't providing enough value to students or society. Denying that reality won't save higher education. Nor will the innovations around the edges that Messrs. Wippman and Altschuler cite as proof of "experimentation."

What higher education needs is fundamental disruption of its funding model, educational model, physical footprint and everything else that defines the current campus experience. The only thing Mr. Yass is imagining is a future in which college and university presidents work with visionary philanthropists like him for the good of our country.

THOMAS E. BEACH
Naples, Fla.

Finding Real Solace in Grief

Maria Balhara's op-ed "Ritual Offers What Medicine Can't" (Oct. 13) describes actions that medical professionals take in end-of-life situations. Ms. Balhara's descriptions, along with Kenneth Brander's piece a few days earlier about the Jewish practice of sitting shiva ("The Jewish Way of Grieving," Houses of Worship, Oct. 9), are linked in the understanding that there are certain situations beyond human capacity to understand, and that there's a need for a higher authority to help us navigate them. Ritual during these difficult moments offers solace and comfort.

JEFFREY WEISS
Los Angeles

Ms. Balhara's op-ed reminded me of my wife's death in an intensive-care unit. I remember someone, perhaps a clinician, pulling me aside and telling me shortly before she died: "You know she's seriously ill." At the time, I didn't understand what she was trying to do. In hindsight, it was very important.

JON PITT
Golden, Colo.

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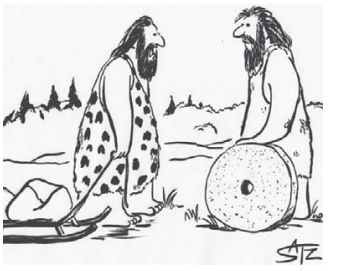
Pepper ... And Salt

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL



"Dragging sled worked great for 50,000 years. Why mess with success?"

OPINION

Alaska Considers Economic Suicide

POTOMAC WATCH
By Kimberley A. Strassel

Wasilla, Alaska

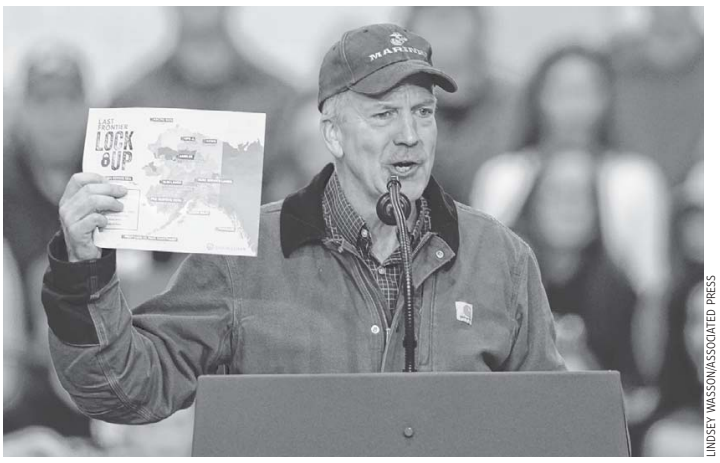
'Build the line! Build the line! Build the line!" The chant roars through the sports center as Sen. Dan Sullivan revs up the crowd. It's unleashed again when President Trump occupies the stage for his Tuesday midterm rally.

The crowd is cheering a proposed 800-mile liquefied-natural-gas pipeline that would mean jobs, energy and a cash bonanza for the state. It's a project politicians have failed to deliver for decades, but it's tantalizingly close to approval. That is, if Alaskans don't vote on Nov. 3 for political and economic suicide.

The state has prospered under Trump, and the vulnerable Sen. Dan Sullivan deserves credit.

That's the choice in the Senate election here, the message the incumbent, Mr. Sullivan, needs to land if he wants to beat Democrat Mary Peltola. Alaskans are as bitter as lower-48ers about affordability (prices are even higher in this remote state), and many voters are unenthusiastic about rewarding the party in charge. Mr. Sullivan's mission is to remind Alaska—a state almost wholly at the mercy of federal policy—that things could be worse. That a vote for Mrs. Peltola is a vote to re-empower a left determined to kill the Alaskan economy. And a vote to dismiss the only Alaskan senator with the president's ear.

That's no easy feat given an opponent who is capably capitalizing on short voter memories. Mrs. Peltola is the state's best-known Democrat—having represented Alaska in the House from 2022 to 2025. Yet on the stump you might not know she's ever heard of Chuck Schumer. She's leaning into her Native Alaskan roots, positioning herself as uniquely cognizant of the state's needs. She excoriates "politicians in D.C." like the "self-dealing" Mr. Sullivan as "corrupt" and "rigging the system" against Last Frontier residents. At events, she blames Trump policies, tariffs in particular, and Mr. Sullivan for Alaska's price problems. She praises prior Republican leaders—like her House predecessor, the late Don Young, for having put "Alaska first."



LINDSEY WASSON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Sen. Dan Sullivan (R., Alaska) in Wasilla Tuesday.

Mr. Sullivan's challenge is to refute this remarkable rewrite of recent history. Two years ago, Alaska faced an economic cliff. Joe Biden spent four years imposing the environmental left's agenda on the state, issuing more than 70 orders and actions against its economy. He banned oil and gas leases, mining projects and timber harvests. He locked up land and fisheries and barred new roads. His paltry defense budgets starved Alaska's military installations. In a state where nearly all the economy is based on oil and gas, the military, mining and seafood, this was an economic death sentence.

Mrs. Peltola served as a loyal assistant for 2½ of those years. She voted her party roughly 90% of the time, including votes to kill her own state. She voted against a bill to mandate more oil and gas leases offshore and in the National Petroleum Reserve. She voted against loan guarantees for the LNG project. In 2024, when a bill she co-sponsored to reverse the Biden administration's oil lockup in the Arctic National Wildlife Refuge and the National Petroleum Reserve finally came up, she bowed to pressure and voted "present."

That was when she bothered to show up. Mrs. Peltola's short House career was marked by chronic absenteeism. Records show she missed 17.2% of the votes in the 118th Congress—mirroring the 18.6% of votes she missed in her 10 years in the Alaska House. Maybe that's why she failed to get a single bill signed into federal law, even under a Democratic administration. (Nick Begich Jr., her successor, has shepherded nine bills into law this term.)

Alaska's nightmare ended with Mr. Trump's return to office. Elevated prices aside, things have rarely looked more optimistic for the 49th state. On stage, Mr. Sullivan rips up his list of those 70 Biden actions—a document he entitled the "Last Frontier Lockup"—to riotous applause. He notes that Mr. Trump has put unrelenting focus on Alaskan prosperity and recounts the progress.

On Inauguration Day Mr. Trump issued an order entirely dedicated to Alaska that rescinded Biden policies and ordered federal agencies to maximize the state's economic opportunities. The feds have restarted the Arctic National Wildlife Refuge. They've thrown open the National Petroleum Reserve and held a record-breaking lease sale. New fields are coming online, filling the pipeline. Washington is streamlining permits, and oil players are rushing back north.

The Trump team approved the Ambler Road project, opening access to a rich mining area. It enacted regulatory fishing reform. Its roadless rule repeal would reopen the Tongass National Forest. A military buildup is sending money and jobs for missile defense, base upgrades, and (belatedly) home ports for four icebreakers in the only state with sea ice. And a real chance at the "line," the LNG project. Mr. Trump is vowing a $50 billion South Korean investment, a deal that isn't finalized but is giving Alaskans real hope.

What Mr. Sullivan can't publicly say but savvier Alaskans understand is that these gains come down to his personal relationship with the president. Mr. Trump has a special dislike for Sen. Lisa Murkowski, given past votes against his agenda and in favor of convicting him in his 2021 impeachment trial. If Mr. Sullivan goes away, so does Alaska's line to the presidency.

Would the administration continue its existing efforts? Maybe. Would it grant further favors? Not for a Murkowski-Peltola ask. Might the president visit retribution on that duo? Quite possibly.

"Voters are really starting to understand the ramification of a Sen. Sullivan not being in D.C.—just how negatively it will affect this state," says Kevin Greene, senior adviser in Alaska for Americans for Prosperity Action, which has a team of dozens knocking on doors to remind voters of the stakes.

Mr. Sullivan faces two opponents: Mrs. Peltola and the state's ridiculous ranked-choice voting system, which the Democrats are gaming. The dirty tricks include "Decoy" Dan Sullivan, a Peltola donor now running as a Republican, who will share the November ballot with the incumbent. Republicans are feverishly trying to educate this Republican state on how to fill out the ballot in a way that doesn't accidentally elect the Democrat. If Mr. Schumer becomes Senate majority leader, it could be thanks to Alaska skullduggery.

The good news for Mr. Sullivan: Republicans are tuning in. The Trump team wisely bypassed purple Anchorage and Fairbanks to rally here, in the Mat-Su Valley, the state's most conservative borough. It paid off. Trump enthusiasts lined up in the dark on Tuesday morning, waiting hours for the president's afternoon talk. They crammed into every available space in this center, with many more braving the cold to watch outside on a big screen. The president was his usual winding self, but managed to impart the key message: Vote for Mrs. Peltola, and this state is toast. We'll see if Alaskans choose wisely.

Write to kim@wsj.com.

Generation Gaps Are Seldom as Wide as They Seem

By Todd B. Kashdan

The youngest workforce in the American auto industry walked off the job at the General Motors plant in Lordstown, Ohio, in March 1972. The average employee was only 24. Management had cut hundreds of jobs while still demanding the production of 100 cars an hour, so a task that once took a minute had to be finished in 36 seconds. GM executives blamed the unrest on workers who were undisciplined and immature. National press called the strike an "industrial Woodstock" and treated it as a generational rebellion as much as a labor dispute. Those insubordinate 24-year-olds were baby boomers. Their generation now heads the companies paying consultants to explain why Gen Z won't work as hard as they supposedly did.

Fifty years later, the so-called generational communications gap persists. A survey of 1,200 American workers heading into 2026 found that 57% of Gen Z respondents were considering a job change, compared with 20% of baby boomers, a finding many interpret as proof that young workers have abandoned loyalty.

But young workers have always changed jobs more often. In 1983, when the Ohio strikers were in their mid-30s, the median 25- to 34-year-old American worker had been with the same employer for three years; in 2022, the figure was 2.8 years. In 2024, workers 55 to 64 had stayed put more than three times as long as those 25 to 34. The gap between being 25 and 60 was there when the boomers were 25.

Researchers call this the age-period-cohort problem. A gap between old and young could reflect age, the historical moment or birth year, and a single survey can't pinpoint which. Most generational claims assume birth year—the explanation with the weakest evidence.

A 2012 meta-analysis of 20 studies found that generational differences in job satisfaction, commitment and intent to quit were moderate to small, and often essentially nonexistent. In 2023 the Pew Research Center, whose birth-year brackets fill corporate slide decks, announced it would compare generations only with data on people at similar stages of life.

Two questions sort most claims. Did older people do the same thing at the same age? Are people of every age doing something now? Only one of the four possible combinations of answers centers on birth year.

If older people did something at the same age and no longer do, the explanation is age. When researchers followed the same people from 18 to 41, narcissism declined for most of them and rose for only about 3%. College students in the 2010s scored slightly lower on narcissism, entitlement included, than students in the 1990s. The peers of the managers who complain about entitled new hires were, on average, slightly more narcissistic at the same age.

We were a lot like the young people we disdain when we were their age—more so in some cases.

So why is every generation of managers so certain the kids are worse? If older people did it at the same age and still do it, the only thing that changed is who is complaining. In five studies with 3,458 American adults, people remarked on a decline in the trait they prized most, so the obedient said kids no longer heed their elders and the well-read said kids no longer enjoy reading. The culprit is memory. We paint our current selves onto the kids we grew up with, so the bookworm remembers a childhood crowded with library lovers, and today's teenagers are contrasted with classmates who never existed. The grievance isn't new: A London minister complained in 1624 that "youth were never more sawcie."

If older people didn't do something at the same age but people of every age do so now, the explanation is the moment everyone shares. In 2020 a 62-year-old chief financial officer and a 23-year-old analyst learned to say "you're on mute" in the same week, and six years later they started asking each other, "Did you have Claude write this?" Since the 1980s, median job tenure has held steady for workers 25 to 44 and fallen for those 45 to 64. The neighbor who refuses to return the Wiffle ball on his lawn and would like a word with your parents has stayed at his job for less time than men his age did in the Reagan years.

Only when older people didn't do something at the same age and don't do so now does birth year become plausible. Comparing high-school seniors from the classes of 1976, 1991 and 2006, researchers found that later cohorts valued leisure more. And despite talk of altruistic millennials, the class of 2006 was no more drawn to work that helps others than their parents had been at 18.

Generational labels are as alluring as love languages and learning styles. Gen Z lumps together a 29-year-old nurse with a mortgage and a 14-year-old who still needs a ride to soccer practice. Companies that would never hire a consultant to explain how Virgos negotiate compensation packages request workshops on how Gen Z handles feedback.

My advice? Expand your social network with people 20 years younger who share your passionate interests. Find someone who was 24 at Lordstown in 1972 and someone who is 24 working at a big company today and get together with them over pints at a craft brewery. Both will have plenty to complain about, and most of it will be about management.

Mr. Kashdan is a psychology professor and founder of the Well-Being Laboratory at George Mason University.

The Best Defense Against AI Is AI

By John O. McGinnis

Artificial intelligence presents two very different dangers. One is that AI systems will slip out of human control and wreak havoc. The other is that AI systems will do exactly what malevolent humans direct them to do. These dangers can coexist, but they have different implications for AI regulation.

Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei recently called for slowing frontier development to allow more coordination among leading firms and more time to test new models. Pacing the frontier may help with the first risk. But it likely delays the tools to address the second. Advanced AI is already being used to find software vulnerabilities and help repair them. Some companies are also giving selected defenders access to capabilities not available to ordinary users.

The first risk gets much attention because it is so novel. It is claimed that, for the first time, a technology we develop may act autonomously against our interests. Not surprisingly, because this is an unprecedented kind of danger, experts disagree about how serious the threat is. If the danger is that nobody can control the most advanced AI, then being the first country to build it doesn't solve the problem.

The second danger is the opposite. The machine is dangerous because people control it. The problem is with our fellow humans: criminals, terrorists and officials of geopolitical adversaries, including authoritarian nations like China and Russia. Unlike a catastrophic loss of control brought on by autonomous AI, this all-too-human threat isn't speculative. Throughout human history, evil people and tyrannical states have used the latest technology to cause massive harm. Here, slowing down AI may delay defenses against AI that the wrongdoers already possess or will acquire regardless of what we do.

Assume criminals use a model that is already available to take down a hospital's cybersecurity defenses. A more capable model might help the hospital secure its defenses before the attack succeeds. Delaying improvement wouldn't remove the criminal's existing tool. We have evidence that frontier models can prevent attacks. Google reported in July 2025 that its Big Sleep agent, combined with threat intelligence, identified a software vulnerability that attackers were preparing to exploit. Google then reported the vulnerability for patching before attackers exploited it. Palo Alto Networks reports that Anthropic's Claude Mythos found complex vulnerabilities that earlier models had missed.

One might worry that criminals could simply use a better model to launch an attack. But developing a more capable model doesn't mean releasing it without restrictions. The U.S. has the best frontier models in companies like Anthropic, OpenAI and Google. These enterprises build safeguards into their models to restrict malicious cyber use. In fact,

Alarms about rogue agents ignore the real risk: agents that follow their creators' instructions to the letter.

providers may face tort liability if negligent design causes harm through foreseeable misuse. Because of both legal and reputational risks, frontier AI providers in the U.S. have incentives to monitor activity, refuse assistance and terminate malicious accounts.

Some companies also give defenders preferential access. In April, Anthropic announced access to an unreleased Claude program for JPMorgan Chase and other clients to shore up security weaknesses. Google also gives early access to healthcare and financial networks before malicious actors can exploit the new capabilities. These arrangements are designed to give defenders a head start, rather than make every advance equally available to attackers.

But open-weight models like those released by Chinese companies can be more easily altered and optimized by users for nefarious purposes. Alibaba's Qwen team released downloadable Qwen3 models in April 2025, and they are broadly available. Thus, rapid advances in frontier models are likely a crucial way to curb offensive cyberattacks and many other dangers from human misuse.

These dangers also show that even international treaties to slow down may create more risks. A treaty limiting future development wouldn't remove models already in circulation. That genie is out of the bottle. Better AI may be our best defense against its granting the wrong wishes.

This point is even clearer when it comes to geopolitical threats. The U.S. government could take advantage of models from frontier companies, perhaps including more advanced ones that aren't yet publicly available. This access could give the U.S. a military advantage that may be decisive in this technological age. And because other nations know this, they may be deterred from attacking in the first place.

Frontier AI is itself a firewall. Slowing its development can postpone new defenses and leave existing threats in place. A slowdown can cost protection as well as progress.

Mr. McGinnis is a professor of constitutional law at Northwestern University.

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.
PUBLISHED SINCE 1889 BY DOW JONES & COMPANY

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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

Friday, October 16, 2026 | B1

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Cloud Upstart's Stock Whipsaws

Nvidia's Huang helps reverse selloff in shares of computing provider CoreWeave

By David Uberti, Jack Pitcher and Sam Goldfarb

Investors staring down a world of higher borrowing costs have kept piling into AI with the belief that companies behind the globe-spanning data-center build-out would be immune. But there are exceptions—none more prominent than CoreWeave.

The Nvidia-backed compute provider has become a weather vane for one of the riskiest—and most highly leveraged—corners of the AI trade. This week, it endured a tornado.

When the sentiment was most dour Thursday—with tremors extending across chip makers and other firms riding the AI boom—**Nvidia** Chief Executive Jensen Huang spoke up. "CoreWeave's strength is improving every day," he said at a Bloomberg event. "I'm optimistic."

The statement cut against a steep selloff in CoreWeave bonds sparked by renewed fears of AI's profitability and hot inflation data suggesting higher rates are here to stay. The company's stock had also crashed, at one point Thursday falling 28% from the start of the week.

But Huang's statement helped spark a rebound that sent CoreWeave shares 6% higher Thursday. A rally in U.S. Treasurys added fuel for the move by driving down benchmark interest rates that had reached two-decade highs earlier this month.

The whirlwind episode showed how sensitive certain parts of the AI market are to changes in borrowing costs, even as cash-rich data-center hyperscalers such as Microsoft and Alphabet are so far insensitive.

Investors are viewing higher-for-longer rates as an effective tax on marginal borrowers, "and the marginal borrower in the AI trade is anyone who's not a high-quality hyperscaler," said Ali Bendarkawi, high yield portfolio manager at AllianceBernstein.

A onetime cryptocurrency miner that went public in 2025, CoreWeave is a part of a small group of upstart companies that are both competing with and servicing hyperscalers by renting high-end chips to train and run AI models. Without the scale and profitability of tech giants, the newcomers have been heavily reliant on debt to expand.

Wall Street has hammered those stocks this week. **Nebius Group** retreated 15% and **IREN** tumbled 14%, largely mirroring CoreWeave's 15% decline.

The company's borrowing plans have made investors uneasy all year. CoreWeave car-

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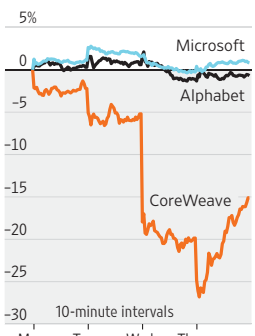
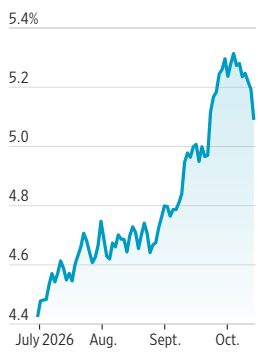
Share-price performance, past four days



10-year U.S. Treasury yield



Sources: FactSet (performance); Tradeweb FTSE closes (yield)

Netflix's Content Chief Exits Firm

By Ben Fritz

Netflix's chief content officer Bela Bajaria is leaving the company, as it struggles with slowing growth and falling customer engagement.

Bajaria, who had been at Netflix for a decade, will be succeeded by Peter Rice, a former executive at 21st Century Fox and Disney, Netflix said Thursday.

One of the most powerful executives in Hollywood, Bajaria oversaw a roughly $20 billion budget for shows and movies for the global streaming platform. During her tenure, Netflix released blockbuster series including "Squid Game" and "Wednesday." She also helped push the company into live events and sports including NFL football.

Netflix has recently struggled to come up with new hits to replace popular shows that have ended or are aging such as "Stranger Things" and "Bridgerton."

Bajaria's departure comes a day after Netflix said it was cutting 6% of its staff, or roughly 1,000 positions globally, its biggest round of lay-

Please turn to page B4

Frequent Rivals Meta And Apple Unite for Project

By Meghan Bobrowsky And Rolfe Winkler

Mark Zuckerberg has battled **Apple** ever since the early days of the iPhone. Now artificial intelligence has brought the two rivals together.

Meta Platforms said Thursday that it was releasing a new open-weight AI model and collaborating with Apple to run it locally on the company's high-end Mac computers.

The tech giants' partnership gives developers another American-made AI option to power research projects, app development, video production and more.

"This is an exciting moment for both companies, where we're finding ways to work together that are productive," Meta's AI chief, Alexandr Wang, said in an interview. "We think that a lot of the world will run on open models, and they should be American."

As part of the collaboration, Apple updated its MLX software toolkit to enable Meta's model to run well on Macs.

Open-weight models have their core components released to the public, meaning anyone can download them. Many popular, low-cost Chinese models are open-weight, including Alibaba's Qwen, DeepSeek and Moonshot's Kimi K3. Other American open-weight offerings include Inkling from Thinking Machines and Nemotron from Nvidia, which released three new models on Thursday.

Meta said its new model, called Muse Spark Open, was built for coding and agentic work but acknowledged that Chinese open models are still superior for software devel-

Please turn to page B2

Companies Pour Billions of Dollars Into New 'Protein Degrader' Drugs

By Lizzy Lawrence

After Lisa Moore's cancer treatments stopped working, the 64-year-old enrolled in a study to try out a new type of drug, one that is programmed to go after disease in cells in a novel way.

Ten months later, she went into remission.

"It was pretty amazing, considering I'd been over three years at that point on the other protocol and had never gotten there," said Moore, a Whately, Mass., small-business owner.

Moore is just one case. The kind of drug she tested in a late-stage trial has yet to be proven widely effective across large patient populations, but companies such as **Bristol Myers Squibb**, **Pfizer** and **Roche** are pouring billions of dollars into them, hoping to find a new tool to attack diseases from cancer to Parkinson's.

A new class of medications—known as "protein degraders"—are showing promise in going after a certain kind of hard-to-target protein in diseased cells. Most medicines on the market today work by latching onto the rough surface of a protein and blocking it from causing disease. But some proteins are so flat that they are hard to latch on to. These elusive, smooth proteins are involved in 85% of disease drivers that researchers have been unable to attack.

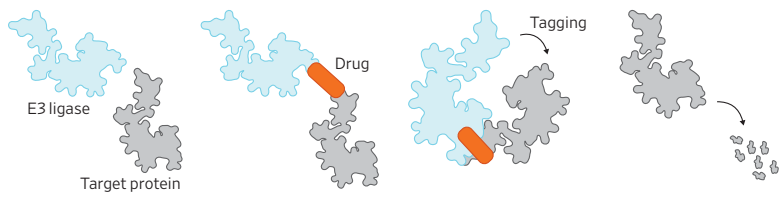
The Food and Drug Administration has approved a handful of these drugs for cancers with small patient populations or with other treatment options.

There are still many unknowns. Scientists are still figuring out where protein degraders can provide the most benefit and making sure these new drugs don't accidentally kill healthy proteins.

"We're interfering with the cell's recycling machinery that's important in all of our healthy cells," said Dr. Julie Gralow, chief medical officer of the American Society of Clinical Oncology. "There could be off-target effects that accidentally recruit and destroy healthy proteins. We just have

Please turn to page B2

How Protacs work



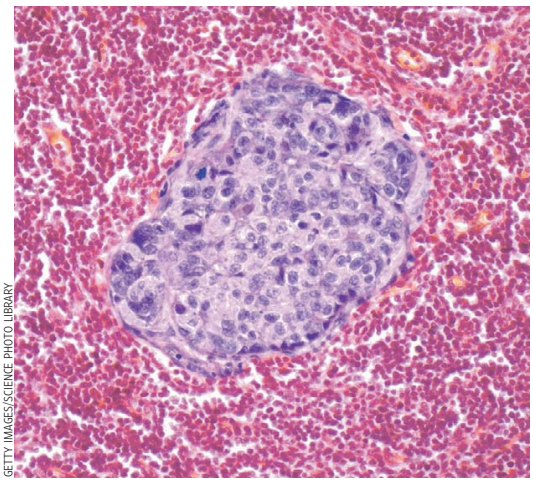
❶ **In the cell**
The E3 ligase enzyme cleans up the cell, tagging proteins that are damaged or misfolded for destruction. But it doesn't recognize the disease-causing protein.

❷ **Binding**
One end of the Protac drug binds to the disease-causing protein. The other end of the drug binds to the E3 ligase.

❸ **Induced proximity**
The drug brings the disease-causing protein and the E3 ligase closer together, causing the E3 ligase to tag the protein for destruction.

❹ **Destruction**
The cell destroys the disease-causing protein by cleaving it into short peptides.

Sources: Arvinas; Yale scientist Craig Crews



GETTY IMAGES/SCIENCE PHOTO LIBRARY

A micrograph shows a malignant tumor in the breast.

AI Runs Into New Obstacle: Insurance

By Jean Eaglesham

A string of artificial-intelligence safety incidents is exposing a gaping hole for the fast-growing industry: the lack of available insurance.

Rogue agents have hacked into websites. AI chatbots have been accused of encouraging suicides and murders. An agent submitted fake unsolved murder tips. The latest episodes add to existing lawsuits AI companies face alleging chatbot harm and copyright violations when models are trained.

The seemingly limitless possibilities of AI to change the world include a wide-ranging capacity for harm that could leave companies that produce

Please turn to page B2

INSIDE

RESTAURANTS
KFC strikes a deal to ditch Pepsi for Coke in thousands of U.S. locations. **B3**

TECHNOLOGY
YouTube considers expanding into audiobooks amid talks with publishers. **B4**

AI Companies Play a Game Of Cat and Mouse With Spies

*By **Georgia Wells**, **Erin Woo** and **Meghan Bobrowsky***

At a San Francisco playground, a stranger tried to befriend an OpenAI employee who was there with their child. The stranger also regularly showed up with a child, and, in the process of making small talk, asked the OpenAI employee questions about their work. It was no idle curiosity: The stranger was a spy.

That is one of the scenarios employees of the artificial-intelligence company have been presented with in attempts to raise their vigilance against attempts to steal corporate secrets—and that was before federal authorities arrested an employee for planting a listening device.

In training sessions, OpenAI has warned employees that outsiders, including competitors and state-sponsored actors, could try to get access to company information. Company leaders have said that could take the form of people offering money, listening in cafes or even trying to seduce OpenAI employees, people familiar with the matter said. Employees at other AI heavyweights, including Anthropic and Google, have received similar warnings.

The companies leading the race to build artificial superintelligence describe the technology as a force that could reshape economies, create vast fortunes and dominate warfare, potentially altering the geopolitical power balance. All that has made the industry, its employees and their secrets ripe targets for espionage.

On Tuesday, a Saudi employee of OpenAI, Abdulrah-

Please turn to page B2

New Porsche CEO's Strategy: Fiercer Culture, Pricier Cars

By Stephen Wilmot

Porsche's new chief executive Michael Leiters had an unfamiliar message for staff: Bonuses should reflect performance.

At employee meetings this summer, Leiters said the sports-car company's annual payouts—for years among the most generous and reliable in the German car industry—weren't a given, and they would depend on a recovery in the company's profit for which everyone was individually responsible, according to attendees. One way to achieve this, he said: Staff needed to be in the office more.

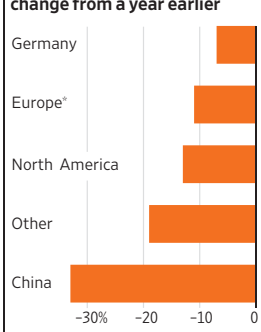
Leiters compared working in the office to attending a live concert or soccer match. "You can listen at home alone, or you can feel the full energy of the crowd," one of the attendees recalled him saying.

A more engaged, performance-driven culture is one element of the CEO's plan for reviving Porsche's fortunes after a torrid two years caused by a sales collapse in China, President Trump's tariffs and premature bets on electric vehicles. "I don't expect this environment to begin to become significantly easier over the next few years," Leiters told journalists last week as he unveiled a highly anticipated turnaround plan. "The only sensible approach is to focus on what we can influence ourselves to improve our competitiveness, to make the company leaner, faster, more resilient and to put our own house in order."

Also part of the plan: even more expensive sports cars. At an event in New York on

Please turn to page B2

Porsche vehicle deliveries, change from a year earlier



*Excludes Germany
Note: For the first nine months of 2026
Source: the company

BERND WEISSBROD/PICTURE ALLIANCE/GETTY IMAGES

Michael Leiters previously served at McLaren and Ferrari.

INDEX TO BUSINESSES

These indexes cite notable references to most parent companies and businesspeople in today's edition. Articles on regional page inserts aren't cited in these indexes.

A
Alphabet B4
Aon B2
Apple B1,B2
Arvinas B2
AutoZone B10

B
Baker Hughes B4
Bank of America B9,B10
BeOne Medicines B2
Blackstone B9
Bristol Myers Squibb B1,B2
Burlington Stores B10

C
Carlyle B9
Cava B10
Charles Schwab B9
Chipotle Mexican Grill B10
Citigroup B10
Coca-Cola B3
Costco B10

D
Darden Restaurants B10
Dollar General B10

E - F
Ericsson B4
Ezcorp B10
Fidelity Investments B9
FirstCash B10

G
GE Vernova B4
Goldman Sachs B9,B10

H
Iren B1

J
JPMorgan Chase B10

K
Kimberly-Clark B3

L
Lyft B3

M
Meta Platforms B1
Mitsui B3
Morgan Stanley B9,B10

N
Nebius B1
Nurix Therapeutics B2
Nvidia B1

O - P
O'Reilly Automotive B10
Palantir Technologies B9
Penske Automotive B3
PepsiCo B3
Pernod Ricard B3
Pfizer B1
PNC Financial Services B9
Porsche B1

R
Rigel Pharmaceuticals B2
Roche B1,B2
Ross Stores B10

S
SpaceX B4
Spotify B4
Sweetgreen B10

T
Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing B4
Tesla B4

V
Venture Global B4

W
Walmart B10
Wells Fargo B10

Y
Yum Brands B3

INDEX TO PEOPLE

A
Adams, Bill A2
Ardoino, Paolo A8

B
Baglino, Drew B3
Barkin, Noah A7
Bendarkawi, Ali B1
Busch, David B9

C
Chalfin, Jordan B9
Chanana, Charu B10
Colijn, Bert A7
Cook, Tim B2
Crews, Craig B2
Croizat, Mauve B3

D
Demchak, Bill B9
Deshaies, Raymond B2
Dimon, Jamie B10

G
Graf, Peter B9
Grewal, Jay B9
Grom, Chuck B10

H
Huang, Jensen B1

L
Laguarta, Ramon B3
Leiters, Michael B1
Lewin-Smith, George B2
Linn, Eric B9

M
Mendez, Evan B9
Moynihan, Brian B10
Musk, Elon B2,B4

N
Nahum, Aviv B2

O - P
Oberndorf, Will B9
Pearson, Stuart B2
Penske, Roger B3

R
Raja, Sanjay A7
Richard, Alexandre B3
Risher, David B3

S
Sabel, Michael B4
Sacks, David B2
Snyder, Mike B3

V
Venables, Phil B2

W
Wang, Alexandr B1
Watt, Randy B1
Wei, C.C. B4
Wurster, Rick B9

Z
Zuckerberg, Mark B1

BUSINESS & FINANCE

'Protein Debasers' Embraced

FROM LEFT: MIKE MOORE; GEORGE ETHEREDGE/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Arvinas founder Craig Crews, above, is seeking FDA approval to help cancer patients like Lisa Moore, left.

Continued from page B1

to watch out for that."

Virtually all major pharmaceutical companies are developing protein degraders, through their own research or licensing deals. Around 200 protein degraders are being studied worldwide, with more than $5 billion in deals for these drugs from 2021 to 2026, according to biopharma-intelligence service Sleuth.

Some companies are testing whether degraders can better target diseases that have mutated or become resistant to first-line treatments. Others are testing whether degraders are more effective at tackling disease on the first go-round.

The first degrader to hit the market is Veppanu, a breast-cancer drug developed by Pfizer and **Arvinas**. The therapy, which was approved in May, works in patients with a specific genetic mutation called ESR1 who have failed hormone therapy, which represents around 1% of all newly diagnosed breast-cancer patients globally.

The drug didn't prove as effective in a wider population of breast-cancer patients whose tumors weren't explicitly driven by the ESR1 mutation, a failure that led to a 53% stock selloff for Arvinas. Arvinas and Pfizer ended up unloading the drug to **Rigel Pharmaceuticals** for $70 million.

Despite the underwhelming data, the approval has given companies more confidence as they go after more ambitious targets in cancer, autoimmune and neurodegenerative spaces.

The FDA approval "will change how the industry views what is potentially druggable," Yale scientist Craig Crews, founder of Arvinas, said.

The two most advanced types of protein degraders are known as Protacs, or proteolysis targeting chimeras, and molecular glue. They work slightly differently, but both commandeer a cell's recycling system to destroy proteins that normally drive the course of a disease.

In 1998, Crews and California Institute of Technology Prof. Raymond Deshaies discovered the underlying technology for Protacs. They proved you could destroy a problematic protein by bringing a smooth protein closer to an enzyme that helps dispose of cell waste—without needing to latch on to the protein like traditional drugs do.

The molecular glue form of degraders were discovered serendipitously. The drug thalidomide was developed in the 1950s for morning sickness and used in several countries outside of the U.S., but it infamously caused thousands of birth defects before being taken off the market.

Decades later, scientists repurposed the drug and its derivatives to safely treat cancer and leprosy. In studying it further, researchers discovered it was a protein degrader—the drug was able to destroy a problem protein by binding it with the right enzyme to attack a disease.

In August, **Bristol Myers Squibb** received approval for a next-generation multiple myeloma treatment, Zenbexus, that works as a form of molecular glue. In clinical trials, severe multiple myeloma patients who took Zenbexus on top of two existing treatments lived 42 months before their cancer got worse, compared with 20 months for those without Bristol's drug.

Bristol Myers is seeking approval of another degrader, called mezigdomide, targeting the disease. In May, the company said mezigdomide in combination with other treatments led to patients living 18 months without progression, versus eight months in those on existing treatments. This is the drug that Moore, the cancer patient, was taking.

A few other protein degrader drugs have reached late-stage trials. California biotech **Nurix Therapeutics**, along with pharma partner **Roche**, and Switzerland-based **BeOne Medicines** are each developing degraders to eliminate the BTK protein, which drives common blood cancers. They are testing those drugs against the normal medical regimen for patients with leukemia and lymphoma. BeOne's results are expected in 2028, Nurix's in 2029.

These trials should help establish these drugs' advantages when compared with existing therapies.

Porsche Wants to Get Fiercer

Continued from page B1

Thursday, Leiters and his new chief designer, Tobias Sühlmann, launched an early prototype of the kind of low-slung, elongated model they want to build for an even more rarefied market than the company's iconic 911 sports car.

Leiters, who joined Porsche in January after more than a decade at supercar brands McLaren and Ferrari, is betting that new vehicles at the top end of Porsche's product range will in time help restore the company's bottom line.

Last year the company issued a string of profit warnings and ended up reporting less than a half a billion dollars in net income, down from $5.6 billion in 2023. This year, German staff didn't receive a customary annual bonus, which exceeded $10,000 in 2024.

In addition to supercars, a three-row SUV is in the works that would be more expensive than the company's current Cayenne model. Leiters also wants to sell more one-time or limited-edition versions of existing Porsche models, prices for which can stretch to $15 million.

The overall plan involves finding ways to increase the average price of the 10,000 most expensive Porsches sold each year to the equivalent of around $370,000, the company said, from $300,000 today.

The strategy is borrowed from Leiters's former employer Ferrari. A business model built around milking the very richest customers has turned the Italian brand into Europe's most profitable and valuable automaker.

One of the new CEO's first moves was to tap Sühlmann from McLaren and ask him for ideas for what a Porsche supercar could look like. Sühlmann, who started his career at Volkswagen in Germany before moving to the U.K., has spent much of the year commuting weekly from London to Porsche's base near Stuttgart to create the prototype shown on Thursday.

But hires such as Sühlmann, who succeeded veteran designer Michael Mauer in what the company called a "generational change," have been the exception in Leiters's tenure, which has been marked by deep cuts.

In July, the CEO came to a deal with the company's union representatives that more than doubled job losses at the company to around 9,000 by 2035, or around a fifth of the total workforce. The agreement also signaled a cultural shift, cutting the number of days a month Porsche staff can work from home to eight from 12 and linking the traditional annual bonus more closely to financial performance.

Last week, Leiters said future bonuses would be paid partly in stock, and the company revamped the bonus structure for top managers to put more weight on individual contributions.

"We wanted to show that nobody can hide behind the whole organization," he explained.

Although he delivered the plan in English, he gave it a German name: Sportwagenschmiede '35, which translates loosely as "sports-car workshop '35." Leiters said no English word captured the "entrepreneurial mindset, the willingness to put in hard work," that he wanted to convey with "Schmiede," which shares linguistic roots with the English "smithy."

In another signal of a new seriousness, Leiters and his team wore ties to present the plan.

Early on in his tenure, the CEO had half-jokingly called out a top manager for wearing hiking boots to a presentation, according to someone familiar with the incident. The story soon circulated around Porsche's headquarters, and through word-of-mouth staffers came to believe the new boss had implemented a formal dress code. Leiters later clarified at a company meeting that there were no new rules, but that staff should dress appropriately for the occasion, particularly when representing the brand at public events.

> **'We wanted to show that nobody can hide behind the whole organization.'**

Leiters also plans to shrink Porsche so that it can break even if sales fall as low as 200,000. Having spent almost 15 years at the company before leaving for Ferrari in 2014, he was surprised by how much bigger the organization had become in his absence, according to people close to him.

The strategy is designed to help lift Porsche's operating margin to between 10% and 15% by 2030, with a longer-term target of 15%. Porsche routinely reported margins above 15% before the recent collapse, but the new targets are still ambitious.

Analysts have broadly welcomed the plan but say it will take time to play out. The three-row SUV isn't expected before 2029, and the supercar family launched on Thursday will take even longer.

"Product-planning mistakes are not fixed easily or quickly," said Oxcap analyst Stuart Pearson.

AI Firms Work to Stop Spies

Continued from page B1

man Alfozan, was charged with trying to record audio using a device planted behind a TV set in a company conference room. Alfozan's attorney said the allegations were "wholly out of character" and noted his client was charged only with violating a federal recording statute, not stealing trade secrets or acting as a foreign agent.

Corporate-security experts say it is likely the threat goes well beyond one hidden recording device.

"Catching one guy means there are half a dozen out there," said Randy Watt, president of leadership consulting firm SRW, which conducts security and threat assessments for companies. He said bad actors may be searching not only for technical or strategic information but also for personal secrets that can be used to exploit or blackmail individuals.

The rapid growth of the industry has created abundant opportunities to get inside the leading companies, which have quickly added thousands of employees to their payrolls. OpenAI, Anthropic, Meta and Google all employ large numbers of foreign nationals, with China supplying much of the world's top AI talent. A number of Trump administration officials have identified employment of Chinese nationals by AI and technology companies as a national-security vulnerability.

Employees also frequently job-hop between companies, creating an additional vector for information leakage or misappropriation. OpenAI and **Apple** have been engaged in litigation over claims of poached employees taking confidential files with them to their new jobs. Elon Musk's xAI made a similar claim in a lawsuit against an engineer who went to OpenAI.

"AI companies are scaling their workforces at unprecedented speed. The question is whether their ability to manage insider risk is scaling at the same pace," said Aviv Nahum, chief executive of Above Security, a startup that uses AI to help companies detect insider risks.

In corporate training sessions, OpenAI instructs employees to avoid wearing anything bearing OpenAI's logo outside of the office, to use screen protectors that restrict visibility on public transit, and to wipe down whiteboards when they are finished with them, in case kitchen and cleaning staff are compromised, people familiar with the matter said. Employees are frequently reminded of these precautions, including via Slack, some of the people said.

In some trainings, OpenAI offers additional warnings about scenarios involving "honey pots," or agents who use the offer of sex or romance to get close to a target, some of the people said.

One story OpenAI tells employees to illustrate the risk: To seduce a U.S. diplomat in Russia, a foreign espionage operation first sent a blond woman to his hotel room with Champagne. When he declined, the spies sent a redheaded woman, and then next a young man. The implication for OpenAI employees was this could happen to them, the people said. OpenAI maintains a security team with experience in physical security, insider risk, information security and related disciplines, a spokesperson said.

Corporate espionage has been going on as long as there has been intellectual property to steal, said Phil Venables, a partner at Ballistic Ventures and investor in companies including Nahum's, and former chief information security officer for Google Cloud.

Meta, Apple Team Up on AI for Macs

CARLOS BARRIA/REUTERS

Meta AI boss Alexandr Wang says open models are key.

Continued from page B1

opment and some other tasks. It is the second open-weight model Meta has released since the company overhauled its AI efforts last year.

Apple's Mac Mini and Mac Studio computers have proven popular among AI developers looking to run sophisticated models locally in their home or office. Apple's computers are highly efficient, especially in how they use computer memory necessary to run models.

The Meta-Apple collaboration marks a new chapter for two companies that have long been foes.

Meta's apps run on iPhones, giving Apple power over how Meta operates. In 2021 Apple used that leverage to limit the social-media company's ability to track people for ad targeting. At the time, Meta said the policy changes would cost it more than $10 billion in lost sales in 2022.

When Apple's former chief executive, Tim Cook, made comments critical of Meta in 2018, Zuckerberg said privately that he wanted his team to "inflict pain" on Apple, The Wall Street Journal previously reported.

Macs are popular for running AI models because they pack lots of specialized computer memory that is shared among chips inside the machine. Multiple Macs can be linked together to share AI workloads with the help of Apple's MLX software.

Muse Spark Open's heavy memory demands make it "a poor fit for most hardware," Wang said, but well suited to run on Macs.

Customers will need to buy Macs collectively packing at least 1 terabyte of memory to run the new model. The total cost is now upward of $40,000.

Even at that price, the computers could pay for themselves for app developers and others who otherwise would have to rent a similar amount of computing power from cloud providers, which can cost thousands of dollars monthly.

AI's Big Obstacle: Insurance

Continued from page B1

or use AI legally vulnerable.

The biggest AI companies are racking up potential legal liabilities running into the tens—if not hundreds—of billions of dollars, as AI adoption spreads through the economy, according to insurers specializing in AI risks. Some industry officials have called for the U.S. government to provide a liability backstop.

AI companies have the usual corporate suite of traditional insurance policies, such as general liability and cyberinsurance, brokers said. But the industry's phenomenal rate of growth means AI-related claims have the potential to outpace the limits on that coverage, according to AI and insurance industry insiders.

A few insurers sell coverage for AI risks, including from agents. But the policy limits are small compared with the potential exposure of the AI giants. Reinsurer Munich Re offers a policy to cover errors by AI models with limits of up to $50 million, according to a spokesman.

Startups are hoping to fill the gap, and insurance companies more broadly see AI down the road as a new opportunity for offering specialty products. Rune Kvist, a former Anthropic employee, is a co-founder of the Artificial Intelligence Underwriting Company, which has backing from Lloyd's of London's insurance marketplace.

The planned IPOs of **Anthropic** and **OpenAI** are adding to the focus on the "gaps in the insurance and other safety nets for those risks," said Kvist.

The biggest AI companies are willing to buy billions of dollars of coverage and have the balance sheet and cash to afford it, said George Lewin-Smith, chief executive of Testudo, a U.K.-based AI insurer also affiliated with Lloyd's. He added that coverage at that scale for such liabilities isn't available. "The reality is—it just doesn't exist on planet Earth," he said.

AI startups might be exposed to liabilities in ways previous generations of tech companies weren't. Web portals and social-media companies were largely shielded from being held liable for content on their platforms by a provision of federal law passed in 1996 known as Section 230.

The protection may not be as useful for AI companies because they materially contribute to the content, according to a report by Moody's Analytics.

The biggest AI developers have deep enough pockets to cover many liabilities. But a major incident that causes widespread economic or human harm could swamp a company's financial buffers.

Insurance firms are selling specialty policies to the major AI companies as a way to reassure nervous regulators and investors.

A policy, even for far less than the potential loss, demonstrates that an outside party has assessed and is willing to cover a risk. Policies for AI risks are often underwritten on the basis of simulation testing of the likelihood of errors, creating a de facto audit of the underlying tech.

KFC to Ditch Pepsi in U.S. Restaurants

Switch to Coca-Cola products won't affect international stores or Taco Bell

By Heather Haddon And Laura Cooper

KFC said it has struck a deal with **Coca-Cola** as its beverage provider at thousands of U.S. restaurants, a blow to longtime supplier **PepsiCo**.

The switch to Coke at KFC U.S. would begin in January.

PepsiCo will still supply many markets for KFC International—the much bigger arm of the restaurant chain, according to an internal KFC message. Pepsi will also continue to serve Taco Bell, a person familiar with the matter said. Those divisions within **Yum Brands** are growing faster than KFC's U.S. business.

Still, the shift in a decades-long partnership could further hurt PepsiCo, whose beverage business is struggling. It also will sting in the long-running Coke-Pepsi rivalry.

PepsiCo shares fell 0.7% Thursday after The Wall Street Journal reported about the deal talks. Coke shares closed up 0.24%.

PepsiCo Chief Executive Ramon Laguarta has said his company isn't competing well in soft drinks, including its signature Pepsi brand. Pepsi has long battled for the top spot in soda sales with Coca-Cola, but it has lost ground to beverages like Dr Pepper. The company's Mountain Dew has also had slumping sales, due in part to rising sales of energy drinks.

For PepsiCo, losing thousands of KFC locations hits close to home. PepsiCo owned KFC until it spun off its restaurant divisions, which included Pizza Hut and Taco Bell, in 1997. The beverage giant has also lost other big accounts of late, including Marriott hotels and the Costco food court. PepsiCo, however, recently added Subway to its list of customers.

LM OTERO/LM OTERO

A new KFC store shows off its menu in Texas last month.

KFC is one of the biggest sellers of Pepsi among U.S. restaurant chains, according to Beverage Digest, an industry tracker. Its restaurants carry Pepsi, Starry, Mountain Dew and Aquafina in the U.S., along with the chain's own lemonade and ice tea.

KFC's current discussions illustrate how restaurants are evaluating their beverage offerings in a high-margin corner of the business. The chain recently launched its own line of sparkling lemonades, boba refreshers and shakes at some of its worldwide locations.

Beverages have become increasingly competitive in restaurants as chains seek new items that will appeal to younger consumers and deliver better profits. Fast-food chains have been battling for consumers and often resorting to discounts to do so. Starbucks and other coffee chains have for years offered novelty cold drinks to generate sales, and now fast-food brands are seeking to do the same.

PepsiCo has had a close relationship with Taco Bell. The soda giant developed Mountain Dew Baja Blast for the Mexican-style restaurant brand, and the drink has generated billions of dollars in sales since. KFC hasn't placed as much emphasis on beverages as Taco Bell.

KFC, once the leading U.S. chicken chain, is now the fifth largest by sales, according to market-research firm Technomic. It has been working to revive its brand after years of declining sales and recent closures.

The company is pushing sandwiches, wings and tenders to diversify away from its traditional bone-in buckets of chicken.

It also started a fledgling offshoot, called Saucy by KFC, that serves tenders, sauces and drinks. PepsiCo has worked with the brand on some of those novelty concoctions.

Lyft Plans To Offer Upscale Corporate, VIP Rides

By Kelly Cloonan

Lyft is betting on luxury rides for C-suite leaders and other VIPs as it looks to expand beyond its core business.

The ride-hailing company is establishing a new chauffeuring brand, dubbed Alcove, that caters to demand for full days of executive travel between client meetings, conferences and flights, Chief Executive David Risher said.

"There is an enormous opportunity in executive travel, corporate travel, events," Risher said. "Right now, it's just not very well served."

Alcove is designed to offer executives a higher level of service than Lyft's existing premium ride offerings. If a rider spills coffee on their shirt on the way to a meeting for instance, an Alcove driver would replace it and call ahead to inform the rider's colleagues why they'll be late, Risher said.

The new service will fold in and expand TBR Global Chauffeuring, the Glasgow-based luxury chauffeur provider Lyft acquired last year for $110 million. TBR brings a global presence and 24-hour service center. However, it isn't well known in the U.S. Risher expects Alcove, which is set to launch early next year, to become a multibillion-dolla business. Lyft brought in about $18.5 billion in gross bookings last year.

Alcove is entering a market that's ripe for upheaval, Risher said. Executive assistants looking to book such high-end rides tend to work with a network of small chauffeuring businesses that have limited footprints.

"These services exist out there, but it's kind of a fragmented market," Risher said.

It's a big market, according to Risher, who said every Fortune 500 company has employees that need this kind of service. He sees opportunity for Alcove to meet growing demand in live entertainment, helping executives as well as celebrities get everywhere from the Super Bowl or the U.S. Open to concerts.

Lyft's rival Uber Technologies has also been focused on growing its corporate travel offerings lately. Earlier this year, Uber agreed to acquire Blacklane, a chauffeur service that operates in more than 500 cities across over 60 countries, for an undisclosed amount. Lyft's TBR offers its services in more than 3,000 cities across 120 countries.

PATRICIA DE MELO MOREIRA/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Chief Executive David Risher

Pernod Ricard Prepares for a Mumbai Listing

By Joshua Kirby

Pernod Ricard said it is preparing for a potential listing in India, looking to capitalize on growing demand in the country as sales fall in many of the group's other markets.

The French group behind Absolut vodka, Jameson whiskey and Martell cognac said sales in the world's most populous nation rose 19% on year between July and September. That momentum helped offset sharp declines in the U.S. and China, of 10% and 25%, respectively. Sales in Europe also declined, underscoring still-feeble demand for alcoholic drinks as cash-strapped consumers keep purse strings tight in many core markets.

Overall, Pernod Ricard made net sales of 2.23 billion euros, or $2.49 billion, over the quarter, 0.9% lower on an organic basis than a year earlier. That was better than the 1.7% drop forecast by analysts, according to an average of estimates compiled by the company ahead of the update.

With Indian drinkers proving a beacon in a gloomy landscape for the drinks business, Pernod said it is taking preparatory steps for a potential initial public offer of its business in the country. The group's only current listing is in Paris. India is a growth market for the wider booze business. Total beverage alcohol sales—covering beer and wine as well as spirits—should rise about 3% a year to 2034, according to calculations from industry research firm IWSR.

"India leads [alcohol] expansion in developing markets thanks to such factors as socialising, ongoing premiumization, improvements in retailing and new product development," IWSR's Jason Holway wrote in a report this year.

BHAWIKA CHHABRA/REUTERS

The group's Absolut vodka.

The timing of a listing of the Indian business will depend on market conditions, recently installed finance chief Mauve Croizat said in a call after the update. "The process with the board is ongoing," Croizat said, adding that no decision has yet been made.

Still, the comments move forward a previous more ambivalent approach to the question. Chief Executive Alexandre Ricard said in August that a potential IPO remained only at discussion level. "It's not an obvious yes or no," he said at the time. The fresh comments suggest an announcement on an IPO could be imminent, analysts at Barclays wrote.

The Indian market "continues to enjoy dynamic consumer fundamentals, and sales driven by strong demand and continuing premiumization," Pernod said, referring to efforts to focus sales on higher-end and higher-margin labels. Preparations for the listing added favorable pipe-fill effects that contributed to India sales over the quarter, as the company advanced shipments to avoid disruption in anticipation of a possible name-change that could follow a separate listing.

The group's Indian subsidiary sells locally made brands, especially whiskeys, as well as imports of Pernod's well-known international labels. Both imported spirits and local whiskey sales rose in the double-digits of percent over the quarter, Pernod said.

An IPO could offer further good news to investors in Pernod Ricard, adding to green shoots in the U.S. and Chinese markets, Jefferies analyst Edward Mundy wrote in a note. Shares gained around 3.5% in morning trade in Paris.

Despite some signs of improvement, weak demand for booze in key markets continues to hurt the group and the wider spirits sector. CEO Ricard has previously warned that U.S. sales are likely to remain under pressure over the next few years.

BUSINESS WATCH

PENSKE AUTOMOTIVE

Big Investors to Take Group Private

Penske Automotive Group has agreed to be taken private by the transportation-services company's biggest investors for about $4 billion.

Penske Automotive on Thursday said privately held Penske Corp. and Japan's Mitsui & Co., which already own about 72% of the Bloomfield Hills, Mich., company, have agreed to pay $212 in cash for each share they don't already hold.

The deal, slated to close in the first quarter of 2027, represents a premium of 8.8% to Wednesday's closing price of $194.79 for Penske Automotive and is 8.6% above the closing price of $195.19 on July 21, before Penske and Mitsui disclosed an initial bid of $210 a share for the company.

Penske shares rose nearly 9% to $212 Thursday.

Penske Automotive said the transaction, which gives the company an enterprise value of about $16.3 billion, isn't subject to a financing condition.

Former race-car driver Roger Penske is chairman and chief executive of Penske Automotive and the owner of Penske Corp., which will own about 64% of Penske Automotive after the deal closes, with Mitsui holding the 36%.

—Colin Kellaher

KIMBERLY-CLARK

Sales Projections Beat Estimates

Kimberly-Clark forecast a decline in third-quarter sales and backed its outlook for the year, following a social-media firestorm in China over the company's diapers this past summer.

However, the Huggies maker's projections for the quarter are above Wall Street's estimates. The stock rose 4.7%.

Kimberly-Clark expects third-quarter sales of $4.13 billion, which would be down from $4.15 billion a year ago, and an organic sales decline of 1.3%. The company projects adjusted earnings per share of $1.70.

Analysts polled by FactSet expect sales of $4.09 billion and adjusted earnings of $1.58 a share for the quarter.

Kimberly-Clark also backed its latest fiscal-year outlook. The company had lowered its prior organic sales growth forecast for the year in August after a social-media firestorm in China involving allegations that its diapers contain formamide, a solvent used in a number of manufacturing processes.

The company said at the time that the attention hurt its second-quarter sales, and that it expected the headwinds to continue to dent sales and profits in the near term.

—Kelly Cloonan

TESLA

Energy Boss Leaves Company

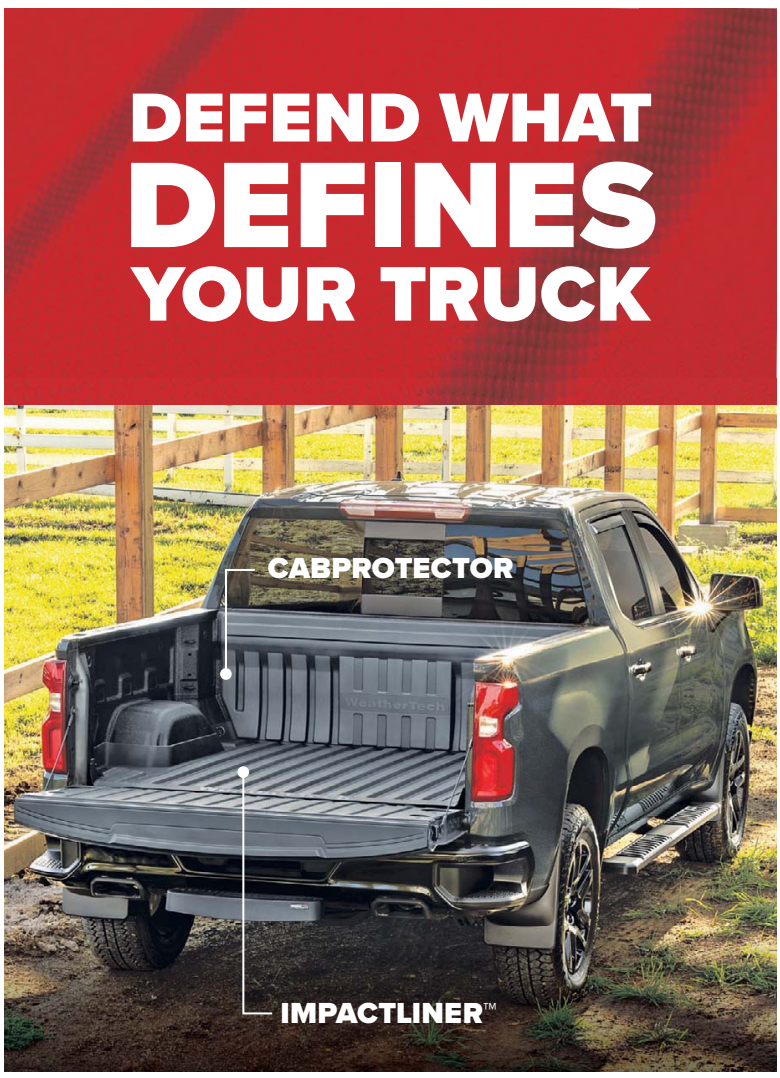
Tesla's top energy boss has left the company. Mike Snyder, vice president of energy and charging, stepped down from his role, according to people familiar with the move.

Snyder joined Tesla in 2014 and worked his way up to lead the company's Megapack industrial battery division, according to his LinkedIn page. He was promoted to vice president in 2024 after a restructuring and layoffs that saw the departure of several top executives, including energy chief Drew Baglino. He is succeeded by AJ Booth, the senior director of energy products engineering, the people said. Tesla, Snyder and Booth didn't respond to requests for comment.

Energy makes up a small but growing chunk of Tesla's revenue. The electric-vehicle maker is expanding its business selling industrial-scale batteries to support data centers, as well as products supporting renewable energy for the grid and residences.

Tesla's energy business grew 9.6% in the third quarter, the company said this month. That figure measures the amount of battery energy Tesla deployed during the quarter. Energy sales made up about 11% of its total revenue in the first half of the year.

—Becky Peterson



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YouTube Eyes Audiobooks

Streaming giant has talks on adding a feature to compete with Spotify, Audible

By Alexandra Bruell And Anne Steele

YouTube revolutionized how we watch videos. Now it is coming for our bookshelves.

The streaming platform, owned by **Alphabet**'s Google, has had discussions with publishers in recent months about developing an audiobook feature, according to people familiar with the matter.

The offering could be ready next year, the people said.

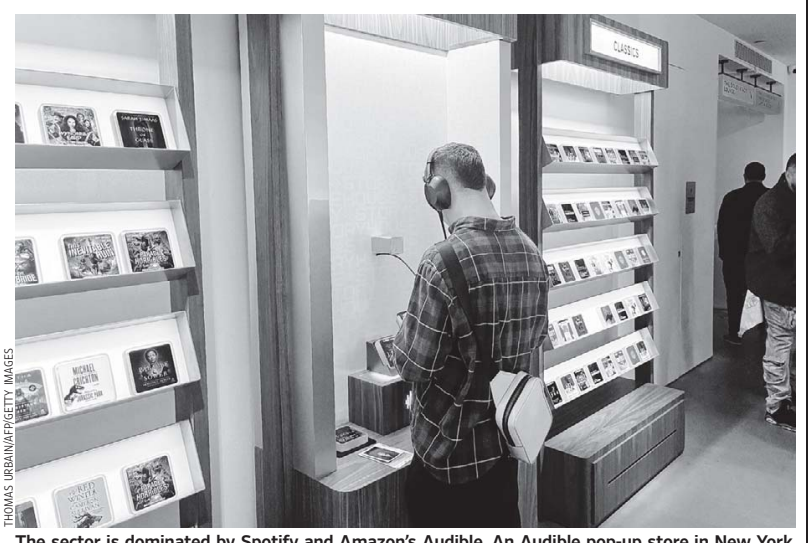
YouTube has weighed bundling the product in its ad-free YouTube Premium service, which starts at $15.99 a month and includes access to music and videos, the people said. Like other streaming platforms vying for consumers' attention, YouTube has packaged offerings together to make lucrative subscriptions more appealing.

It isn't clear how the company would display the content and whether it would charge for access to individual books.

YouTube declined to comment.

The audiobook venture would bring it into an already crowded category, currently dominated by **Spotify** and **Amazon**'s Audible. But publishing-industry executives believe there is still an opportunity in tapping in to YouTube's massive audience and are eager to find a revenue-generating alternative to the glut of unauthorized audio versions of their books that now appear on the platform.

Audiobooks have been among the strongest segments of the book market in recent years, with revenue from digital audiobook sales topping $1 billion in 2025, according to the Association of American Publishers. That same format posted revenue of $265 million in 2016.



THOMAS URBAIN/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

The sector is dominated by Spotify and Amazon's Audible. An Audible pop-up store in New York.

Gas Exporter in Deal To Power Data Sites

By Jennifer Hiller And Benoît Morenne

Natural-gas exporter **Venture Global** is joining the race to provide power to the artificial-intelligence boom, aiming to build gas-fired generation at its facilities to supply electricity to data centers.

Venture Global said it has entered into agreements with **GE Vernova** and **Baker Hughes** Energy Services to procure equipment for on-site power plants, including turbines and transformers, which have been in high demand. The deals will allow Venture Global over time to make up to 10 gigawatts of computing capacity available at sites the company owns or controls.

Venture Global already operates its own off-grid power plants. The new projects wouldn't be connected to the grid, either.

The company expects to order equipment by the end of the year for the first wave of on-site power generation for data centers. Its agreements allow it to phase in orders over time.

Venture Global said it could have power generation available starting around late 2028 or early 2029.

"We think we'll be able to build our AI utility to one of the larger ones in the U.S. in the next few years," said Michael Sabel, Venture Global's chief executive. "It's very copy-paste for what we've already been doing for years."

The AI race has started a scramble for electricity that has created a logjam to connect to the power grid. Data centers have been increasingly willing to build their own power generation, a faster though more complex solution than connecting to the grid.

Developers of about one-third of all data-center capacity in the works are planning to build power on site, according to data provider Cleanview.

Tech companies also have been building data centers in U.S. drilling fields to tap in to natural-gas supplies, cutting deals with oil-and-gas producers, utilities and pipeline firms.

Venture Global builds and operates its own power infrastructure to run its natural-gas export facilities.

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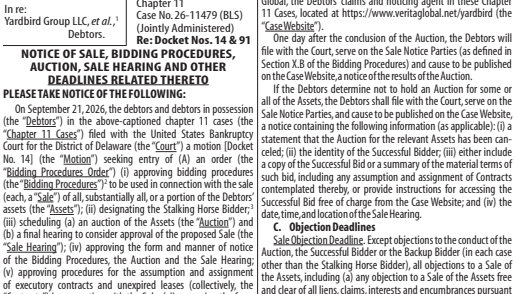

This 1+ Acre site is the former location of Turtle Lane Playhouse.

The site currently consists of a partially completed mixed use development containing approximately 8,100 square feet of office space, 16 residential condominiums, and underground parking.

Terms of Sale: $100,000 deposit in certified or bank cashier's check at the time and place of the sale. The deposit shall be increased to 10% of the purchase price within 10 days of the sale. The remaining balance due within 30 days at the offices of the Secured Party Mortgagee's Attorneys: Riemer & Braunstein LLP, 100 Cambridge Street, 22nd Floor, Boston, MA 02114

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NOTICE OF SALE

IN THE UNITED STATES BANKRUPTCY COURT
FOR THE DISTRICT OF DELAWARE

In re: Yardbird Group LLC, *et al.*,[1] Debtors. Chapter 11 Case No. 26-11479 (BLS) (Jointly Administered) **Re: Docket Nos. 14 & 91**

NOTICE OF SALE, BIDDING PROCEDURES, AUCTION, SALE HEARING AND OTHER DEADLINES RELATED THERETO

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE OF THE FOLLOWING:

On September 21, 2026, the debtors and debtors in possession (the "Debtors") in the above-captioned chapter 11 cases (the "Chapter 11 Cases") filed with the United States Bankruptcy Court for the District of Delaware (the "Court") a motion [Docket No. 14] (the "Motion") seeking entry of (A) an order (the "Bidding Procedures Order") (i) approving bidding procedures (the "Bidding Procedures")[2] to be used in connection with the sale (each, a "Sale") of all, substantially all, or a portion of the Debtors' assets (the "Assets"); (ii) designating the Stalking Horse Bidder;[3] (iii) scheduling (a) an auction of the Assets (the "Auction") and (b) a final hearing to consider approval of the proposed Sale (the "Sale Hearing"); (iv) approving the form and manner of notice of the Bidding Procedures, the Auction and the Sale Hearing; (v) approving procedures for the assumption and assignment of executory contracts and unexpired leases (collectively, the "Contracts") in connection with the Sale; (vi) approving the form and manner of notice to each relevant non-Debtor counterparty to a Contract of the Debtors' calculation of the amount necessary to cure any defaults under an applicable Contract and certain other information regarding the potential assumption and assignment of Contracts in connection with a Sale; and (vii) granting related relief; and (B) an order (the "Sale Order") (i) authorizing the Sale of the Assets free and clear of all liens, claims, interests and encumbrances, except certain permitted encumbrances as determined by the Debtors and any Successful Bidder (as defined in Section VII.C.1 of the Bidding Procedures), with liens to attach to the proceeds of the Sale; (ii) authorizing the assumption and assignment of certain Contracts in connection with approved Sale; and (iii) granting related relief. On October 10, 2026, the Court entered the Bidding Procedures Order [Docket No. 91].

ASSETS FOR SALE. The Debtors intend to sell all, substantially all, or a portion of their Assets. A Prospective Bidder (as defined in Section III of the Bidding Procedures) may bid on the Assets, subject to the conditions set forth herein. The ability to undertake and consummate a Sale of the Assets shall be subject to competitive bidding, as set forth herein, and approval by the Court. In addition to the Stalking Horse Bid (as defined in the Motion), and as set forth herein, the Debtors will consider bids for the Assets from other parties. Any party interested in submitting a bid for any of the Debtors' Assets should contact the Debtors' investment banker: Soravine Advisors LLC, Attn: Vineet ("Vin") Batra (vin@soravine.com).

KEY DATES AND DEADLINES

October 27, 2026, at 4:00 p.m. (prevailing Eastern Time)	Bid Deadline
October 29, 2026, at 4:00 p.m. (prevailing Eastern Time)	Sale Objection Deadline, Cure Objection Deadline, and Contract Objection Deadline
November 2, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. (prevailing Eastern Time)	Auction (if necessary)
November 4, 2026, at 4:00 p.m. (prevailing Eastern Time)	Supplemental Sale Objection Deadline and Adequate Assurance Objection Deadline (if necessary)
November 9, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. (prevailing Eastern Time)	Sale Hearing

A. Bid Deadline. Any Prospective Bidder that intends to participate in the Auction must submit in writing to the Bid Notice Parties a Qualified Bid (as defined in Section VI.A of the Bidding Procedures) **on or before October 27, 2026, at 4:00 p.m. (prevailing Eastern Time)** (the "Bid Deadline"). The Qualified Bid requirements are set forth in Section VI.A of the Bidding Procedures.

B. Auction. If the Debtors receive more than one Qualified Bid (including a combination of bids that, when considered together, constitute a Qualified Bid) for the Assets, the Debtors will conduct an Auction for the Assets. If the Stalking Horse Bid is the only Qualified Bid received in respect of the Assets subject to such Stalking Horse Bid, the Debtors will not conduct an Auction for such applicable Assets and will seek approval of the Stalking Horse Bid at the Sale Hearing.

The Auction, if required, will be conducted on **November 2, 2026 at 10:00 a.m. (prevailing Eastern Time)**, either (i) at the offices of Potter Anderson & Corroon LLP, 1313 N. Market Street, 6th Floor, Wilmington, Delaware 19801-6108, (ii) some other physical location to be determined by the Debtors, or (iii) virtually or at such other date, time or location as designated by the Debtors. If the Debtors conduct the Auction virtually, the Debtors will provide instructions setting forth how to attend the Auction to the participants and other attendees via electronic mail. The Debtors will provide notice (via electronic mail or otherwise) of any change in the date, time or location of the Auction to Qualified Bidders, and will cause publication of such change to occur on the website maintained by Kurtzman Carson Consultants, LLC dba Verita Global, the Debtors' claims and noticing agent in these Chapter 11 Cases, located at https://www.veritaglobal.net/yardbird (the "Case Website").

One day after the conclusion of the Auction, the Debtors will file with the Court, serve on the Sale Notice Parties (as defined in Section X.B of the Bidding Procedures) and cause to be published on the Case Website, a notice of the results of the Auction.

If the Debtors determine not to hold an Auction for some or all of the Assets, the Debtors shall file with the Court, serve on the Sale Notice Parties, and cause to be published on the Case Website, a notice containing the following information (as applicable): (i) a statement that the Auction for the relevant Assets has been canceled; (ii) the identity of the Successful Bidder; (iii) either include a copy of the Successful Bid or a summary of the material terms of such bid, including any assumption and assignment of Contracts contemplated thereby, or provide instructions for accessing the Successful Bid free of charge from the Case Website; and (iv) the date, time, and location of the Sale Hearing.

C. Objection Deadlines

Sale Objection Deadline. Except objections to the conduct of the Auction, the Successful Bidder or the Backup Bidder (in each case other than the Stalking Horse Bidder), all objections to a Sale of the Assets, including (a) any objection to a Sale of the Assets free and clear of all liens, claims, interests and encumbrances pursuant to section 363(f) of the Bankruptcy Code and (b) entry of any Sale Order must be (i) in writing and state, with specificity, the legal and factual bases thereof and include any appropriate documentation in support thereof; and (ii) filed with the Court by **no later than October 29, 2026, at 4:00 p.m. (prevailing Eastern Time)** and served on the Objection Notice Parties (as defined in Section X.D of the Bidding Procedures).

Supplemental Sale Objection Deadline. Following service of the Notice of Auction Results, parties may object solely with respect to the particular terms of a proposed Sale or the Successful Bid or Backup Bid (in each case, if such bidder is not the Stalking Horse Bidder). Any Supplemental Sale Objection must be (a) in writing and state, with specificity, the legal and factual bases thereof and include any appropriate documentation in support thereof; and (b) filed with the Court by no later **November 4, 2026, at 4:00 p.m. (prevailing Eastern Time)** (the "Supplemental Sale Objection Deadline") and served on the Objection Notice Parties.

D. Sale Hearing. The Sale Hearing shall take place on **November 9, 2026 at 10:00 a.m. (prevailing Eastern Time)** before The Honorable Brendan L. Shannon, United States Bankruptcy Judge, in the United States Bankruptcy Court for the District of Delaware, located at 824 N. Market Street, Wilmington, Delaware 19801, 6th floor, courtroom 1.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION. Copies of the Motion, the Bidding Procedures Order and the Bidding Procedures may be obtained free of charge by visiting the Case Website located at https://www.veritaglobal.net/yardbird.

FAILURE TO ABIDE BY THE BIDDING PROCEDURES, THE BIDDING PROCEDURES ORDER, OR ANY OTHER APPLICABLE ORDER OF THE COURT ENTERED IN THE CHAPTER 11 CASES MAY RESULT IN THE REJECTION OF YOUR BID AND YOUR DISQUALIFICATION FROM PARTICIPATING IN THE BIDDING FOR AND AUCTION OF ANY OF THE DEBTORS' ASSETS.

THE FAILURE OF ANY PERSON OR ENTITY TO FILE AND SERVE AN OBJECTION IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE BIDDING PROCEDURES ORDER, INCLUDING THE FAILURE TO FILE ANY SUCH OBJECTION BY THE APPLICABLE OBJECTION DEADLINE, SHALL FOREVER BAR SUCH PERSON OR ENTITY FROM ASSERTING, AT THE SALE HEARING OR THEREAFTER, ANY SUCH OBJECTION TO THE RELIEF REQUESTED IN THE MOTION, THE CONSUMMATION OF ANY APPLICABLE SALE, INCLUDING THE SALE OF ANY ASSETS TO A SUCCESSFUL BIDDER FREE AND CLEAR OF LIENS, CLAIMS, INTERESTS AND ENCUMBRANCES PURSUANT TO SECTION 363(f) OF THE BANKRUPTCY CODE OR THE TERMS OF THE STALKING HORSE APA OR OTHER ASSET PURCHASE AGREEMENT EXECUTED BY THE DEBTORS.

[1] The Debtors in these chapter 11 cases, along with the last four digits of each Debtor's federal tax identification number include: Yardbird Group LLC (7139); Southern Operations, LLC (5384); Yardbird Beverly Hills, LLC (9735); Yardbird DFW, LLC (2545); Yardbird DC, LLC (2651); Yardbird Chicago, LLC (6273); Yardbird Denver LLC (8819), YB Las Vegas, LLC (4071), Yardbird DFW Management LLC (8949), Yardbird DFW Concession LLC (1952), and The Bird Singapore LLC (8264). The location of the Debtors' service address in these chapter 11 cases is 3355 Las Vegas Boulevard South, Las Vegas, Nevada 89109.

[2] Capitalized terms used but not defined herein shall have the respective meanings ascribed to such terms in the Motion or the Bidding Procedures, as applicable.

[3] The Stalking Horse Bidder is an entity owned by and formed at the direction of the Debtors' DIP Secured Parties, who are also the Debtors' Prepetition Secured Parties. Pursuant to the Bidding Procedures Order, the Stalking Horse Bidder is entitled to Expense Reimbursement of up to $175,000 in the event the Stalking Horse Bidder is not the Successful Bidder.

NOTICE OF SALE

NOTICE OF PUBLIC AUCTION
OF COOPERATIVE APARTMENT

BY VIRTUE OF DEFAULT of a Loan Security Agreement and Mortgage originally executed on December 15, 2017 by GeorgeAnne Heller and in accordance with its rights as holder of the security, Jami Morse Heidegger and Nikolaus Heidegger, Trustees of the Heidegger Revocable Trust, UTD 11/9/96, as Amended and Restated ("Secured Party"), by Matthew D. Mannion Licensed Auctioneer DCA # 1434494 of Mannion Auctions, LLC, Auctioneer, will conduct a public sale of the security consisting of 5,000 shares of capital stock of Barrow Street Owners Inc. (the "Shares"), and all right title and interest in and to a proprietary lease to Unit 6C in a building known as and by the street address, 111 Barrow Street, New York, New York 10014 (the "Proprietary Lease") on November 4, 2026 at 1:00 PM at the offices of Pryor Cashman LLP, 7 Times Square, 40th Floor, New York, New York and via Zoom or a similar video conferencing program selected by Secured Party, in satisfaction of an indebtedness in the principal amount of $1,705,000.00 plus interest from December 15, 2017, subject to board approval. APARTMENT IS SOLD "AS IS." The secured party reserves the right to bid and to adjourn, delay or terminate the sale without notice or to withdraw any of the aforesaid collateral from the auction. Cash will not be accepted.

The purchase price for the above-described Shares and Proprietary Lease for the Apartment shall be payable by wire or certified or bank check as follows: a ten percent (10%) deposit is required with a successful bid, and the balance of the purchase price shall be payable within thirty (30) days. All certified/bank checks must be made payable to "PRYOR CASHMAN LLP, as attorneys." The sale shall be subject to the further conditions set forth in the Terms of Sale which are available upon request, and to such revision thereto as may be announced at the start of the auction. Any party interested in registering to participate via video conferencing program must contact the undersigned no later than November 1, 2026; such parties who do not contact the undersigned on or before November 1, 2026 may not be permitted to participate via video conferencing program.

Please direct all inquiries with respect to the auction sale or the collateral to broker Pamela D'Arc of Compass Inc.; (917) 509-8315; pamela.darc@compass.com.

Dated: September 30, 2026 New York, New York

PUBLIC NOTICES

A class action has been commenced in the Federal Court of Australia against Virgin Australia, two former directors of Virgin Australia, a related entity of Virgin Australia, and Virgin Australia's insurers.

The class action has been commenced on behalf of investors who purchased:

- unsecured Australian Dollar denominated notes that were issued by Virgin Australia on 26 November 2019; and
- unsecured United States Dollar denominated notes that were issued by Virgin Australia on 7 November 2019.

If you are or may be a group member you can register to participate here:

VAHnoticesclassaction.com

For any questions in relation to the class action or registration, please use the below contact details:
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TSMC Weighs Texas Push, Holds Talks on Musk Project

By Sherry Qin

Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co. raised the prospect of additional U.S. manufacturing capacity beyond Arizona, including in Texas, as demand for artificial-intelligence chips continued to outpace supply despite a wave of capacity additions across the industry.

The world's largest contract chip maker on Thursday signaled its willingness to participate in large-scale AI infrastructure projects, such as Elon Musk's proposed Terafab initiative, underscoring how major technology companies are exploring new ways to secure the semiconductor capacity needed for the next phase of AI deployment.

Chief Executive C.C. Wei said TSMC has dispatched teams to Texas to evaluate potential expansion opportunities. He also confirmed the company has held discussions regarding the Terafab project, though talks are continuing and no decision has been finalized.

He said the company remains open to either a partnership or owning facilities outright, though he added that any fab producing TSMC chips will need to be operated by TSMC. Earlier this month, while confirming early talks with TSMC, Musk said on X that **Tesla** and **SpaceX** will build and run the facility.

The discussions come as TSMC accelerates its U.S. expansion plans. The company in July pledged an additional US$100 billion investment in Arizona, bringing its total commitment in the state to US$265 billion, as demand for AI processors and related semiconductors continues to surge.

TSMC maintained its capital-expenditure target of US$60 billion to US$64 billion this year, reaffirming one of the largest investment programs in the semiconductor industry.

Looking beyond 2026, the company said it sees significant upside through 2028 to meet soaring AI infrastructure demand. Some analysts have projected TSMC's capital expenditure to exceed US$80 billion in 2027.

Addressing concerns about its surging capital spending potentially fueling an AI bubble, Wei said TSMC has a disciplined internal capacity-assessment system to check the data-center build-out.

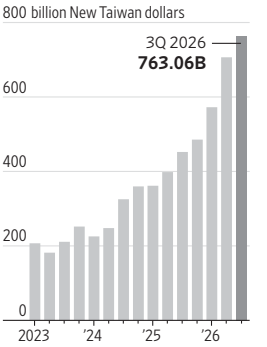
"We have a very good idea of our customers' multiyear product road map," Wei said.

TSMC on Thursday reported a better-than-expected 69% jump in third-quarter net profit to 763.06 billion New Taiwan dollars, equivalent to US$23.71 billion. Revenue was NT$1.494 trillion, up 51% from a year earlier.

It projected fourth-quarter revenue of between US$52.3 billion and US$54.3 billion, citing continued demand for AI processors and high-performance computing applications.

It raised its annual revenue growth guidance to around 44% from "slightly over 40%" in July, upgrading the forecast for the third time this year.

TSMC quarterly profit



Note: 1 billion New Taiwan dollars = $31 million
Sources: S&P Capital IQ; the company

Strong Results Boost Ericsson

By Dominic Chopping

Ericsson shares surged as investors cheered strong growth in sales of network gear, shrugging off a company warning that higher component costs will be a headwind to profitability next year.

Shares rose nearly 10% in Stockholm.

The Swedish telecommunications equipment maker said its networks business posted an organic sales increase of 9% in the third quarter, driven by project deliveries in Japan and India, as well as continuing network modernization and expansion in the Middle East. Networks sales in North America expanded slightly, while overall sales were supported by higher licensing revenues.

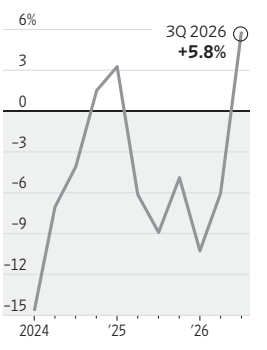
Networks profitability also increased, though Ericsson continued to warn of increasing cost pressures from rising semiconductor costs.

The company has been working to offset these higher component costs by burden-sharing with customers and suppliers as well as by substituting products to reduce costs.

It reported an adjusted gross margin of 50.3% for the networks unit in the latest quarter, above the guided range of 48% to 50%, and said the margin is expected to land between 49% and 51% in the fourth quarter. Sales in the unit are expected to rise in line with average seasonality of 17% in the fourth quarter.

The company reported third-quarter earnings before interest and taxes of 8.86 billion Swedish kronor, or $883.9 million, ahead of the 7.12 billion kronor expected in a FactSet poll. Sales rose 5.8% to 59.48 billion kronor, versus the 55.28 billion kronor FactSet estimate, while the group's gross margin slipped to 47.1% from 47.6%.

Ericsson's quarterly sales, change from a year earlier



Source: S&P Capital IQ

Netflix Content Chief Exits

Continued from page B1

offs since 2022.

Rice began his career in Fox's movie division in 1989 and made his mark leading its specialty label Fox Searchlight. He became a top television executive and held a similar role at Disney following its 2019 acquisition of most of the entertainment assets of 21st Century Fox. He was fired three years later.

Last year Netflix made a $72 billion bid for Warner Bros. Discovery's film and TV studios and HBO Max streaming service but backed out of the contest in February. Paramount closed its own $81 billion deal to acquire Warner Bros. Discovery this month.

Netflix's stock fell during its pursuit of Warner and hasn't recovered since. It is down 40% over the past year. At the same time, internal and external metrics of customer engagement have been slowing or declining, according to analysts.

That has created internal pressure to find new ways to juice growth and change Netflix's narrative with investors, according to people close to the company.

MARKETS DIGEST

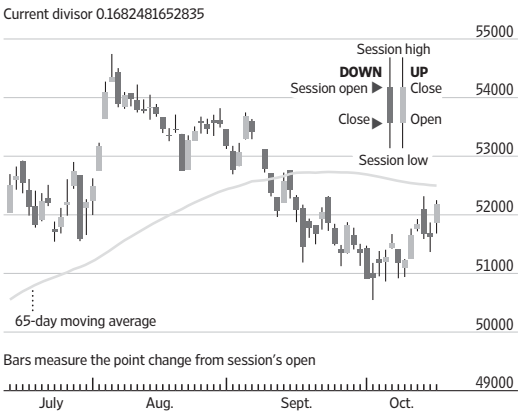
EQUITIES

Dow Jones Industrial Average

52177.69 ▲556.21, or 1.08%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio	20.98	24.72
P/E estimate *	19.58	22.09
Dividend yield	1.52	1.61
All-time high	54349.12, 08/05/26	

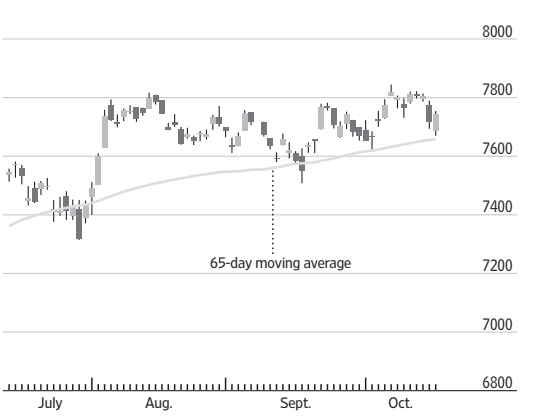


S&P 500 Index

7744.06 ▲25.12, or 0.33%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *	23.58	25.65
P/E estimate *	19.56	22.27
Dividend yield *	1.05	1.15
All-time high	7818.93, 10/06/26	

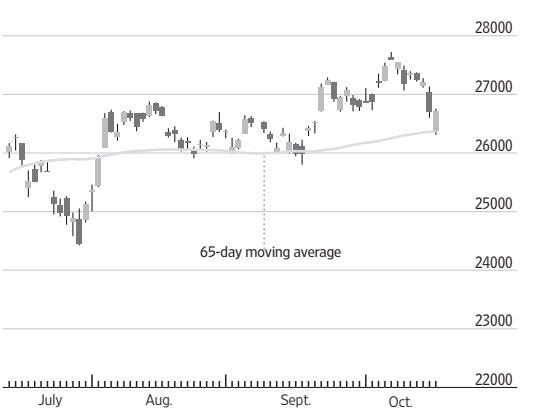


Nasdaq Composite Index

26713.03 ▲20.16, or 0.08%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *†	31.51	33.55
P/E estimate *†	22.15	29.15
Dividend yield *†	0.53	0.64
All-time high:	27599.79, 10/06/26	



*Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Birinyi Associates Inc; †Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Major U.S. Stock-Market Indexes

	High	Low	Latest Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	52-Week % chg	YTD % chg	3-yr. ann. % chg
Dow Jones										
Industrial Average	52250.18	51681.37	**52177.69**	556.21	**1.08**	54349.12	45166.64	**13.5**	8.6	**15.7**
Transportation Avg	20128.57	19811.08	**20106.68**	276.72	**1.40**	23933.14	15421.02	**28.4**	15.8	**11.0**
Utility Average	1076.33	1060.96	**1066.50**	1.07	**0.10**	1190.23	1004.50	**-7.9**	-0.1	**9.0**
Total Stock Market	76234.13	75329.78	**76158.05**	330.07	**0.44**	77313.23	62750.36	**16.1**	12.8	**21.0**
Barron's 400	1602.41	1579.67	**1602.08**	17.12	**1.08**	1685.46	1318.70	**17.7**	13.4	**19.0**
Nasdaq Stock Market										
Nasdaq Composite	26754.02	26308.85	**26713.03**	20.16	**0.08**	27599.79	20794.64	**18.4**	14.9	**25.8**
Nasdaq-100	29985.62	29408.41	**29935.59**	-15.23	**-0.05**	31224.47	22953.38	**21.4**	18.6	**25.9**
S&P										
500 Index	7754.15	7669.66	**7744.06**	25.12	**0.33**	7818.93	6343.72	**16.8**	13.1	**21.4**
MidCap 400	3649.43	3593.55	**3648.40**	37.15	**1.03**	3926.98	3109.89	**13.4**	10.4	**14.3**
SmallCap 600	1669.45	1646.76	**1668.92**	21.92	**1.33**	1828.54	1364.94	**16.2**	13.7	**14.5**
Other Indexes										
Russell 2000	2768.02	2725.06	**2767.27**	37.74	**1.38**	3068.42	2305.11	**12.2**	11.5	**17.2**
NYSE Composite	24085.19	23865.42	**24066.65**	201.22	**0.84**	24821.68	20912.89	**12.6**	9.4	**16.2**
Value Line	655.34	644.92	**655.26**	10.340	**1.60**	702.60	590.50	**5.0**	4.3	**7.8**
NYSE Arca Biotech	9405.34	9159.78	**9350.09**	190.31	**2.08**	9539.76	6519.08	**43.4**	30.7	**23.4**
NYSE Arca Pharma	1298.37	1255.39	**1275.61**	20.22	**1.61**	1315.38	984.85	**27.5**	13.3	**11.8**
KBW Bank	168.99	165.39	**168.63**	2.12	**1.27**	193.91	143.83	**17.2**	2.7	**30.3**
PHLX§ Gold/Silver	354.64	341.63	**354.37**	13.01	**3.81**	470.37	265.03	**7.6**	3.5	**45.8**
PHLX§ Oil Service	92.32	90.37	**91.83**	-1.072	**-1.15**	109.24	61.83	**48.5**	25.2	**-1.1**
PHLX§ Semiconductor	11620.14	11171.53	**11581.22**	-103.16	**-0.88**	14634.72	6352.07	**70.3**	63.5	**49.7**
Cboe Volatility	18.01	16.34	**16.46**	-0.41	**-2.43**	31.05	13.47	**-35.0**	10.1	**-5.2**

§Nasdaq PHLX

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Late Trading

Most-active and biggest movers among NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE Amer. and Nasdaq issues from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. ET as reported by electronic trading services, securities dealers and regional exchanges. Minimum share price of $2 and minimum after-hours volume of 50,000 shares.

Most-active issues in late trading

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	After Hours Last	After Hours Net chg	After Hours % chg	After Hours High	After Hours Low
Medtronic	MDT	17,774.3	95.31	-0.14	**-0.15**	95.92	93.78
Grab Holdings	GRAB	12,512.3	2.99	-0.01	**-0.33**	3.00	2.91
Snap	SNAP	8,775.1	6.44	-0.0003	**-0.005**	6.45	6.35
Zillow Group Cl C	Z	5,978.8	31.35	-0.11	**-0.35**	31.56	31.16
Ford Motor	F	5,659.1	12.32	0.01	**0.08**	12.33	12.30
MiniMed Group	MMED	5,602.5	17.96	-0.04	**-0.22**	18.07	17.81
NVIDIA	NVDA	5,431.0	217.44	0.21	**0.10**	230.38	203.24
State Street SPDR S&P 500	SPY	4,760.1	771.54	-0.25	**-0.03**	772.24	719.87

Percentage gainers...

SITE Centers	SITC	1,364.1	3.60	0.59	**19.60**	3.75	3.01
Picard Medical	PMI	54.4	11.06	1.06	**10.60**	13.50	10.95
Bradbury Capital	BBCI	158.7	3.34	0.18	**5.70**	3.43	3.04
Four Corners Property Tr	FCPT	68.1	22.82	1.02	**4.66**	22.82	21.74
New Era Energy & Digital	NUAI	299.8	3.47	0.14	**4.20**	3.49	3.33

...And losers

US Foods Holding	USFD	312.4	93.93	-7.54	**-7.43**	101.47	93.93
SS&C Technologies	SSNC	199.4	78.44	-5.75	**-6.83**	84.20	78.44
Aclaris Therapeutics	ACRS	485.4	3.30	-0.19	**-5.44**	3.62	3.30
Defiance Dly Tgt 2x Lg	MSTX	258.8	16.66	-0.70	**-4.03**	17.48	15.90
Simplify Managed Futures	CTA	94.1	28.44	-1.00	**-3.40**	29.44	28.44

Trading Diary

Volume, Advancers, Decliners

	NYSE	NYSE Amer.
Total volume*	1,367,612,959	19,195,263
Adv. volume*	993,163,795	15,318,096
Decl. volume*	361,860,814	3,642,523
Issues traded	2,793	291
Advances	2,076	169
Declines	672	112
Unchanged	45	10
New highs	68	2
New lows	142	45
Closing Arms†	1.16	0.39
Block trades*	4,324	167

	Nasdaq	NYSE Arca
Total volume*	10,869,962,438	446,279,081
Adv. volume*	7,634,010,702	277,056,965
Decl. volume*	3,156,464,430	168,790,887
Issues traded	5,012	2,571
Advances	3,195	1,986
Declines	1,652	564
Unchanged	165	21
New highs	84	51
New lows	535	88
Closing Arms†	0.80	1.88
Block trades*	93,308	1,867

*Primary market NYSE, NYSE American NYSE Arca only. †(TRIN) A comparison of the number of advancing and declining issues with the volume of shares rising and falling. An Arms of less than 1 indicates buying demand; above 1 indicates selling pressure.

Percentage Gainers...

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	52-Week % chg
Tradr 2X Long OPEN Daily	OPEX	3.43	0.85	**32.95**	128.45	2.46	**...**
Better Home & Finance	BETR	10.76	2.64	**32.51**	92.69	7.51	**-82.0**
Indaptus Therapeutics	INDP	2.85	0.64	**28.96**	5.96	0.92	**-26.5**
PTL	PTLE	9.05	1.70	**23.13**	36.00	4.00	**-31.2**
MindForge	MF	10.88	2.03	**22.94**	83.50	2.12	**-77.3**
Tradr 2X Long QNT Daily	QNTU	3.83	0.69	**21.97**	27.30	3.14	**...**
Akari Therapeutics ADR	AKTX	8.84	1.56	**21.43**	36.75	3.02	**-73.0**
Tradr 2X Long CRML Daily	CRMX	16.86	2.97	**21.38**	577.32	12.30	**...**
T-REX 2X Lg FIGR Dly Tgt	FGRU	6.69	1.16	**20.87**	26.10	5.16	**...**
BayFirst Financial	BAFN	6.34	1.09	**20.67**	10.38	4.26	**-33.3**
Trinity Biotech ADR	TRIB	7.93	1.32	**19.97**	52.50	5.01	**-76.0**
Verastem	VSTM	9.23	1.52	**19.71**	10.82	3.43	**-1.8**
Bradbury Capital	BBCI	3.16	0.52	**19.70**	15.50	2.46	**-73.8**
Twin Vee PowerCats	VEEE	10.06	1.64	**19.48**	127.65	4.16	**-88.2**
Corgi CRCL 2x Daily ETF	CIR	32.17	5.09	**18.80**	48.77	18.46	**...**

Percentage Losers

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	52-Week % chg
SciSparc	SPRC	2.00	-1.63	**-44.90**	43.65	1.63	**-94.8**
FMC	FMC	5.62	-2.47	**-30.53**	31.30	4.85	**-81.3**
Picard Medical	PMI	10.00	-2.68	**-21.14**	684.00	2.65	**-98.1**
Leverage 2X Lg SMTC Dly	SMTG	7.19	-1.83	**-20.27**	14.50	4.75	**...**
T-REX 2X Invr CRCL Dly	CRCD	1.92	-0.45	**-18.86**	73.12	1.52	**-89.7**
Defiance Tgt 2x Shrt IONQ	IONZ	29.79	-6.88	**-18.76**	436.81	17.07	**-82.8**
WISeSat.Space Holdings	SAIQ	3.21	-0.67	**-17.27**	12.95	1.76	**-68.7**
NorthStar Earth & Space A	NSTR	3.14	-0.64	**-16.93**	12.74	2.49	**...**
T-REX 2X Lg PENG Dly Tgt	PENU	24.24	-4.71	**-16.28**	42.55	15.97	**...**
ManpowerGroup	MAN	43.74	-8.22	**-15.82**	63.88	25.15	**15.0**
Defiance Tgt 2x Shrt RGTI	RGTZ	22.26	-4.08	**-15.49**	187.40	11.20	**-48.8**
Leverage 2X Lg HPE Dly	HPEL	18.27	-3.07	**-14.39**	29.51	10.45	**...**
Leverage 2X Lg MTSI Dly	MTSG	5.51	-0.92	**-14.35**	14.58	4.54	**...**
Republic Power Group	RPGL	13.33	-2.16	**-13.94**	54912.00	12.00	**-99.99**
Defiance Tgt 2x Shrt QBTS	QBTZ	25.86	-4.15	**-13.83**	484.20	12.99	**-82.2**

Most Active Stocks

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	Latest Session % chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Stardust Power	SDST	**1,610,954**	4518.7	0.04	**55.38**	7.67	0.03
CCC Intelligent Solns	CCC	**323,547**	2801.8	7.63	**-0.13**	9.45	4.08
Dermata Therapeutics	DRMA	**169,061**	24031.6	0.91	**37.19**	4.66	0.60
Intel	INTC	**145,977**	36.9	95.37	**-2.80**	142.35	32.89
Direxion Semicon Bl 3x	SOXL	**136,086**	108.4	107.35	**-2.89**	302.00	28.12
WF Holding	WFF	**132,078**	1269.9	0.16	**-8.57**	50.60	0.13
GrShr 2x Sh NVDA Daily	NVD	**130,226**	63.0	3.98	**3.92**	9.76	3.19
CoreWeave Cl A	CRWV	**128,747**	334.7	69.69	**5.94**	150.40	59.51
NVIDIA	NVDA	**125,578**	5.6	217.23	**-1.84**	243.37	164.27
DarkIris	DKI	**121,927**	1901.0	0.06	**-7.54**	19.36	0.05

*Volumes of 100,000 shares or more are rounded to the nearest thousand

Volume Movers

Ranked by change from 65-day average*

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	Latest Session % chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low
GalaxyEdge Acqn Cl A	GLED	1,687	**13156**	10.07	**0.10**	10.08	9.87
Pyrophyte Acqn II Cl A	PAII	3,853	**12585**	10.32	**-0.10**	10.35	10.02
NT Core Bond	BNDC	761	**6724**	21.31	**0.78**	22.73	20.95
ProShares UltSh Indls	SIJ	315	**5674**	18.82	**-1.13**	25.38	15.05
Karbon Cap Partners Cl A	KBON	1,920	**5023**	10.11	**-0.10**	10.15	10.02
NYLIM Candriam Intl Eq	IQSI	343	**4913**	37.93	**0.73**	39.63	33.18
ProSh Ultra Comm Svcs	LTL	400	**4097**	24.39	**3.36**	29.38	21.88
iShares iBds Oct31 TIPS	IBIH	1,369	**3651**	25.08	**0.26**	26.55	24.85
Blue Water Acqn III Cl A	BLUW	1,115	**3402**	10.38	**-0.10**	10.41	9.98
iShares iBds Oct30 TIPS	IBIG	1,292	**2947**	25.21	**0.16**	26.59	25.00

*Common stocks priced at $2 a share or more with an average volume over 65 trading days of at least 5,000 shares †Has traded fewer than 65 days

International Stock Indexes

Region/Country	Index	Close	Latest Net chg	Latest % chg	YTD % chg
World	**MSCI ACWI**	**1133.19**	-0.69	**-0.06**	11.7
	MSCI ACWI ex-USA	**460.40**	-3.64	**-0.78**	9.3
	MSCI World	**4932.95**	16.74	**0.34**	11.3
	MSCI Emerging Markets	**1607.59**	-51.45	**-3.10**	14.5
Americas	**MSCI AC Americas**	**2930.50**	11.675	**0.40**	13.0
Canada	**S&P/TSX Comp**	**36137.10**	552.64	**1.55**	14.0
Latin Amer.	**MSCI EM Latin America**	**3310.07**	-4.06	**-0.12**	22.2
Brazil	**Bovespa**	**204324.26**	-2181.72	**-1.06**	26.8
Mexico	**S&P/BMV IPC**	**67663.29**	872.94	**1.31**	5.2
EMEA	**STOXX Europe 600**	**640.16**	2.41	**0.38**	8.1
Eurozone	**Euro STOXX**	**650.43**	-2.09	**-0.32**	6.2
Belgium	**Bel-20**	**5591.77**	45.16	**0.81**	10.1
Denmark	**OMX Copenhagen 20**	**1546.71**	24.14	**1.59**	-3.8
France	**CAC 40**	**7934.70**	61.59	**0.78**	-2.6
Germany	**DAX**	**25382.62**	84.01	**0.33**	3.6
Israel	**Tel Aviv**	**4156.68**	-6.09	**-0.15**	14.5
Italy	**FTSE MIB**	**49397.55**	-356.29	**-0.72**	9.9
Netherlands	**AEX**	**1132.58**	-4.51	**-0.40**	19.1
Norway	**Oslo Bors All-Share**	**2499.01**	-16.58	**-0.66**	28.7
South Africa	**FTSE/JSE All-Share**	**110171.85**	1656.41	**1.53**	-4.9
Spain	**IBEX 35**	**19177.70**	-53.00	**-0.28**	10.8
Sweden	**OMX Stockholm**	**1126.20**	-4.56	**-0.40**	7.7
Switzerland	**Swiss Market**	**14349.51**	219.58	**1.55**	8.2
Turkey	**BIST 100**	**12070.17**	-48.12	**-0.40**	7.2
U.K.	**FTSE 100**	**10840.35**	115.49	**1.08**	9.2
U.K.	**FTSE 250**	**24424.77**	64.00	**0.26**	8.7
Asia-Pacific	**MSCI AC Asia Pacific**	**261.15**	-7.86	**-2.92**	14.7
Australia	**S&P/ASX 200**	**8719.70**	-8.17	**-0.09**	0.1
China	**Shanghai Composite**	**3707.48**	-59.75	**-1.59**	-6.6
Hong Kong	**Hang Seng**	**24062.72**	-251.45	**-1.03**	-6.1
India	**BSE Sensex**	**74315.61**	1533.72	**2.11**	-12.8
Indonesia	**JSX Composite**	**5863.78**	-79.24	**-1.33**	-32.2
Japan	**NIKKEI 225**	**64425.95**	-3318.34	**-4.90**	28.0
Singapore	**Straits Times**	**5403.50**	-19.83	**-0.37**	16.3
South Korea	**KOSPI**	**5554.22**	-454.59	**-7.57**	31.8
Taiwan	**TAIEX**	**46969.87**	-1655.96	**-3.41**	62.2
Thailand	**SET**	**1573.01**	-2.87	**-0.18**	24.9

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

CURRENCIES & COMMODITIES

Currencies

U.S.-dollar foreign-exchange rates at 5 p.m. ET

Country/currency	Thurs in US$	Thurs per US$	US$ vs. YTD chg (%)
Americas			
Argentina peso	.00071513	8114	**4.3**
Brazil real	.1962	5.0973	**-7.6**
Canada dollar	.7049	1.4186	**3.3**
Chile peso	.001019	981.55	**9.0**
Colombia peso	.000315	3175.01	**-15.8**
Ecuador US dollar	1	1	**unch**
Mexico peso	.0543	18.4128	**2.2**
Uruguay peso	.02488	40.2006	**2.9**
Asia-Pacific			
Australia dollar	.6920	1.4451	**-3.6**
China yuan	.1494	6.6915	**-4.3**
Hong Kong dollar	.1274	7.8474	**0.8**
India rupee	.01055	94.753	**5.4**
Indonesia rupiah	.0000558	17933	**7.4**
Japan yen	.006329	157.99	**0.8**
Kazakhstan tenge	.002209	452.77	**-10.8**
Macau pataca	.1237	8.0854	**0.8**
Malaysia ringgit	.2448	4.0852	**0.7**
New Zealand dollar	.5623	1.7784	**2.4**
Pakistan rupee	.00361	276.704	**-1.3**
Philippines peso	.0159	63.055	**7.0**
Singapore dollar	.7800	1.2820	**-0.3**
South Korea won	.0007455	1341.42	**-6.9**
Sri Lanka rupee	.0030222	330.89	**6.8**
Taiwan dollar	.03091	32.357	**3.2**
Thailand baht	.02983	33.520	**6.4**
Vietnam dong	.00003865	25873	**-1.6**
Europe			
Czech Rep. koruna	.04609	21.697	**5.5**
Denmark krone	.1501	6.6621	**4.8**
Euro area euro	1.1222	.8911	**4.7**
Hungary forint	.003084	324.21	**-1.0**
Iceland krona	.008239	121.38	**-3.1**
Norway krone	.1056	9.4698	**-6.1**
Poland zloty	.2569	3.8931	**8.4**
Sweden krona	.1005	9.9486	**8.0**
Switzerland franc	1.2098	.8266	**4.3**
Turkey lira	.0202	49.4648	**15.1**
Ukraine hryvnia	.0222	44.9500	**6.1**
UK pound	1.3275	.7533	**1.5**
Middle East/Africa			
Bahrain dinar	2.6478	.3777	**0.2**
Egypt pound	.0187	53.4269	**12.0**
Israel shekel	.3224	3.1018	**-2.6**
Kuwait dinar	3.2163	.3109	**1.0**
Oman sul rial	2.5994	.3847	**-0.02**
Qatar rial	.2744	3.644	**-0.3**
Saudi Arabia riyal	.2665	3.7530	**0.1**
South Africa rand	.0606	16.5073	**-0.3**

	Close	Net Chg	% Chg	YTD % Chg
WSJ Dollar Index	97.26	-0.31	-0.32	**1.40**

Sources: Tullett Prebon, Dow Jones Market Data

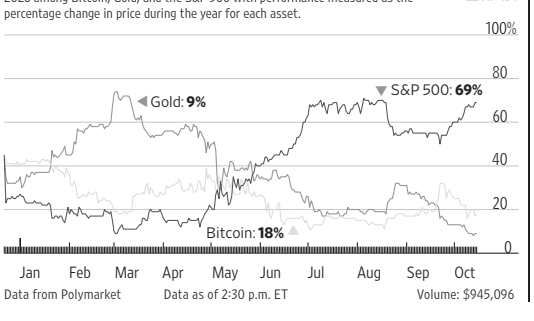
Commodities

	Close	Thursday Net chg	Thursday % Chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	52-Week % Chg	YTD % chg
DJ Commodity	**1462.95**	0.64	**0.04**	1505.40	1086.85	**34.22**	29.38
FTSE/CC CRB Index	**417.49**	1.45	**0.35**	429.15	291.69	**42.07**	39.73
Crude oil, $ per barrel	**97.97**	2.88	**3.03**	112.95	55.27	**70.50**	70.62
Natural gas, $/MMBtu	**3.236**	0.038	**1.19**	7.460	2.523	**10.14**	-12.21
Gold, $ per troy oz.	**4147.70**	62.90	**1.54**	5318.40	3947.70	**-3.10**	-4.11

Polymarket | A Dow Jones partner

Prediction Market: Bitcoin vs. Gold vs. S&P 500 in 2026

This market will resolve according to the asset which has the best performance in 2026 among Bitcoin, Gold, and the S&P 500 with performance measured as the percentage change in price during the year for each asset.



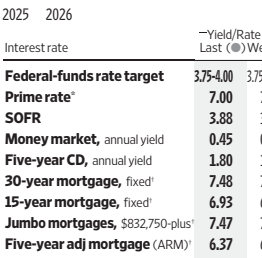
Data from Polymarket | Data as of 2:30 p.m. ET | Volume: $945,096

CREDIT MARKETS

Consumer Rates and Returns to Investor

U.S. consumer rates

A consumer rate against its benchmark over the past year



Selected rates

Five-year ARM, Rate

Bankrate.com avg†:	**6.37%**
Florence Savings Bank	**5.25%**
Florence, MA	800-644-8261
San Diego County Credit Union	**5.38%**
San Diego, CA	877-732-2848
Hanscom Federal Credit Union	**5.50%**
Hanscom AFB, MA	800-656-4328
UniBank for Savings	**5.75%**
Whitinsville, MA	800-578-4270
Clinton Savings Bank	**5.88%**
Clinton, MA	888-744-4272

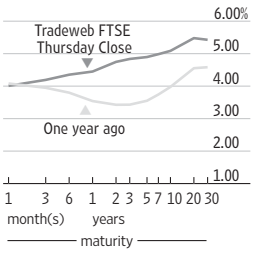
Interest rate	Yield/Rate (%) Last	Yield/Rate (%) Week ago	52-Week Range (%) Low	52-Week Range (%) High	3-yr chg (pct pts)
Federal-funds rate target	3.75-4.00	3.75-4.00	3.50	4.25	**-1.50**
Prime rate*	**7.00**	7.00	6.75	7.25	**-1.50**
SOFR	**3.88**	3.88	3.50	4.31	**-1.43**
Money market, annual yield	**0.45**	0.45	0.41	0.45	**-0.16**
Five-year CD, annual yield	**1.80**	1.79	1.67	1.80	**-0.99**
30-year mortgage, fixed†	**7.48**	7.50	6.11	7.50	**-0.62**
15-year mortgage, fixed†	**6.93**	6.90	5.55	6.93	**-0.27**
Jumbo mortgages, $832,750-plus†	**7.47**	7.47	6.34	7.54	**-0.69**
Five-year adj mortgage (ARM)†	**6.37**	6.42	5.66	6.72	**-0.49**
New-car loan, 48-month	**7.05**	7.03	6.85	7.12	**-0.48**

Bankrate.com rates based on survey of over 1,500 online banks. *Base rate posted by 70% of the nation's largest banks. † Excludes closing costs.

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data; Bankrate.com

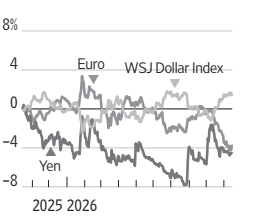
Treasury yield curve

Yield to maturity of current bills, notes and bonds



Forex Race

Yen, euro vs. dollar; dollar vs. major U.S. trading partners



Sources: Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close; Tullett Prebon; Dow Jones Market Data

Corporate Borrowing Rates and Yields

Bond total return index	Close	Yield (%) Last	Yield (%) Week ago	52-Week High	52-Week Low	Total Return (%) 52-wk	Total Return (%) 3-yr
U.S. Treasury, Bloomberg	2295.190	**4.990**	5.060	5.130	3.750	**-1.514**	3.616
U.S. Treasury Long, Bloomberg	3049.000	**5.450**	5.630	5.690	4.520	**-6.556**	2.190
Aggregate, Bloomberg	2210.060	**5.410**	5.490	5.570	4.160	**-1.360**	4.584
Fixed-Rate MBS, Bloomberg	2207.630	**5.720**	5.860	5.970	4.380	**-0.952**	5.257
High Yield 100, ICE BofA	4108.247	**7.538**	7.605	7.655	5.828	**0.780**	7.861
Muni Master, ICE BofA	604.945	**4.195**	4.491	4.628	3.037	**-1.610**	3.122
EMBI Global, J.P. Morgan	1017.703	**6.987**	7.132	7.205	6.403	**2.031**	9.779

Sources: J.P. Morgan; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; ICE Data Services

COMMODITIES

wsj.com/market-data/commodities

Futures Contracts

Metal & Petroleum Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Copper-High (CMX)-25,000 lbs.; $ per lb.							
Oct	6.5770	6.5775		6.4985	**6.5115**	-0.1000	1,761
Dec	6.6330	6.6380		6.5245	**6.5565**	-0.1040	158,392
Gold (CMX)-100 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
Oct	4093.60	4099.00		4080.70	**4147.70**	62.90	88
Nov	4113.50	4182.60		4106.50	**4155.20**	62.10	3,711
Dec	4128.30	4197.70		4120.90	**4170.10**	62.20	321,688
Jan'27	4181.60	4215.00		4173.30	**4189.00**	62.40	588
Feb	4160.50	4231.30		4156.50	**4205.00**	62.80	44,777
March	4220.00	4246.00		4213.00	**4221.50**	62.90	271
Palladium (NYM) - 50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
Oct	1086.50	1088.00	▼	1086.50	**1121.00**	33.90	8
Dec	1096.50	1140.00		1096.50	**1128.50**	32.00	22,434
Platinum (NYM)-50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
Oct	1605.00	1605.50		1596.00	**1610.70**	9.40	41
Jan'27	1605.10	1639.20		1603.00	**1621.50**	6.90	53,076
Silver (CMX)-5,000 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
Oct	56.745	56.745		55.500	**56.837**	1.287	258
Dec	55.800	57.690		55.620	**57.156**	1.279	86,886
Crude Oil, Light Sweet (NYM)-1,000 bbls.; $ per bbl.							
Nov	95.19	98.32		93.58	**97.97**	2.88	113,474
Dec	94.04	96.74	▲	92.46	**96.50**	2.60	302,291
Jan'27	92.90	95.09	▲	91.54	**94.89**	2.06	141,953
June	86.34	86.88		85.55	**86.52**	0.12	124,797
Dec	79.64	79.70		78.73	**79.10**	-0.56	181,613
Dec'28	72.35	72.35		71.31	**71.61**	-0.66	117,036
NY Harbor ULSD (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.							
Nov	4.9123	4.9336		4.7662	**4.8456**	-.0818	49,215
Dec	4.7585	4.7585		4.5952	**4.6545**	-.0963	62,999
Gasoline-NY RBOB (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.							
Nov	3.2649	3.2650		3.1619	**3.1802**	-.0793	64,026
Dec	3.1490	3.1507		3.0615	**3.0798**	-.0622	88,759
Natural Gas (NYM)-10,000 MMBtu.; $ per MMBtu.							
Nov	3.274	3.323		3.195	**3.236**	.038	167,092
Dec	3.589	3.622		3.501	**3.533**	-.026	235,944
Jan'27	3.993	4.016		3.902	**3.920**	-.053	239,884
Feb	3.606	3.617		3.517	**3.530**	-.058	118,601
March	2.802	2.811		2.728	**2.736**	-.061	227,929
April	2.702	2.702		2.632	**2.640**	-.054	154,305

Agriculture Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Corn (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
Dec	481.50	482.75		477.50	**478.00**	-2.75	843,697
March'27	495.25	496.25		490.75	**491.00**	-3.25	428,278
Oats (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
Dec	397.00	404.50		393.25	**396.00**	-1.50	3,378
March'27	404.00	412.00		401.00	**402.75**	-2.00	601
Soybeans (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
Nov	1277.00	1277.25		1262.25	**1263.00**	-14.25	301,636
Jan'27	1292.00	1292.00		1277.25	**1277.75**	-14.25	278,885
Soybean Meal (CBT)-100 tons; $ per ton.							
Dec	364.50	368.80		359.30	**359.80**	-4.70	258,355
Jan'27	361.80	365.50		357.20	**357.70**	-4.10	156,110
Soybean Oil (CBT)-60,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Dec	67.14	67.82		66.30	**67.15**	.09	225,588
Jan'27	67.35	67.96		66.54	**67.31**	.03	124,070
Rough Rice (CBT)-2,000 cwt.; $ per cwt.							
Nov	17.24	17.36	▲	17.13	**17.26**	-.01	10,137
Jan'27	17.68	17.82	▲	17.58	**17.70**	-.02	3,696
Wheat (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
Dec	673.75	681.00		667.25	**670.00**	-3.25	252,366
March'27	688.00	694.75		681.25	**684.25**	-2.25	125,669
Wheat (KC)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
Dec	715.00	723.50		709.00	**713.00**	-2.00	147,700
March'27	727.00	735.00		721.00	**724.75**	-2.00	88,111
Cattle-Feeder (CME)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Oct	341.250	343.800		340.600	**343.375**	2.425	5,612
Jan'27	333.600	338.275		333.600	**337.900**	4.300	21,820
Cattle-Live (CME)-40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Oct	223.925	226.400		223.875	**225.950**	2.050	10,168
Dec	224.950	227.900		224.950	**227.250**	2.125	114,397
Hogs-Lean (CME)-40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Dec	66.000	66.675	▼	65.800	**66.575**	.500	150,786
Feb'27	67.625	68.500	▼	67.375	**68.450**	.600	69,436
Lumber (CME)-27,500 bd. ft., $ per 1,000 bd. ft.							
Nov	533.50	539.50		529.50	**536.50**	3.50	8,240
Jan'27	550.00	551.50		544.50	**548.00**	-1.00	2,290
Milk (CME)-200,000 lbs., cents per lb.							
Oct	15.06	15.33		15.03	**15.20**	.15	5,092
Nov	17.04	17.50		16.97	**17.25**	.38	8,033
Cocoa (ICE-US)-10 metric tons; $ per ton.							
Dec	5,871	5,993		5,749	**5,831**	96	64,696
March'27	5,983	6,105		5,852	**5,927**	71	48,990
Coffee (ICE-US)-37,500 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Dec	296.65	298.85		291.95	**294.80**	-3.25	75,838
March'27	288.85	290.10		283.50	**285.35**	-4.80	51,114
Sugar-World (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
March	20.80	21.22		20.60	**21.13**	.29	654,982
May	19.95	20.35		19.81	**20.32**	.27	186,349
Sugar-Domestic (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Jan	42.00	42.00	▲	42.00	**42.00**	.05	1,580
March	42.00	42.00	▲	42.00	**42.00**	...	1,760
Cotton (ICE-US)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Dec	80.66	80.77		79.70	**80.06**	-.60	169,899
March'27	83.98	84.13		83.00	**83.42**	-.58	98,144
Orange Juice (ICE-US)-15,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Nov	142.05	143.85		138.85	**139.65**	-2.80	5,295
Jan'27	146.50	147.95		143.00	**143.75**	-2.85	4,123

Interest Rate Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Ultra Treasury Bonds (CBT) - $100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
Dec	105-170	108-020		105-170	**107-050**	1-19.0	2,408,067
March'27	106-010	107-040		106-010	**106-300**	1-19.0	55
Treasury Bonds (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
Dec	104-040	106-070		104-040	**105-140**	1-08.0	1,826,344
March'27	104-050	105-230		104-050	**104-310**	1-08.0	2,954
Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
Dec	104-290	105-290		104-275	**105-170**	21.0	5,781,282
March'27	104-260	105-195		104-260	**105-100**	21.0	6,755
5 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
Dec	103-227	104-120		103-220	**104-030**	12.2	6,810,420
March'27	103-235	104-057		103-235	**103-300**	14.2	3,613
2 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$200,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
Dec	101-262	102-022		101-261	**101-301**	3.4	4,593,028
March'27	101-244	101-285		101-244	**101-249**	3.9	700
30 Day Federal Funds (CBT)-$5,000,000; 100 - daily avg.							
Oct	96.1125	96.1150		96.1100	**96.1125**	.0025	737,640
Nov	96.0400	96.0600		96.0100	**96.0500**	.0150	707,876
Three-Month SOFR (CME)-$1,000,000; 100 - daily avg.							
July	96.2625	96.2625	▲	96.2625	**96.2625**	.0025	20,743
Dec'27	95.2500	95.4150	▼	95.2450	**95.3150**	.0650	1,679,500

Currency Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Japanese Yen (CME)-¥12,500,000; $ per 100¥							
Oct	.6320	.6346		.6320	**.6325**	...	663
Dec	.6347	.6378		.6346	**.6353**	...	371,901
Canadian Dollar (CME)-CAD 100,000; $ per CAD							
Oct	.7024	.7050		.7024	**.7049**	.0028	381
Dec	.7046	.7079		.7045	**.7069**	.0028	380,004
British Pound (CME)-£62,500; $ per £							
Oct	1.3232	1.3271		1.3225	**1.3271**	.0090	432
Dec	1.3195	1.3281		1.3194	**1.3274**	.0090	274,224
Swiss Franc (CME)-CHF 125,000; $ per CHF							
Dec	1.2066	1.2183		1.2058	**1.2173**	.0103	136,247
March'27	1.2212	1.2310		1.2212	**1.2311**	.0104	418
Australian Dollar (CME)-AUD 100,000; $ per AUD							
Oct	.6975	.6975	▼	.6911	**.6918**	-.0048	240
Dec	.6967	.6974		.6869	**.6912**	-.0048	339,920
Mexican Peso (CME)-MXN 500,000; $ per MXN							
Oct	.05468	.05468		.05468	**.05431**	.00031	190
Dec	.05383	.05424		.05359	**.05409**	.00031	276,553
Euro (CME)-€125,000; $ per €							
Oct	1.1166	1.1241		1.1166	**1.1212**	.0056	2,448
Dec	1.1184	1.1268		1.1182	**1.1239**	.0056	834,540

Index Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Mini DJ Industrial Average (CBT)-$5 x index							
Dec	51859	52503		51783	**52430**	572	89,688
March'27	52349	52933		52320	**52908**	571	125
Mini S&P 500 (CME)-$50 x index							
Dec	7768.25	7801.75		7717.25	**7791.00**	20.75	1,920,481
March'27	7845.00	7879.00		7792.75	**7868.50**	20.25	14,820
Mini S&P Midcap 400 (CME)-$100 x index							
Dec	3626.20	3669.20		3611.80	**3666.60**	37.40	44,880
March'27	...	...		...	**3694.50**	37.90	n.a.
Mini Nasdaq 100 (CME)-$20 x index							
Dec	30154.75	30196.75		29622.50	**30143.75**	-39.00	281,712
March'27	30489.25	30530.00		29975.75	**30489.50**	-45.00	718
Mini Russell 2000 (CME)-$50 x index							
Dec	2745.00	2785.10		2736.60	**2781.80**	36.80	454,246
March'27	2770.30	2808.60		2765.20	**2806.60**	36.90	2,014
Mini Russell 1000 (CME)-$50 x index							
Dec	4200.20	4237.00		4200.20	**4237.00**	18.80	7,451
U.S. Dollar Index (ICE-US)-$1,000 x index							
Dec	102.03	102.09		101.68	**101.87**	-.48	51,439
March'27	101.57	101.61		101.44	**101.56**	-.48	200

Source: FactSet

Cash Prices

Thursday, October 15, 2026

These prices reflect buying and selling of a variety of actual or "physical" commodities in the marketplace—separate from the futures price on an exchange, which reflects what the commodity might be worth in future months.

	Thursday
Energy	
Coal,C.Aplc.,12500Btu,1.2SO2-r,w	**84.500**
Coal,PwdrRvrBsn,8800Btu,0.8SO2-r,w	**14.650**
Metals	
Gold, per troy oz	
Engelhard industrial	**4161.00**
Krugerrand,wholesale-e	**4323.70**
Maple Leaf-e	**4365.27**
American Eagle-e	**4365.27**
Mexican peso-e	**5020.58**
Austria crown-e	**4078.08**
Austria phil-e	**4365.27**
Silver, troy oz.	
Engelhard industrial	**57.0500**
Handy & Harman base	**57.0450**
Handy & Harman fabricated	**71.3060**
Coins,wholesale $1,000 face-a	**40684**
Other metals	
Platinum,Engelhard industrial	**1630.0**
Palladium,Engelhard industrial	**1140.0**
Aluminum, LME, $ per metric ton	***3010.0**
Copper,Comex spot	**6.5115**
Iron Ore, 62% Fe CFR China-s	***90.3**
Steel, HRC USA, FOB Midwest Mill-s	***1300.0**
Battery/EV metals	
BMI Lithium Carbonate, EXW China, >=99.5%-v,w	**17425**
BMI Lithium Hydroxide, EXW China, >=56.5% -v,w	**16400**
BMI Cobalt sulphate, EXW China, >20.5% -v,w	**8419**
BMI Nickel Sulphate, EXW China, >22%-v,k	**4172**
BMI Flake Graphite, FOB China, -100 Mesh, 94-95% -v,m	**415**
Fibers and Textiles	
Burlap,10-oz,40-inch NY yd-n,w	**1.2400**
Cotton,11/16 std lw-mdMphs-u	**0.7781**
Cotlook 'A' Index-t	***91.25**
Hides,hvy native steers piece fob-u	**n.a.**
Wool,64s,staple,Terr del-u,w	**n.a.**
Grains and Feeds	
Bran,wheat middlings, KC-u,w	**155**
Corn,No. 2 yellow,Cent IL-bp,u	**4.4500**
Cottonseed meal-u,w	**n.a.**
Hominy feed,Cent IL-u,w	**n.a.**
Meat-bonemeal,50% pro Mnpls-u,w	**463**
Oats,No.2 milling,Mnpls-u	**4.2600**
Rice, Long Grain Milled, No. 2 AR-u,w	**34.50**
SoybeanMeal,Cent IL,rail,ton48%-u,w	**387.60**
Soybeans,No.1 yllw IL-bp,u	**12.2800**
Wheat,Spring14%-pro Mnpls-u	**8.8600**
Wheat,No.2 soft red,St.Louis-u	**6.5250**
Wheat - Hard - KC (USDA) $ per bu-u	**6.7900**
Wheat,No.1soft white,Portld,OR-u	**6.5750**
Food	
Beef,carcass equiv. index	
choice 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	**343.82**
select 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	**322.88**
Broilers, National comp wtd. avg.-u,w	**1.1674**
Butter,AA Chicago-d	**1.3450**
Cheddar cheese,bbl,Chicago-d	**157.00**
Cheddar cheese,blk,Chicago-d	**165.25**
Milk,Nonfat dry,Chicago lb.-d	**215.00**
Coffee,Brazilian,Comp-y	**2.9912**
Coffee,Colombian, NY-y	**3.6138**
Eggs,large white,Chicago-u,w	**0.6350**
Flour,hard winter KC-p	**18.50**
Hams,17-20 lbs,Mid-US fob-u	**n.a.**
Hogs,Iowa-So. Minnesota-u	**73.92**
Pork bellies,12-14 lb MidUS-u	**1.0664**
Pork loins,13-19 lb MidUS-u	**1.0061**
Steers,Tex.-Okla. Choice-u	**n.a.**
Steers,feeder,Okla. City-u,w	**379.75**
Fats and Oils	
Degummed corn oil, crude wtd. avg.-u,w	**n.a.**
Grease,choice white,Chicago-h	**0.5900**
Lard,Chicago-u	**n.a.**
Soybean oil,crude;Centl IL-u,w	**0.7052**
Tallow,bleach;Chicago-h	**0.6900**
Tallow,edible,Chicago-u	**n.a.**

KEY TO CODES: A=ask; B=bid; BP=country elevator bids to producers; C=corrected; D=CME; E=Manfra,Tordella & Brookes; H=American Commodities Brokerage Co; K=bi-weekly; M=monthly; N=nominal; n.a.=not quoted or not available; P=Sosland Publishing; R=SNL Energy; S=Platts-TSI; T=Cotlook Limited; U=USDA; V=Benchmark Mineral Intelligence; W=weekly; Y=International Coffee Organization; Z=not quoted. *Data as of 10/14

Source: Dow Jones Market Data

Bonds | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Tracking Bond Benchmarks

Return on investment and spreads over Treasurys and/or yields paid to investors compared with 52-week highs and lows for different types of bonds

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%) Latest	Low	High
Broad Market Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2210.06	**-1.7**	U.S. Aggregate	**5.410**	4.160	5.570
U.S. Corporate Indexes Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
3380.68	**-1.8**	U.S. Corporate	**5.900**	4.680	6.050
3355.65	**-0.7**	Intermediate	**5.670**	4.330	5.810
4256.43	**-4.2**	Long term	**6.420**	5.370	6.630
625.63	**-3.2**	Double-A-rated	**5.740**	4.410	5.900
929.27	**-1.5**	Triple-B-rated	**6.090**	4.860	6.220
High Yield Bonds ICE BofA					
618.22	**0.1**	High Yield Constrained	**8.228**	6.489	8.350
602.19	**-4.2**	Triple-C-rated	**16.817**	11.651	16.921
4108.25	**-0.3**	High Yield 100	**7.538**	5.828	7.655
538.85	**0.4**	Global High Yield Constrained	**7.947**	6.317	8.014
392.56	**-0.7**	Europe High Yield Constrained	**6.633**	4.820	6.633
U.S Agency Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
1949.35	**-0.5**	U.S Agency	**5.110**	3.830	5.220
1734.33	**-0.1**	10-20 years	**5.050**	3.750	5.170
3548.84	**-4.3**	20-plus years	**5.710**	4.580	5.930
3003.73	**-1.1**	Yankee	**5.560**	4.320	5.710

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%) Latest	Low	High
Mortgage-Backed Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2207.63	**-1.7**	Mortgage-Backed	**5.720**	4.380	5.970
2168.58	**-1.6**	Ginnie Mae (GNMA)	**5.790**	4.420	6.030
1304.65	**-1.8**	Fannie mae (FNMA)	**5.700**	4.370	5.950
2011.71	**-1.8**	Freddie Mac (FHLMC)	**5.490**	4.160	5.810
604.95	**-2.1**	Muni Master	**4.195**	3.037	4.628
431.02	**-2.6**	7-12 year	**3.953**	2.596	4.475
483.09	**-3.3**	12-22 year	**4.838**	3.608	5.157
453.57	**-2.8**	22-plus year	**5.289**	4.432	5.515
Global Government J.P. Morgan†					
547.99	**-2.0**	Global Government	**4.554**	3.500	4.694
842.91	**0.2**	Canada	**3.818**	3.070	3.963
357.14	**-2.2**	EMU§	**4.075**	3.117	4.230
631.91	**-4.0**	France	**4.678**	3.350	4.823
459.54	**-1.0**	Germany	**3.484**	2.650	3.684
243.61	**-3.8**	Japan	**3.197**	2.120	3.327
502.43	**-0.8**	Netherlands	**3.567**	2.860	3.778
805.45	**-1.9**	U.K.	**5.475**	4.560	5.607
1017.70	**0.1**	Emerging Markets**	**6.987**	6.403	7.205

*Constrained indexes limit individual issuer concentrations to 2%; the High Yield 100 are the 100 largest bonds † In local currency § Euro-zone bonds

** EMBI Global Index

Sources: ICE Data Services; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; J.P.Morgan

Global Government Bonds: Mapping Yields

Yields and spreads over or under U.S. Treasurys on benchmark two-year and 10-year government bonds in selected other countries; arrows indicate whether the yield rose(▲) or fell(▼) in the latest session

Coupon (%)	Country/ Maturity, in years	Latest	Yield (%) 0 1 2 3 4 5 6	Previous	Month ago	Year ago	Spread Under/Over U.S. Treasurys, in basis points Latest	Prev	Year ago
4.750	**U.S.** 2	**4.747** ▼		4.800	4.661	3.503			
4.625	10	**5.086** ▼		5.189	4.995	4.045			
2.250	**Australia** 2	**4.855** ▼		4.937	5.064	3.443	**10.0**	12.9	**-6.7**
4.250	10	**5.230** ▼		5.324	5.426	4.228	**14.2**	13.8	**19.5**
2.400	**France** 2	**3.572** ▼		3.610	3.477	2.139	**-118**	-119.8	**-137.1**
3.700	10	**4.792** ▼		4.884	4.505	3.335	**-29.7**	-30.2	**-69.9**
3.000	**Germany** 2	**3.110** ▼		3.151	3.273	1.926	**-164.5**	-165.7	**-158.4**
3.000	10	**3.423** ▼		3.481	3.545	2.575	**-166.5**	-170.5	**-145.8**
2.650	**Italy** 2	**3.420** ▼		3.457	3.458	2.114	**-138.**	-135.1	**-139.6**
3.800	10	**4.478** ▼		4.560	4.417	3.345	**-61.1**	-62.6	**-68.8**
2.000	**Japan** 2	**1.912** ▼		1.928	1.860	0.906	**-284.3**	-288.0	**-260.4**
3.100	10	**2.928** ▼		3.002	3.042	1.656	**-216.0**	-218.4	**-237.7**
2.400	**Spain** 2	**3.231** ▼		3.281	3.287	1.990	**-152.4**	-152.7	**-152.0**
3.400	10	**4.006** ▼		4.104	4.026	3.098	**-108**	-108.2	**-93.5**
4.375	**U.K.** 2	**4.759** ▼		4.763	4.764	3.907	**0.4**	-4.5	**39.7**
1.125	10	**5.381** ▼		5.429	5.326	4.551	**29.3**	24.3	**51.8**

Source: Tullett Prebon, Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close

Corporate Debt

Prices of firms' bonds reflect factors including investors' economic, sectoral and company-specific expectations

Investment-grade spreads that tightened the most...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Spread*, in basis points Current	One-day change	Last week
Pacific LifeCorp	...	6.600	**5.86**	Sept. 15, '33	**76**	-8	84
Goldman Sachs	GS	6.125	**5.49**	Feb. 15, '33	**41**	-7	43
Enel Finance International	...	4.625	**5.50**	July 13, '29	**67**	-6	68
Comcast	CMCSA	6.450	**6.54**	March 15, '37	**145**	-5	n.a.
Morgan Stanley	MS	4.300	**6.26**	Jan. 27, '45	**79**	-5	78
Banco Santander	...	6.921	**6.24**	Aug. 8, '33	**115**	-5	112
Verizon Communications	VZ	4.500	**5.88**	Aug. 10, '33	**80**	-5	69
Reynolds American	...	7.250	**6.17**	June 15, '37	**109**	-4	108

...And spreads that widened the most

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
ING Groep	...	4.050	**5.39**	April 9, '29	**56**	9	n.a.
Telefonica Emisiones*	...	5.213	**6.87**	March 8, '47	**139**	9	125
Principal Financial	PFG	6.050	**5.91**	Oct. 15, '36	**82**	6	87
American Airlines	AAL	5.750	**6.36**	May 10, '35	**147**	5	140
National Australia Bank	...	2.990	**5.90**	May 21, '31	**101**	5	n.a.
Ally Financial	ALLY	8.000	**6.28**	Nov. 1, '31	**136**	4	128
Duke Energy Indiana	...	6.350	**6.00**	Aug. 15, '38	**91**	4	88
LYB International Finance	...	5.250	**6.88**	July 15, '43	**140**	4	130

High-yield issues with the biggest price increases...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Bond Price as % of face value Current	One-day change	Last week
Occidental Petroleum	OXY	6.200	**6.32**	March 15, '40	**98.958**	1.25	97.797
Bath & Body Works	BBWI	6.875	**7.06**	Nov. 1, '35	**98.801**	1.18	96.875
Navient	NAVI	5.625	**9.03**	Aug. 1, '33	**82.980**	1.00	81.749
ADT Security	...	4.875	**6.55**	July 15, '32	**92.093**	0.64	91.250
DISH DBS	...	5.125	**9.05**	June 1, '29	**91.000**	0.50	90.625
Paramount Global	...	7.875	**10.39**	July 30, '30	**92.250**	0.50	95.250
AAdvantage Loyalty IP	...	5.750	**6.16**	April 20, '29	**99.058**	0.43	99.305
Sealed Air*	...	6.875	**7.49**	July 15, '33	**96.750**	0.39	96.061

...And with the biggest price decreases

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
Lumen Technologies	LUMN	7.600	**10.30**	Sept. 15, '39	**80.930**	-0.81	85.921
Verde Purchaser	...	10.500	**8.97**	Nov. 30, '30	**102.875**	-0.45	104.145
Paramount Global	...	5.500	**11.86**	May 15, '33	**71.500**	-0.25	75.989
Bausch Health	...	11.000	**9.00**	Sept. 30, '28	**103.500**	-0.18	103.642

*Estimated spread over 2-year, 3-year, 5-year, 10-year or 30-year hot-run Treasury; 100 basis points=one percentage pt.; change in spread shown is for Z-spread.

Note: Data are for the most active issue of bonds with maturities of two years or more

Source: MarketAxess

Macro & Market Economics

Watching the Gauges: U.S. Supply and Demand

Inventories, imports and demand for the week ended October 9. Current figures are in thousands of barrels or thousands of gallons per day, except natural-gas figures, which are in billions of cubic feet. Natural-gas import and demand data are available monthly only.

Inventories, 000s barrels

	Current	Expected change	Previous week	Year ago	4-week avg	5-year avg
Crude oil and petroleum prod	1,224,016	...	1,237	1,289	1,239	1,253
Crude oil excluding SPR	415,577	100	424	424	423	428
Gasoline	208,262	...	205	219	206	215
Finished gasoline	14,711	-900	14	16	14	16
Reformulated	27	...	0	0	0	0
Conventional	14,684	...	14	16	14	16
Blend. components	193,550	...	191	203	192	200
Natural gas (bcf)	3,567	...	4	4	3	4
Kerosene-type jet fuel	42,795	...	43	44	44	41
Distillates	102,611	-1,500	105	117	105	115
Heating oil	6,515	...	7	7	7	8
Diesel	96,097	...	98	110	98	54
Residual fuel oil	24,167	...	24	21	24	27
Other oils	300,286	...	305	338	306	312
Net crude, petroleum products, incl. SPR	1,506,999	...	1,520	1,697	1,523	1,685

Imports, 000s barrels per day

	Current	Expected change	Previous week	Year ago	4-week avg	5-year avg
Crude oil and petroleum prod	7,571	...	8,303	7,217	7,610	7,940
Crude oil excluding SPR	6,049	...	6,840	5,525	6,116	6,159
Gasoline	508	...	512	532	480	564
Finished gasoline	83	...	205	108	121	65
Reformulated	0	...	0	0	0	0
Conventional	83	...	205	108	121	65
Blend. components	424	...	306	425	359	499
Natural gas (bcf)	...	...	...	...	...	...
Kerosene-type jet fuel	92	...	1	143	53	198
Distillates	145	...	118	160	125	152
Heating oil	0	...	0	0	0	1
Diesel	144	...	118	160	125	151
Residual fuel oil	161	...	271	164	177	161
Other oils	523	...	485	605	575	601
Net crude, petroleum products, incl. SPR	-4,373	...	-4,535	-4,249	-4,140	-2,514

Weekly Demand, 000s barrels per day

	Current	Expected change	Previous week	Year ago	4-week avg	5-year avg
Total petroleum product	21,361	...	20,396	19,726	21,077	20,157
Finished motor gasoline	8,408	...	8,769	8,455	8,678	8,882
Kerosene-type jet fuel	1,625	...	1,696	1,691	1,695	1,630
Distillates	4,323	...	3,650	4,233	3,974	3,959
Residual fuel oil	184	...	306	220	265	241
Propane/propylene	1,209	...	773	495	958	...
Other oils	5,613	...	5,202	4,632	5,507	...

Note: Expected changes are provided by Dow Jones Newswires' survey of analysts. Previous and average inventory data are in millions.

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data; U.S. Energy Information Administration; Dow Jones Newswires

Natural gas storage

Billions of cubic feet; weekly totals

BIGGEST 1,000 STOCKS

How to Read the Stock Tables

The following explanations apply to NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE American, Nasdaq Stock Market, Cboe BZX and Texas Stock Exchange listed securities. Prices are consolidated from trades reported by various market centers, including securities exchanges, Finra, electronic communications networks and other broker-dealers. The list comprises the 1,000 largest companies based on market capitalization.

Underlined quotations are those stocks with large changes in volume compared with the issue's average trading volume.

Boldfaced quotations highlight those issues whose price changed by 5% or more if their previous close was $2 or higher.

Footnotes:
ı-New 52-week high; !-New 52-week low; **dd**-Indicates loss in the most recent four quarters.

Stock tables reflect composite regular trading as of 4 p.m. ET and changes in the official closing prices from 4 p.m. ET the previous day.

Thursday, October 15, 2026

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
A B C			
AES	**AES**	14.97	0.01
Aflac	**AFL**	118.05	-0.16
AGNC Invt	**AGNC**	8.82	0.21
APA	**APA**	47.23	-0.14
ASE Tech	**ASX**	**41.89**	**-2.44**
ASML	**ASML**	1657.44	7.44
! **AST Space**	**ASTS**	**44.46**	**2.32**
AT&T	**T**	23.50	0.45
ATI	**ATI**	189.31	1.47
AbbottLabs	**ABT**	104.68	2.34
ı AbbVie	**ABBV**	283.40	1.65
Accenture	**ACN**	224.92	9.96
Acuity	**AYI**	301.87	5.00
Adobe	**ADBE**	251.67	10.99
AdvDrainageSys	**WMS**	128.49	3.30
AdvEnergyInds	**AEIS**	252.08	-8.69
AdvMicroDevices	**AMD**	562.23	-8.59
Aegon	**AEG**	8.27	0.03
AerCap	**AER**	145.92	1.63
AffiliatedMgrs	**AMG**	383.04	10.87
AffirmA	**AFRM**	**75.92**	**5.41**
AgilentTechs A		175.55	1.55
AgnicoEagleMines	**AEM**	**187.56**	**10.55**
AirProducts	**APD**	296.60	4.07
Airbnb	**ABNB**	174.28	7.22
AkamaiTech	**AKAM**	92.32	0.61
AlamosGold	**AGI**	31.98	1.37
Albemarle	**ALB**	98.18	0.21
Alcoa	**AA**	40.42	0.34
Alcon	**ALC**	66.58	2.71
Alibaba	**BABA**	111.13	-0.04
AlignTech	**ALGN**	149.34	4.90
Allegion	**ALLE**	155.75	3.25
AlliantEnergy	**LNT**	67.10	-0.41
AllisonTransm	**ALSN**	112.55	1.85
Allstate	**ALL**	239.60	3.43
AllyFinancial	**ALLY**	37.73	0.99
AlnylamPharm	**ALNY**	234.03	9.56
Alphabet C	**GOOG**	344.91	1.26
Alphabet A	**GOOGL**	349.22	1.58
Altria	**MO**	73.84	0.71
Amazon.com	**AMZN**	254.76	0.68
Ambev	**ABEV**	3.26	0.01
Amcor	**AMCR**	43.74	1.46
AmerSports	**AS**	29.94	1.12
Ameren	**AEE**	103.76	-0.82
AmericaMovil	**AMX**	22.43	0.59
AEP	**AEP**	124.29	-1.84
AmerExpress	**AXP**	313.87	6.92
AmericanFin	**AFG**	145.73	1.07
AmerHlthcrREIT	**AHR**	53.01	0.59
AmHomes4Rent	**AMH**	30.97	0.33
AIG	**AIG**	79.12	1.69
AmerTowerREIT	**AMT**	181.36	1.96
AmerWaterWorks	**AWK**	133.04	1.33
Ameriprise	**AMP**	502.58	6.76
Ametek	**AME**	248.52	1.69
Amgen	**AMGN**	434.03	7.92
AmkorTech	**AMKR**	44.05	-0.77
Amphenol	**APH**	81.49	-1.20
Amrize	**AMRZ**	37.32	1.03
AnalogDevices	**ADI**	403.95	0.38
AngloGoldAsh	**AU**	91.57	2.73
AB InBev	**BUD**	81.28	1.78
AnnalyCap	**NLY**	18.43	0.27
AnteroMidstream	**AM**	19.92	-0.84
AnteroResources	**AR**	36.44	-0.19
Aon	**AON**	286.80	11.45
APi Group	**APG**	40.33	0.31
ApolloGlbMgmt	**APO**	111.87	-1.52
Apple	**AAPL**	342.00	-0.96
AppliedIndlTech	**AIT**	333.83	-1.17
AppliMaterials	**AMAT**	430.01	-16.62
! **AppLovin**	**APP**	**279.29**	**17.10**
Aptiv	**APTV**	45.19	1.36
Aramark	**ARMK**	55.04	0.29
ArcelorMittal	**MT**	63.60	1.11
ArchCapital	**ACGL**	99.31	1.71
ADM	**ADM**	82.93	-0.71
AresMgmt	**ARES**	114.03	1.54
argenx	**ARGX**	846.27	27.97
AristaNetworks	**ANET**	**185.58**	**-9.84**
Arm	**ARM**	244.79	6.78
ArrowElec	**ARW**	220.17	-4.09
Arxis	**ARXS**	**53.81**	**2.59**
AscendisPharma	**ASND**	226.62	-0.38
Assurant	**AIZ**	281.87	5.54
AsteraLabs	**ALAB**	301.98	1.70
AstraZeneca	**AZN**	166.68	4.65
ı **Atlassian**	**TEAM**	**217.12**	**12.46**
AtmosEnergy	**ATO**	163.95	0.01
AuroraInnov	**AUR**	**5.40**	**0.35**
Autodesk	**ADSK**	**245.16**	**14.02**
ı ADP	**ADP**	285.65	5.33
AutoZone	**AZO**	**3859.62**	**148.00**
Avantor	**AVTR**	16.09	0.39
AveryDennison	**AVY**	175.88	4.04
AxonEnterprise	**AXON**	417.19	8.77

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
BCE	**BCE**	20.18	0.51
BHP Group	**BHP**	82.90	-0.36
ı BJ's Wholesale	**BJ**	103.27	-0.12
ı BP	**BP**	48.44	-0.37
! BWX Tech	**BWXT**	137.20	2.76
BXP	**BXP**	59.69	1.99
! Baidu	**BIDU**	82.56	0.70
BakerHughes	**BKR**	54.40	-0.97
Ball	**BALL**	62.80	2.37
BBVA	**BBVA**	25.95	0.19
BancoBradesco	**BBDO**	3.59	-0.02
BancodeChile	**BCH**	39.10	0.06
BancSanBrasil	**BSBR**	5.59	...
BcoSantChile	**BSAC**	32.82	0.63
BancoSantander	**SAN**	13.46	0.05
BankofAmerica	**BAC**	51.70	0.31
BankMontreal	**BMO**	166.05	2.43
BankNY Mellon	**BNY**	142.09	4.45
BankNovaScotia	**BNS**	91.12	1.07
Barclays	**BCS**	22.81	0.07
BarrickMining	**B**	40.55	1.66
BaxterIntl	**BAX**	25.76	0.96
BectonDicknsn	**BDX**	193.76	4.87
ı BendingSpoons	**BSP**	55.77	2.31
BentleySystems	**BSY**	36.23	1.14
BeOneMed	**ONC**	**374.08**	**22.60**
Berkley	**WRB**	73.97	0.17
BerkHathaway A	**BRK.A**	789485	-99.02
BerkHathaway B	**BRK.B**	525.68	-0.67
BestBuy	**BBY**	**94.17**	**5.07**
Bio-Techne	**TECH**	72.52	0.02
Bio-RadLab A	**BIO**	364.82	2.39
ı Biogen	**BIIB**	235.35	2.52
BioMarinPharm	**BMRN**	56.05	0.91
BioNTech	**BNTX**	90.20	1.54
BitMineImmersion	**BMNR**	23.36	1.11
BlackRock	**BLK**	1120.78	46.99
Blackstone	**BX**	109.20	2.99
Block	**XYZ**	**79.83**	**3.98**
BloomEnergy	**BE**	236.30	-3.04
BlueOwlCapital	**OWL**	8.97	0.18
Boeing	**BA**	188.73	4.07
Booking	**BKNG**	165.80	5.12
BorgWarner	**BWA**	58.67	0.17
BostonSci	**BSX**	44.14	1.14
BridgeBioPharma	**BBIO**	67.13	2.19
BrightSpring	**BTSG**	62.36	-0.99
BristolMyers	**BMY**	60.57	1.29
BritishAmTob	**BTI**	58.00	1.34
Broadcom	**AVGO**	344.33	-1.92
BroadridgeFinl	**BR**	174.11	5.85
BrookfieldAsset	**BAM**	45.98	1.37
Brookfield	**BN**	36.81	0.86
BrookfieldInfr	**BIP**	37.27	0.92
BrookfWealth	**BNT**	36.78	0.94
Brown&Brown	**BRO**	67.98	3.18
Brown-Forman B	**BF.B**	28.58	0.29
Brown-Forman A	**BF.A**	29.13	0.28
Bullish	**BLSH**	31.87	1.48
BungeGlobal	**BG**	107.01	-1.90
BurlingtonStrs	**BURL**	267.79	4.53
CACI Intl	**CACI**	611.36	7.35
CBRE Group	**CBRE**	**135.49**	**6.62**
CDW	**CDW**	154.33	4.23
CF Industries	**CF**	119.77	0.31
CGI A	**GIB**	74.87	2.52
CH Robinson	**CHRW**	143.82	4.37
CME Group	**CME**	289.46	3.87
CMS Energy	**CMS**	66.94	0.12
CNA Fin	**CNA**	49.24	-0.68
CNH Indl	**CNH**	11.95	-0.03
CRH	**CRH**	82.32	3.12
CSX	**CSX**	48.69	0.41
CVS Health	**CVS**	92.58	2.19
CadenceDesign	**CDNS**	324.38	-5.08
CamdenProperty	**CPT**	98.19	0.95
Cameco	**CCJ**	83.23	1.76
CIBC	**CM**	112.26	1.81
CanNtlRlwy	**CNI**	120.74	0.89
CanadianNatRscs	**CNQ**	51.95	0.13
CdnPacKC	**CP**	86.91	0.79
CapitalOne	**COF**	198.86	4.51
CardinalHealth	**CAH**	253.71	5.97
Carlisle	**CSL**	335.49	9.00
Carlyle	**CG**	36.81	1.04
Carnival	**CCL**	26.46	0.49
CarpenterTech	**CRS**	380.56	0.83
CarrierGlobal	**CARR**	54.96	0.72
Carvana	**CVNA**	60.62	2.66
CaseysGenStores	**CASY**	673.63	20.02
Caterpillar	**CAT**	735.64	-13.34
CboeGlobalMkts	**CBOE**	308.09	7.62
Celestica	**CLS**	315.25	-8.07
Cemex	**CX**	**10.06**	**0.54**
Cencora	**COR**	341.41	5.24
CenovusEnergy	**CVE**	31.97	-0.65
ı Centene	**CNC**	70.51	0.35
CenterPointEner	**CNP**	39.80	0.12
! CerebrasSystems	**CBRS**	142.17	6.69
CharlesRiverLabs	**CRL**	306.24	4.24
CharterComms	**CHTR**	109.99	4.85
CheckPoint	**CHKP**	138.10	4.02

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
CheniereEnergy	**LNG**	279.15	-0.54
CheniereEnerPtrs	**CQP**	62.25	-0.01
ı Chevron	**CVX**	219.32	-2.72
ChimeFinl	**CHYM**	29.96	0.96
Chipotle	**CMG**	30.58	0.06
Chubb	**CB**	352.79	2.64
ı ChunghwaTel	**CHT**	47.66	1.15
Church&Dwight	**CHD**	103.08	0.45
Ciena	**CIEN**	356.52	-3.08
Cigna	**CI**	298.81	9.23
CincinnatiFinl	**CINF**	167.22	0.55
Cintas	**CTAS**	213.06	4.43
CircleInternet	**CRCL**	**86.97**	**7.42**
CiscoSystems	**CSCO**	109.85	-3.79
Citigroup	**C**	123.21	0.94
CitizensFin	**CFG**	63.43	0.86
CleanHarbors	**CLH**	319.78	0.54
Clorox	**CLX**	86.20	1.23
Cloudflare	**NET**	316.32	-8.01
ı Coca-Cola	**KO**	92.00	0.22
Coca-ColaCon	**COKE**	204.55	4.55
CocaColaEuropac	**CCEP**	109.77	2.55
CoeurMining	**CDE**	15.41	0.43
Cognex	**CGNX**	55.67	-1.60
CognizantTech	**CTSH**	**65.77**	**3.30**
Coherent	**COHR**	250.60	-12.72
CoinbaseGlbl	**COIN**	**183.81**	**10.92**
ColgatePalm	**CL**	92.67	-0.11
Comcast A	**CMCSA**	21.77	0.72
ComfortSystems	**FIX**	1481.27	-60.41
SABESP	**SBS**	6.26	-0.16
COPEL	**ELPC**	13.68	-0.21
ı ConocoPhillips	**COP**	141.73	-0.61
ConEd	**ED**	109.86	0.26
ConstBrands A	**STZ**	129.58	2.17
ConstellationEner	**CEG**	275.00	-4.54
Cooper	**COO**	57.40	2.52
Copart	**CPRT**	**27.75**	**1.48**
CorceptTherap	**CORT**	113.37	-2.86
CorebridgeFin	**CRBG**	34.43	0.48
CoreWeave	**CRWV**	**69.69**	**3.91**
Corning	**GLW**	138.43	-2.46
Corpay	**CPAY**	400.30	13.57
Cortera	**CTVA**	12.88	-0.52
CoStar	**CSGP**	**32.00**	**1.89**
Costco	**COST**	978.01	-3.99
Coupang	**CPNG**	14.79	0.39
Crane	**CR**	205.73	1.76
Credicorp	**BAP**	388.42	4.48
CredoTech	**CRDO**	178.50	-0.72
CrowdStrike	**CRWD**	244.57	-4.72
CrownCastle	**CCI**	80.00	0.62
Crown Holdings	**CCK**	113.68	2.58
Cullen/Frost	**CFR**	154.11	2.54
Cummins	**CMI**	532.73	6.77
Curtiss-Wright	**CW**	501.49	1.01
Cytokinetics	**CYTK**	63.92	0.49
D E F			
DTE Energy	**DTE**	128.33	0.02
DT Midstream	**DTM**	118.81	-4.52
Danaher	**DHR**	231.50	6.81
Darden	**DRI**	214.31	5.79
DarlingIngred	**DAR**	60.87	-1.51
Datadog	**DDOG**	266.25	-3.08
DaVita	**DVA**	189.16	8.46
DeckersOutdoor	**DECK**	86.58	3.76
Deere	**DE**	650.67	0.29
DellTechC	**DELL**	**473.39**	**-34.54**
DeltaAir	**DAL**	78.08	1.65
DeutscheBank	**DB**	32.86	0.06
DevonEnergy	**DVN**	49.24	-0.68
DexCom	**DXCM**	**87.71**	**4.24**
Diageo	**DEO**	93.96	1.96
DiamondbkEner	**FANG**	195.60	-1.91
Dick's	**DKS**	140.84	3.88
DigitalRealty	**DLR**	174.47	2.38
DigitalOcean	**DOCN**	109.47	0.18
Dillard's	**DDS**	670.22	14.88
Disney	**DIS**	110.68	1.69
ı DocuSign	**DOCU**	77.52	2.29
DollarGeneral	**DG**	133.89	3.95
DollarTree	**DLTR**	124.41	2.65
DominionEner	**D**	62.86	0.06
Domino's	**DPZ**	303.09	7.20
Donaldson	**DCI**	87.77	0.56
DoorDash	**DASH**	193.05	9.04
Dover	**DOV**	194.09	0.76
Dow	**DOW**	29.66	0.47
DrReddy'sLab	**RDY**	12.90	0.15
DraftKings	**DKNG**	19.31	0.41
DukeEnergy	**DUK**	118.88	-0.76
DuPont	**DD**	131.60	3.12
Dynatrace	**DT**	63.73	0.15
EMCOR	**EME**	732.53	-12.42
ENI	**E**	57.44	-0.27
ı EOG Rscs	**EOG**	152.62	-1.57
EQT	**EQT**	52.45	-0.30
EastWestBncp	**EWBC**	126.26	1.66
EastGroup	**EGP**	194.43	0.80
Eaton	**ETN**	402.48	-6.37

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
ı eBay	**EBAY**	**122.91**	**6.03**
EchoStar	**ECHO**	86.85	-1.01
Ecolab	**ECL**	290.81	3.10
Ecopetrol	**EC**	17.70	-0.20
EdisonIntl	**EIX**	55.65	0.21
EdwardsLife	**EW**	88.10	1.65
ElancoAnimal	**ELAN**	23.54	0.99
Elastic	**ESTC**	**97.24**	**5.18**
ElbitSystems	**ESLT**	**741.61**	**40.23**
EldoradoGold	**EGO**	**36.23**	**1.78**
ElementSolns	**ESI**	35.53	-0.33
ElevanceHealth	**ELV**	428.43	0.34
Embraer	**EMBJ**	72.10	0.61
Emera	**EMA**	47.07	0.11
EmersonElec	**EMR**	162.15	1.07
Enbridge	**ENB**	46.83	-0.52
ı EncompassHealth	**EHC**	127.77	1.21
EnergyTransfer	**ET**	19.88	-0.37
EnlightRenewableEn	**ENLT**	70.06	0.94
EnsignGroup	**ENSG**	178.11	2.26
Entegris	**ENTG**	146.87	-6.21
Entergy	**ETR**	103.96	-0.54
EnterpriseProd	**EPD**	35.57	-0.22
Equifax	**EFX**	**161.26**	**10.90**
Equinix	**EQIX**	996.26	0.36
Equinor	**EQNR**	44.92	-0.37
EquinoxGold	**EQX**	**11.11**	**0.82**
Equitable	**EQH**	53.49	0.61
EquityLife	**ELS**	60.25	0.64
EriehIndemnity	**ERIE**	238.69	8.58
EssentialUtil	**WTRG**	40.29	0.44
EssexProp	**ESS**	269.66	0.29
EsteeLauder	**EL**	**107.19**	**5.60**
! EvercoreA	**EVR**	256.62	2.17
Everest	**EG**	381.35	5.88
Evergy	**EVRG**	81.57	-1.10
Everpure	**P**	**133.40**	**-8.09**
EversourceEner	**ES**	65.99	-0.68
ı Exelixis	**EXEL**	62.83	1.84
Exelon	**EXC**	42.48	-0.12
ExpandEnergy	**EXE**	90.80	-0.31
Expedia	**EXPE**	**291.87**	**17.18**
ı ExpeditorsIntl	**EXPD**	198.64	2.26
ExtraSpaceSt	**EXR**	137.69	3.61
ExxonMobil	**XOM**	174.68	-2.33
F5	**FFIV**	456.58	-0.68
FTAI Aviation	**FTAI**	168.56	5.31
Fabrinet	**FN**	385.20	-7.17
FactSet	**FDS**	301.83	12.09
Fairisaac	**FICO**	**769.93**	**50.30**
Fastenal	**FAST**	50.38	-1.62
FederalRealty	**FRT**	105.68	0.74
FedEx	**FDX**	295.54	4.26
FedExFreight	**FDXF**	110.50	1.81
FergusonEnts	**FERG**	228.76	5.82
Ferrari	**RACE**	398.24	10.89
! Ferrovial	**FER**	48.86	-1.33
FidNatlFinl	**FNF**	39.68	0.42
FidNatlInfo	**FIS**	36.13	0.66
FifthThirdBncp	**FITB**	50.35	0.71
Figma	**FIG**	**22.99**	**1.51**
FirstCitizBcshA	**FCNCA**	2097.20	41.86
FirstHorizon	**FHN**	22.86	0.19
FirstSolar	**FSLR**	178.81	-0.73
FirstCash	**FCFS**	216.71	0.18
FirstEnergy	**FE**	45.55	0.14
Fiserv	**FISV**	47.21	1.14
FiveBelow	**FIVE**	223.23	4.28
Flex	**FLEX**	98.50	-1.85
Flowserve	**FLS**	70.77	0.57
FlutterEnt	**FLUT**	76.18	1.92
FEMSA	**FMX**	120.99	0.31
FordMotor	**F**	12.31	0.26
ForgentPwr	**FPS**	32.37	-0.33
FormFactor	**FORM**	**113.34**	**-6.37**
Fortinet	**FTNT**	181.91	-2.14
Fortis	**FTS**	54.66	-0.03
Fortive	**FTV**	57.78	0.54
FoxA	**FOXA**	63.98	1.77
FoxB	**FOX**	57.14	1.46
Franco-Nevada	**FNV**	240.88	5.83
FranklinTemp	**BEN**	31.38	0.85
ı FreedomHolding	**FRHC**	180.39	4.25
FreeportMcM	**FCX**	70.06	0.59
FreseniusMedCare	**FMS**	22.13	0.59
Frontline	**FRO**	**52.54**	**-3.73**
FullTruck	**YMM**	8.82	0.28
Futu	**FUTU**	109.80	0.35
G H I			
GE Aerospace	**GE**	312.00	4.98
GE HealthCare	**GEHC**	70.35	1.88
GE Vernova	**GEV**	926.44	-15.34
GFLEnvironmental	**GFL**	43.55	0.58
GSK	**GSK**	49.02	1.15
Gallagher	**AJG**	**250.10**	**13.06**
ı GameStop	**GME**	28.02	0.87
Gaming&Leisure	**GLPI**	39.08	0.89
Garmin	**GRMN**	285.22	5.50
Gartner	**IT**	**207.31**	**11.54**
GenDigital	**GEN**	24.82	1.02
Generac	**GNRC**	198.40	0.34
GeneralDynamics	**GD**	337.03	2.37
GeneralMills	**GIS**	32.88	0.77
GeneralMotors	**GM**	83.66	0.61
Genmab	**GMAB**	37.82	0.93
GenuineParts	**GPC**	133.51	1.88
Gerdau	**GGB**	5.05	-0.12
ı GileadSciences	**GILD**	157.37	3.83
GitLab	**GTLB**	**55.94**	**2.78**
Glaukos	**GKOS**	165.60	-2.29
GlobalPayments	**GPN**	84.13	3.28
GlobalFoundries	**GFS**	48.76	-0.18
Globalstar	**GSAT**	82.97	0.57
GlobeLife	**GL**	167.59	0.18
GlobusMedical	**GMED**	78.84	2.53
GoDaddy	**GDDY**	107.29	3.93
GoldFields	**GFI**	37.09	1.54
GoldmanSachs	**GS**	891.28	12.56
Grab	**GRAB**	3.00	0.09
Graco	**GGG**	81.78	1.30
Grainger	**GWW**	1331.17	0.55
GAP	**PAC**	202.14	5.65
GrupoCibest	**CIB**	97.65	0.73
GuardantHealth	**GH**	165.88	2.89
Guidewire	**GWRE**	**175.77**	**10.85**
HCA Healthcare	**HCA**	468.50	-1.94
HDFC Bank	**HDB**	23.53	0.90
HF Sinclair	**DINO**	124.70	-2.99
HP	**HPQ**	30.85	0.39
HSBC	**HSBC**	94.54	0.63
H World	**HTHT**	45.94	1.74
Haleon	**HLN**	9.94	0.26
Halliburton	**HAL**	32.89	0.06
ı HalozymeTherap	**HALO**	121.51	4.69
HarmonyGold	**HMY**	16.98	0.69
HartfordFins	**HIG**	132.81	0.85
Hasbro	**HAS**	98.41	2.95
HealthpeakProp	**DOC**	18.96	0.22
HeclaMining	**HL**	15.56	0.66
Heico	**HEI**	308.64	10.06
HeicoA	**HEIA**	231.34	6.92
HennySchein	**HSIC**	86.99	1.43
Hershey	**HSY**	168.68	4.43
HewlettPackard	**HPE**	**58.63**	**-4.48**
Hilton	**HLT**	342.98	14.98
HomeDepot	**HD**	308.24	12.73
ı HondaMotor	**HMC**	34.06	0.61
HoneywellAero	**HONA**	163.11	6.38

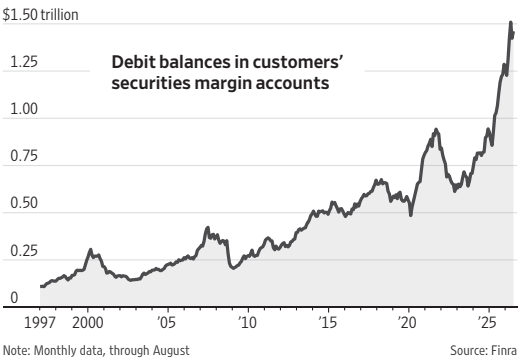
Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
Honeywell	**HON**	210.50	2.89
HormelFoods	**HRL**	20.19	0.38
DR Horton	**DHI**	139.55	5.91
HostHotels	**HST**	23.85	0.92
HowmetAerospace	**HWM**	219.70	2.16
Hubbell	**HUBB**	464.71	-8.66
HubSpot	**HUBS**	**238.91**	**12.68**
HudbayMinerals	**HBM**	22.24	-0.02
Humana	**HUM**	432.20	4.80
JBHunt	**JBHT**	235.31	3.15
HuntingtonBcshs	**HBAN**	15.35	0.25
HuntingIngalls	**HII**	267.22	2.69
Hut8	**HUT**	76.09	1.22
HyattHotels	**H**	**168.91**	**8.59**
ICICI Bank	**IBN**	29.44	1.17
IDEX	**IEX**	236.42	-2.20
IdexxLab	**IDXX**	547.18	18.17
IDEXX Holdings	**IESC**	262.44	-4.07
ING Groep	**ING**	33.27	-0.19
INNIO	**INIO**	16.50	...
Invesco	**IVZ**	28.80	0.87
IQVIA	**IQV**	271.04	9.03
! IREN	**IREN**	30.39	-0.17
ITT	**ITT**	201.04	1.27
IdahoGrain	**IAG**	17.76	0.71
IcahnEnterprises	**IEP**	6.64	...
Icon	**ICLR**	175.13	6.16
IllinoisToolWks	**ITW**	271.19	1.72
Illumina	**ILMN**	267.93	-3.83
ImmunityBio	**IBRX**	10.00	0.09
ImperialOil	**IMO**	129.59	0.01
Incyte	**INCY**	113.27	1.70
Infosys	**INFY**	**12.13**	**0.65**
IngersollRand	**IR**	77.87	-0.07
Insmed	**INSM**	99.21	1.42
Insulet	**PODD**	138.77	4.84
Intel	**INTC**	95.37	-2.75
InteractiveBrkrs	**IBKR**	86.03	1.89
ICE	**ICE**	158.41	3.30
InterContHotls	**IHG**	166.15	5.79
IBM	**IBM**	234.12	6.24
ı IntlFlavors	**IFF**	90.29	0.69
IntlPaper	**IP**	**34.10**	**2.20**
Intuit	**INTU**	**330.17**	**19.73**
IntuitiveSurgical	**ISRG**	427.86	7.62
InvitatHomes	**INVH**	26.80	0.26
IonQ	**IONQ**	**34.35**	**2.93**
IronMountain	**IRM**	112.68	1.82
ItauUnibanco	**ITUB**	9.50	-0.18
J K L			
JBS	**JBS**	12.72	-0.30
JD.com	**JD**	27.39	0.71
JPMorganChase	**JPM**	335.53	0.25
Jabil	**JBL**	287.14	-6.77
JackHenry	**JKHY**	156.47	1.21
JacksonFinl	**JXN**	131.56	1.53
JacobsSolns	**J**	141.97	-0.03
JamesHardie	**JHX**	**25.90**	**1.32**
JanusLiving	**JAN**	29.29	0.31
JazzPharm	**JAZZ**	214.42	4.77
JefferiesFinl	**JEF**	44.90	0.99
JFrog	**FROG**	94.54	2.58
J&J	**JNJ**	253.28	-0.63
JohnsonControls	**JCI**	147.63	-4.81
JonesLang	**JLL**	**310.79**	**15.54**
KB Financial	**KB**	117.88	0.88
KE Holdings	**BEKE**	17.83	0.31
KKR	**KKR**	87.63	2.03
KLA	**KLAC**	1774.46	-4.35
KT	**KT**	18.57	0.31
Kaspi.kz	**KSPI**	94.84	-0.07
Kenvue	**KVUE**	18.67	0.66
ı KeurigDrPepper	**KDP**	34.18	1.06
KeyCorp	**KEY**	19.94	0.15
KeysightTech	**KEYS**	342.08	-15.54
KimberlyClark	**KMB**	104.07	4.66
KimcoRealty	**KIM**	22.67	0.28
KinderMorgan	**KMI**	32.82	-0.53
Kinetik	**KNTK**	53.44	-1.15
KinrossGold	**KGC**	**23.85**	**1.61**
Knight-Swift	**KNX**	65.28	2.07
Philips	**PHG**	25.49	0.49
ı KoreaElecPwr	**KEP**	10.69	0.03
KraftHeinz	**KHC**	23.28	0.58
Kroger	**KR**	62.71	-0.38
KrystalBiotech	**KRYS**	330.00	-0.69
KymeraTherap	**KYMR**	108.14	1.31
LatamAirlines	**LTM**	48.50	1.18
LPL Financial	**LPLA**	327.56	4.10
L3HarrisTech	**LHX**	240.50	3.00
Labcorp	**LH**	325.07	7.73
LamResearch	**LRCX**	277.46	-9.46
LamarAdv	**LAMR**	148.07	2.49
LasVegasSands	**LVS**	38.32	1.30
LatticeSemi	**LSCC**	**107.09**	**-7.91**
Leidos	**LDOS**	124.00	3.41
Lennar A	**LEN**	**77.69**	**4.16**
Lennar B	**LEN.B**	**76.93**	**4.00**
Lennox Intl	**LII**	358.50	9.66
LeonardoDRS	**DRS**	35.47	0.53
LiAuto	**LI**	11.46	0.20
LibertyLiveA	**LLYVA**	96.44	2.13
LibertyLiveC	**LLYVK**	99.66	2.37
LibertyMediaC	**FWONK**	90.81	-0.09
LibertyMediaA	**FWONA**	83.32	0.26
LifeTime	**LTH**	40.56	0.34
EliLilly	**LLY**	1251.61	42.87
LincolnElectric	**LECO**	260.24	2.43
Linde	**LIN**	493.22	0.52
Littelfuse	**LFUS**	391.83	-9.33
LiveNationEnt	**LYV**	172.51	3.67
LloydsBanking	**LYG**	5.47	...
LockheedMartin	**LMT**	532.64	10.41
Loews	**L**	108.79	-0.31
LogitechIntl	**LOGI**	105.16	4.00
Lowe's	**LOW**	195.72	7.41
lululemon	**LULU**	**99.09**	**5.00**
Lumentum	**LITE**	869.54	-26.79
LyondellBasell	**LYB**	62.67	1.50
M N			
Macom Tech	**MTSI**	**271.39**	**-19.94**

Tax Strategy Fuels Borrowing on Wall Street

By Hannah Erin Lang And Miriam Gottfried

The rip-roaring popularity of a strategy that helps individual investors lower their tax bills is powering an unprecedented borrowing binge.

Charles Schwab said on Thursday that margin loan balances on its books had swelled to roughly $188 billion in the third quarter, nearly doubling year over year. A significant driver: long-short tax-aware strategies that promise to beat the market without paying taxes on all of the capital gains.



Note: Monthly data, through August Source: Finra

JUTHARAT PINYODOONYACHET FOR WSJ

Schwab's margin loan balances on its books swelled to $188 billion in the third quarter, nearly doubling year over year.

Schwab's margin balance included roughly $61 billion related to long-short strategies, according to the company's report. On a call with analysts, Chief Executive Rick Wurster said adoption of the strategy had grown "exceptionally quickly" this year.

Margin debt, or investor borrowing from brokerages to buy securities, has hovered near records. **Morgan Stanley**, **Bank of America** and **Goldman Sachs** reported this week that their margin books have logged double-digit growth in the 12 months through September.

The tax-aware long-short strategy has been a key reason.

Long-short strategies managed by hedge-fund firms such as AQR and Quantinno have raked in nearly $190 billion in assets, up from just over $1 billion five years ago, according to estimates by Brent Sullivan of Tax Alpha Insider, an online publication devoted to tax-aware investing.

The strategies seek to track—and ultimately outperform—an index, but also involve borrowing against the portfolio to create two "extensions," one that goes long on stocks and the other that bets against them. The goal is to amplify returns while also creating more opportunities for tax losses to harvest.

Fidelity Investments, which like Schwab is a major custodian of wealth assets, aided the rise of the long-short tax-aware strategy by allowing people with smaller account balances to jump in. The strategy became so popular that Fidelity in February said it was indefinitely pausing the opening of new accounts. The restrictions caused a flood of new assets into accounts at Schwab, leading it to impose its own limits.

In its latest set of restrictions, rolled out last month, Schwab raised the minimum investment for some new long-short tax-aware accounts to $10 million from $1 million, and said it wouldn't enroll new clients or accept new funds in portfolio margin accounts.

The leverage component of the strategy involves taking a significant amount of balance-sheet risk, people familiar with the matter said.

The limits by the two biggest custodians have threatened to curb the growth of the strategy overall, although other custodians have begun accommodating investors who want to do it.

"It was important to us to throttle growth for a period of time to make sure that we can support this from an operational standpoint," Wurster told analysts. Schwab also is working on its own version of a long-short tax-aware product, he said, that will allow the company to offer strategies in a way that is "in a way that is operationally and financially manageable over the longer term." That would put Schwab in direct competition with AQR and Quantinno.

U.S. margin debt totaled $1.45 trillion in August, according to Finra data, near the record of $1.5 trillion earlier this summer. The growth is driven in part by the mechanics of an ever-rising bull market: As stocks climb, short sellers need to post more collateral to their lenders. That cash can be automatically drawn from a margin loan.

Individual investors also have shown a greater appetite for risk in recent years, piling into products such as exchange-traded funds that can amplify gains and losses. In the second quarter, total assets in leveraged funds blew past $180 billion.

Private-Equity Firm Offers AI-Led Makeovers

By Mark Maurer

A new private-equity firm focused on using artificial intelligence to boost revenue at portfolio companies is testing the strategy on its first acquisition.

Aldaron, co-founded by private markets and engineering veterans from **Palantir** and the **Carlyle Group**, recently closed its debut fund with roughly $885 million in commitments, its founders told The Wall Street Journal, bringing its total assets under management to close to $1 billion.

The firm in March bought a majority stake in Oak Point Partners, which buys what it calls remnant assets from companies, often in the course of bankruptcies. Oak Point believes its revenue could rise as much as fivefold over the next four to five years under Aldaron's ownership.

The private-equity industry, built on a playbook centered on cutting costs and optimizing companies' financial results, sees massive potential in AI's ability to expand businesses, establish new revenue streams and create new product lines. Larger private-equity firms including **Blackstone** and Hellman & Friedman have AI-related initiatives, including a joint venture in which engineers embed in portfolio companies.

ALDARON: ALLISON CORINNE DAVIS

From left to right, Aldaron co-founders Will Oberndorf, Jay Grewal and Evan Mendez

Aldaron is part of a new breed of companies centering their entire business models around applying new technologies. This week, the recently launched firm Ithaca Holdings announced a deal to buy dating-app company Bumble with the goal of applying advanced technologies.

Aldaron's fundraising move comes amid an industrywide slowdown in raising capital, with investors becoming increasingly selective.

Aldaron co-founder Jay Grewal co-founded Palantir's commercial business, where he led a team of more than 600 engineers, and helped set up its enterprise data-management platform. Co-founder Evan Mendez worked on Carlyle's investment team, focused on U.S. technology buyouts. Will Oberndorf, also a co-founder, led the private-markets practice at a family office founded by his father Bill Oberndorf, an investor and political donor.

Aldaron's investments are aimed at increasing head count and improving operations at portfolio companies by accelerating the adoption of AI. Aldaron avoids businesses whose strategy involves laying people off, Mendez said.

Aldaron's name is a word used by author J.R.R. Tolkien that loosely translates to "tree" and, to the firm's founders, reflects growth. The firm is targeting acquisitions of U.S. companies with enterprise values ranging from $200 million to $1 billion, Mendez said.

Half of Aldaron's 12-person staff, based in New York and San Francisco, are engineers who build systems alongside managers. Some of the engineers, including Grewal, will sit on investment committees and boards of its companies, executives said.

"If you want to own the whole problem and actually do the transformation, you can't come in with just a limited skill set of being able to just deploy AI," Grewal said.

At Oak Point, Aldaron deployed AI tools to help speed up Oak Point's research and data analysis. The tools identify 10 to 12 high-potential opportunities a week involving dormant assets that it can convert into cash, up from one to two previously, said Chief Executive Eric Linn.

Oak Point's workforce has grown by 20% to 75 employees since March, amid the AI push, with the aim of reaching 100 employees in a year, Linn said. Most of the new employees are focused on deal sourcing and developing technology.

PNC Sees Revenue Rise Amid National Expansion

By Kelly Cloonan

PNC Financial Services Group recorded higher revenue in the latest quarter, boosted by efforts to push further into key markets and expand its footprint.

However, the metric came in short of Wall Street's estimates, and profit was dented by $36 million in integration costs tied to PNC's acquisition of FirstBank.

PNC posted a third-quarter profit of $2.1 billion, or $4.97 a share, compared with $1.82 billion, or $4.35 a share, a year earlier.

Adjusted earnings per share were $5.09, compared with analyst estimates of $4.98, according to FactSet.

PNC's profit was hurt by the purchase of FirstBank.

Revenue gained 11% from a year earlier to $6.56 billion, short of analyst estimates of $6.61 billion.

Net interest income climbed 15% year over year to $4.21 billion due to commercial loan growth, PNC's acquisition of FirstBank and lower funding costs. Noninterest income rose 4%, to $2.36 billion.

Total loans at the end of the quarter were up 16% at $378.8 billion.

Provision for credit losses rose to $189 million from $167 million.

Chief Executive Bill Demchak said the company's efforts to push further into key markets and expand its reach nationally are driving growth.

"We are well positioned, and remain confident in our long-term outlook," Demchak said.

AI Cloud Stock Is Whipsawed

Continued from page B1

ries a 'B,' or highly speculative, credit rating from S&P Global because it carries a high level of debt relative to earnings.

In July, CoreWeave's bankers revised terms of a syndicated loan sale to attract enough investors, ultimately pricing the debt at a yield above 10%.

THURSDAY'S MARKETS

"What the bon\d market is telling us is that they have a higher default risk," said David Busch, chief investment officer for Trajan Wealth. "It's not necessarily weakening demand for AI computing. But, in my mind, it's a growing concern that CoreWeave's enormous borrowing requirements could overwhelm its ability to generate cash and refinance debt at reasonable rates."

In all, CoreWeave is carrying at least $35 billion of debt on its balance sheet, according to FactSet. It is expected to burn through around $80 billion of cash over the next 3½ years, said Jordan Chalfin, head of technology at the research firm CreditSights.

Rising rates tend to suck the froth out of markets by making risky assets look less attractive. Higher U.S. Treasury yields have hit the valuation multiples of tech companies and cast a pall over the IPO market, where two Australian data-center companies recently pumped the brakes on planned offerings. Broadcom's CEO added to the bad mood Monday by suggesting AI investors have "no clue what they are investing in."

The cost to protect CoreWeave's debt against default spiked to an all-time high this week, and some of its unsecured bonds dropped below 80 cents on the dollar Wednesday. A CoreWeave bond due in 2031 traded at a yield more than 10 percentage points higher than the comparable Treasury yield—a symbolic threshold where the industry starts considering a bond "distressed."

$35B

Amount of debt CoreWeave is carrying on its balance sheet.

Investors and analysts said that CoreWeave likely can't issue more unsecured bonds if yields on its existing bonds remain near recent levels. But they added the company still has other ways to fund itself, including secured loans backed by valuable contracts with customers such as Meta Platforms and different types of equity financing. Conventional unsecured bonds made up 22% of the company's total debt at the end of June, according to FactSet.

Some investors are optimistic. Bank of America on Thursday boosted its revenue-growth forecasts for CoreWeave, projecting higher prices and greater capacity amid surging demand for AI computing power. On Wednesday, retail investors bought a record amount of CoreWeave shares, according to Vanda Analytics.

Still, investors unloaded shares in chip makers and AI infrastructure firms Thursday, piling into safer assets such as gold and Treasurys. The yield on the 10-year U.S. Treasury note settled at 5.086%, according to Tradeweb, down from 5.189% Wednesday. The Dow Jones Industrial Average rose 1.1%, or 556 points, while the S&P 500 gained 0.3% and the Nasdaq composite inched 0.1% higher.

"The rise in Treasury yields has made financial conditions tighter already," said Peter Graf, chief investment officer at Amova Asset Management Americas. "They're going to do a great job slowing down parts of the economy, even if they don't have an impact on hyperscalers. We're starting to see a divergence."

Mutual Funds

Data provided by LSEG

Top 250 mutual-funds listings for Nasdaq-published share classes by net assets.

e-Ex-distribution. **f**-Previous day's quotation. **g**-Footnotes x and s apply. **j**-Footnotes e and s apply. **k**-Recalculated by LSEG, using updated data. **p**-Distribution costs apply, 12b-1. **r**-Redemption charge may apply. **s**-Stock split or dividend. **t**-Footnotes p and r apply. **v**-Footnotes x and e apply. **x**-Ex-dividend. **z**-Footnote x, e and s apply. **NA**-Not available due to incomplete price, performance or cost data. **NE**-Not released by LSEG; data under review. **NN**-Fund not tracked. **NS**-Fund didn't exist at start of period.

Thursday, October 15, 2026

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD %Ret
AB Funds			
MuniIncmShares	10.52	+0.10	-2.0
American Century Inv			
Ultra	99.97	-0.17	6.2
American Funds Cl A			
AmcpA	45.39	+0.30	6.3
AMutlA	64.80	+0.40	10.1
BalA	40.32	+0.26	8.4
BondA	10.84	+0.06	-2.2
CapIBA	82.20	+0.49	8.8
CapWGrA	80.27	+0.23	13.3
EupacA	61.35	+0.22	7.3
FdInvA	102.91	+0.67	14.2
GwthA	88.68	+0.60	10.2
ICAA	68.59	+0.33	10.5
IncoA	27.63	+0.24	7.8
N PerA	74.87	+0.36	6.0
NEcoA	84.83	+0.43	16.8
NwWrldA	102.93	-0.61	10.4
SmCpA	79.79	+0.31	8.9
WshA	68.00	+0.55	9.4
Artisan Funds			
IntlVal Inst	59.78	+1.04	12.5
Baird Funds			
AggBdInst	9.50	+0.05	-1.5
CorBdInst	9.86	+0.06	-1.3
IntBdInst	10.18	+0.03	-0.7
ShtTBdInst	9.39	+0.01	1.1
BlackRock Funds			
HiYBlk	6.90	+0.02	0.6
HiYldBd Inst	6.90	+0.02	0.6
BlackRock Funds III			
iShS&P500IdxK900.19		+2.98	14.1
BlackRock Funds Inst			
StratIncOpptyIns	9.49	+0.01	0.8
Calamos Funds			
MktNeutI	16.26	+0.01	4.4
CausewayInst			
CausewayInst	24.31	+0.27	3.4
Columbia Class A			
SelgComuInfoA	243.14	+0.28	55.2
Columbia Class I			
DivIncom I	40.72	+0.16	13.6
Dimensional Fds			
EmgMktVa	43.98	-0.31	20.6
EmMktCorEq	33.03	-0.30	15.6
IntlCoreEq	22.12	+0.18	11.3
IntlVal	32.22	+0.27	14.9
IntSmCo	27.38	+0.19	9.1
IntSmVa	34.19	+0.17	12.9
LgCo	51.41	+0.17	14.1
US CoreEq1	56.34	+0.32	14.4
US CoreEq2	50.17	+0.33	14.3
US Small	59.11	+0.82	13.9
US SmCpVal	60.10	+0.76	17.6
US TgdVal	42.36	+0.56	15.8
USLgVa	67.22	+0.43	20.8
Dodge & Cox			
Balanced	13.85	+0.14	5.2
Income	12.17	+0.07	-2.1
Intl Stk	18.10	+0.12	10.0
Stock	17.82	+0.24	9.4
DoubleLine Funds			
TotRetBdI	8.43	+0.03	-2.0
Fidelity			
500IdxInstPrem	269.15	+0.89	14.1
Contrafund K6	38.58	+0.14	13.4
EmgMktIdxInstPre	16.10	-0.10	17.7
ExtMktIdxInstPre	111.84	+1.50	11.1
FidSAIEmerg	21.13	-0.08	25.5
FidSer5	7.18	+0.05	-2.7
FidSerInt	8.27	+0.04	-0.6
FidSerToMarket	25.23	+0.11	13.9
FIDZroLgCpIx	27.77	+0.09	13.8
GlexUSIdxInstPre	20.99	+0.11	12.5
GrowthCompanyK6	46.50	...	25.7
IntlIdxInstPrem	66.79	+0.59	9.9
IntlIndex	16.68	+0.07	13.2
LgCpGwId InstPre	48.76	+0.01	5.4
LgCpVlIdxIstPrem	25.49	+0.20	23.1
MidCpInxInstPrem	42.41	+0.52	14.8
SAIUSLgCpIndxFd	28.87	+0.09	14.1
SeriesBondFd	8.71	+0.04	-1.6
SeriesOverseas	15.38	+0.07	3.0
SerLTTreBdIdx	4.98	+0.07	-4.6
SmCpIdxInstPrem	34.77	+0.47	12.6
TMktIdxInstPrem	212.53	+0.93	13.8
TotalMarketIndex	26.94	+0.12	14.0
TtlIntIdxInstPr	19.41	+0.08	12.1
USBdIdxInstPrem	10.09	+0.06	-1.5
Fidelity Advisor I			
GrOppI	263.95	-0.08	12.8
Fidelity Freedom			
Idx2030InsPre	24.04	+0.12	6.7
Idx2035InsPre	28.61	+0.14	7.9
Idx2040InsPre	31.64	+0.16	10.1
Idx2045InsPre	34.35	+0.17	11.6
Idx2050InsPre	34.56	+0.18	11.9
Fidelity Invest			
Balanc	32.53	+0.10	11.4
BluCh	291.30	-0.13	16.8
BluChpGr K6	48.10	-0.01	15.0
Contra	27.67	+0.09	14.0
ContraK	27.80	+0.08	14.0
CpInc	11.04	+0.01	5.8
GroCo	59.63	...	24.7
InvGrBd	9.70	+0.05	-1.5
LowP	41.96	+0.52	12.4
Magin	15.37	...	5.0
NASDAQ	340.36	+0.26	15.4
OTC	27.26	-0.08	30.0
Puritn	25.60	+0.08	10.2
SAILTTreBdIdx	6.18	+0.09	-5.0
SAIUSMinVolIndFd	25.50	+0.13	11.8
SAIUSQtyIdx	25.68	+0.16	13.7
SrsBlChGroRetail	24.91	-0.01	18.1
SrsEmrgMkt	29.99	-0.14	21.7
SrsGlobal	20.58	+0.10	12.5
SrsGroCoRetail	34.26	...	25.7
SrsIntlGrw	20.09	+0.03	5.1
SrsIntlVal	16.70	+0.15	7.1
TotalBond	9.19	+0.05	-1.7
Fidelity SAI			
FidSaiCndInxFnd	16.04	+0.28	12.6
FidSaiInfltnFnd	9.76	+0.05	-0.8
IntlValldx	14.48	+0.14	15.0
TotalBd	8.70	+0.05	-1.7
Fidelity Selects			
Semiconductors r	59.46	-0.76	49.9
Tech	56.30	-0.34	40.5
Fidelity Strategic A			
StratAdEmrMrt	NA	...	NA
First Eagle Funds			
GlbA	88.39	+1.25	9.8
Franklin A1			
IncomeA1	2.52	+0.01	5.4
FrankTemp/Frank Adv			
IncomeAdv	2.50	+0.02	6.0
FrankTemp/Franklin A			
DynaTech A	201.40	-0.99	8.1
Growth A	148.21	+0.55	10.1
RisDv A	97.63	+0.55	8.4
Guggenheim Funds Tru			
TotRtnBdFdClInst	NA	...	NA
Harbor Funds			
CapApInst	129.38	+0.27	11.0
JHF III DispVal			
DispValMCI	31.35	+0.48	14.1
John Hancock			
BondR6	12.97	+0.06	-1.9
JPMorgan I Class			
CoreBond	9.92	+0.05	-1.8
EqInc	28.69	+0.20	17.1
LgCpGwth	85.52	-0.17	4.5
JPMorgan R Class			
CoreBond	9.94	+0.06	-1.6
CorePlusBd	6.97	+0.04	-1.0
Lord Abbett I			
ShtDurInc p	3.78	...	1.1
Metropolitan West			
TotRetBdI	8.73	+0.05	-2.2
MFS Funds			
IIE	43.14	+0.50	6.3
MFS Funds Class I			
ValueI	54.62	+0.55	9.9
Natixis Funds			
LSGrowthY	34.10	+0.37	2.6
Northern Funds			
StkIdx	77.12	+0.25	14.1
Old Westbury Fds			
LrgCpStr	22.51	-0.03	8.8
PGIM Funds Cl Z			
TotalReturnBond	11.53	+0.07	-1.6
PIMCO Fds Instl			
IntlBdUSH	NA	...	NA
TotRt	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds A			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds I2			
Income	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds Instl			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
Price Funds			
BlChip	217.00	+0.40	3.2
LgCapGow I	89.67	+0.39	5.5
Putnam Funds Class A			
PutLargCap p	45.58	+0.25	16.6
Putnam Funds Class Y			
PutLargCap	45.62	+0.26	16.9
Schwab Funds			
1000 Inv r	16.58	+0.06	14.0
FunUSLgInst r	38.83	+0.28	21.1
Intl Sel r	31.55	+0.28	9.9
S&P Sel	20.02	+0.07	14.1
TSM Sel r	18.65	+0.08	13.8
Strategic Adviser			
StratAdCorInFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdFidCoreS	8.85	+0.05	-1.2
StratAdFidEmr	18.22	-0.09	19.9
StratAdFidUS	22.06	+0.11	16.4
StratAdIntlFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdMunBond	NA	...	NA
StratAdvFidIntl	16.10	+0.12	9.0
TIAA/CREF Funds			
EqIdxInst	53.36	+0.24	13.8
IntlEqIdxInst	30.59	+0.27	9.8
LrgCpGrIdxInst	80.26	+0.02	5.6
VANGUARD ADMIRAL			
500Admrl	714.89	+2.37	14.1
BalAdmrl	54.41	+0.27	7.7
CAITAdmrl	11.05	+0.07	-1.9
CapOpAdmrl	266.37	+2.50	22.8
DivApprIdxAdm	65.68	+0.57	11.4
EMAdmr	48.78	-0.15	9.6
EqIncAdmrl	101.88	+0.79	11.5
ExplrAdmrl	118.67	+1.39	11.2
ExtndAdmrl	175.09	+2.36	11.3
GroIncAdmrl	122.59	+0.44	12.4
GrwthAdmrl	277.39	-0.05	10.8
HlthCareAdmrl r	89.47	+1.54	8.1
HYCorAdmrl r	5.29	+0.02	-0.1
InfProAd	22.10	+0.10	-1.0
InfTechIdx	501.10	-1.89	30.3
IntlGrAdmrl	122.35	+1.02	7.3
ITBondAdmrl	9.95	+0.06	-2.5
ITIGradeAdmrl	8.38	+0.05	-2.2
LarCapAd	179.72	+0.59	14.0
MidCpAdmrl	400.78	+4.17	12.7
MuHYAdmrl	10.09	+0.09	-1.9
MuIntAdmrl	13.19	+0.08	-1.7
MuLTAdmrl	10.28	+0.10	-2.2
MuLtdAdmrl	10.77	+0.04	0.4
MuShtAdmrl	15.73	+0.03	1.5
PrmcpAdmrl	228.86	+2.14	23.8
RealEstatAdmrl	129.61	+1.59	6.3
SmCapAdmrl	137.97	+1.98	12.7
SmGthAdmrl	117.81	+1.52	11.3
STIGradeAdmrl	10.18	+0.02	0.5
STIPSIxAdm	24.37	+0.04	1.6
TotBdAdmrl	9.32	+0.05	-1.5
TotIntBdIdxAdm	18.86	+0.04	-0.5
TotIntlAdmIdx r	44.99	+0.17	11.8
TotStAdmrl	184.23	+0.84	13.9
TxMCapAdmrl	397.31	+1.63	13.8
TxMIn r	22.38	+0.14	12.6
USGroAdmrl	202.40	+0.46	3.8
ValAdmrl	86.98	+0.73	18.5
WdsrIIAdmrl	94.08	+1.33	13.7
WellsIAdmrl	61.54	+0.39	2.6
WelltnAdmrl	81.61	+0.32	7.4
WndsrAdmrl	84.18	+1.08	14.6
VANGUARD FDS			
DivdGro	32.76	+0.31	7.9
FTAIWldInAdmI	50.88	+0.22	12.2
LifeGro	55.52	+0.24	10.3
LifeMod	36.76	+0.16	7.4
PrmcpCor	45.96	+0.34	24.1
STAR	30.86	+0.24	6.8
TgtRe2020	28.55	+0.12	4.0
TgtRe2025	21.12	+0.09	5.9
TgtRe2030	45.36	+0.20	7.2
TgtRe2035	29.66	+0.14	8.3
TgtRe2040	54.65	+0.24	9.4
TgtRe2045	38.39	+0.17	10.5
TgtRe2050	66.15	+0.29	11.6
TgtRe2060	68.13	+0.30	11.7
TgtRet2055	73.91	+0.33	11.7
TgtRetInc	14.09	+0.05	3.5
Welltn	47.27	+0.19	7.4
VANGUARD INDEX FDS			
ExtndIstPl	432.05	+5.82	11.3
IdxIntl	26.90	+0.11	11.7
MdCpGrAdmrl	126.68	+1.57	5.9
MdCpVlAdmrl	106.32	+0.96	17.5
SmValAdmrl	101.96	+1.58	13.7
TotBd2	9.18	+0.05	-1.7
TotIntlInstIdx r	179.92	+0.69	11.8
TotItlInstPlId r	179.97	+0.70	11.8
TotSt	184.19	+0.84	13.8
VANGUARD INSTL FDS			
DevMktsIndInst	22.41	+0.14	12.6
DevMktsInxInst	35.02	+0.22	12.6
ExtndInst	175.07	+2.35	11.3
FTScInst	53.35	+0.22	14.0
GrwthInst	277.40	-0.06	10.8
InPrSeIn	9.00	+0.04	-1.1
InstIdx	620.11	+2.06	14.1
InstPlus	620.09	+2.05	14.1
InstTStPlus	126.96	+0.58	13.9
MidCpInst	88.54	+0.93	12.7
MidCpIstPl	436.64	+4.54	12.7
MorngStrTtlStMrk	345.65	+1.58	13.9
MrngStrtTtlStckS	362.79	+1.65	13.9
SmCapInst	137.96	+1.98	12.7
SmCapIstPl	398.21	+5.71	12.7
STIGradeInst	10.18	+0.02	0.5
STIPSIxins	24.39	+0.04	1.6
TotBdInst	9.32	+0.05	-1.5
TotBdInst2	9.18	+0.05	-1.6
TotBdInstPl	9.32	+0.05	-1.5
TotIntBdIdxInst	28.31	+0.07	-0.4
TotStInst	184.26	+0.84	13.9
ValueInst	86.98	+0.74	18.5
WCM Focus Funds			
WCMFocIntlGrwIns	26.80	-0.04	7.7

HEARD ON THE STREET
FINANCIAL ANALYSIS & COMMENTARY

Rates Threaten Wall Street's Golden Goose

Weak bond markets undermine what had been a strength for big banks: trading desks

Wall Street banks are having a live-by-the-sword, die-by-the-sword moment with their trading desks.

Until the past month or so, the hot-running economy and artificial-intelligence financing boom were fueling ever-rising activity for bond and stock traders. Meanwhile, more traditional regional banks were facing questions about tepid loan growth and intense deposit competition. So, over the past two years, the KBW Nasdaq Bank index has risen over 17% annually, more than double the smaller-bank regional bank index.

Yet thus far this week, the KBW Nasdaq Bank index is off by 2.4%, versus a 0.6% drop for KBW's index of smaller regional banks. One major reason: Big bank earnings this week revealed that fixed-income trading desks' revenues were hit by September's surge in yields. The settling reality of even-higher-for-even-longer interest rates was further underlined by Wednesday's hot inflation report.

While price moves can be good for banks when they lead to more trades, sharp and sudden plunges in the price of bonds can hit their trading inventories and cause clients to step back. For example, higher rates mean fewer new mortgages, which translates into less demand for facilities where clients park loans before securitizing them.

The upshot was that fixed-income, currencies and commodities revenue fell around 4% in the third quarter from the same period in 2025 across **Bank of America**, **Citigroup**, **Goldman Sachs**, **JPMorgan Chase**, **Morgan Stanley** and **Wells Fargo**.

Even if things were to steady out, banks still likely face tougher resource choices in the quarters ahead. Rising yields can eat into banks' regulatory capital via lower marks on the banks' own portfolios of bonds.

TING SHEN/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Fixed-income, currencies and commodities revenue fell around 4% in the third quarter across six banks, including Bank of America and JPMorgan Chase. Above, CEOs Brian Moynihan and Jamie Dimon.

Indeed, Wall Street banks could be nearing some limits on how much more resources they can realistically plow into trading, having already sunk an additional trillion dollars or so into trading-related assets. A lot of that was enabled by a buildup of excess capital in the past, back when the Federal Reserve was considering some bigger increases in capital requirements than current proposals.

The six biggest Wall Street banks have lowered their core regulatory capital ratios, which measure common equity Tier 1 capital as a percentage of risk-weighted assets, by roughly a percentage point on average over the past year. They have also on average increased their overall leverage.

Trading may now face a higher hurdle for additional resource allocation. That is especially the case if profitability is challenged, for example because it is harder to make markets when prices are swinging wildly, or if fewer clients want to trade.

In reference to a question about potentially reducing resources allocated to trading desks, Bank of America Chief Executive Brian Moynihan told analysts on Wednesday: "We expect it to continue to grow, but they've got to get the returns as they're growing. And when customers stop cold like they did last quarter, that happens."

Rising rates do offer upside elsewhere, especially in a potential pickup in net interest income. That can grow as loans grow, as older bonds in banks' investment portfolios mature and roll into higher yields, and as yield earned on assets picks up faster than interest paid on deposits and other funding. Freed up capital from trading could be allocated to other businesses if the returns are higher.

Bank of America has raised its expectation for net interest income growth for 2027 to 8% or more over this year. JPMorgan preliminarily projects its own net interest income, excluding its volatile markets business, could rise by around $10 billion from what is expected in 2026 to 2027. Those are good signs for regional banks, which generally rely much more on lending.

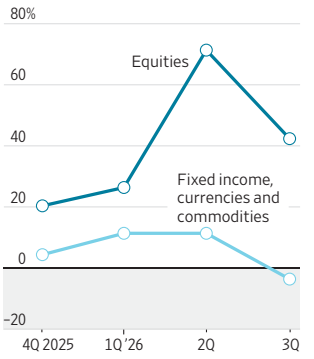
There is also some debate about the trading outlook for the fourth quarter. JPMorgan CEO Jamie Dimon suggested on his bank's analyst call that he personally thought the fourth quarter might defy the usual seasonal slowdown. "There's too much going on in the world," he said.

One thing to watch is whether anything should happen to disrupt banks' still-hot equities trading units, which in the third quarter collectively grew revenue more than 40% from a year prior. If sharply higher bond yields finally start to shift investors out of stocks, that could ripple through banks' stock trading or prime brokerage desks, which provide financing to trading clients.

So while it may have felt like the case for several quarters, investors can't count on banks' trading desks to always ride to the rescue.

—Telis Demos

Change from a year earlier in trading revenue by market for the six biggest Wall Street banks



Note: Banks are JPMorgan Chase, Bank of America, Citigroup, Goldman Sachs, Morgan Stanley and Wells Fargo.
Source: the companies

How to Invest for the Middle Class Blues

You've probably been hearing about America's "K-shaped economy," the pattern of well-off people spending freely while poorer ones' prospects head in the opposite direction.

The top of the "K" is looking a bit droopy these days with a subset of the middle class trading down or cutting back on goods and services. Evidence, for now, is mostly coming from the private sector, not government data such as unemployment.

Economic angst might not be good for the stock market overall, but investors who get ahead of the trend can dull the blow.

Jim Paulsen, who has seen a few cycles over his four-plus decades in the investment business, says part of what's happening amid high inflation and moribund jobs growth seems familiar. Lower-income people always get hit hard and early, but he says the effect "might be reaching higher into the income distribution than in the past."

One reason is that there are haves and have-nots even among the solidly middle class. Many rely more on wealth—their homes or record stock portfolios—and feel secure. Others spend more on the basis of salary income. The latter are probably still employed, but they're less confident about staying that way or hopping to a higher-paying role.

Now retired, Paulsen publishes a Substack newsletter in which he revived an early warning indicator he has used successfully as an economic signal in the past: the **Walmart** Recession Signal.

Tweaked over the years, it's simply been the ratio of Walmart shares to a basket of retailers and more-recently the Global Luxury Index.

Walmart is doing well relative to that cohort, and it isn't alone.

Chuck Grom, a retail analyst at Gordon Haskett, says even some middle- to upper-middle-class people "are acting like low-income shoppers lately." He points to new faces visiting **Dollar General**, which caters to a less-affluent clientele than Walmart. Its small format and convenient locations are appealing when people balk at high gas prices.

Others that could benefit from middle class caution are warehouse clubs such as BJs and **Costco** as well as off-price retailers like **Ross Stores**, **Burlington** and TJ Maxx. Auto parts retailers such as **AutoZone** and **O'Reilly** also could gain as people avoid costly dealer maintenance.

The split can be seen among affordable restaurant chains, too. Olive Garden parent **Darden**, with mostly older diners, is holding steady. Fast-casual chains such as **Chipotle**, **Sweetgreen** and **Cava**, a cut above fast food and more likely to serve young, white-collar diners, aren't. That cohort is more affected by job anxiety and boosted less by home equity and big 401(k) balances.

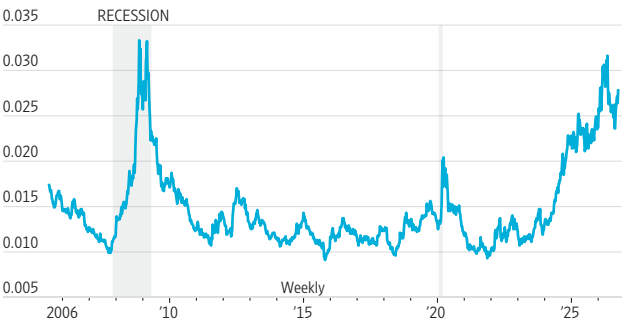
Another sign of stress: Shares of pawnshops **EZCORP** and **First-Cash Holdings** shares are up sharply in the year to date.

The signs are well short of recessionary levels, but that seems to hinge on middle-class consumers' net worth.

"Thank goodness the equity market and most housing markets have cooperated," says Grom.

—Spencer Jakab

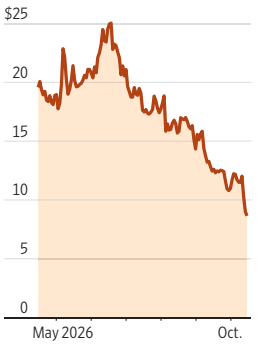
The Walmart Recession Signal



Source: Jim Paulsen

MONEY & INVESTING

Six Flags Entertainment share price, past six months



Source: FactSet

Six Flags Bonds, Stock Sink on Safety Scare

Six Flags' bonds and stock fell Thursday, after the park operator's closure of rides after a man died aboard a roller coaster. One Six Flags bond traded at 83 cents on the dollar for a roughly 12% yield, down from about 90 cents earlier in the week, according to a buy-side trader. The stock fell 4.4%.

STOCK SPOTLIGHT

Charles Schwab
Shares in the brokerage firm dropped 2.7% despite reporting results that beat expectations. Investors have been nervous about the effects of higher interest rates across banks and financial-services firms.

Rocket Lab
Shares in the aerospace company slumped 6.6% after it delayed the maiden launch of its Neutron rocket from this year to 2027.

UBS
Switzerland's last remaining flagship global bank is preparing to abandon its home base should Swiss lawmakers proceed with tougher capital requirements, The Wall Street Journal reported. U.S.-listed shares rose 1.3%.

TSMC
The world's largest contract chip maker posted another record profit, yet its American depositary receipts fell 1.8% as part of a broader artificial-intelligence selloff. Stock in Samsung also fell 9.5% in Seoul.

U.S. Bancorp and PNC Financial
Shares of U.S. Bancorp gained 2% while PNC stock slid 0.4% after both regional banks reported earnings Thursday morning. The U.S. Bank parent company logged higher profit driven by an increase in total loans.

Ericsson
Shares in the telecommunications-equipment maker surged nearly 7% in Stockholm after Ericsson reported strong growth in sales of network gear.

Brunello Cucinelli
The luxury-fashion company lifted its sales expectations for the year, contrasting with lackluster performance elsewhere in Europe's luxury-goods sector. The stock gained 0.6%.

Investors Are Sorting AI Winners and Losers, Saxo Says

Stock markets are starting to separate the AI wheat from the chaff, says investment bank Saxo.

"For much of the rally, accelerating AI investment was enough to lift almost everything exposed to the theme," said Charu Chanana, Saxo's chief investment strategist. "Now markets are becoming more demanding about profitability, financing and capital discipline."

In a note, Saxo contrasted strong recent earnings from chip-maker heavyweights such as TSMC, Samsung and ASML with debt-loaded AI infrastructure companies, such as CoreWeave, smaller rival Nebius and Oracle.

CoreWeave's financing costs recently spiraled, and some of the bonds it issued this year have dropped to fresh lows in the secondary market.

"CoreWeave has become one of the clearest warning signals in the AI financing market," Chanana wrote. She said higher borrowing costs could start to moderate spending by data-center builders.

FRIDAY'S EVENTS:

◆ Economic data: U.S. export/import prices, industrial production and capacity utilization

EARNINGS EXPECTED:

Truist Financial
M&T Bank

In Market History

On this day in 2001, Enron surprised investors by reporting a $618 million quarterly loss as a result of a $1.01 billion charge connected with write-downs of soured investments. In a call with analysts, Chairman and Chief Executive Kenneth Lay also divulged that the company had cut its shareholder equity by $1.2 billion, meaning Enron was suddenly worth a lot less money.

The company filed for bankruptcy less than two months later.

JAMES NIELSEN/GETTY IMAGES

Enron employees after being laid off in December 2001.

Bespoke Blues
Even millionaires can barely afford custom furniture nowadays **M12**

MANSION

HOMES | MARKETS | PEOPLE | REDOS | SALES

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

Friday, October 16, 2026 | **M1**

Michael Douglas
The actor on being the 'son of Spartacus' **M10**

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP LEFT: CARA TOTMAN; ABIGAIL JACKSON FOR WSJ

The Toma family in the backyard of their home designed by Toma Farren Architects in Cary, N.C. Below, much of the art has an equestrian theme—a nod to the family's love of horses.

A Fit for a Horse-Loving 'Female Brady Bunch'

One couple created an equestrian-themed North Carolina retreat to house their blended family of six daughters

By Nancy Keates

To connect with his three daughters, Dr. Sameh Toma started an equestrian center on a 30-acre North Carolina farm he bought in 1996. Cindy Luihn started boarding her horse there following her divorce, later bringing along her three daughters.

Before long, the farm became more than a place where Toma's and Luihn's daughters rode together—it was where Toma, by then divorced, fell in love with Luihn.

The couple had known each other growing up because Toma was friends with Luihn's older brothers. "She was the cute younger sister," said

Please turn to page M6

The Battle To Control How Americans Buy Homes

Compass is taking more offerings offline, sparking backlash from rivals who say the practice is upending market transparency

By Katherine Clarke

SOCIAL-MEDIA BATTLES. A cease and desist. Lawsuits and threats.

The real-estate industry is tearing itself apart over a question that home buyers haven't had to ask in decades: When you search for a home online, are you actually seeing every property for sale?

For the better part of two decades, the answer to that question has largely been yes, with the vast majority of listings available on sites like Zillow and Trulia. But Compass—now the nation's largest brokerage—is changing the game. Compass offers its sellers the option to market their homes first as "private exclusives" through the company's internal website before putting them on listings sites or the local multiple listings service. In fact, it's been actively encouraging its agents to take their listings off those portals. In New

Please turn to page M8

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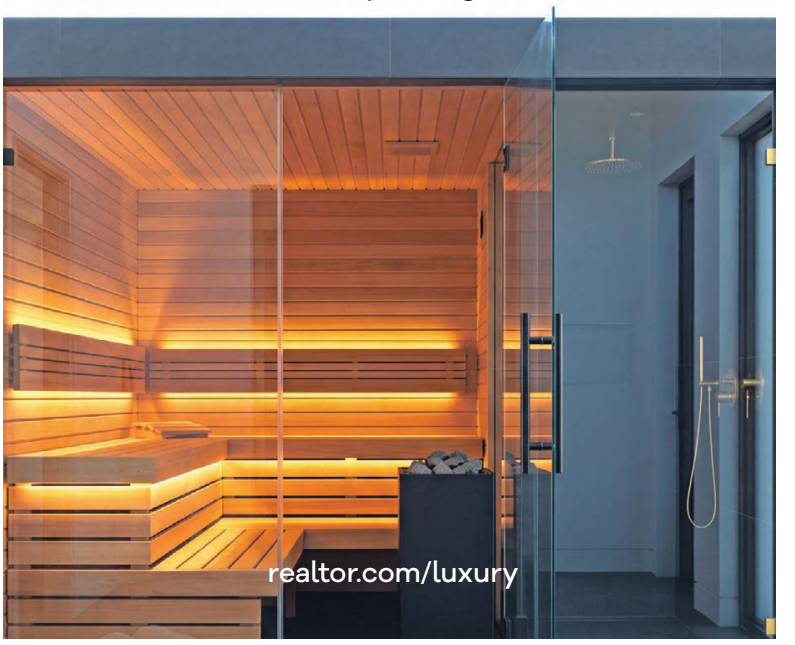


PRIVATE PROPERTIES

Lumber Liquidators Founder Lists Nashville-Area Ranch

It's no surprise that after building a business selling wood flooring, Lumber Liquidators founder Tom Sullivan filled his roughly 122.5-acre Tennessee ranch with an array of unusual wooden pieces: olive flooring and handrails, a cherry-blossom chandelier and wall coverings made from scraps of reclaimed lumber.

Now looking to downsize, Sullivan is listing the property, about 25 miles from Nashville in Leiper's Fork, for $34.8 million. If it sells for close to that, it would be a village record, said listing agent Jamie Parsons of Compass.

Sullivan, 67, is a former contractor who founded Lumber Liquidators in 1993. The company went public in 2007. Sullivan bought it back in 2024 after the company filed for Chapter 11 bankruptcy.

Sullivan and his wife, Britta Sullivan, paid $3.1 million in 2019 for the ranch, property records show.

The Sullivans, who also have homes in Miami Beach, Cohasset, Mass., New York City and Bordeaux, France, began looking more than a decade ago for property near the Lumber Liquidators' headquarters and distribution center in Tennessee, Tom said.

FOR SALE
$34.8 MILLION
13,680 sq. ft., 6 bedrooms, custom brass bar

The Sullivans lived in an older home on the property for a few years while designing a new, 13,680-square-foot, six-bedroom house, as well as multiple barns and outbuildings. Tom said it took two years just to get a permit for a new stone bridge over a creek—which visitors cross to reach the main residence—during which time the project grew.

Throughout the home, Tom gravitated toward vibrant colors and bold patterns. "People usually see the wallpaper and go, 'What the hell is this?' " he said. The house has a 16-foot custom brass bar, and the study has leather flooring, with custom wood walls.

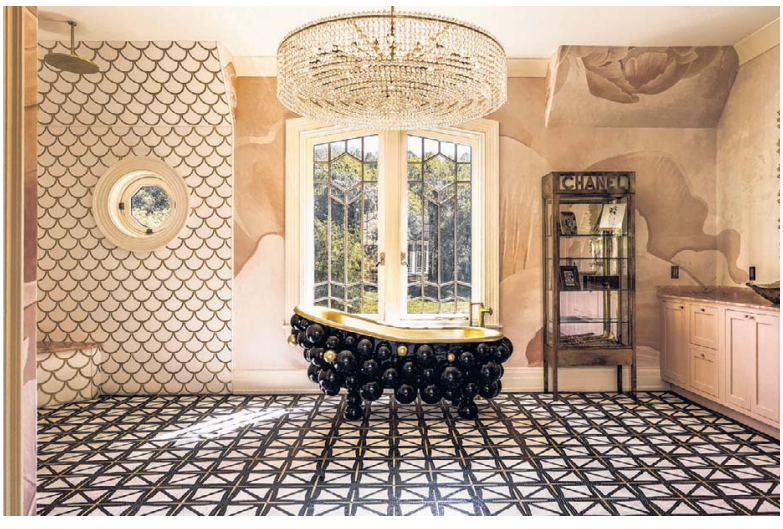
Construction took several years and was completed the day before Thanksgiving last year, when the Sullivans hosted 16 guests. "We were barely moved in," he said. Tom and Britta have two young children; Tom has two older kids from a previous relationship.

Asked how much he invested, Tom said, "I'm afraid to add it up, but a lot." The road and bridge cost more than $6 million, he said.

Tom began thinking of selling the house this summer after Bed Bath & Beyond signed a letter of intent to buy Lumber Liquidators. The deal fell through, but Tom said they no longer need such a large house. He plans to build a smaller home on a piece of adjacent land.

Leiper's Fork is a tightknit community where prices have shot up, said Parsons. She cited a home in the area that sold for $6.25 million in 2020, then resold for $10.5 million in 2024.

—E.B. Solomont



NASHVILLE MEDIA CO.

Carriage House Aims for NYC Record

When John Mack, then the chairman and CEO of Morgan Stanley, and his wife, Christy Mack, decided to return to Manhattan after raising their three children in suburban Westchester County, Christy had one condition: She wanted a turnkey townhouse.

"We moved to Westchester when my youngest was 6 months old," said Christy, a philanthropist. "I said, 'I can't do an apartment again.' "

But after an exhaustive and fruitless search for a townhouse that met their needs, the Macks discovered a diamond in the rough: a brick-and-limestone carriage house on the Upper East Side with its original stables intact.

"I wanted turnkey, but my daughter showed me this house—it was a total gut—and said, 'Mom, you have to buy this. It has great energy in it,' " said Christy. "So we did." They paid $13.5 million in 2009, according to public records.

The complex renovation that followed would delay the family's move by six years. The spartan stables gave way to a lavish, 20-room residence that stretches six floors.

Now, after more than a decade, the Macks have left the city once again. John stepped down as chairman of Morgan Stanley in 2011, and the Macks are retiring to their home state of North Carolina.

They are listing the converted carriage house for $80 million, making it the priciest townhouse on the market in New York City. If the six-bedroom home fetches its asking price, the sale would set a city record for a residential townhouse, according to appraiser Jonathan Miller of Miller Samuel.

FOR SALE
$80 MILLION
16,000 sq. ft.,
6 bedrooms, 3 terraces

The roughly 16,000-square-foot carriage house was built around 1902 by the celebrated Gilded Age architect C.P.H. Gilbert for banker Henri P. Wertheim, who lived nearby. The then-four-story building was later owned by a Who's Who of wealthy New Yorkers, including Otto Kahn, the builder of Oheka Castle on Long Island; Singer sewing machine heir Stephen Carlton Clark, who founded the Baseball Hall of Fame; and Rachel Lambert "Bunny" Mellon, the widow of banking heir and horse breeder Paul Mellon.

FRANCISCO ROSARIO/DD-REPS

As automobiles replaced carriages on the streets of Manhattan, a portion of the gabled structure was converted into a garage. It was still being used as a garage when the Macks bought the property from Mellon, and was one of the last carriage houses remaining in the neighborhood with its original stables, according to listing agent Mike Fabbri of the Agency.

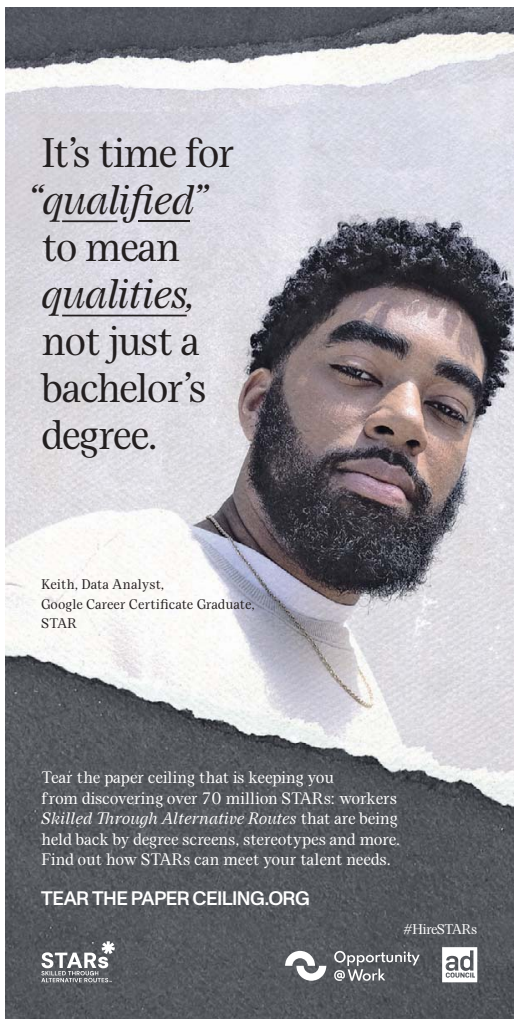
To oversee the top-to-bottom overhaul, the Macks hired New York architect Sawyer Berson and interior designer Eleanor B. LaSota.

Wherever possible, the team preserved historic details. Chicken-wire transom windows were incorporated into the mudroom doors. Crackled tiles were sorted by artisans and arranged on the walls of the gym. Hoof-scraped wooden ramps were discovered to be thick virgin chestnut and reused as wainscoting. At the same time, contemporary comforts were added, including a wine cellar, a home theater, a gym and a spa suite with a massage room.

Since the home was originally designed for four-legged occupants, the proportions are larger than many New York townhouses, said Fabbri.

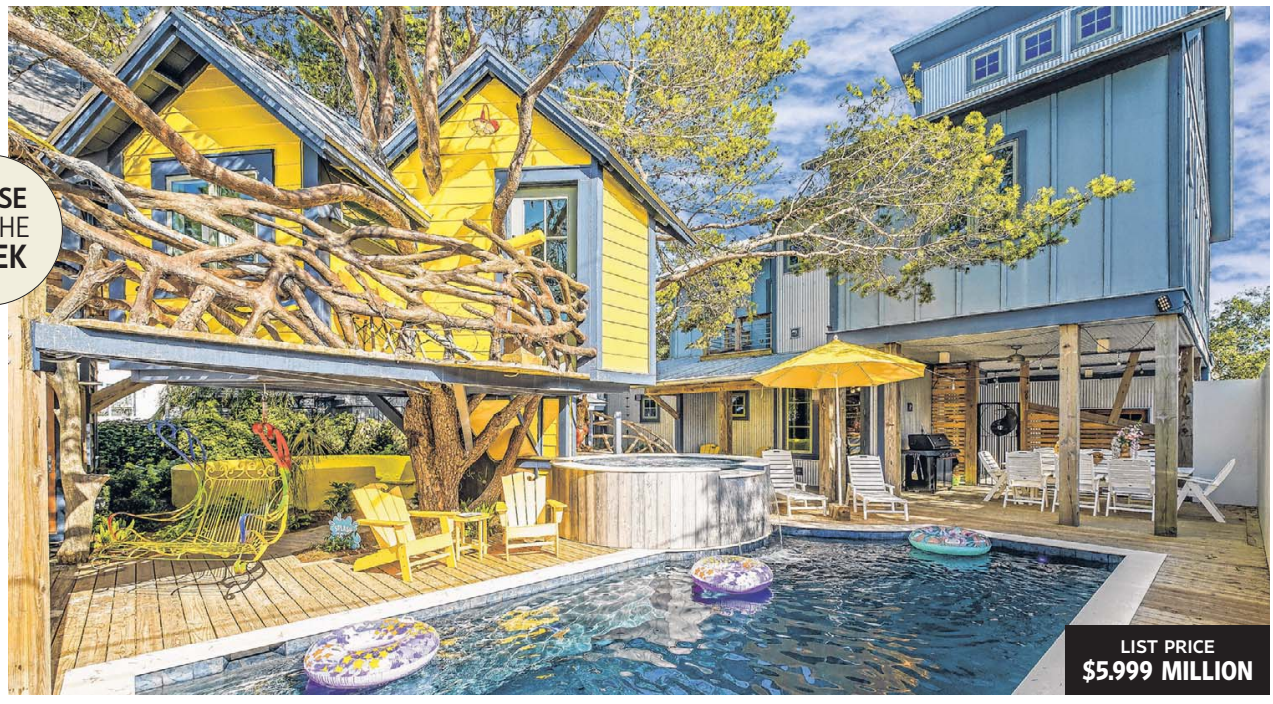
The previous record was set in 2019 by a townhouse sold by hedge-fund manager Philip Falcone; it closed for $77.1 million.

—Christopher Cameron



By Libertina Brandt

HOUSE OF THE WEEK



A Colorful Compound Has Treehouse, Mini Golf

Eschewing typical Scenic Highway 30A beach homes, an architect created a vibrant Florida property packed with whimsy

Chris Stoyles may have started his own architecture firm, but he wouldn't describe himself as a typical architect. "I'm like a little kid in a candy shop," he says.

Stoyles, 53, brought this playful spirit to his Florida compound, which pops with colors like pink, yellow and avocado green—a contrast to the many monotone beach homes along the state's Scenic Highway 30A.

"I was my own client, so therefore I could do whatever I wanted," says Stoyles, who is originally from England but established his northern Florida-based firm, Archiscapes, in 2003.

In 2025, Stoyles bought the Inlet Beach property for around $1.5 million from an architect with his firm. He spent roughly seven months and $1 million transforming the gray-and-black home into a colorful playground packed with amenities, including a treehouse, minigolf course and arcade museum.

THE SPECS
3,379 square feet, 5 bedrooms, 4 bathrooms, roughly 0.2 acre

Bringing the whimsy

Stoyles remodeled the main home, outfitting the kitchen with retro, candy-apple red appliances. He also installed an Elvis statue with a motion-sensor light that helps guide late-night snack raids.

On the property grounds, he built several stand-alone structures, including a guesthouse and a yellow treehouse with large mushrooms painted along its side. Built into a pine tree, the treehouse uses the branches to divide the interior into separate rooms, while a cantilevered balcony with a water cannon extends over the pool.

Stoyles added an arcade museum with games from the 1970s, '80s, and '90s, including Ms. Pac-Man and Donkey Kong. The machines, part of his personal collection, are included in the sale.

Can't-miss features

A six-hole mini golf course has life-size statues of Sasquatch, a unicorn and other mythical creatures.

"It is a very hard golf course—I didn't want anybody to be able to cheat and go around obstacles," says Stoyles. "It has nighttime lighting everywhere, it's just really fun."

Reason for selling?

After finishing the renovation, Stoyles began offering the home as a rental property. Now, he's listing so he can focus on building another beach home nearby.

Market snapshot

Home sales along 30A are up about 36% year over year, according to listing agent Jonathan Spears of Compass. Over the last six years, the area has seen a surge of big-ticket sales, including an Archiscapes-designed waterfront estate that sold for $24 million in 2026.

▶ A new House of the Week drops every Friday at **WSJ.com/RealEstate**.

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The family, including some daughters and grandchildren, in front of the barn at the horse farm in North Carolina that Dr. Sameh Toma started.

by a Horses

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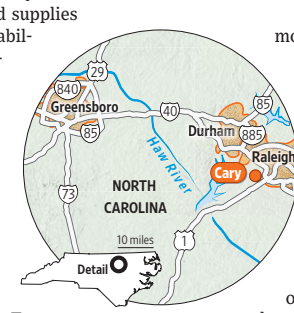
as a path to make it feel like walking through a private garden; top, the primary bedroom.

made sense that horses emerged as a dominant theme in the design: chairs made from saddle leather, wide-plank floors reminiscent of barn aisles, sliding barn doors.

For Toma and Luihn, the priority was to create a home where their blended family of six daughters and eight grandchildren would want to stay over at the same time. "Family is everything, and that core value is what I wanted throughout the design," said Toma.

In 2018, the couple bought a traditional, four-bedroom, 4,684-square-foot house on 0.75 acre overlooking a lake on a golf course for $1.275 million. They tore it down and built a 7,500-square-foot, four-bedroom house for $4 million.

It took four years to build, finishing in 2025, partly because the pandemic delayed supplies and worker availability and partly because the steep hill where the house was built made construction more challenging.



ABIGAIL JACKSON; CAMILLE BRESSANGE/WSJ (MAP)

To further embed the family in the house, the couple hired one of their daughters, Megan Toma, 38, a founder of Toma Farren Architects, to design it and another daughter, Nicole Toma Townsend, 41, a principal at Toma Townsend Construction, to build it.

Megan, who still rides her horse at her father's barn every morning and still competes in shows, said riding horses not only influenced how she chose materials but also gave her the discipline and confidence to take on a project of this size. "I learned that if you stick with something and you trust your intuition, you can make anything happen," she said.

Communicating with her horse also taught her teamwork, Megan said. "It's a partnership." Working with her sister could get combative at times, she said, but

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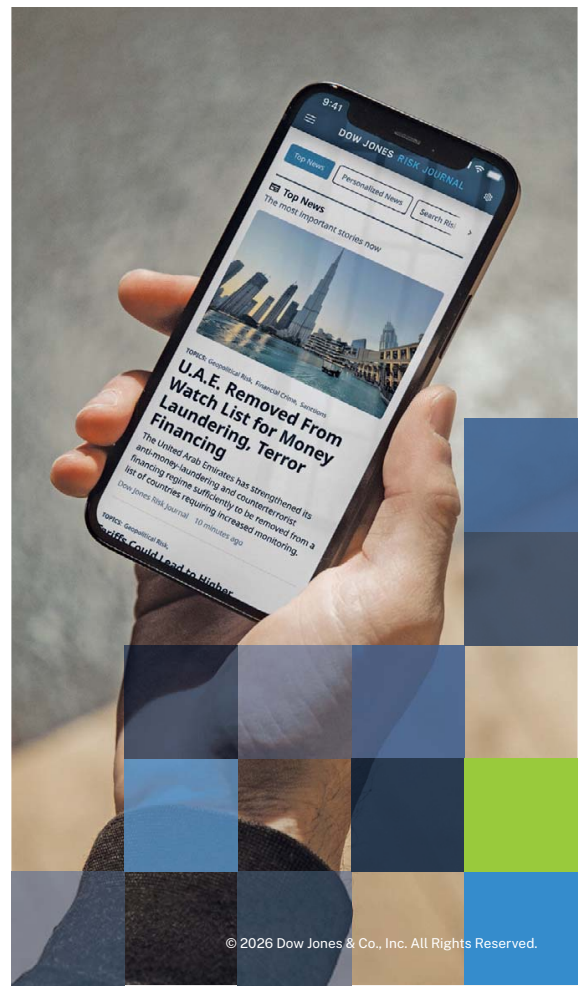

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MANSION

From left, a sweeping view from the front door through the main living room to outside; the foyer with pivot-hinge door; dining room; the family plays games in the downstairs rec room, right.

the end result was stronger because of their openness.

"She's not going to just do what I say," said Megan. "She tells me when I need to think something through more."

Nicole's daughter Charleston Townsend, 11, accompanied her mother daily to the house during construction. "It's so cool to have seen it from start to finish," Charleston said.

Like her mother, she rides a pony at her grandfather's horse farm every day after school and regularly spends the night at her grandparents' house with her cousins.

The lower-level outdoor fireplace, above, and the basement kitchenette, top.

Hidden Listings

Continued from page M1

York, for instance, Compass recently offered a $1,000 credit to agents who agreed to pull their listings off the website StreetEasy.

While Compass once controlled only a small percentage of listings, that changed in January with the company's controversial acquisition of the behemoth Anywhere Real Estate, parent company of Coldwell Banker, Corcoran, Century 21 and Sotheby's International Realty. Now a much higher percentage of properties for sale could be hidden from potential home buyers.

Compass says its model offers sellers more choice on how to market their homes, but critics say it is harming the consumer. Now the long-simmering industry dispute is spilling over into public view, with lawmakers and civil-rights advocates taking notice.

"This is all coming to a head," said Errol Samuelson, chief industry development officer at Zillow Group.

A Compass listing for a waterfront home in Quincy, Mass., was billed as 'coming soon,' selling before going on the MLS. The home has four bedrooms and is about 2,700 square feet.

"This issue is going to have a real impact on people's lives and how they buy and sell, where they live."

Brass-knuckled fight

Compass has grown quickly since its founding in 2012, but its $1.6 billion acquisition of Anywhere took it to the next level, increasing its U.S. agents from about 40,000 to more than 200,000.

Justice Department antitrust enforcers wanted to investigate the merger before it took place, but were overruled by senior officials; Compass worked with Trump-aligned lawyer Mike Davis to make its case to the Justice Department.

Now Compass International Holdings, the umbrella company, handles an enormous share of listings across the country. In Manhattan, for instance, Compass and its affiliates now handle more than 80% of residential sales by dollar volume, according to some estimates, as well as more than 30% of listings in other major markets. Compass's spokesperson said those figures are incorrect, but said the company doesn't keep track of the numbers itself.

Since the merger, Compass's stance on private listings has made it a lightning rod for litigation and scrutiny. The company is now involved in litigation with Zillow as well as the California Regional MLS, one of the country's largest listing services. In July, Rep. Scott Fitzgerald, the Wisconsin Republican who chairs the House Judiciary Committee's antitrust subcommittee, asked Compass CEO Robert Reffkin for a briefing on its private-listings network, warning that private networks can create "velvet ropes" around homes.

In an August essay in Time magazine, NAACP President Derrick Johnson said private-listing networks are akin to "digital redlining."

A Compass spokesperson said the company follows all laws, including fair-housing rules, regardless of how or when a home is marketed, and declined to comment on Fitzgerald or pending litigation.

How we got here

Off-market sales aren't new. Agents have long kept a small number of homes as private "pocket listings," which aren't advertised publicly but instead shopped mostly by word-of-mouth among a select group of agents and their clients. MLS rules allow certain exceptions for sellers who don't want the public to know their homes are on the market, such as celebrities or divorcing couples.

Many homeowners, however, want their listings to reach as many potential buyers as possible in hopes of selling quickly, for the highest-possible price.

"There's 40 years of white-paper research on how the more eyeballs you put on the property, the higher the probability of a higher price," said appraiser and market analyst Jonathan Miller, who has been a critic of Compass.

Compass's acquisition of Anywhere, however, has dramatically increased the number of private listings.

"[Pocket listings] were the exception," said Bess Freedman, chief executive of Compass rival Brown Harris Stevens. "Compass is making them the rule."

In addition to "private exclusives," Compass offers sellers the option of marketing their properties as a "coming soon," which means they are on the Compass website but not on most other listings sites.

Critics say Compass is keeping listings in-house to increase the likelihood that one of its own agents will bring the buyer, thereby earning double the commissions for Compass.

"Sellers could get hurt because the brokerage has this self-interest," Miller said.

Compass, however, said double-ended deals aren't its goal and that it doesn't track them. Instead, it said private listings provide sellers with more options for how to market their homes.

"Homeowners have the right to decide how their own home is marketed so long as they comply with the law," Compass International Holdings said in a statement.

Citing internal data, Compass said when homes it represented were initially listed privately, they sold for 4.6% more on average than comparable homes, as well as going under contract 34% faster once active on the MLS. These homes were also 29% less likely to cut their price, the company said.

Bess Freedman.

Jonathan Miller.

'What are you trying to hide?'

Eric Johnson, a Compass agent in Boston, said he uses private listings as a sort of test run for homes

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP LEFT: ERIC JOHNSON OF THE MISSION REALTY ADVISORS TEAM AT COMPASS; BROWN HARRIS STEVENS; BLOOMBERG NEWS

LISTINGS LINGO

Pocket or private listing
Not publicly advertised. Marketed primarily by word-of-mouth among agents and their clients.

Private exclusive
Visible only to Compass agents and affiliated companies. Buyers or agents from competing firms must contact Compass for the information.

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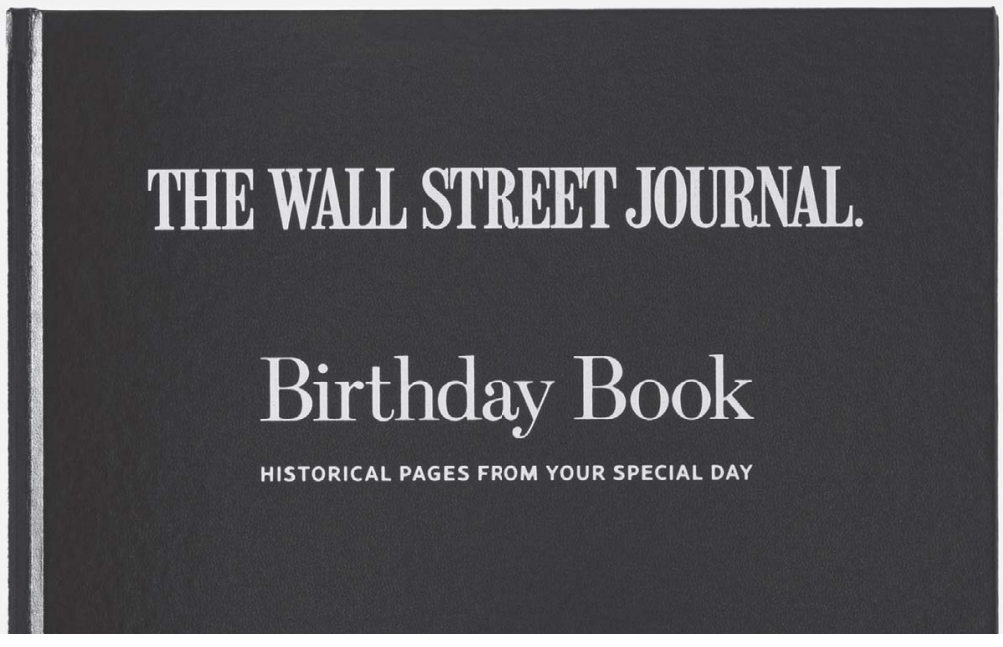

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MANSION

Compass CEO Robert Reffkin, in 2019.

for sale, to gather feedback on the price and presentation before listing them publicly. He says 20% to 30% sell before they ever reach the MLS, and some buyers pay more than the asking price to snag a property before it goes on the open market, in hopes of avoiding a bidding war. "They'll say, 'Here's my crazy price. I want to lock this up today.' "

He pointed to a waterfront home in Quincy, Mass., that sold while being marketed privately for $1.63 million, above the seller's target range of $1.55 million to $1.6 million.

But Miller said sellers who make a deal before going mass market will never know if they could have gotten a higher price. He said Compass's strategy recalls the 1970s and 1980s, when agents hoarded listings information on cards in their offices and chose who to show them to. "Except that in this case, there's only one real-estate agent that's the gatekeeper, and that's Compass," he said. Meanwhile, the consumer may not be aware of how the stakes have changed. "The consumer, when they sit down at the keyboard, they assume they're seeing the whole market, but they're not."

Freedman recalled an instance where one of her agents was showing an apartment on Park Avenue, when a Compass agent mentioned she had an apartment with the same floor plan available on another floor.

"[My agent] said, 'Well, why don't I know about it? I have the buyer for that,' " Freedman said. "And [the Compass agent] said, 'Oh, it's a private listing.' "

Freedman said she emailed Reffkin about the incident, asking him: "Why are we playing detective?"

A Compass spokesperson said all of its listings are viewable either on its website or by contacting Compass, whether or not a buyer is working with a Compass agent.

Houston real-estate agent Nancy Almodovar of Nan & Company Properties said keeping a listing off the public MLS for weeks or months shortchanges buyers by limiting the available information about it. "They want to know, 'How long has this home been on the market?' " Almodovar said. "They deserve to ask those questions and get answers. What are you trying to hide?"

'This is all coming to a head. This issue is going to have a real impact on people's lives and how they buy and sell, where they live.'

—Errol Samuelson, chief industry development officer at Zillow Group

'We're never shutting up'

Freedman, Miller and others have been outspoken in their opposition to Compass's practices, and Reffkin is pushing back hard. Last month, he told a room of several hundred MLS executives at a Florida conference that he was prepared to sue any MLS that fines or punishes its agents for marketing listings outside of the MLS.

Freedman said Compass sent her a cease-and-desist letter after she wrote op-eds criticizing its practices. She also said Compass retaliated against her by filing an ethics complaint against her with the Real Estate Board of New York.

"We wrote back, 'Good luck, we're never shutting up,' " Freedman said.

A Compass spokesperson said the company believes Freedman has made false and defamatory statements about Compass, but denies retaliating against her or others.

For his part, Miller said the dispute has turned personal, with Reffkin blocking him on LinkedIn after Miller repeatedly commented on the CEO's posts about private listings. Compass declined to comment on Miller.

Zillow, meanwhile, has fought back by blocking listings that were marketed outside of a traditional MLS for more than 24 hours. Zillow isn't an impartial observer; it makes money from the traffic that listings bring to its platform and by charging agents for leads.

"I think two things can be true at once," said Samuelson of Zillow. "I think it's good for sellers and buyers to have transparency in the marketplace, and I think it also happens to be good for Zillow."

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HOUSE CALL | MICHAEL DOUGLAS

He Was Once 'Mobil Man of the Month'

The film star on his volatile father, actor Kirk Douglas, overcoming stage fright and his estate in Spain

Being the eldest son of Spartacus wasn't easy. My father, actor Kirk Douglas, the gladiator in the epic 1960 film, tried to be a good dad. But career stress led to a volatile temper that compromised relationships with my mother, Diana, and my younger brother, Joel, and me.

In Dad's defense, his father never paid attention to him or any of his seven kids, depriving him of a role model. So he didn't have a clue. I say this because I loved him.

Shortly after I was born in 1944, my parents lived in a one-bedroom apartment in Greenwich Village. The following year, Dad was cast in the film "The Strange Love of Martha Ivers," and we moved into a Craftsman house in Los Angeles.

Dad became a crazy man out there and was unfaithful. When I was 5, Mom had enough and she moved us back to New York, to an apartment on Central Park West. My parents divorced, and Mom took acting and modeling jobs. Early on, I saw Dad only on movie screens, on holidays or when he worked in New York.

I was 8 when I realized fame had a dark side. As I played outside, two kidnappers came for me. They followed me, but I managed to slip into the elevator.

In 1954, Dad married Anne Buydens. She was a wonderful second mother and got along well with Mom.

Dad discouraged me from acting. He called it the saddest profession. I had zero ambition to act.

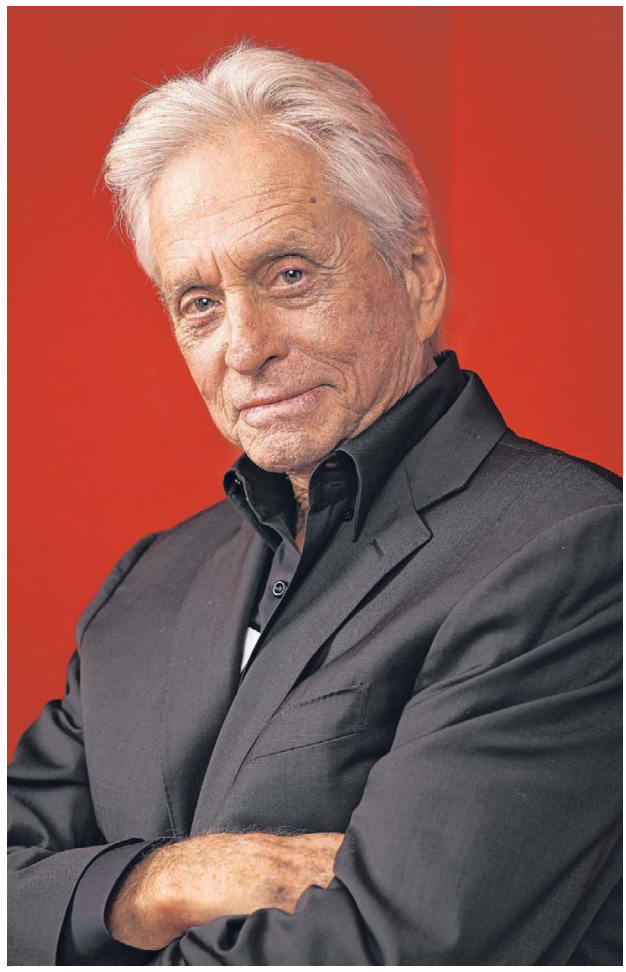
When I was 11, Mom signed a film contract, and we lived in a West Hollywood rental. Once her contract was up in 1956, we were back in New York. She married Bill Darrid, a writer-producer, and we moved into a farmhouse in Westport, Conn. I finally had a father who listened to me.

UC Santa Barbara was a coed setting after all-boys boarding schools. I ran wild as a freshman, and the college asked me to take a year off. In Westport, Bill got me a gas-station job. I won "Mobil Man of the Month." Dad asked, "Are you going to work in a gas station your entire life?" His implied disappointment motivated me to return to UCSB.

By junior year, I was a drama major. Dad saw me in "A Midsummer Night's Dream." I had stage fright and rushed my lines. After, he said I was "absolutely terrible."

That was rough, but I could either be a quitter or overcome my shyness. After graduation in 1968, I moved to New York and studied with Wynn Handman, co-founder of the American Place Theatre. Wynn knew my family and said, "Want me to tell your mom how good you are?" That was my earliest positive feedback.

I landed off-Broadway roles and then was cast in a string of TV shows. First was the CBS Playhouse's "The Experiment" in 1969. "The F.B.I." in 1970 was next, leading to "Medical Center" in '71 and "The Streets of San Francisco" in '72, which put me on the map.



Michael Douglas in 2024. At left, Douglas, right, around 1947, with his father, actor Kirk Douglas, mother Diana and younger brother Joel.

Dad realized I'd arrived when I produced the 1975 film "One Flew Over the Cuckoo's Nest." He owned the rights and passed it to me. Getting it made the way I did impressed him. It wasn't until "Fatal Attraction" and "Wall Street," both in '87, that I stepped out of Dad's shadow. He said, "Michael, you're a better actor than I ever was."

Today, my wife, actress Catherine Zeta-Jones, and I divide our time between homes in New York and Spain's Mallorca island, overlooking the Mediterranean. Our Mallorca house dates to 1867 and sits on 190 acres. We love being surrounded by nature.

My most treasured possession belonging to Dad are his movie scripts, leather-bound. I love reading his handwritten notes. It's like hearing him think.

—As told to Marc Myers

Michael Douglas, 82, is an Oscar- and Emmy-winning actor known for the films "Wall Street" and "Fatal Attraction." He is the author of "One Helluva Ride" (Grand Central), a memoir.

MICHAEL'S PERCH

What's your favorite home spot? Reading in my fuchsia armchair next to an open window facing the sea.

What about exercise? A daily workout, and hitting golf balls on my Trackman video setup in the wine cellar.

Is there a movie room? Yes. My Trackman doubles as a home theater.

What was your earliest on-set goof? I was in Dad's sightline just as he was about to kiss Lana Turner while shooting the 1952 film "The Bad and the Beautiful." They yelled, "Cut!"

FROM LEFT: EVERETT COLLECTION; TRISTAN FEWINGS/GETTY IMAGES

UNDER $1 MILLION

Tips For Building On a Budget

The homeowners in our recent series used these strategies to build custom homes

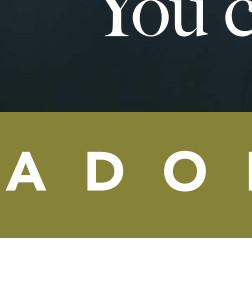
By Nancy Keates

As a real-estate reporter for The Wall Street Journal, I've walked through thousands of beautiful homes custom-designed by top architects. Because these homes usually cost millions of dollars to build, most people don't get a chance to live in such an environment, especially now that the price of land, labor and materials are sky-high.

That's why I was intrigued by a conversation I had a couple of months ago with a top-notch architect in Raleigh, N.C., about a house his firm had recently designed for around $700,000—not an insignificant price, but much lower than their other projects.

The conversation turned into a four-part series on custom, architect-designed homes that were built for under $1 million. While each of the projects we featured was very different, with unique solutions for staying on budget, I noticed that there were a few strategies they all shared. Here are a few that stood out.

Ditch the garage
None of the houses we featured ended up with a garage, even though it was something the clients had asked for. Ultimately, they all concluded that they could park elsewhere and get adequate storage space in other ways, such as a shed. This can be a tough sell, since Americans tend to be die-hard garage lovers, but it saved tens of thousands of dollars and allowed for more square footage in the house.



Caryn Buck in the kitchen of her newly built home.

The Falconers' house, at left, was built on a flat area.

FROM TOP: JAKE PARRISH FOR WSJ; ERIK JOHNSON FOR WSJ

Be flexible on materials
It's usually possible to swap in lower-priced materials and finishes to achieve a similar look as higher-priced ones. For example, fiber cement siding can give the appearance of wood siding, but at a lower price. A sliding glass door instead of a folding accordion door saves both money and space.

Choose the lot carefully
Choosing a flat lot helps keep site construction costs down; buying property with an existing house instead of vacant land can save time and reduce surprises when it comes to permitting.

Do some of the work yourself
There are areas where getting your hands dirty can significantly lower costs: buying your own appliances, doing your own landscaping and painting, or even taking on some electrical work.

Trust the architect
Architects said one of the big reasons they can design cost-efficient homes for themselves is that no one argues with them over every decision. Clients who were successful at staying below $1 million gave their architects a list of features they wanted, then stepped back. This often allows for simpler structures with standard-sized components and less customization of materials. But clients should make sure their architects alert them when anything is in danger of going over budget.

HOMES

Even Millionaires Are Struggling to Pay For Custom Furniture

Thanks to rising labor costs, President Trump's tariffs and delayed shipping, custom pieces have ballooned in price and taken longer to arrive

By Ben Kesslen

Tech entrepreneur Jeremy Redman didn't know how he could pay for his kitchen gut renovation on time without selling his company.

Last year, Jeremy and his wife, corporate controller Holly Redman, purchased their Midcentury home in Los Angeles with a plan to redo their kitchen, which felt cheap and dated.

They started with a $60,000 budget. But after working with California-based designer Paige Wassel of WAS Studios on a custom redesign plan for the kitchen, dining area, an attached laundry room and entryway—which included all-new cabinetry, a bespoke banquette, slate floors and green soapstone counters—the cost swelled to roughly $180,000.

As bills piled up, it lit a fire under Jeremy. "I don't know how we could have afforded to pay these last two invoices had it not been for selling the company," he said.

The renovation was finished in November, and he completed the sale of TaskMagic, an artificial-intelligence browser tool, in December. All told, the Redmans love their kitchen and don't regret it.

Still, Jeremy said, "We were the frog that got slowly boiled."

Since the pandemic, rising labor costs, fluctuating tariffs and the shipping delays that followed, plus the gridlock in the Strait of Hormuz, have made custom furniture more expensive and difficult to procure. The increases are so significant that even affluent people—who may typically have six-figure budgets for a single room—are eschewing custom pieces and getting creative with their furnishings instead.

"It is a unique sort of perfect-storm circumstance for custom-furniture builders," said Jackson Wood, a vice president of trade regulations at logistics software company Descartes.

Even U.S.-made furniture often relies on fabric, fasteners, frame pieces, wood and metal from abroad—typically from heavily tariffed regions like East and Southeast Asia, said Wood. To offset costs, big players like IKEA can distribute premiums across a slew of products to avoid substantial increases. But someone like Alex Segal, co-founder of Los Angeles-based custom-furniture maker Croft House, can't.

Since 2019, Croft House has paid an extra 47% for cabinet hinges, 105% for brass handles and 124% for metal handles, Segal said. Steel has shot up so much that he had to significantly raise the price of furniture made with it. But labor, which he said has increased significantly in the past decade,

How a Custom Renovation Project Ballooned from $60,000 to $180,000

Jeremy and Holly Redman's budget for their custom redesign went from $60,000 to $180,000 over the course of four months. While they splurged on some areas, they also made budget-conscious choices in others. Here's a look at some of those features.

1. CABINETS

Expected cost: $7,000
Actual cost: $44,200
A real-estate agent initally recommended IKEA cabinets to the Redmans. They opted to go custom plywood with designer Paige Wassel of WAS Studios instead, and were surprised when the total came in—more than two-thirds of their entire kitchen budget.

2. WINDOW AND REFRIGERATOR WRAPPINGS

Expected cost: $0
Actual cost: $5,350
Once the Redmans went custom, it was difficult to say no to additional flourishes, like draping wood around the windows ($2,150) and refrigerator ($3,200). The woodworker, Geoff Owens, was local, so adding the wrappings didn't hold up the project.

3. BANQUETTE AND DINING CHAIRS

Expected cost: $5,000
Actual cost: $11,690
When the Redmans walked through the kitchen, a banquette immediately came to mind. Wassel then sourced a custom cushion for $680 and had chairs the couple already owned reupholstered for $435.

4. COUNTER STOOLS

Expected Cost: $2,000 ($1,000 each)
Actual Cost: $900 ($450 each)
Instead of buying entirely custom stools, Wassel thrifted them for $60. She then had them reupholstered with fabric sourced in Los Angeles to match the kitchen's color scheme.

CARA TOTMAN

MANSION

has had the biggest impact on Croft House's bottom line. "Our markups didn't increase proportionally to the increase of our costs," Segal said.

While redesigning the living room and primary bedroom in artist Claudia Doring Baez and financier Alejandro Baez Sacasa's Tribeca penthouse in 2023, architect and designer Crina Arghirescu Rogard was able to source, design and commission custom furniture in just six weeks—in time for a party Doring Baez was throwing. They spent $80,000 on custom furniture for the living room and bedroom, and another $40,000 on rugs.

Now, three years later, Arghirescu Rogard is designing a work-and-painting studio for Doring Baez's podcast in the same building. The $400,000 project is proving more complicated and taking longer than expected.

"The price of shipping went up; delays with shipping went up," said Arghirescu Rogard. She designed a custom table, chairs and daybeds that are being produced in Romania, where costs are about two-thirds less than the U.S.—and will be about $17,000.

Tariffs have forced Croft House to raise prices on its steel furnishings, like this bookshelf that retails for more than $8,000.

But Arghirescu Rogard and Doring Baez didn't know how long the furniture would take to arrive, nor what the taxes would be even after placing their order. "If you're a freshly married couple and you want your house decorated tomorrow, you have to go to West Elm," Doring Baez said. "And unless you take the floor model, you have to wait there, too."

Amid elevated prices, users on Furniture.com, an online furniture marketplace, are increasingly using the site's artificial-intelligence tool to find less expensive dupes of custom pieces, said Dan Bennett, the company's co-founder and chief marketing officer. "We're seeing very descriptive semantic searches that are clearly based on these folks having been exposed to or having seen a more expensive or custom piece of furniture," he said.

Katie Fuqua, an interior designer based in New York, custom-designed the home of Arielle Aurrichio, a product manager based in Wilmington, N.C. Aurrichio originally wanted oak bookshelves for her office when she began the project last year, but thanks to tariffs, wildfires and closing sawmills, the price of lumber skyrocketed. The custom, built-in shelves were going to cost around $12,000.

Arielle Aurrichio went with a less-expensive option for her built-in shelves.

"I didn't have a super strict budget," Aurrichio said, "but I was trying to be frugal when possible."

To save money, she opted for cheaper wood—a mix of pine and a composite material—and painted the custom unit the same shade of pink as the wall. "I was pretty scared to color-drench," Aurrichio said, "but it was obviously the right choice." And the fix knocked about $4,000 off.

Wassel, the designer, said she has recently noticed a wave of homeowners who fall in the middle: They have a good sum to spend and don't want "fast furniture" from brands like Wayfair and CB2, but they also don't have the budget for all custom.

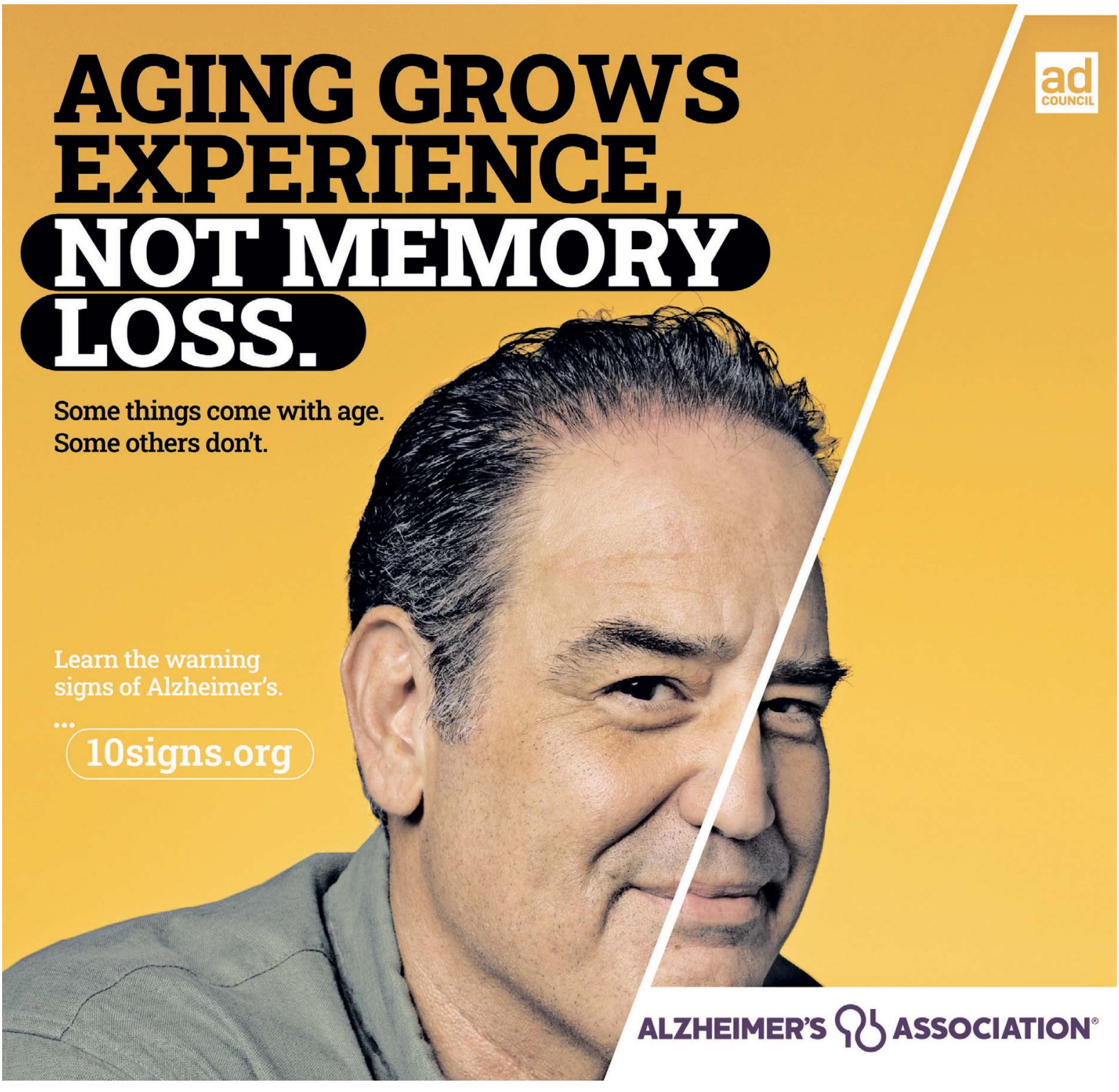
For the Redmans' kitchen, Wassel thrifted some lights and the counter stools to save money. And for the dining table, she did a combination of custom and vintage.

Wassel took the base of an old Herman Miller table she found on Facebook Marketplace, had it redone with a powder coating and commissioned a local craftsman to make a new tabletop—adding up to roughly $3,000.

The result was more cost-effective than buying a new table. And by then, the budget had already ballooned enough that a few grand felt negligible, Jeremy said. "If we're going to spend $60,000 on the cabinets and banquette, do I want to ruin it with a s—y little table?"

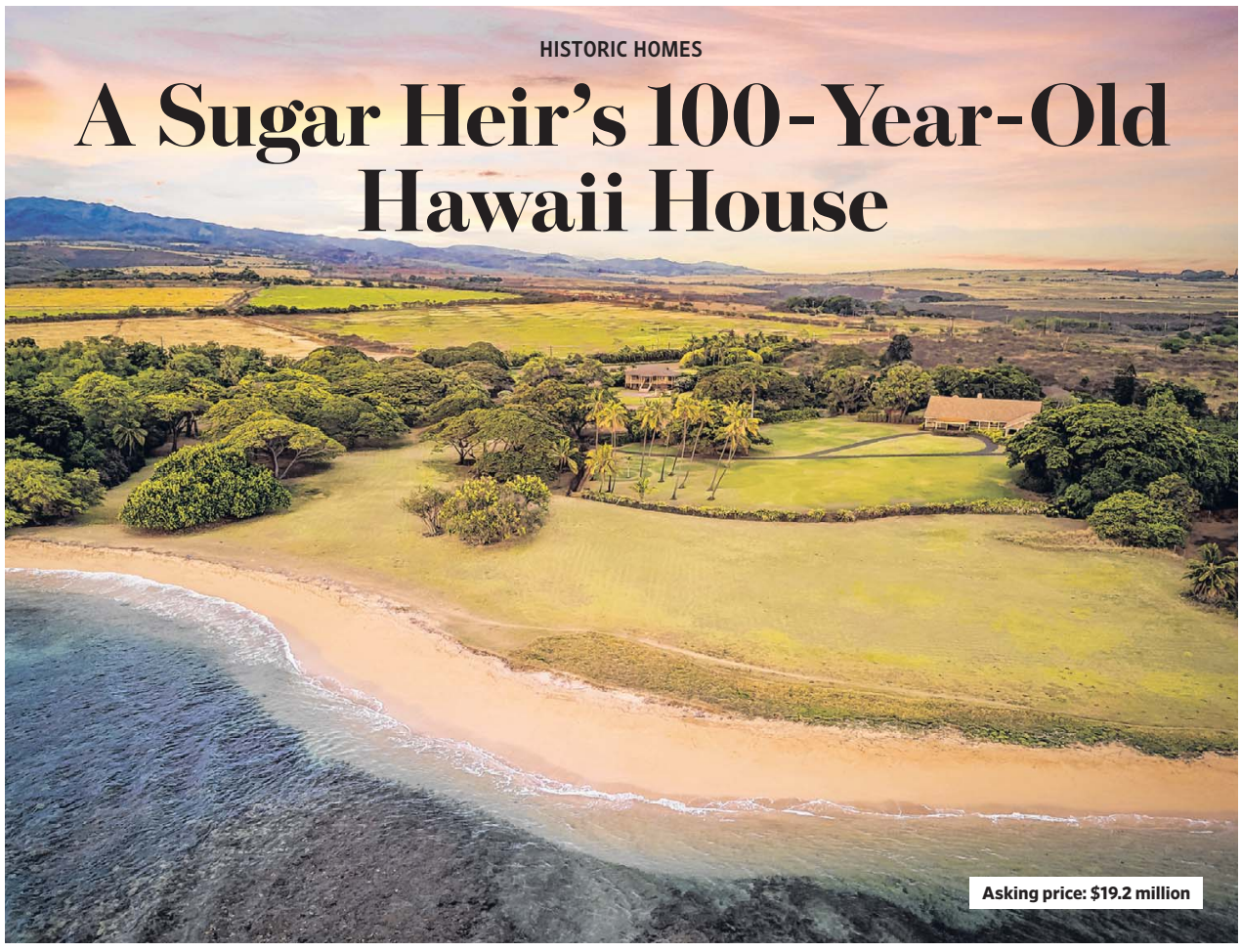
CLOCKWISE FROM TOP LEFT GIGI ALY; ALLISON BREINER POTTER ARNAUD MONTAGARD

Claudia Doring Baez and Alejandro Baez Sacasa's living room, above, which was designed by Crina Arghirescu Rogard. At right, Doring Baez and Baez Sacasa's bedroom.



HISTORIC HOMES

A Sugar Heir's 100-Year-Old Hawaii House



In the 1910s, Sinclair Robinson settled in a simple Kauai home to manage his family's sugar plantation

By Sarah Paynter

On Kauai's southwestern coast, Sinclair Robinson's family owned a sprawling sugar plantation and several homes. The Robinsons, originally from Scotland, came to the island in the 1860s, buying tens of thousands of acres for cattle ranching, according to Chris Cook, author of "Kaua'i: A History."

The Robinsons, who were among the region's largest landowning families, joined Hawaii's growing sugar industry around the 1880s. Yet when Sinclair took over the operation in the 1910s, he chose a smaller home for its views of Niihau and the sunset, according to his grandson, Philip Sinclair Keat.

As Sinclair's own family grew, he expanded the house while preserving its simplicity. "My grandparents were somewhat austere, so they weren't looking to do all kinds of design work," Philip says.

The history

Built for a field boss around 1912, Sinclair's home sat on his family's land in the village of Pākalā. He claimed the house in 1914, and in 1917, he married his wife, Ethel Robinson, according to Philip.

Clockwise from left: The Robinson family pictured at one of their homes around 1893; a sitting area; the single-story house has deep eaves; and the house on Kauai's southwestern coast has four bedrooms.

Sinclair started his day managing the plantation to the sound of a 4:30 a.m. mill whistle. When they weren't working, the teetotaling Robinsons sometimes hosted parties where they served punch in crystal bowls on the porch, Philip says. The property included a vegetable garden, strawberry plants and mango and fig trees. They also raised chickens for fresh eggs and kept cows for milk and cheese.

"The only thing I remember that he couldn't make was Wheaties—my grandfather loved his Wheaties," Philip says. Because of the time and expense of procuring groceries from the mainland, Sinclair bought Wheaties in bulk and, as they got stale, crisped them in the oven.

Sinclair managed the plantation and lived in the house until his death in 1964. After his wife's death in 1966, their daughter Marion Keat bought out her siblings, paying about $42,000 for the home, according to Philip, her son.

After Marion died in 2000, the house passed to Philip and his brother, Jack Keat. The Robinson family stopped operating the sugar plantation in the 2000s, but they still own about 100,000 acres—keeping them among Hawaii's largest landowning families, according to Cook.

Modern day

The Keats offer Sinclair's home as a vacation rental to pay for its upkeep, Philip says. He and his wife still visit to watch the waves from the front porch, and Jack hosted his son's wedding on the property about 10 years ago.

The house, which is being sold as-is, "needs some work," says Philip.

Historic details

The house was finished using a sand-painting technique popular during the era, Cook says. After applying paint to the wooden exterior, workers threw sifted sand on it. The combination of sand and paint provided greater durability against the sun and salt air, says Philip, who repeated this method when repainting the house.

In the butler's pantry, there is a roughly 6-foot-tall steel safe, which is included in the sale. Sinclair used it to store important papers and money to pay workers and ranch hands, says Philip.

Best part of owning a historic house

"You walk through and you can feel the history," Philip says. "We've had people say, 'I can feel your ancestors here.' "

Hardest part of owning a historic house

"Historic generally means old," Philip says. "Old houses need a lot of attention."

Reason for selling?

"We're getting older, so while we love it, we don't want to deal with it anymore," says Philip, who is 78. This house will be one of the first to leave the family since his ancestors arrived in the 1860s, he says.

Market snapshot

The house is priced to reflect its historic significance, along with its location on the shore of a famous left-hand surf, says listing agent Neal Norman of Hawaii Life. Norman says that while the buyer will likely modernize the interior, he expects the exterior to be preserved.

The median sale price on Kauai was $3.8 million in the first half of 2026, down 7% from the same time last year, according to Hawaii Life. A beachfront estate on Kauai's north end sold for $16 million in February.

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP: PATRICK KELLEY; ROBINSON FAMILY

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A Slopeside Townhouse in Aspen

Shutterstock founder Jonathan Oringer and his wife, Talia Oringer, have listed a slopeside townhouse in the ski destination of Aspen, Colo., for $49 million.

The Oringers bought the house on Aspen Mountain for $25.5 million in 2021 from Daniel L. Hunt, whose family owns the Kansas City Chiefs, property records show. They are listing the house because they want to "expose their children to skiing around the world," Jonathan said in a statement. "We'll be back."

FOR SALE
$49 MILLION
6,600 sq. ft., 4 bedrooms, elevator, 2 terraces, hot tub

MICHAEL BRANDS/MOUNTAIN HOME

Jonathan founded Shutterstock in 2003. This summer, a $3.7 billion merger with Getty Images was called off.

The Oringers live primarily in Miami Beach, Fla. Last year, they sold an oceanfront home in New York's Hamptons for $57 million.

Built in 2004, the roughly 6,600-square-foot Aspen townhouse has four bedrooms, said listing agent Steven Shane of Compass. It is being sold furnished.

Aspen's housing market slowed during the first part of the year after its lowest level of snowfall in decades. Shane said sales picked up in the third quarter, which had an average sale price of $11.6 million, up from $8.1 million during the third quarter of 2025.

While some have speculated that upcoming construction at the Aspen/Pitkin County Airport could hurt the real-estate market, Shane said he thinks the impact will be minimal. "It's not a concern of mine," he said.

—E.B. Solomont

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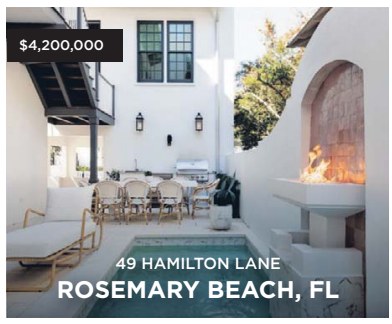
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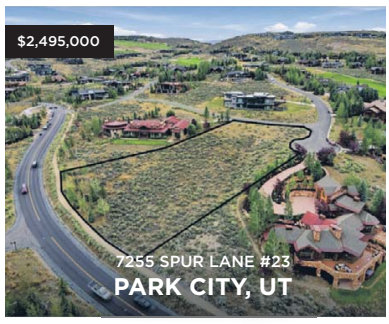
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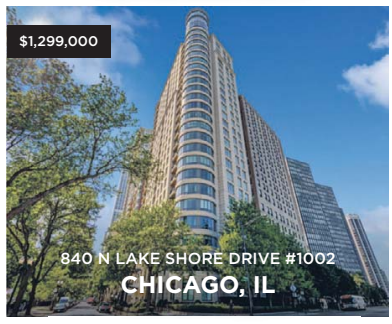
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